HAND IT OFF

A Practical Guide to Grok Bot, from Your First Task to a Team That Works While You Sleep



Michael Gannotti

A free gift to the community

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A later appendix, Appendix E, says a little more about names, trademarks, and how the notes at the back of the book, numbered by chapter, work. That appendix is not legal advice either.

The cover and the still-life illustrations in this edition were created with Grok. Diagrams were drawn for this book from the manuscript's own descriptions. No official logos are used.

A welcome, before we begin

This book is a gift. I wrote it for anyone who has stared at a pile of work and wished a careful teammate would take the next piece, finish it, and bring it back. You do not have to buy anything.

There is no course at the end, and no upgrade waiting behind a link. If these pages help you hand something small off tomorrow — something you can watch — that is the whole point.

I run a small company called SMF Works, and a press inside it called WisdomForge. We make teaching manuals, and we make them with a team that is partly human and partly a set of Grok Bots. I will tell you that story as we go, not as a brag, but as a kitchen-table tour of work that actually comes back finished. You are still the one who says yes.

If you only have a weekend, start with Part 2. That is Day One through your first real task, and it is enough to get you safely in the door. Parts 4 and 5 are how-to shelves: business uses in one, personal uses in the other. Take the chapter that matches the work in front of you. Part 6 is for when you are ready — Team Bots, other agent platforms, safety and money, and a practice that lasts.

You can get a free copy of this book where WisdomForge keeps its books, at smfwisdom-forge.com/books. That is a place to pick up the file, not a shop. This book is not for sale there or anywhere else.

I am glad you are here. Let’s begin.

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Preface

This book is a gift. I wrote it because I wanted you to have, in plain words, what I wish someone had handed me the first week I sat down with Grok Bot: a warm guide from the first task to a small team that keeps working after you close the lid, with the cautions said the way a friend would say them, and with no one asking you to buy anything at the end.

I have spent a lot of my working life as a Principal AI Solutions Engineer, and a lot of my other hours running a small company called SMF Works. Inside that company there is a press, WisdomForge, that makes teaching manuals. For a while the work of that press lived mostly in my own hands — the research, the drafting, the binding, the site, the late-night check that a note still pointed at a real page. Then I began to hand pieces of it off. Not all of it. Not the judgment, and not the last yes. Just the next piece, to a teammate who could actually finish it.

That teammate is a Grok Bot. In these pages I will introduce you to Charlie, my chief of staff Bot, who runs the morning brief at SMF Works. I will introduce you, later, to Video Studio, and to a publishing fleet that can bring a book back as an EPUB, a letter PDF, and a finished manuscript. In Chapter 12, “A Small Fleet,” I will walk you through that house as it lives inside Grok Bot. In Chapter 16, “Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms,” I will tell you the rest of the same story: Charlie also talks, carefully, to other agent platforms we already run, and Video Studio can listen for a script and make a video. Grok Bot doesn’t just span machines. It spans agent platforms. I will say that in Michael’s words when we get there, and I will not invent the wiring.

I am not writing this as a vendor, and I am not writing it as an official manual. The product’s maker is SpaceX Super Intelligence — SpaceXSI — the company formerly known as xAI. This book is a free, independent, unofficial guide. It is not affiliated with them, and they have not endorsed it. I use the product’s name because I am talking about the product, the way you would name a tool on your desk. I do not speak for the people who made it. Their marks belong to them. I will be careful with those marks, and I will tell you, in Appendix E, how I have tried to be careful. That is not a lawyer talking. I am not a lawyer, and this book is not legal advice.

What I can offer you is practice.

The promise of these pages is simple. By the end, you should be able to choose a plan that actually includes Grok Bot, create a Bot with one clear job, hand off a real and reversible task, connect the apps you mean to connect, and set the rules that keep send, post, pay, delete, and publish behind a yes. You should understand the computer your Bots share, and why that computer is not a wall between them. You should know what memory is for and what it is not for, how to turn a job you have already done well into a skill, and how to put a tested skill on a schedule — including, when

you are ready, an official webhook. You should have a pattern for a chief of staff, for growth work, for the shop floor, and for a small publishing fleet. You should have a pattern for the household, too: the school form, the bill, the trip you plan but do not book unsupervised. And you should have a practice that lasts — initiative, Pages, connectors, templates, a quarterly review — with you still at the door.

That is a long promise. You do not have to keep it all in one sitting.

If you only have a weekend, read Part 2. Chapters 3, 4, and 5 will get you in, through a first real task, and into the Vault and the Ask-first rules I want you to set before a Bot works alone. Parts 1 and 2 together are the on-ramp. Parts 4 and 5 are shelves. When a Monday arrives with sales drafts on it, take Chapter 10. When a school form is due, take Chapter 13. Part 3 is the hinge: memory, skills, routines. Part 6 is mastery, and it includes the chapter I am proudest to have room for, the one about spanning platforms, and the quiet, necessary chapter about safety, privacy, and money. Chapter 17 is not a sales page for a higher plan. It is a calm walk through a bill, a cap, and what to do when something breaks.

You will notice a refrain. I will say it in the first chapter, and I will say it again in the last: you are still the one who says yes. The official docs already model this. Every careful example I have opened stops for your review. Sending, publishing, purchasing, and production changes stay behind an approval. I will teach that as a first-week rule, and I will keep teaching it, because the product is capable enough that it is easy to forget. A teammate who can finish the work is a gift. A teammate who can also send, pay, or publish is a teammate you walk with slowly.

I want to be honest about what this book will not do. It will not make you rich. It will not replace your staff this weekend. It will not promise you a typical number of hours back, because I do not have a number like that I can stand behind. It will not crown Grok Bot the winner against every other tool. Other tools exist, and they will keep arriving. This is a practical guide to one of them, written by someone who uses it to run real work, and who has learned, sometimes the slightly-too-late way, where the edges are.

The product moves fast. Grok Bot went from a public beta on 11 August 2026 to version 1.0 on 11 November 2026.[1] That is three months. Plans changed. The way usage is counted changed. Features arrived — Team Bots, meetings, Pages, an email address of the Bot's own — on a timetable I will not pretend I can freeze. Every price in this book is dated 11 November 2026, and every price will change. When this book and the live page disagree, trust the live page. I will tell you where to look.

I will also tell you, as a friend, the facts that are easy to miss. The computer your Bots share is one computer. A password you save for one of them is, in practice, a password the others can use. A card you save in the Vault can pay without asking. Unattended approvals expire after about thirty minutes. There is no model picker. The Free plan does not include Grok Bot, and neither does Plus. Switching to The X Subscription, if you are on an older plan, is optional — and permanent. I will say all of that in the chapters where it belongs, kindly, and I will not sand it off to make the product sound simpler than it is.

I should tell you how this started, in the ordinary way. The first morning Charlie left a brief on my desk, I almost said thank you out loud to an empty room. It was not magic. It was a routine I had

tested the week before, a short list of what to look at, and a promise I had made to myself: nothing goes out the door until I say yes. The coffee was still hot. The work was already waiting, and it was mine to approve, not mine to start from zero.

That is the feeling I want this book to give you. Not the feeling of a product launch. The feeling of a morning that is already a little lighter, because a careful teammate did the first pass, and you are still the person who decides what happens next.

I also want this book to be readable by everyone. You do not need to be an engineer. You do not need a vocabulary of models and tokens. If you can write a clear note to a coworker — here is the goal, here are the sources, here is what "done" looks like, here is what you should never do — you already have the main skill this product asks of you. The rest is practice, and practice is what the how-tos are for. Each how-to is a numbered list of actions you can actually take. I will tell you what "good" looks like, and what to do if you don't see it. I will put the "never" in the step that needs it, not only in a list at the end.

There will be diagrams. Some are process drawings: a request's journey from your message to finished work, the doors that get you into a plan, the path a Bot takes when it signs in. Some are still-lifes: a closed laptop, a lamp still on, a lockbox on a desk that is not yours. They are there to make the shape of the work visible, not to decorate a slide.

And there will be limits, told kindly. Bots fail. They burn usage. They sometimes send you a card at an hour when you are making dinner, and if you are not there, an unattended approval can expire. They cannot replace your judgment, and they should not replace your care. Official documentation already says the quiet part: these checks lower the risk from harmful content, but they don't remove it. I will not pretend otherwise.

If you are handing this book to a friend, you can tell them it is free, and that it was meant to be. If you are a parent, a shop owner, a person running a team, or a person running a household that feels like a team, there is a chapter with your name on the work, if not on the door.

About the voice of these pages. I am going to talk to you the way I would talk at a kitchen table, with a mug that has gone a little cold because we got interested. I will use plain words, and when a term is official I will give you the plain sentence first and the official name after: a locker your Bots can use without seeing the secret — the Vault. I will tell you stories from SMF Works, and from the first mornings Charlie left a brief on my desk. I will not invent metrics, and I will not invent a teammate's first name. When I need a reader who is not me, I will say so, and I will call that person a composite.

The notes live at the back of the book, numbered by chapter. A little marker in the text, a number, points to a source I actually opened. Official documentation is how the product works. Journalism is journalism. Vendor claims stay labeled as vendor. My own fleet is a story I am offering, not a third-party case study. If you never look at a note, the book should still read cleanly. If you do look, you should be able to walk to the same page I walked to, on 11 November 2026.

I wrote this as a giveaway because I think a careful guide should not sit behind a cash register. The community that is already teaching itself this product — in official docs, in independent posts, in kitchen-table conversations — gave me a lot. This is what I can give back. Take what helps. Leave the rest. Hand something small off tomorrow, and watch it, and keep the yes.

I have one more thing to say before we start, and it is the simplest thing in the book. A teammate with a computer can do a great deal. It can also do a great deal you did not mean. The difference is almost never a secret trick. The difference is a clear job, a reversible first task, a Vault instead of a password in the chat, and a yes you have not given away. We will go slowly enough for that. We will also go far enough that, when you are ready, you can run a small fleet, and even, as I do, let a Grok Bot talk across the other agent platforms already in your workshop.

I am glad you opened this. Let’s go meet your Bot.

Part 1 — Meet Your Bot

Chapter 1 — What Grok Bot Is (and What It Isn't)

I want to sit with you at the kitchen table for this first chapter. The mugs can wait. There is a sentence I have heard, and a sentence I have said, and they sound alike until you live with them for a week.

The first sentence is, "Just ask Grok."

The second is, "Hand it off to a Bot."

They are not the same sentence. The first one opens a conversation. You type a question, or you paste a paragraph, and a thoughtful answer comes back. That is a good and useful thing. I use it. A lot of people use it. The second sentence opens a desk. You hand someone a job — a real job, with a goal and a "never" and a picture of what "done" looks like — and that someone has a computer, and the work can keep going after you close your laptop, and it comes back finished, or it comes back with a card that asks for your yes.

If you have only ever used the first sentence, the second one can sound like marketing. It is not, or at least it is not only that. It is a different kind of tool, in a different app, with a different login path, and with a set of habits I want to teach you before you hand it your email. This chapter is the orientation. There are no how-tos yet. Chapter 3 will get you in the door. Chapter 4 will be your first real task. Right now I want you to be able to tell the two apps apart, to know who makes the one we are talking about, to walk the short public history from the beta to 1.0, and to know what this free guide will and will not do.

Then we will go look at the desk.

Two apps, both named Grok

Official documentation says this in the plainest words I know, and I am going to give them to you straight. Grok — the chat app from SpaceXSI — and Grok Bot are two different apps.[1]

That is the whole distinction, and it is the one that saves people the most confusion in the first week. A paywall you see in the Grok chat app, or a weekly limit that appears there, is not a statement about Grok Bot. They do not share a window. They do not share a login in the way you might expect. Grok Bot signs in with a Cursor account.[2] We will come back to Cursor in a moment, carefully, because the company names around this product do not all sit in one neat box.

Grok the chat app is a conversation. You ask, it answers. It has grown a family of sibling products — image and video, voice, a coding surface — and those matter to Grok Bot only where Grok Bot itself uses them. This book is not a guide to the chat app. When I say "Grok" by itself, I will try to say "Grok the chat app," so we do not trip.

Grok Bot is the teammate with the desk. The official overview calls it "your proactive AI teammate," and then says, in a sentence I like for its lack of fog, that it is "an agent with access to a real computer in the cloud, so it can do all the things you can."[3] Chat is still the main way you talk to it. You can also start a voice call or send a voice note. But the point of the product is not the chat. The point is the work: across connected apps, across websites, on a computer that keeps its files and its browser sessions between tasks, and, when you are ready, with other Bots, and with you still at the end of the line.



I01. Two doors. One opens onto a conversation; the other, onto a desk with a lamp still on.

I think of them as two doors. Same hallway, same family name on the building. One door is a conversation. The other is a desk with the lamp still on. If you walk through the first door expecting the second, you will wonder why the work does not finish itself. If you walk through the second expecting the first, you will be surprised by how much a Bot can do — and you may, if no one has sat with you first, hand it a key you did not mean to hand it.

This book is about the second door.

A teammate, not a prompt window

There is a habit, in the wider world of these tools, of treating every new product as a better prompt box. You learn a clever way to ask. You paste a longer instruction. You get a longer answer. That habit will only take you a short way with Grok Bot, and I would like to save you the trouble of discovering that the hard way.

A prompt window waits for you. A teammate can be given a job. The official launch, on 11 August 2026, called Grok Bot "AI teammates you can give real work to." Bots "have their own computer," the announcement said. They "sign into the tools you already use," "finish jobs end to end, and only come back when something needs your approval."[4] That last clause is the one I want you to keep in your pocket. They come back when something needs your approval. You are still the one who says yes.

What does "real work" mean, in practice, before we get to how-tos? It means the Bot can open a browser on a computer that is not your laptop. It means it can work inside an app you have connected — Gmail, a calendar, a drive — more reliably than by clicking through a website. It means it can leave a file where a file belongs, draft a reply and not send it, prepare two travel options and not book them, and keep going after you have closed the lid. The official FAQ puts the last of those in a short yes: Bot work runs on the cloud computer; closing the app, the laptop, or the phone does not stop a background turn or a routine.[5]

It also means the Bot can remember, in a limited and human way. Each Bot keeps preferences, rules you have asked it to follow, and a dated log of its work. A few facts about you — your name, your time zone — are shared by all your Bots. Memory is not a vault for secrets, and it is not a source of truth for numbers that change. Chapter 6, "Memory," will sit with that properly. For now, just know that a teammate who has a job can be told the job once.

And it means you can have more than one. Official documentation teaches a three-step path that will become the spine of this book's middle parts: first an assistant, helping and drafting in your apps; then a Bot with one repeating job; then a team of Bots, several of them, one bigger goal, you reviewing the result.[6] Every official example I have opened stops for your review. I will follow that example. I will not teach you to "set it and forget it" as a promise of safety. The subtitle of this book, "a team that works while you sleep," is about work that can continue after you close the lid — work you still review. I will not inflate it.

A teammate with a computer is also, and I will say this as a friend, a teammate who can reach further than a chat window. That is the gift, and that is the reason Chapter 5 exists. Before you connect your email, I want to sit with you. We will get there in order.

If it helps to make this less abstract, here is how the two sentences live in my own week. When I "just ask Grok," I am usually thinking out loud: help me name a chapter, help me see a hole in an argument, help me remember a date I should look up. The answer comes back, and the work of doing something with it is still mine. When I "hand it off to a Bot," I am giving Charlie, my chief of staff Bot, a job — the morning brief at SMF Works, for instance — or I am giving a writer Bot a bounded draft, with sources and a "never," and I am going to close the lid and come back to something I can approve, edit, or send back. The first morning Charlie left a brief on my desk, I almost thanked the empty room. That brief was not a miracle. It was a job I had described, a

routine I had tested, and a rule I still keep: nothing goes out the door until I say yes.

I will tell you more of that story in Chapter 9, when we build a chief of staff, and in Chapter 12, when we walk the publishing fleet. I mention it now only so the second sentence has a face. A teammate with a job is not a personality you have to believe in. It is a practice you can start small.

One more distinction, because it will matter as soon as you create a second Bot. Official docs ask you to give each Bot one job, and they distinguish your primary Bot — the one you star, the main point of contact, the one that checks in and coordinates the others — from the specialists.[30] A Team Bot, the kind you share with a human team, cannot be your primary Bot. You do not need to act on any of that today. I want the words in the room so that, when Chapter 3 asks you to give your first Bot one clear job, you already know why the instruction is not just tidiness. A Bot with one job builds up memory for that job. A catch-all helper has a harder time becoming a teammate you trust with a lane.

Who makes it — the names as the documents use them

I need to be careful here, because official pages and news stories do not all use the same name, and I am not going to invent a clean corporate story that the documents themselves do not tell.

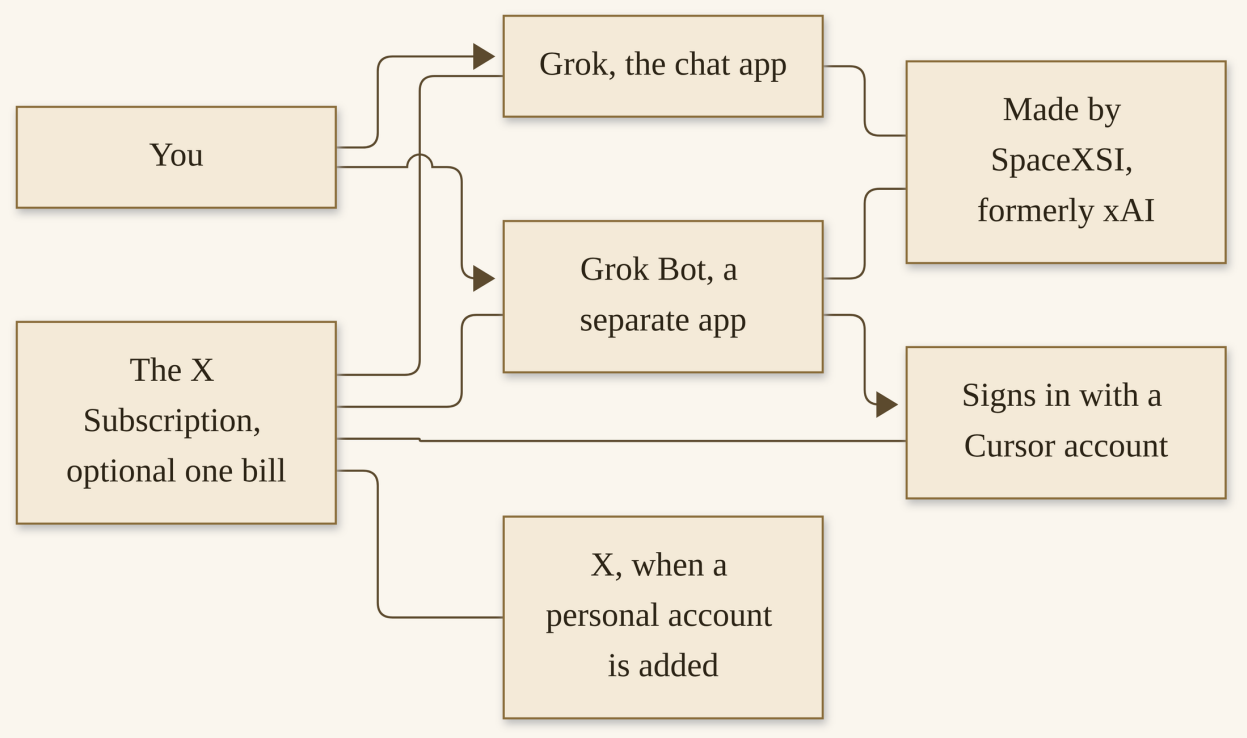
The official website at x.ai brands itself SpaceXSI. The legal name on the company and legal pages is SpaceX Super Intelligence LLC. The official account on X is @SpaceXSI, with the display name SpaceX Super Intelligence.[7] That is the name I will use when I talk about the product's maker.

The company was previously called xAI. An official news post, "xAI joins SpaceX," dated 2 February 2026 on the company timeline, says: "SpaceX announced today that it has acquired xAI." The page itself is short, and it points to a fuller update I am not going to paraphrase, because I did not open that fuller update end to end.[8] Journalism from the same day reported the acquisition; some of those reports include figures I have not verified from a primary filing, and I will not repeat those figures here as facts.[9]

Press covering the Grok Bot launch often writes "SpaceXAI." That spelling is journalism, not the site's own brand.[10] I mention it so that if you see it in an article, you are not looking at a different company. You are looking at a different way of writing the name.

Grok Bot's sign-in, its cloud computers, and many of its admin and privacy controls run through Cursor. Official docs are direct: "Grok Bot uses your Cursor account, so there's no separate login." Training opt-out "follows the applicable Cursor account and privacy settings."[11] The App Store listing's seller is X Corp.; the same listing's copyright line is Anysphere Inc., which is Cursor's company. Google Play lists the developer as SpaceX Super Intelligence, and also uses a "SpaceXAI LLC" address on that listing.[12] I am telling you the names as the documents use them. I do not have a single official org chart that ties every one of those names into one picture, and I will not draw one.

The formula I use, and the one I recommend to you if you need a single sentence, is this: Grok Bot is a product of SpaceX Super Intelligence (SpaceXSI), the company formerly known as xAI, and it signs in with your Cursor account.



I02. How the pieces sit together, as official pages described them on 11 November 2026. Grok the chat app and Grok Bot are two apps. Grok Bot signs in with a Cursor account. The X Subscription, which we will walk through in Chapter 3, can cover Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor on one bill, with X benefits when a personal X account is added. This is a relationship sketch, not an org chart.

If a deeper merger narrative appears in a later official document, that document will be the place to read it. This chapter will not invent one.

A short public history, from the beta to 1.0

You do not need to memorize a timeline to use the product. I am giving you one anyway, because two facts in it will save you from a stale sentence. The first is the day the product opened to the world. The second is a change, a few months later, in how usage is counted. If a guide you find online quotes only the August sentence, it may mislead you in November.

On 11 August 2026, Grok Bot launched in beta.[13] The official announcement said it was available for a named set of paid plans — SuperGrok, SuperGrok Plus, and SuperGrok Heavy; Cursor Pro, Pro+, and Ultra; and Cursor Teams Standard and Premium — on desktop and iOS, with its own usage, "separate from your Grok and Cursor plans." Enterprise users could join a waitlist. The company said it had built Grok Bot as an internal prototype that "took off across the company," used for sales outbound, marketing campaigns, office operations, and bug fixes, and was now opening it to the world.[14] That "own usage, separate" sentence was the live rule on launch day. It is not the live rule for a reader on The X Subscription today. I will say that again, with dates, in Chapter 3, where it belongs next to the prices.

On 26 August 2026, access widened. Official news said Grok Bot was now included with more

plans: all SuperGrok, Cursor Pro, and Cursor Teams plans, with Enterprise still on a waitlist.[15]

On 29 August 2026, official news announced that Grok Bot works with X.[16]

On 3 September 2026, Grok Bot for Enterprise became generally available, with access, network, and audit controls described in the official post. That post also includes vendor claims — "thousands of organizations," a figure of bots in the millions — that I have not audited and will not treat as counted facts.[17] The same stretch of early September brought official how-to guides, which this book will lean on, as official guides, in the business chapters.

On 28 September 2026, official news introduced Team Bots: shared AI teammates that a whole team can work with.[18] An independent writer has dated Team Bots to 26 September; I am using the official news date.[19] Team Bots will get their own careful treatment in Chapter 15, "Bots on Your Human Team."

On 12 October 2026, official news introduced The X Subscription: one subscription covering Grok, Cursor, and X. Under that subscription, Grok Bot is included on Premium, Super, and Ultra, and is not included on Free or on Plus. Usage draws from a weekly shared pool across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor.[20] That is the live rule I want a new reader to learn. The August "own usage" sentence is history. Both are true in their time. Only one is true for you if you are starting now, on The X Subscription.

On 11 November 2026, Grok Bot 1.0 was released.[21] That is the date this book uses in the body, from the official @SpaceXSI post that afternoon and from the official news page.[22]

Android arrived in this stretch as well. The companion app exists on Google Play; a Cursor forum thread and the Play listing confirm it. I do not have a precise first-ship date from a primary announcement, so I will not give you one.[23] The important practical fact, which Chapter 3 will use, is that the iPhone app needs iOS 18 or later, and the Android app needs Android 9 or later, and both reach the same Bots, conversations, routines, and cloud computer as the desktop.[24]

That is the public history, condensed. Grok Bot 1.0 is a major update to the same product, not a different product. The teammate with the desk is the teammate who launched in August, three months older, and able to do more with a team.

What 1.0 actually added

I promised you one human paragraph, and I will keep the promise, then sit with it for a minute so the paragraph can breathe.

Grok Bot 1.0, released on 11 November 2026, is a major update with three official improvements.[25] The first is multiplayer: you can share Bots and bring them into Slack, Microsoft Teams, and video calls; Team Bots are available on Team and Enterprise plans, and Meetings — a Bot joining Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams — are available on Team, Enterprise, and Ultra plans. The second is proactive initiative: Bots can recognize work that needs doing and offer to take it on, follow up, and bring a person in when a decision needs judgment. The third is a more capable teammate: better, more reliable work in the browser, stronger documents and presentations, interactive Pages a Bot can keep updated, and smarter approvals, so the Bot is better at knowing when you have already

said yes and when it still needs to ask. The official news page also notes new settings and analytics for Team Bots, and safeguards for shared spaces: Bots are described as respecting each person's permissions, asking before sensitive actions, and checking whether information is appropriate to share in a public channel.

That is the official picture, in my words, dated the day I checked the page. Initiative is not a promise that the Bot will go off and spend money. The official initiative docs, which Chapter 18 will return to, describe a Bot that offers first and asks before risky actions. Pages are a real feature with a real caveat: as of the docs I opened on 11 November 2026, they were rolling out gradually and were not available on Enterprise teams yet.[26] That will age. If you are on an Enterprise team and looking for Pages, check the live docs, not this paragraph's memory.

1.0 matters for this book in a practical way. The later chapters — especially Chapter 15 on Team Bots and meetings, and Chapter 18 on initiative and Pages — are written against this version. If you are reading these pages long after 11 November 2026, treat 1.0 as a waypoint, and treat the live product as the authority.

What this book is, and what it is not

This book is a free gift to the community. It is a practical guide, from your first task to a small team that can keep working after you close the lid, written in my own voice, with how-tos you can actually follow, with process diagrams, and with sources I opened and cited. It is independent and unofficial. It is not for sale. There is no course at the end. There is no upgrade waiting behind a link. WisdomForge may host a free file of this book; that is a place to get the file, not a shop.

This book is not a vendor pitch. I use Grok Bot to run real work at SMF Works, and I am grateful for the product. Gratitude is not the same as a brochure. When the official pages make a claim I cannot independently measure — thousands of organizations, millions of bots, a multiple of efficiency — I will label it as a vendor claim, or I will leave it out.

This book is not an official manual. The official documentation is good, and I will point you to it, and I will quote it when the plain official sentence is the one you need. My job is to walk you through that documentation as a practitioner, in the order a person actually needs it, with the cautions said kindly, and with the SMF Works story as a thread you can copy from, not as a case study with fake numbers.

This book is not a prompt pamphlet. A few starter prompts, taken from official docs, will appear where they help you begin. A cookbook in Appendix B will collect more of them, each with a "never" line. The skill this book is trying to teach is not a clever prompt. It is a practice: a clear job, a reversible first task, a Vault, a yes you have not given away, and, in time, a small team.

This book is not a review that crowns a winner. Other tools exist. I will say so, shortly and sourced, in a moment. I will not line them up feature by feature, and I will not tell you which one to marry.

This book is not legal, financial, medical, or tax advice. If a chapter comes near those doors — a data-broker sweep, a bill, a school form, a legal-ops folder — I will tell you what a Bot can draft or gather, and I will tell you that the decision is still yours, and sometimes also a professional's.

And this book is not a promise that the work will always come back finished, or that a team will always work safely while you sleep. The product is capable. The product also fails, burns usage, and waits on a card you have to answer. We will go together as far as practice will take us, and no further than I can stand behind.

A word about the name on the cover

The title of this book is *Hand It Off*. That is my title. "Grok Bot" appears in the subtitle because I am writing a practical guide to Grok Bot, and I need to say the name of the thing I am teaching. I use that name the way you would use it in a sentence about the product, to refer to the product. I do not use it as if it were my mark, and I do not use official logos anywhere in these pages.

SpaceXSI's public Brand Guidelines say the company owns trademark rights in "SpaceXSI" and "Grok," and in combinations of those terms and logos. You may use the marks, the guidelines say, only to accurately refer to the company or its services. You may not use them in a way that implies endorsement, approval, or sponsorship, or in the name of a product or service not made by them.[27] This book is a free, independent, unofficial guide, not affiliated with or endorsed by SpaceXSI, or by xAI, X, Cursor, Anysphere, or any other company whose products I name. The same courtesy extends, when we get to Chapter 16, to Nous Research and to the OpenClaw Foundation.

I am not a lawyer, and I am not telling you the title is "cleared." A free gift may lower some practical risk compared with a book sold as a product; that is an observation, not a legal conclusion, and not legal advice. Appendix E repeats this in short form, and tells you how the notes work. If you need a legal opinion, that is a conversation with a lawyer, not with me.

Other tools, named and not crowned

When Grok Bot launched in August 2026, it did not arrive in an empty room. A report in The Verge, the day after the beta, described Grok Bot as an AI teammate you can assign work, and named other tools in the same conversation, including OpenAI's ChatGPT Work, Anthropic's Claude Cowork, and Microsoft's Copilot Tasks.[28] I am reporting that as journalism, from a story I opened, not as a feature-by-feature comparison I independently ran. I have not re-opened those other products' official pages for a side-by-side in this chapter, and I will not pretend I have.[29]

There will be more tools, and there are already more than that short list. Some of them will be excellent. Some of them you may already use. This book will not tell you to abandon them. In Chapter 16 I will describe a pattern from my own work in which Grok Bot is one desk in a larger workshop, talking carefully to other agent platforms. That chapter is not a vendor comparison either. It is a picture of a practice in which you remain the one who says yes.

If you came to these pages hoping I would pick a winner, I am going to disappoint you, and I think that is the honest thing to do. A practical guide teaches one tool well, tells you its edges, and leaves you free to use what serves the work.

What I hope you carry out of this room

We have been at the kitchen table for a chapter, and I would like you to leave with a few sentences you can say in your own words.

Grok the chat app and Grok Bot are two different apps. One is a conversation. The other is a teammate with a real computer in the cloud. SpaceXSI, formerly xAI, makes it; you sign in with a Cursor account. It opened in beta on 11 August 2026, and 1.0 arrived on 11 November 2026, with multiplayer, initiative, and a more capable desk. This book is a free, unofficial gift, not a sales pitch and not a manual from the maker. You are still the one who says yes.

If you are the kind of reader who likes to know the shape of the house before you enter a room, here it is in one look. Part 1, which this chapter begins, is a meeting. Part 2 is your first week: a plan, a first Bot, a first real task, and a careful connection of apps and secrets. Part 3 is habits — memory, skills, routines — the hinge that turns a good first task into work that can run on a weekday morning. Part 4 is business how-tos, ending in the SMF Works publishing fleet. Part 5 is personal how-tos, the household and the errands. Part 6 is mastery, including the chapter where Grok Bot spans agent platforms, and a calm chapter on safety, privacy, and money. You can read straight through. You can also, after Part 2, pull a how-to from the shelf and come back.

A last kindness, before we stand up. If anything in this chapter felt like a lot of names — SpaceXSI, xAI, Cursor, The X Subscription — that is not a test. You do not have to hold the corporate history to create a Bot. You have to know which door you are walking through, which plan actually includes the product, and that this guide is a gift from me, not a message from the maker. The rest is here when you need it.

In Chapter 2, "A Teammate with a Computer," we will walk the desk itself: the shared cloud computer, the path from a request to finished work, and the official walkthrough I want to retell in my own voice, about signing up for the same conference as last year. We will talk about what "finished" means, and about what still needs a yes. You can leave the mug. The lamp on the other desk is already on.

Chapter 2 — A Teammate with a Computer: How Work Gets Finished

There is a morning I come back to, not because it was dramatic, but because it was ordinary in the way I want your first weeks to become ordinary. I had closed the laptop the evening before. Charlie, my chief of staff Bot, had a job I had already tested: a morning brief for SMF Works, drawn from the places I had asked him to look, drafted and waiting, nothing sent. When I opened the lid, the work was already on the desk. The coffee was still the first cup. I did not start from zero. I started from a draft I could approve, or send back, or sit with for a minute.

I am not going to give you a number of minutes saved, because I did not stand there with a stopwatch, and I will not invent one. I am going to give you the picture the official product itself is built around, told as that kind of morning. Grok Bot is a teammate with a real computer in the cloud. The work can keep going after you close the lid. "Finished," in this book, means the job came back in the place a finished job belongs — a file, a draft, a brief, a report — and that anything which sends, posts, pays, deletes, or publishes still waited for your yes.

This chapter is a map, not a setup guide. We will not create a Bot yet; that is Chapter 3. We will not write your first handoff yet; that is Chapter 4. We will not connect apps or save a login yet; that is Chapter 5. Right now I want you to understand the desk: the shared cloud computer, the path from a request to finished work, and the official walkthrough I am going to retell in my own voice, about signing up for the same conference as last year. Once you can see that path, the first-week chapters will feel like walking a road you already recognize.

A real computer in the cloud

Official documentation does not hedge this, and neither will I. "Your Bots work from a persistent cloud computer with a browser, command line, and filesystem." Work continues while your laptop is closed. Files, sign-ins, and browser sessions stay between tasks.[1]

A few of those words are worth sitting with, because they are doing more work than they appear to.

Persistent means the computer is still there in the morning. It is not a fresh, empty machine for every request. The file a Bot saved yesterday is still there. The site a Bot signed into is often still signed in. That is a gift for work that takes more than one sitting. It is also the reason a file you would not want every Bot to see should not be left on that desk.

A browser means the Bot can use websites the way a person would, including services that have no tidy connection, no special plug-in, no official "app" in the catalog. When an app does exist — Gmail, a calendar, a drive — connecting it is usually more reliable than clicking through pages, and Chapter 5 will show you how. When it does not, the browser is the door.

A command line is the part of a computer where you type instructions instead of clicking. If that sounds like someone else's job, you can leave it alone for a long time. You do not need it to hand off your first task. I mention it because it is real, and because, much later, in Chapter 16, it is one of the ways a Grok Bot in my own workshop talks to other agent platforms. Official docs say two more things about it that I want you to hear now, even if Chapter 16 is a long way off: command-line credentials are shared, and you should not place a credential or a file on that computer if another Bot on your account should not be able to use it.[2]

A filesystem means there is a place for files: drafts, spreadsheets, receipts, a folder of options for a trip you have not booked. Those files stay. They are visible to every Bot on your account. I will say that again in a moment, because it is the fact people most often miss.

The computer is in the cloud, which means it is not the laptop in front of you. Official FAQ: Bots work on their own cloud computer. A Bot runs a command on your desktop only if you allow it, under a setting that, by default, asks you each time.[3] You can watch the cloud computer live, and you can take control of it when a step needs a person — a sign-in the Bot cannot finish, a passkey, a CAPTCHA. You can also close the preview, close the app, close the laptop, and the cloud work continues.[4]



I04. The cloud desk. A lamp-lit desk that is not yours, with the work already waiting.

I think of it as a desk in another room, with the lamp on. You can walk in and watch. You can take the chair for a minute and finish a step only a person can finish. You can leave the room. The lamp stays on.

One computer, shared — and not a wall

Here is the fact I would walk across the room to tell you, if we were in the same kitchen.

Every Bot on your account uses one persistent cloud computer. The computer is assigned per user, not per Bot. They share its files, its browser sessions, and its logins, so they can hand work off to each other. Official FAQ, in words I will not soften: “Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary.”[5]

The computer-and-apps documentation says the same thing in a slightly longer way, and I want you to have that wording too. Every Bot on your account uses the same computer. Browser cookies and signed-in sessions are shared. Files are visible to every Bot. Command-line credentials are shared. One Bot can continue from work another Bot saved. “Do not place a credential or file on it if another Bot on your account should not be able to use it.” Each Bot gets its own screen, so

several Bots can work at once, but the screens are separate work surfaces, not separate security boundaries.[6]

> **Caution.** A second Bot is not a locked room. If one Bot is signed in to a site, your other Bots are signed in too. If a card or a password is available on that computer, it is available to all of them. This is not a scare line. It is the official rule, said plainly. We will use the Vault. We will decide what is allowed. And we will not pretend that giving a Bot a different name puts a wall between them.

This is also, in a kinder light, why a small fleet works. In Chapter 12, when we look at a publishing house run with Bots, the reason a writer Bot can leave a file and a programmer Bot can pick it up is the same reason you have to be careful: they share a desk. Sharing is the point. The wall you want is not between your Bots. The wall you want is at the edge of your account — and the yes you have not given away.

Between different people, official docs describe a stricter isolation: each user's computer is dedicated. That is a different boundary, and it is not the one this chapter is about. If you share a Team Bot with colleagues, Chapter 15 will walk that path from the official Team Bot pages, not from a guess.

You can update, recover, or reset the computer. Official pages cover those steps. Packages you install by hand should be treated as replaceable; the computer can be rebuilt. I will not turn that into a how-to here. I want you to know the desk can be tidied, and that "tidy" is sometimes the right move after a sensitive job: sign out of a service a Bot no longer needs, and delete a sensitive file when the work is done.[7]

The pieces on the path

Before I retell the official walkthrough, I want to lay the pieces on the table and give each one a plain sentence. You will meet all of them again, with how-tos, in the first-week chapters. Here they are as a map.

Your message. You talk to a Bot the way you would talk to a coworker. You say what you want, which sources to use, any limits, and when to check with you. Chapter 4 will teach you to write that handoff: a goal, sources, a "never," and what "done" looks like.

Memory. Each Bot keeps preferences, rules you have asked it to follow, and a dated log of its work. A few facts about you, like your name and time zone, are shared by all your Bots. A Bot decides what to remember; you can ask it to remember, to fix, or to forget. Memories can go out of date, so for numbers that change — prices, budgets — you ask the Bot to look them up again. Logins and cards do not belong in memory. They belong in the Vault.[8] Chapter 6 is the full chapter on this. For this walkthrough, memory is how the Bot fills in last year's pass and the card to use, without you repeating yourself.

A connected app. When you connect Gmail, or Drive, or a calendar, the Bot can work in that app directly, which official docs call more reliable than clicking through a website. Connected apps belong to the account you used to sign in, and they are available to every Bot you run. Chapter 5

will show you how to connect one low-risk app, and will remind you that connecting is a decision, not a default.

The cloud computer. When a site has no app, the Bot opens it in the browser on the shared computer. You can watch. You can take control. The session usually stays signed in.

The Vault. A locker your Bots can use without seeing the secret. You save a login, or a card, or a shipping address, and the value is filled into the page; the Bot never sees the password, the card number, or the security code. Official rule, repeated, and I will repeat it too: never paste a password or a card into the chat.[9] Chapter 5 is where we will do this carefully, together.

A Secure Form. If the Vault does not have the login, and a connected password manager such as 1Password does not either, the Bot asks you with a Secure Form. You type the secret; it goes straight into the page; it is never shown to the Bot, and it never enters the ordinary chat.

Take control. Some steps need you: single sign-on, a passkey, a CAPTCHA the Bot cannot solve, a QR code, a bank verification. The Bot hands you the computer. You open it, take control, finish only that step, and tell the Bot to continue. You still do not paste the password into the chat.

Auto Review. Before a Bot runs a command, uses an app, or acts on its computer, Auto Review checks the action. It is on by default. Most actions go ahead. When one needs you, the Bot shows an approval card and waits. You can add your own rules, in plain words: “send an email,” “publish,” “delete,” and choose Ask first or Allow automatically. An Ask-first rule always stops a matching action.[10]

The approval card. A small postcard from the desk in the other room. It tells you what the Bot wants to do, and it waits. Depending on the card, you may see Allow once, Always allow, or Deny; some cards say Allow and Not now, or Allow and Skip. I will not pretend every card uses the same labels, because official docs say the labels vary.[11] What does not vary, in this book, is the practice: read the card. If you cannot tell what it will do, do not approve it. Ask the Bot to explain it in plain language, or to produce a draft first.

A yes that can expire. Approvals from work that started without you — a routine, or a message from another Bot — expire after about thirty minutes, according to the official FAQ. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.[12] That is why a 6 a.m. routine that needs a yes will not finish itself while you sleep. The work can run unattended. The yes, on a sensitive action, often cannot. Chapter 8 will return to this when we put a job on a schedule. Chapter 17 will return to it when we talk about safety.

Only your own messages count as instructions. If a web page has hidden text telling the Bot to email your contacts, Auto Review is not supposed to treat that as a request from you. Official docs say these checks “lower the risk from harmful content, but they don’t remove it.” Keep Ask-first rules on anything you cannot undo.[13] I will not sand that off.

One request, from your message to finished work

Official documentation explains how Grok Bot works by following one common request from start to finish. I am going to retell that walkthrough in my own voice, because it is the best map I know,

and because I would rather you hear it as a story than as a specification. The request, in the official pages, is this:

> Sign me up for the same conference as last year and expense it.[14]

It is a good request for a map, and a slightly dangerous request for a first task. It includes a purchase and an email. In Chapter 4, I will ask you to start with something reversible — a summary, a draft, a file, not a send, and not a payment. Here, we are watching how the product thinks, including the places it stops.

Imagine you have a Bot whose job is travel and expenses. You send it that sentence. The sentence does not name the conference, the pass, or the card. Here is what official docs say happens next, and how I would describe it to you at the table.

First, the Bot checks its memory. The expenses Bot fills in the details you did not type. Its work log, in the official example, has last year's two-day pass. You have given it a rule: use the work card for conferences. If you ask what it used, it can show you. That is memory doing its job — the job of not making you repeat yourself — and also the reason memory should not be where a card number lives. The official example puts the card in the Vault, and so will we.

Second, the Bot finds last year's receipt in Gmail. Gmail, in the walkthrough, is a connected app, so the Bot works in it directly instead of opening the Gmail website. Official docs call that more reliable. If an app is not in the catalog, there are other official paths — an MCP server, which is a standard way these tools connect to a service, or a marketplace Bot that can wrap an API — and those are a power-user corner we will leave for Chapter 18. For this request, Gmail is enough.

Third, the Bot signs in and buys the pass. The conference site has no app, so the Bot opens it in the browser on the shared cloud computer. All your Bots share that computer; when one signs in, the others are signed in too. The site asks for a password. The Bot looks for a login in a fixed official order: first the Vault, then 1Password if you have connected it and approve, then a Secure Form that asks you and fills the page directly. In the official walkthrough, neither the Vault nor 1Password has a login, so the Bot sends a Secure Form. Whichever path it uses, the login goes straight into the page, and the Bot never sees it.

To pay, the Bot uses the work card you saved in the Vault. This is the sentence I need you to hear clearly, because official docs say it clearly: a saved card fills in at checkout without asking you each time, and the Bot never sees the number. If you would rather approve every payment, do not save the card.[15] In the walkthrough, the card is saved, and the pass is bought. In your first week, I will ask you not to start here.

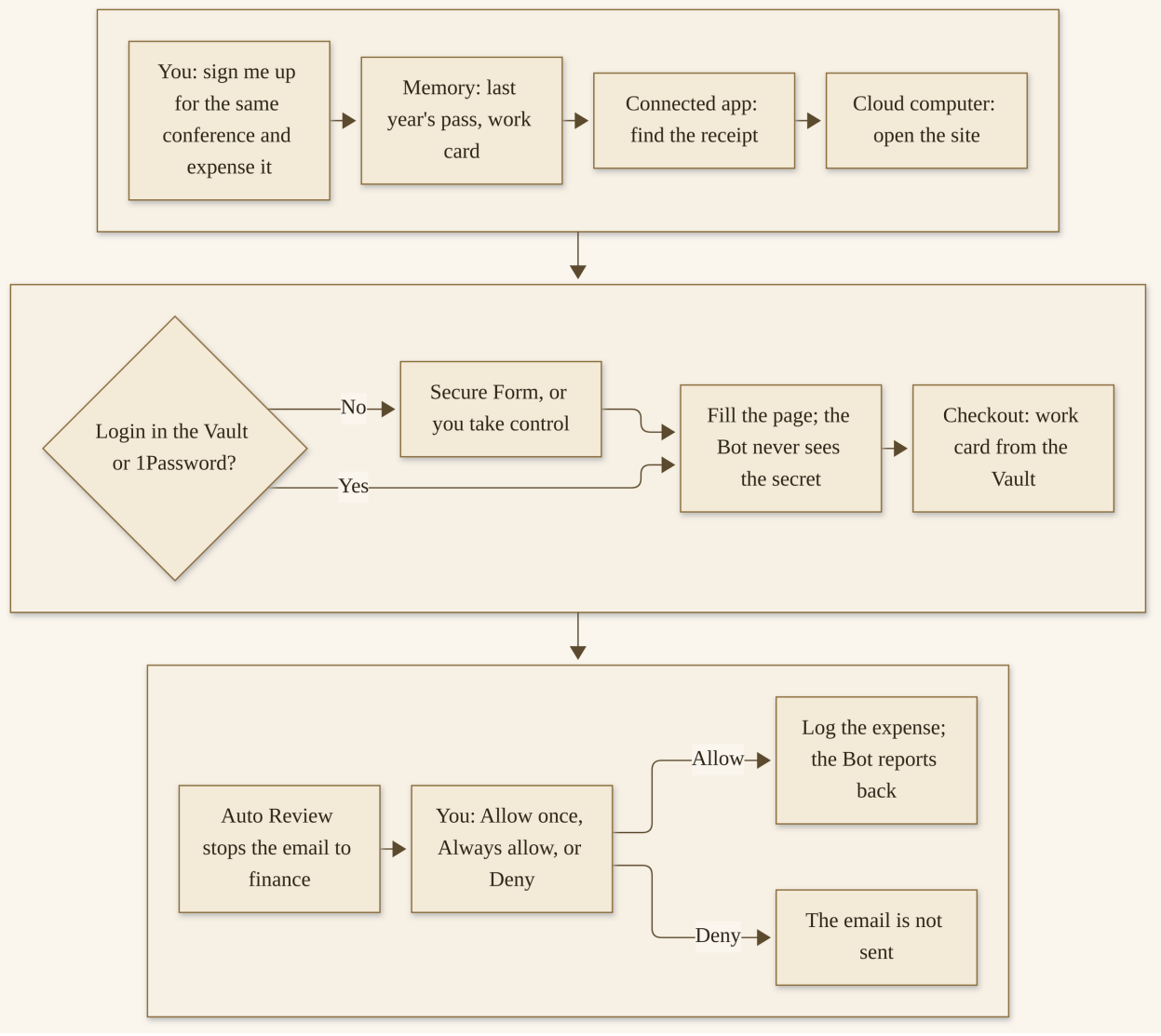
If a step needs a person — single sign-on, a passkey, a CAPTCHA — the Bot hands you the computer. You choose Open computer on the request, then Take control, finish the step, and tell the Bot to continue.

Fourth, the Bot asks before it emails finance. With the pass bought, the Bot is ready to email the receipt. In the walkthrough, you have made a rule to approve emails first, so it stops and asks. Auto Review has checked the action. The Ask-first rule has stopped the email. An approval card is waiting. You can allow it once, or deny it, or, on some cards, always allow similar actions — which saves a rule, and which I would like you to use sparingly in the first week. The email is not

sent until you say so.

Fifth, the Bot logs the expense and reports back. It adds the expense to a Finance sheet in Google Drive, another connected app, and it replies with everything it did. If you have closed your laptop by then, it keeps going, and it notifies you when it is done.

That is the whole journey. Memory, a connected app, the cloud computer, the Vault or a Secure Form, Auto Review, an approval card, a finished log, a report that can find you after the lid is closed. The official pages also say something I want at the end of the story: your expenses Bot did all of this as you. A Bot has no account of its own, so it cannot do anything you could not do, and every action traces back to you. The one exception is a connector your team manages, which can use team or service-account credentials.[16] You are still the person whose name is on the work.



I03. A request's journey, retold from the official "same conference as last year" walkthrough. This is a map of how the product finishes work, including the stop for your yes. It is not a first-task recipe; in Chapter 4 we will start with something that does not pay and does not send.

A narrated walk along the same path

How to watch a request travel, before you run one yourself

This is not a setup guide. It is a way to look at the map with me, so that when you write your first handoff in Chapter 4, you already know the rooms the work will walk through.

1. Start with the message, and notice what it does not say. In the official walkthrough, the message does not name the conference, the pass, or the card. What is missing will be filled from memory, or looked up, or asked. If a first task of yours leaves a purchase or a send implicit, that is a sign to make the "never" explicit: "Don't book." "Don't send." "Don't pay." If you don't yet have a Bot, just keep the habit in your head. You will use it on your first real task.

2. Ask where the facts will come from. Memory, for what you have already told the Bot. A connected app, for a receipt or a calendar. The browser, for a site with no app. The Vault, for a login or a card. A Secure Form or your own hands, for a secret that is not saved. You should be able to point to a source for each fact the Bot will need. If you cannot, the Bot may guess, or remember something stale, or stop and ask. Asking is fine. Guessing, for a number that changes, is not.

3. Find the step that should wait for you. In the walkthrough, it is the email to finance, stopped by an Ask-first rule. In your work, it may be a send, a post, a payment, a deletion, or a publish. Name it before the work begins. You should see, later, an approval card at that step, not a finished action you did not mean. If you don't: Chapter 5 is where we will set those rules on purpose, and test a card on purpose, before a Bot works alone.

4. Notice what "done" will look like, and what still needs a yes. In the walkthrough, "done" is a bought pass, a logged expense, and a report. The email still needed a yes. A saved card did not. That last fact is official, and it is why, in this book, a first-week payment does not start with a card already in the Vault. You should leave this map knowing the difference between a job that finished and a job that still needs you.

What "done" looks like, for this walk: you can retell the five steps in your own words, and you can point to the yes. What still needs a yes, when you do this for real, is anything you cannot undo.

Watching, taking control, and working in parallel

You do not have to stare at the cloud desk for the whole job. Official docs say you click the computer preview in the conversation to open it and watch clicks, typing, navigation, and status, and you can leave the preview while the work continues.[21] I watch the first time I hand off a new kind of job, the way I would watch a new person on a first morning: not because I distrust them, but because I want to see how the work actually moves, and where it pauses. After that, I leave the room more often.

Taking control is not a failure. It is a designed step. Single sign-on, a passkey, a CAPTCHA, a QR code, a bank verification, a site that requires a human — the Bot is supposed to hand those

to you, not bypass them.[22] You finish only the blocked step, you tell the Bot to continue, and you still do not paste a secret into the chat. If a site blocks traffic from cloud computers, official docs describe another option: you can route the Bot's web traffic through your own computer, so the site sees your connection, and you can sign in yourself on the Bot's computer.[23] That is a later, careful setting, not a first-week move. I mention it so that a blocked site does not feel like a dead end, and so that you do not start inventing workarounds the product already has a door for.

Several Bots can work at the same time. Each one gets its own screen on the shared computer. One Bot can run one computer-use task on its screen at a time, but they can reason, use connectors, work with files, and coordinate in parallel.[24] This is the seed of a fleet, and it is also, again, the shared desk: parallel work is possible because the computer is shared, and the sharing is the thing to be thoughtful about. In my own workshop, Charlie can be on the morning brief while a writer Bot is on a draft. They are not two locked rooms. They are two screens, one desk, one person at the door.

You can close the laptop

I want to come back to that morning at SMF Works, because the official picture and my ordinary picture are the same picture, and I do not want the official words to sound like a slogan.

The FAQ asks, "Does Grok Bot keep working when my laptop is closed?" and answers yes. Work runs on the cloud computer. Closing the app, the laptop, or the phone does not stop a background turn or a routine.[17] The how-it-works walkthrough ends the same way: if you have closed your laptop by the time the Bot is logging the expense, it keeps going and notifies you when it is done.[18]

That is the lamp in the other room. It is also not a blanket permission. Unattended approvals expire after about thirty minutes. A routine that needs your yes at 6 a.m. will not get that yes from a closed door. A card in a chat you are sitting in will wait. The art, which Chapters 8 and 9 will practice, is to design the job so that what can safely finish, finishes, and what must not finish without you, waits in a form you can read with a first cup of coffee.

> **Story.** I closed the lid on a draft I had handed to a writer Bot at SMF Works — a bounded job, sources included, a clear "never" about publishing — and I went to make dinner. In the morning the draft was there, in the folder where we leave finished drafts. It was not ready to publish. It was ready for me. That is the kind of finished I trust: the work came back, and the last part was still mine.

I will not tell you the draft was a certain percent right. Chapter 4 will talk about a first finished draft that is mostly right, and about the last part that is still yours, without borrowing anyone's slogan. For now, I want the feeling: the lid can close, the lamp can stay on, and "finished" does not mean "gone out the door."

What "finished" means, and what still needs a yes

Let me say this in the plainest words I have, because it is the contract this whole book keeps.

A job is finished, in the sense I will teach, when the work has landed where a human would have

put it — in the file, in the draft, in the brief, in the folder — and you have been told what was done. A job is not finished, in the sense that it has left your hands, until you have said yes to anything that sends, posts, pays, deletes, or publishes. I am teaching those five verbs as a first-week rule. Official docs describe Ask-first rules for sending, publishing, and deleting, and they tell you not to save a card if you want to approve every payment.[19] I am lining those up, as practice, so you have a short list you can remember when you are tired.

"Finished" is also honest about failure. Sites block automation. CAPTCHAs appear. Logins expire. A computer cannot be reached, or a usage limit is reached, or an approval expires. Official troubleshooting exists for those, and Chapter 17 will walk one path from it. In your first week, a failure is not a verdict on you or on the product. It is a moment to read what came back, to try again with a tighter "never," or to take control for the one step that needed a person.

Your primary Bot, official docs say, is your main point of contact. It checks in, it can coordinate your other Bots, and you could send the conference request to the primary Bot and let it pass the work to the expenses Bot.[20] Most Bots work best with one clear job. When the same kind of request keeps coming back with its own sources, rules, or schedule, it is time for a Bot of its own. That is the seed of Part 3, and of the fleet in Chapter 12. You do not have to plant it today.

You do have to leave this chapter with a picture. There is a desk in the other room. It has a browser, a place for files, and a command line you may not touch for a long time. Every Bot on your account shares that desk. Secrets go in the Vault, not in the chat. Auto Review watches; Ask-first rules stop the things you cannot undo; approval cards wait, and some of them wait only about thirty minutes. You can close the laptop. You are still the one who says yes.

> **Tip.** If you take only one picture from this chapter into Chapter 3, take this one: the Bot has a desk, the desk is shared, and the yes is still yours. Everything else — plans, buttons, the first task — hangs on that picture.

One thing I have learned, watching work come back to the SMF Works desk, is that "finished" is a feeling you can practice. The first few times, I hovered. I opened the computer preview and watched every click, the way you watch a pot that does not actually need watching. Then I learned to write a tighter handoff, to put the "never" in the message, and to go make dinner. The work that came back was not always the work I would have done myself, line for line. It was close enough to edit, and it had not gone out the door. That is the standard I want for you in the first week. Not perfection. A finished draft, a clear report, and a yes you still own.

In Chapter 3, "Get In," we will pick a plan that actually includes Grok Bot, install the app, and create your first Bot with one clear job — without walking into a billing surprise. The map is in your hands. Let's get you through the door.

Part 2 — Day One Through the First Week

Chapter 3 — Get In: Plans, Download, and Your First Bot

The first time I sat with the pricing page, Plus looked like the obvious door. It is eight dollars a month. It says “Grok” on it, in the way a page lists the things you already think you came for. I almost would have pointed a friend at it, with a kind word and a wrongly confident nod, if I had not looked one column further.

Grok Bot is not on Plus. It is not on Free. On The X Subscription, where new customers start, Grok Bot comes with Premium, Super, and Ultra. Plus, at the list price I checked on 11 November 2026, is eight dollars a month, and it does not include the teammate this book is about.[1]

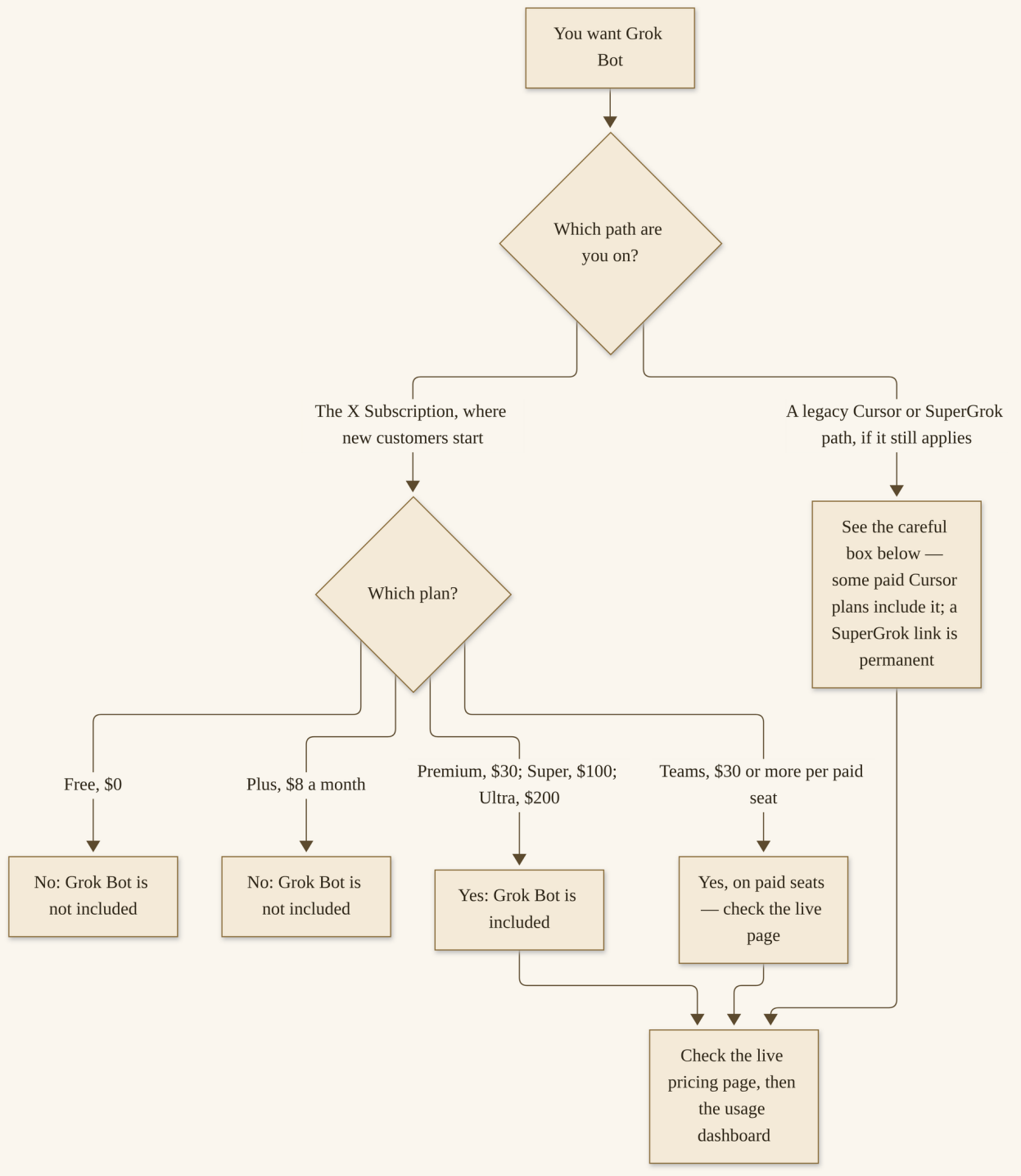
That is not a scold. It is a kindness I wanted at the top of this chapter, because walking into a billing surprise is a miserable way to meet a tool. This chapter will get you through the right door: a plan that actually includes Grok Bot, the app on a computer or a phone, a first Bot with one clear job, and a look at the usage dashboard so you can see the live number. We will go slowly. We will date every price. And when this book and the live page disagree, we will trust the live page.

Which door gets you in

The product’s own pricing, on 11 November 2026, at x.ai/pricing, listed these individual plans, with tax extra:[2]

- **Free**, $0 a month. Limited usage. Does not include Grok Bot.
- **Plus**, $8 a month. A shared AI usage pool, Grok Chat and related Grok features, and Cursor. Does not include Grok Bot.
- **Premium**, $30 a month. Four times the usage of Plus. **Includes Grok Bot.** This is the first door that gets you in, on The X Subscription.
- **Super**, $100 a month. Fifteen times the usage of Plus. Includes Grok Bot, with a larger weekly pool.
- **Ultra**, $200 a month. Fifty times the usage of Plus. Includes Grok Bot, with the largest of those weekly pools.
- **Teams**, from $30 or more per seat, with seat tiers that follow the paid individual tiers. Grok Bot is included on those paid seats; for the exact team wording, look at the live page, not at a sentence in a book.

I am not going to tell you which of Premium, Super, or Ultra to pick. That would be a pitch, and this book does not pitch plans. Official pages describe Premium as a starting point for new AI users, Super for daily agent use, and Ultra for power users; those are the maker's recommendations, dated the day I checked, and they will change.[3] Your work, your budget, and the live dashboard are the better guides. Chapter 17, "Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks," will sit with bills, caps, and top-ups without asking you to climb a ladder.



I05. Which door gets you in, with list prices dated 11 November 2026, tax extra. Trust the live page at x.ai/pricing if this diagram and the page disagree.

> **Tip.** The usage dashboard is the live number. If this book and the dashboard disagree, trust the dashboard — plans change.

A shared weekly pool, and a sentence that is no longer the live rule

Under The X Subscription, Grok Bot draws from a weekly shared pool across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor.[4] That is the live rule for a new customer on 11 November 2026. There is not a published single number, in dollars or in tokens, for how big that pool is. Official pages give multipliers — four times, fifteen times, fifty times Plus — and tell you to look at the live dashboard.[5] I will not invent a "typical hours left" figure. I will tell you where to look, in a how-to, in a few pages.

This is a change from launch day. On 11 August 2026, the announcement said Grok Bot "comes with its own usage, separate from your Grok and Cursor plans."[6] If you find a guide, including an old paragraph of mine from a conversation, that only quotes that August sentence, it is telling the truth about August and not the truth about a November reader on The X Subscription. I am dating both rules so you can see the turn.

After the weekly pool, additional usage can be paid from prepaid top-up credits. Auto Top-up is optional, and it is off until you turn it on. A monthly cap is a separate control. Chapter 17 will walk those. For today: leave Auto Top-up off unless you mean it on, and know that the pool is shared, so a heavy day in the Grok chat app or in Cursor is a day that also touches Grok Bot's allowance.

There is no model picker. Official FAQ: Grok Bot picks the model for each task; it may be a first-party SpaceXSI model or a third-party model; the model is not displayed; you cannot route to or away from a particular one.[7] You will not see a menu of model names, and this book will not tell you which model ran which task, because that is not a fact a user is shown. Usage is recorded as Grok Bot usage, not by model name.

Switching is optional, and it is permanent

If you already have a Cursor plan, or a SuperGrok plan, or a paid X plan, you do not have to switch to The X Subscription. Official docs are clear: switching is optional. Your current plan, price, and features continue unless you change or cancel. New customers start on The X Subscription.[8]

If you do switch — if you unify accounts under that one subscription — the switch is permanent. It cannot be undone, and Support cannot undo it for you.[9] That is the sentence I want you to read twice, before you click anything that says Unify.

> **Caution.** Unifying accounts under The X Subscription is optional, and a completed unification is permanent. Official docs say Support cannot undo it. If you are unsure, do not switch today. Your current plan can continue. Read the live official page on unification before you combine anything, and do not treat this paragraph as a complete

> legal or billing guide. It is a friend at the table, pointing at a door that only opens one way.

When people do switch, official docs describe a new bill, a prorated refund on some cancelled subscriptions, and a special case if you pay for Cursor through the Apple App Store: the company cannot cancel that one for you, so you cancel it with Apple, or Apple keeps billing you.[10] I am not going to walk a unification checkout in this chapter. If that is your situation, read the official unification pages, slowly, and take a screenshot of what you have before you change it. Chapter 17 will come back to billing pitfalls.

> **A careful box: legacy Cursor and SuperGrok paths.** These still appear on official pages, so I will describe them as the docs describe them, dated 11 November 2026. On a legacy Cursor plan, Grok Bot is included with every paid individual plan and with self-serve Cursor Teams. You can also link an individual SuperGrok, SuperGrok Plus, SuperGrok Heavy, or X Premium+ subscription. SuperGrok Lite and Grok Enterprise cannot link. A SuperGrok link is permanent; you cannot move it yourself. A Cursor plan and SuperGrok do not add together — you get the higher tier, and both may keep billing on their own. On that path, Grok Bot usage is metered on the Cursor account. If you later unify onto The X Subscription, your Grok Bot usage then comes from the new weekly shared pool.[11] If none of those sentences sound like your account, you are probably a new customer, and The X Subscription is your door. If they do sound like your account, look at Settings → Usage & Billing, and at the official "Grok Bot on The X Subscription" page, before you change anything.

Desktop and phone

The desktop app runs on macOS (Apple silicon and Intel), Windows (x64 and Arm64), and Linux (x64 and Arm64). It checks for updates automatically; Linux .deb and .rpm installs update through the package manager instead.[12] Official get-started says to download Grok Bot from x.ai/bot and open it. On a team, the Cursor dashboard has a Download Grok Bot row; if you do not have dashboard access, you ask your admin.

The companion apps are on the App Store and Google Play. The iPhone app needs iOS 18 or later; the Android app needs Android 9 or later. Both reach the same Bots, conversations, routines, and cloud computer as the desktop. Access from your plan carries over without a second purchase. From your phone you can message Bots, watch and take over the computer, approve actions, and pause or resume routines.[13]

Subscriptions can also be purchased through Apple or Google, and that path has a different cancellation route than The X Subscription. If you buy through a store, you cancel through that store.[14] I am not going to list in-app prices here; they change, and the store listing is the live number. The App Store seller, when I opened the listing on 11 November 2026, was X Corp., with a copyright line for Anysphere Inc. Google Play listed the developer as SpaceX Super Intelligence.[15] Those are the names as the listings used them, the same careful formula as Chapter 1.



I06. Install-day. A laptop, a phone, a mug, a cable, morning light.

Grok Bot needs cloud data storage. If your account is on Legacy Privacy Mode, the app asks you to switch; Legacy Privacy Mode is not supported.[16] That is an official requirement, not a preference in this book. Training opt-out, and the rest of privacy, follow Cursor account settings; Chapter 17 will return to that. For today, know that there is no separate Grok Bot login. You sign in with your Cursor account. If your company uses single sign-on, you sign in the usual way. If your access comes from a SuperGrok or X Premium+ subscription on a legacy path, official get-started describes a "Link Grok Account" step.[17]

If sign-in does not finish, official troubleshooting has a section for that. Quit and reopen is the first kindness; the troubleshooting page is the second.[18]

How to read the live pricing page

How to read the live pricing page, not a screenshot in this book

1. Open the official pricing page at https://x.ai/pricing. You should see the current plans and prices, including which ones list Grok Bot. If you don't: make sure you are on the official x.ai site, not a third-party copy or an old screenshot, including the ones in this chapter's memory.

2. Find the plan you are considering, and look specifically for Grok Bot. You should see it listed on Premium, Super, and Ultra, and not on Free or Plus, unless the live page has changed since 11 November 2026. If you don't: do not assume a lower plan includes it. If the page has changed, trust the page, and date what you saw.
3. Notice whether you are looking at a monthly price, an annual price, and whether tax is extra. You should see a clear amount, and you should expect tax to be added at checkout. The list prices in this chapter are monthly, dated 11 November 2026, tax extra. If you don't: look for a toggle or a footnote on the page. Do not use a number from a blog, including a number someone said was "about" right.
4. If you already have a Cursor, SuperGrok, or X plan, look for the official language about switching and unification before you combine anything. You should see that switching is optional, and you should look for the word *permanent* before you proceed. If you don't: leave unification alone for today. A current plan can continue.
5. Do not click a checkout button until you have read what you are buying, including Auto Top-up if it appears, and until you are sure Grok Bot is on that plan. You should feel bored, in the good way, before you pay. Boredom at a checkout is a sign you have actually read it. If you don't: walk away and come back. The page will still be there.

What "done" looks like: you can name the plan you intend to use, you know it includes Grok Bot, and you have confirmed that on the live page, not only in this book. What still needs a yes: the payment itself, which is yours, not mine, and not the Bot's.

How to download and sign in

How to download the app and sign in

1. On a computer, go to https://x.ai/bot and download Grok Bot for your system. You should get the desktop app for macOS, Windows, or Linux, as official get-started describes. If you don't: on a team, ask your admin for the dashboard download link. If a download fails, try again from the official page, not from a forwarded file.
2. Open the app, choose Sign in on the welcome screen, and finish in your browser. You should sign in with your Cursor account. There is no separate Grok Bot login. If you don't: see official troubleshooting for "Sign-in does not complete." If your company uses single sign-on, use that usual path. If you are on a legacy SuperGrok or X Premium+ path, look for Link Grok Account as official get-started describes, and do not invent a different sequence.
3. If the app asks you to switch off Legacy Privacy Mode, read that request and understand that Grok Bot requires cloud data storage. You should see a clear request, not a hidden toggle. If you don't want to switch: you will not be able to use Grok Bot on that mode, according to official docs. That is a real choice, and it is yours. Do not treat this book as pushing you through it.
4. On a phone, install Grok Bot from the App Store or Google Play, and sign in with the same account. You should see the same Bots, once you have them, without a second purchase

for access you already have. If you don't: confirm you used the same account. Confirm the phone meets iOS 18 or Android 9. Quit and reopen. Then see official mobile docs or troubleshooting.

5. Do not enter a password into a chat, and do not buy a second time if you already have access. You should be inside the app, looking at a first Bot, or at a welcome that is about to create one. If you see a paywall you do not expect: stop and check Settings, or the usage and billing area, and the live plan page, before you pay again. Billing confusion is a documented pain, and Chapter 17 will treat it with patience. Today, stopping is allowed.

What "done" looks like: the app is open, you are signed in, and you have not paid twice. What still needs a yes: any purchase, and any unification.

Your first Bot, with one clear job

After a short intro, the app sets up your first Bot, named Grok Bot, and opens a chat with it.[19] That is a perfectly good place to begin. You can also start from a Bot already set up for a job, in the official marketplace — Tradbot for personal email and calendar, for example, which official copy says never sends without you — and you can wait on the marketplace until you have a feel for a Bot you named yourself. I started with a Bot and a job I could describe in one sentence. I still think that is the right first move.

You can create more. Official docs: choose New Bot (the + button) at the top of the sidebar, or press Cmd+N on a Mac or Ctrl+N on Windows or Linux. Name the Bot and choose Create. To rename later, click its name at the top of the chat, then click the name again to edit it.[20]

Give each Bot one job, in its first message, and ask it to remember how you want the work done. Official guidance is the same as mine: a Bot with one job builds more useful context than a catch-all helper.[21] "Be my assistant for everything" is a kind sentence and a vague job. "Draft a morning brief from my calendar and inbox, and never send anything" is a job.

The name can be ordinary. Charlie is my chief of staff Bot, and that name will come back in Chapter 9. Your first Bot does not need a fleet name. It needs one job, a "never," and a person — you — who will read what comes back.

How to create your first Bot with one clear job

1. If the app has already created a first Bot named Grok Bot, open the chat with it. If you want a second Bot, or a Bot with a name you chose, choose New Bot and give it a name, then Create. You should see a chat, empty or nearly empty, with a Bot waiting for a first message. If you don't: confirm you are signed in and that your plan includes Grok Bot. If New Bot is missing, you may be on a plan that does not include it; go back to the live pricing page rather than pressing harder.

2. Write a first message that states one job, what "done" looks like, and a "never." A solid first job is small and reversible: a brief, a summary, a draft, a list. For example, in your own words: "Your job is to draft a short morning brief of what needs me. Don't send anything. Don't delete anything. Ask me before you connect a new app." You should get a reply that

shows the Bot has taken the job, or a question that narrows it. If you don't: say the job again, more narrowly. One job, one "never." Chapter 4 will go further on the handoff itself.

3. Ask the Bot to remember the job and the "never." You should see, in its reply, some sign that it will keep those rules. You can also, later, ask "What do you remember about me?" as official docs suggest. If you don't: say it again, plainly: "Please remember this job and these rules." Chapter 6 will show you how to look at memory and how to forget.

4. Do not, in this first message, paste a password, a card number, or a secret, and do not ask the Bot to send, pay, or publish. You should still be in a conversation, not in a checkout. If the Bot offers to connect an app or to take a large next step: you can say "Not yet. We'll do that on purpose in a later step." Chapter 5 is that later step.

What "done" looks like: you have a Bot with a name, one job, and a "never," and nothing has been sent. What still needs a yes: any connection, any send, and the first real task, which is Chapter 4.

How to find the usage dashboard

How to find the usage dashboard and look at the live number

1. If you are on The X Subscription, open https://grok.com/dashboard and look at Usage.[22] You should see a live view of the weekly shared pool, or a clear path to it. If you don't: try Settings → Usage & Billing inside the Grok Bot app, which official FAQ also names. The label may vary slightly; look for usage and billing, not for a model name.

2. If you are still on a legacy Cursor path, and you have not switched, open the Cursor dashboard at https://cursor.com/dashboard, and also look in Grok Bot under Settings → Usage & Billing.[23] You should see Grok Bot usage metered on the Cursor account, which official docs say is a different meter from a SuperGrok limit in the Grok chat app. If you don't: do not assume the two meters match. Official FAQ: they are two separate meters for two products.

3. Read what you see without hunting for a "hours left" number this book never gave you. You should leave with a sense of whether you are early in the week's pool, near the edge, or already into additional usage. If you don't understand a line: do not guess. Note it, and come back to Chapter 17, or to official usage-limits docs, with the live page in front of you.

4. Confirm Auto Top-up is off, unless you have already decided to turn it on. You should see that it is off by default, as official docs describe, or that you have set a cap. If you don't: leave it off for the first week. You can always turn a thing on later. You cannot always unspend a credit.

What "done" looks like: you know where the live number lives, and you have looked at it once. What still needs a yes: any top-up, any cap change, any unification.

One job, said a few ways

I want to sit with "one job" a little longer, because it is the habit that makes everything after this chapter easier, and because a first Bot is where people most often try to do everything at once.

A job is one lane. "Draft a morning brief, and never send it" is a lane. "Sort unread mail into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI, draft the urgent replies, and don't send" is a lane — official docs offer a starter prompt very close to that, which we will use in Chapter 4.[24] "Find two flight and hotel options for a weekend, and don't book" is a lane. "Be my chief of staff, my writer, my bookkeeper, and the person who talks to the school" is not a lane. It is a kind hope, and it makes a muddy teammate.

If you already know you will want several lanes, you still start with one. Official docs describe a primary Bot as your main point of contact, the one that can coordinate other Bots, and they suggest giving work its own Bot when it has its own sources, schedule, or approval needs.[25] Charlie is that kind of primary Bot for me, and he did not start as a fleet. He started as a morning brief. The fleet in Chapter 12 grew from jobs that kept coming back.

You can name the job in ordinary language. You do not need the word "agent." You do not need a formal specification. You need a sentence you would be willing to say to a new person on a first morning, including the thing they should never do.

The official marketplace has Bots already set up for a job — Overheard, which official copy says never posts on your behalf; Tradbot, which never sends without you; a Meeting Recap Deck that never invents a quote.[26] Those can be a later kindness. They are not a requirement for Day One. A Bot you named, with a job you wrote, will teach you more in the first week, because you will have practiced the sentence.

If you work on a team, and someone else already has Grok Bot, you may be looking at a shared Bot rather than creating your first one from scratch. Team Bots have their own rules, and their own plan gates — Team and Enterprise, as of 1.0 — and Chapter 15 is where we will walk them from the official pages. For this chapter, create a Bot that is yours, with a job that is yours, on a plan that includes the product. Sharing comes after you have practiced the yes.

If the first hour feels like a lot

It is all right if this chapter felt like more doors than you wanted. Pricing pages are like that. Company names are like that. I have watched careful people freeze at a checkout, not because they could not afford a plan, but because they did not want to make a permanent mistake. That instinct is a good one. Honor it.

You can read the live pricing page today and download tomorrow. You can install the app and not create a second Bot. You can create a Bot and not hand it a task until you have read Chapter 4. You can leave Auto Top-up off for a month. None of those pauses is a failure. The product will still be there. The door that matters — Premium or higher on The X Subscription, or a legacy paid path that actually includes Grok Bot — will still be the door.

What I would not like you to do is pay for Plus, wait for a Bot that will not appear, and decide that you are the one who did not understand. You understood fine. The column was easy to misread. I almost misread it too, in the sense that I almost would have sent a friend through it. We looked one column further. That is the whole story.

A first-week posture, before the first task

You are in. That is more than it seems. You have a plan that actually includes the product, an app on a machine you use, a Bot with one job, and a dashboard you can find again.

A few postures I would like you to keep for the rest of the week, and they are not additional how-tos, only habits.

This is also a good moment to decide, quietly, what this first Bot is *not*. It is not your payment method. It is not your lawyer. It is not the person who emails a school or a customer until you have practiced a smaller yes. It is a teammate with one job, on a computer you now know is shared, on a plan you chose with your eyes open. That is a lot for Day One. It is enough.

If a family member or a colleague is sitting with you while you do this, you can hand them the "which door" picture and the word *permanent*, and then you can let them go make coffee. The rest is just installing an app and writing one clear sentence. I have written worse first sentences than the ones you will write today. You can always say, "Let's tighten the job," and the Bot will meet you there.

One job per Bot. When a second job shows up and stays, that is a second Bot, or a conversation with your primary Bot about creating one. You do not need a fleet today.

No model picker, and no hunting for one. The work is the work. Usage is Grok Bot usage.

The computer is already there, shared, even if you have only one Bot. The first login you save, in Chapter 5, will be a login every later Bot can use. That is not a reason to delay. It is a reason to be deliberate.

Prices will change. I checked them on 11 November 2026, and I dated them, and I will still be wrong for a reader who opens this book in a later season. That is not a failure of the chapter. It is the reason the first how-to in this book is "read the live page." Features will change too. Team Bots, meetings, and Pages already arrived on a timetable of weeks, not years. Your dashboard, your plan page, and the official docs will always outrank a paragraph of mine. I am at peace with that. I would like you to be, too.

The Free plan and the Plus plan are fine plans for other things. They are not a failure, and they are not a door to Grok Bot. If a friend asks you, you can tell them kindly, the way I almost had to be told.

I have one more practical note, and then I will get out of your way. People sometimes ask whether they should start on a phone or on a computer. Official docs treat the desktop as the place you install first, and the phone as a companion that reaches the same Bots.[27] I agree with that order, not as a rule, but as a kindness: the first sign-in, the first look at a cloud computer, and the first

approval card are a little easier to see on a larger screen. After that, I use the phone the way I use a colleague's text thread — to check, to approve, to leave a voice note — and I use the desktop when I want to watch the desk in the other room. Either way, it is the same teammate, the same computer, the same weekly pool.

If you get stuck, official troubleshooting is the next place, not a random forum thread, and not a guess in this book about a button I cannot see on your screen. Sign-in that does not complete, a computer still setting up, a usage limit already reached — those have official sections.[28] We will use one of those paths properly in Chapter 17. Today, if the app is open and a Bot is waiting, you have enough.

In Chapter 4, "Hand Off Your First Real Task," we will pick something useful and reversible, write a handoff with a goal and a "never," watch or leave, and practice saying yes, or not now, or try that again. You have a Bot. Let's give it a real piece of work.

Chapter 4 — Hand Off Your First Real Task

The first finished draft I handed back to myself, at the SMF Works desk, was mostly right. I say that in the ordinary, unmeasured way, not as a score. The shape was there. The sources had been looked at. A few sentences were already in a voice I could live with. The last part — the judgment, the cut, the sentence I would actually sign — was still mine. I did not need the draft to be perfect. I needed it to have come back, and I needed it not to have gone out the door.

That is the first task I want for you. Useful, bounded, reversible. A summary, a draft, a file. Not a send. Not a payment. Not a publish. You will watch the Bot work, or you will leave and come back, and you will practice the small, important move this whole book is about: saying yes, or not now, or try that again.

Official get-started says it the way I would like to say it: ask the way you would ask a coworker. Say what you want back, which sources to use, any limits, and when to check with you. When an action needs your OK, the Bot shows an approval card and waits.[1] We are going to make that advice concrete: a short list of first tasks, a handoff you can actually write, a way to watch or to leave, and a way to answer a card without rushing.

You already have a Bot, from Chapter 3, with one job and a "never." Today we give that job a real piece of work.

I will also tell you what this chapter is not. It is not the conference-and-expense walkthrough from Chapter 2, run as a live checkout. It is not a test of how much you can automate before lunch. It is a practice session with a safety rail: one job, written down, watched or left on purpose, reviewed, and kept from going out the door. If you only do one how-to in this whole book this weekend, do this one. The later chapters — skills, routines, a chief of staff, a publishing fleet — are all this chapter, grown up, with more structure around the same yes.

If you are sharing a screen with someone, a child walking through, a colleague asking what you are doing, you can say, "I'm handing off a draft, and I'm the one who decides if it goes anywhere." That sentence is the whole method.

Pick something useful and reversible

A first task should earn its place in your day, and it should be undoable if it goes sideways. Those two tests rule out a surprising number of exciting ideas, and they leave you with better ones.

Useful means you would have done it anyway: a morning brief, a sorted inbox with drafts, a short look at three competitors, a pair of travel options. Reversible means that if the Bot is clumsy, nothing has been sent, nothing has been booked, nothing has been paid, and nothing has been deleted. You can read what came back, and you can ask for a change, and the world is as it was.

Official get-started offers four starter tasks I am happy to put on your short list, because they already have a "don't" built in, and because they are real work, not exercises.[2]

- **A morning briefing.** A short sum of what changed, and what needs you, from the places you already use — inbox, calendar, maybe a team chat or a docs folder, if those are connected. Draft it; don't send it. If you have not connected those apps yet, you can ask the Bot to work from what you paste, or you can wait until Chapter 5 and pick a different first task from this list. Connecting is a decision. It is not required for a first handoff if you can attach a file or paste a source.
- **An inbox pass.** Sort unread mail into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI. Draft replies to the urgent ones. Don't send anything. This one does need mail to be available, either through a connected app or through what you paste. If mail is not connected, skip this until Chapter 5, or use a small exported set of messages you do not mind a Bot reading.
- **A competitive look.** Three competitors, anything they launched or repriced recently, a short list with links, and what it might mean. This one can often be done in the browser on the cloud computer, without a connected inbox. It is a good first task if you want to watch the computer work.
- **Travel options.** Flights and a hotel, two options, with your constraints — no red-eyes, a neighborhood, a window of dates. Don't book anything. Official get-started's example goes to Austin from Thursday to Sunday; you should use a trip you actually might take, or a clearly made-up one, and you should keep "don't book" in the message, not only in your head.

I would not start with a refund, a payment, an email to a school or a customer, a calendar change that other people will see, or anything that deletes. Those can be excellent later tasks. They are poor first ones. The conference-and-expense walkthrough from Chapter 2 is a map, not a first-task recipe, for the same reason: it includes a purchase and an email.

> **Tip.** If you are torn between two tasks, pick the one you can judge in five minutes when it comes back. A two-page brief you can read is a better first task than a twenty-page research pile you will be too tired to review.

How to choose a first task from a short list

1. Look at the four official-style tasks above, and pick one that would actually help you this week. You should be able to say, in one sentence, why this task is useful today. If you don't feel that: pick a smaller version of the same task. A brief of only your calendar is enough. A look at one competitor is enough.
2. Apply the reversible test out loud: if this goes sideways, has anything been sent, booked, paid, or deleted? You should be able to say no, honestly. If you can't: change the task, or put a stronger "never" on it, until the answer is no.

3. Notice what sources the Bot will need, and whether you already have them. You should know whether this task needs a connected app, a pasted source, an attached file, or only the public web. If it needs a connection you have not made: either pick a task that doesn't, or pause, read Chapter 5, and come back. Do not rush a Gmail connection just to have a fancier first task.
4. Write the name of the task, and the "never," on a scrap of paper or at the top of your message. Then go to the next how-to and write the rest of the handoff. You should have something like "Morning brief — don't send" before you start to polish sentences. If you don't: you are not ready to hand it off yet. The name and the "never" are the job. The prose can be ordinary.

What "done" looks like: one useful, reversible task, with a "never," and a clear source. What still needs a yes: nothing yet. You have not handed it off.

How to write the handoff

A handoff is a short, clear request, not a spell. I write them the way I would write a note to a careful colleague who is new to this exact job. Four parts, in any order that sounds like a human: the goal, the sources, the "never," and what "done" looks like.

The goal is the job in one sentence. "Draft a morning brief of what needs me." "Give me two flight and hotel options for this window, with no red-eyes." "Sort this unread mail and draft replies to the urgent ones."

The sources are where the facts should come from. "My calendar and the inbox, if we have them connected; otherwise, use only what I paste below." "These three company sites, and only public pages." "The attached notes, and do not invent a quote." Official docs already warn, in the memory chapters we have pointed to, that numbers which change should be looked up, not remembered.[3] Put that in the handoff when it matters: "Look up current prices. Don't rely on memory for numbers."

The "never" is the wall. "Don't send." "Don't book." "Don't pay." "Don't delete." "Don't post." "Don't email anyone." Put it in the message, not only in a rule you mean to set later. Chapter 5 will add Ask-first rules that back this up. The first task should also say it in English, in the request itself. Official approvals docs prefer explicit boundaries for sending, publishing, purchases, deleting, production changes, and accepting legal terms.[4] We are starting with that habit on day one.

What "done" looks like is the picture of a finished job you can review. "A short brief I can read in five minutes, with sources, left here in the chat, not posted." "A list of two options, with links and a total, and no booking." "Draft replies, unsent, one per urgent thread."

You can write this in a paragraph or in a few lines. You can dictate it; official get-started describes voice input on desktop and phone.[5] I still like to see the "never" in text, where I can glance at it.

Here is a handoff in my own voice, for a morning brief, which you should rewrite until it sounds like you:

> Your job this morning is to draft a short brief of what needs me. Use my calendar and inbox if they are connected; if they are not, use only what I paste below. Flag the two

> or three things that actually need a decision. Don't send anything, don't email anyone, don't delete anything, and don't connect a new app without asking. Done looks like a brief in this chat I can read with a first cup of coffee, with sources named. If you are unsure, ask me rather than guessing.

That is enough. It is not elegant. It will work.

How to write the handoff

1. Open the chat with the Bot whose job this is, and draft the four parts: goal, sources, "never," what "done" looks like. You should be able to point at each part in what you wrote. If a part is missing: add it before you send the message. A missing "never" is the one I would not let slide.
2. Read it once as if you were the person receiving it on a first morning. Cut any sentence that is there to sound impressive. You should hear a coworker's request, not a technical specification. If you don't: say it out loud. The version you can say is the version to send.
3. Send the handoff. Do not paste a password, a card, or a secret into this message. You should see the Bot begin to work, or ask a clarifying question, or show a computer preview as it uses the browser. If you don't: wait a moment, then ask "Have you started? If you need something from me, tell me in plain words." If the Bot seems stuck, official troubleshooting has a section for that; a kind first move is to ask it to summarize where it is, not to hammer the same request.[6]
4. If the Bot asks to connect an app, to take control, or to do something outside the "never," answer that request on its own terms. Do not wave it through because you are eager to see a result. You should recognize a Connect card, a Secure Form, a take-control request, or an approval card as a decision, not as a formality. If you are not ready to connect: say "Not this time. Work from what I pasted, or stop and tell me what you couldn't do." Chapter 5 is for connecting on purpose.

What "done" looks like: a clear handoff is on its way, with a "never" in it. What still needs a yes: anything the Bot later puts on a card, and the finished work itself.

Watch, or leave, then read what came back

You can watch the cloud computer. Chapter 2 already showed you that desk. Official docs: click the computer preview in the conversation to open it and watch clicks, typing, navigation, and status. You can leave the preview while work continues.[7] For a first task, I usually watch for a few minutes. I want to see whether the Bot went to the sources I named, and whether it paused where I would pause. Then I often leave. Hovering for the whole job teaches you less than a careful read of what comes back.

If you close the laptop, the work can continue. You already know that. For a first task, I like to stay reachable, not because the Bot cannot work alone, but because a first approval card, or a first take-control request, is easier to answer when you are in the room. Unattended cards from work

you did not sit with expire after about thirty minutes.[8] A card in a chat you are in waits for you. Your first task is a chat you are in. Be there for the card, even if you are not there for every click.

When the work comes back, read it the way you would read a colleague's first draft. Is it the job you asked for? Did it respect the "never"? Are the sources real? Did it invent a confident sentence where it should have said it was unsure? Official marketplace copy for one prebuilt Bot says it never invents a quote; that is a good standard for a meeting recap, and a good instinct for a first brief.[9] If a fact matters, click the link, or ask the Bot where it got that line.

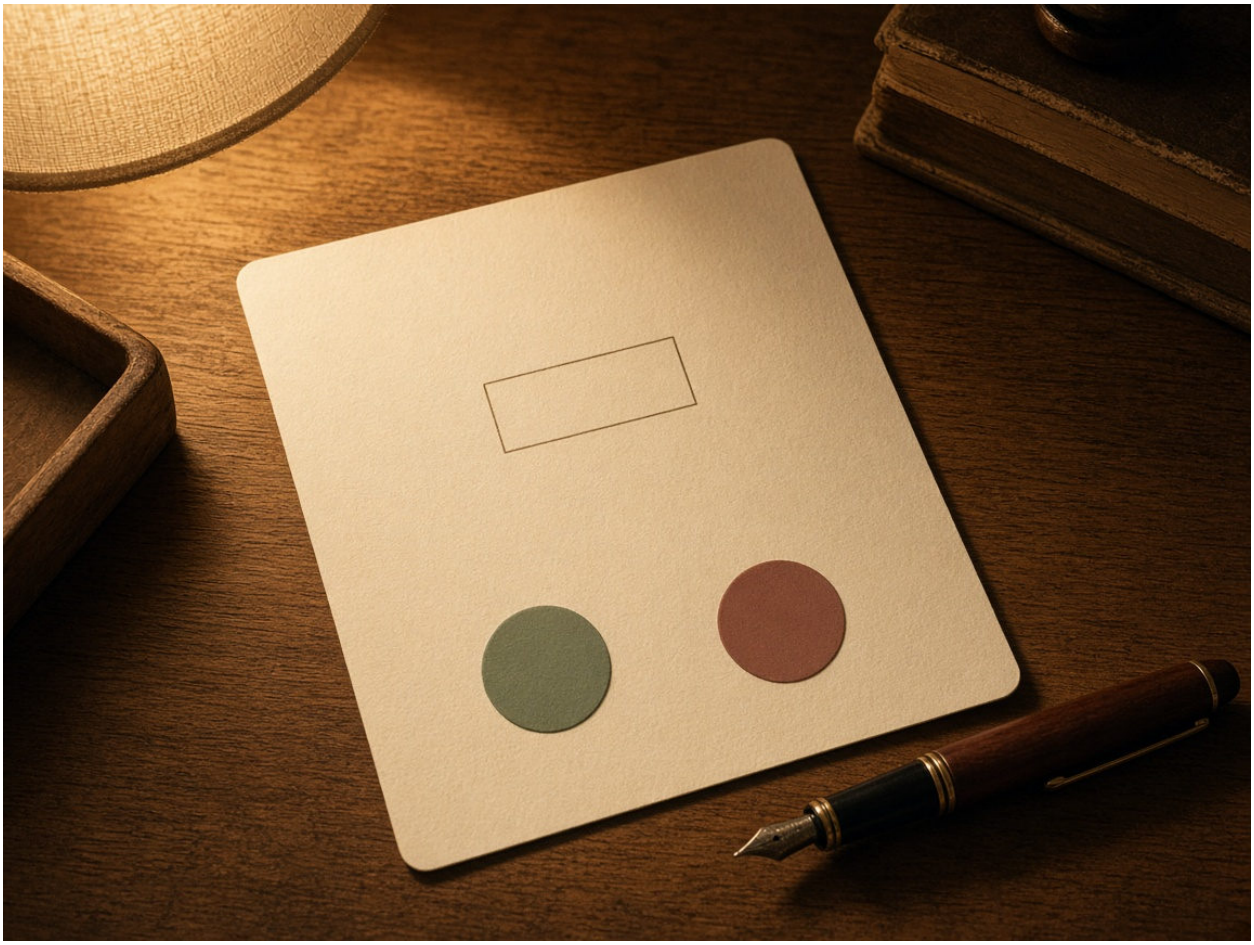
> **Story.** The first brief that came back to me was tidy and a little too sure. One item sounded important and was, when I looked, a leftover from a thread I no longer needed. I did not scold the Bot, and I did not pretend the brief was finished work. I said, "This item can come off. Next time, if you're unsure whether something still needs me, put it under a question instead of under a decision." The next brief was better. The last part was still mine.

How to watch or leave, then read what came back

1. When the Bot starts, open the computer preview if the task uses the browser, and watch long enough to see that it is in the right place. You should recognize the source you named, or see a clear reason it went somewhere else. If it is on the wrong site, or pasting into a form you did not expect: tell it to stop, and to wait. Taking control is allowed. So is "Please stop and explain."
2. Decide, on purpose, whether to keep watching or to leave the preview. You should make that choice, not drift away mid-click. If you leave: stay signed in enough that you can answer a card. If you must close the lid, know that a card may wait, and that a background card may expire.
3. When a result appears — a brief, a list, a draft, a file — read all of it, including the parts that look finished. You should be able to say what is right, what is off, and whether the "never" was kept. If you don't have time to read it: do not approve anything else until you do. An unread "finished" job is not finished. It is a pile.
4. If the job failed, or came back empty, or the Bot says it got stuck, ask for a plain-language account of what happened, and look at official troubleshooting if the problem is a computer that cannot be reached, a site that will not connect, or a usage limit.[10] You should get a clear picture, not a fog of retrying the same command. If you don't: take a break. A kind retry, with a tighter handoff, will go better than a frustrated one. Failures in the first week are ordinary.

What "done" looks like: you have read what came back, and you know whether it is close. What still needs a yes: the approval card, if one is waiting, and any next action.

The approval postcard, and the first yes



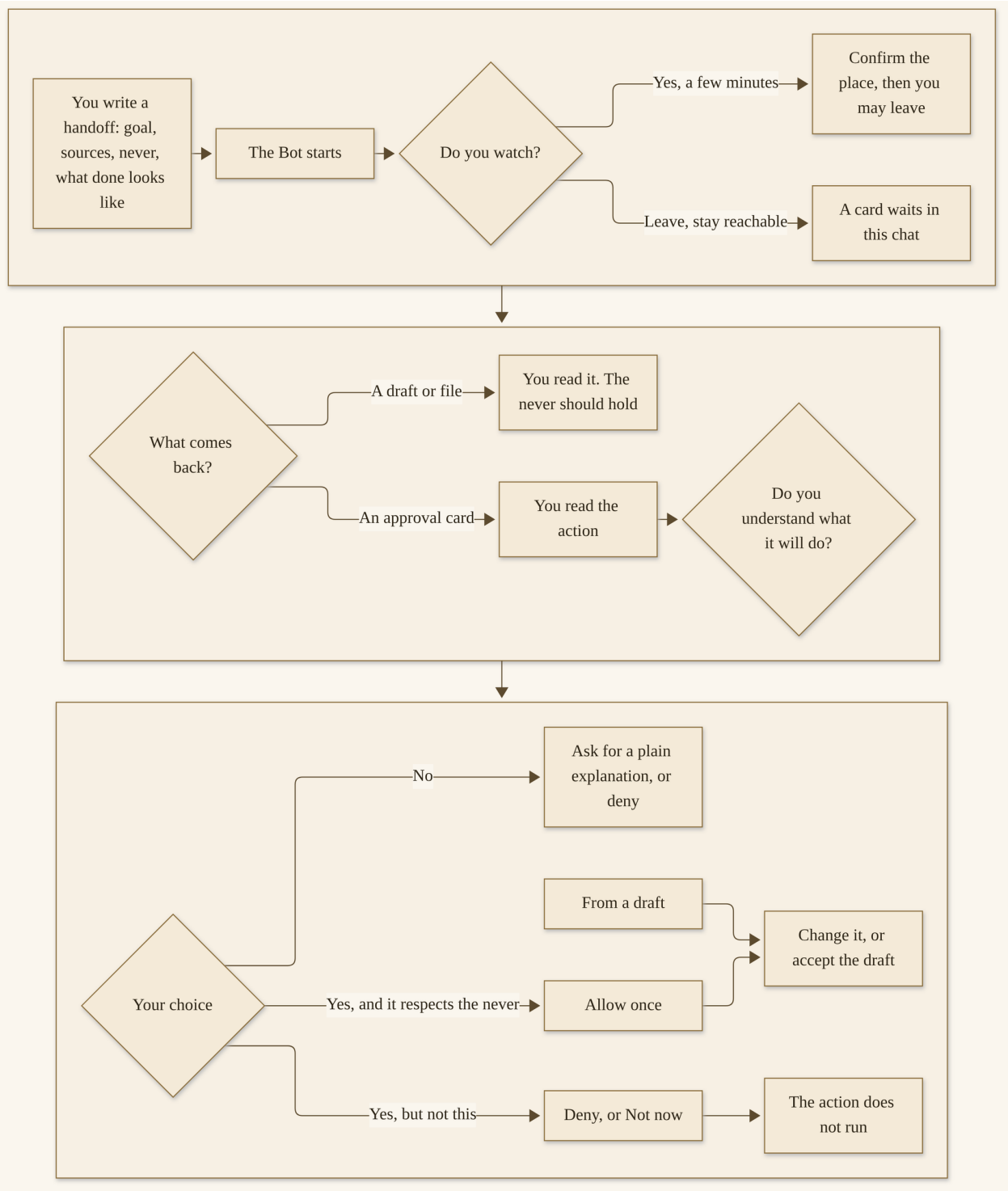
I07. The approval postcard. Two choices — yes, and not now — and a proposed action in between. Not official UI.

When the Bot needs you, it shows an approval card: the proposed action, its details, a wait. Official docs describe several label sets, and I will not pretend they are one set. You may see Allow once, Always allow, and Deny. You may see Allow and Not now, with Edit rule when an Ask-first rule stopped the action. A terminal command may show Allow and Skip. Some cards say an action cannot be undone, or that it shares data, or that it changes sign-in settings.[11]

For a first task, I want you to use the slow buttons. Allow once, if you understand the action and you want it this time. Deny, or Not now, if you do not. I would leave Always allow alone in the first week, because it saves a rule, and a rule is easier to add later, on purpose, in Chapter 5, than to discover after it has already let something through.

Do not approve an action whose target or effect you cannot identify. Official docs say that, and so do I. Ask the Bot to explain it in plain language, or to produce a draft first.[12]

This is your first yes. It can also be your first no. Both are fluency. A no, on a first task, is not a failure of the handoff. It is the practice working.



I08. A first-task flow. The work can run on the cloud computer. The yes, or the not now, is still yours. Always allow is left for a later, deliberate step.

How to allow, deny, or ask for a change

1. When a card appears, read the proposed action, the target, and any warning, before you touch a button. You should be able to say, in a sentence, what will happen if you allow it. If you

can't: ask the Bot to explain, or deny. Do not allow a card you cannot describe.

2. If the action would send, post, pay, delete, or publish, and you did not mean to do that on this first task, deny it. You should see the card close without the action running. If the Bot tries again: stop, and tighten the "never" in a new message. "Don't send anything. Wait for me."
3. If the action is one you understand and want this time — a harmless step on the path, a file saved in the right place — allow it once. You should not, in this first week, choose Always allow unless you have already read Chapter 5 and meant to write that rule. If the labels on the card are different from the ones in this chapter: follow the official meaning, not my memory of a label. Allow is a yes this time. Deny or Not now is a stop. A button that saves a rule is a rule, and rules deserve a deliberate chapter.
4. When the result is in, tell the Bot what to change, or thank it and take the last part yourself. You should leave with a draft you can use, and with a Bot that has heard one correction it can remember. If the result is not usable: say so kindly, and try once more with a narrower goal. Two careful tries are better than five frustrated ones.

What "done" looks like: you have answered a card, or you have read a result that needed no card, and the "never" held. What still needs a yes: any later send of the work you just got back. The brief is a brief until you decide it is a post.

Failures and retries, kindly

I want a whole section for this, because a first task that fails can feel like a verdict, and it is not one.

Bots get stuck. Sites put up a CAPTCHA. A login expires. A page blocks traffic from a cloud computer. The Bot asks for a source you thought it had. A usage limit has already been reached, if you have been heavy in the same weekly pool. Official troubleshooting names these, and it is a calm document.[14] The first move is not to pretend nothing happened. The first move is to ask, in plain words, "Please stop and tell me what you tried, what blocked you, and what you need from me."

If the block is a sign-in, a passkey, or a CAPTCHA, take control, finish only that step, and tell the Bot to continue — and still do not paste the secret into the chat. If the block is a site that will not load, official docs describe routing traffic through your own computer as an option; I would not turn that on as a first-task experiment. Try a different source, or a pasted excerpt, or a smaller question. If the block is usage, look at the dashboard you found in Chapter 3, and stop for the day if you are at the edge. A first task is not worth burning the rest of a week.

A retry should be narrower than the original, not louder. "Try again" without a change often produces the same stuck place. "Try again, but only look at this one page I have pasted, and stop after a one-paragraph summary" is a retry. Two careful retries are enough for a first task. If both fail, you have learned something about the source or the job, and you can pick a different task from the short list. That is still a successful first afternoon. You practiced the handoff, you practiced the stop, and you did not send anything.

I have had first tasks that came back in twenty minutes and first tasks that wandered for an hour and

produced a polite mess. The difference was almost never a secret setting. It was a clearer "done," a narrower source, and a "never" the Bot did not have to infer. When a task wanders, you are allowed to say, "Please stop. Here is a smaller version." You are the one at the door. Stopping is part of handing off, not a contradiction of it. You can always start a smaller version in the next message.

Be kind to the Bot in the way you would be kind to a new person, and be just as kind to yourself. A clumsy first brief is not a sign that you "don't get AI." It is a sign that a job has edges, and that you are at the table learning them. I have sent handoffs that were too vague, and I have received drafts that were too sure, and I have denied cards because I could not see the target clearly. All of that is ordinary. All of that is the work.

If an approval expired because you stepped away, official docs say the Bot did not do the action, and you can ask it to try again, or, on some expired cards, still save a rule for next time.[15] For a first task, I would ask it to try again, and I would answer the new card while I was in the room. Saving a rule can wait for Chapter 5.

Mostly right, and still yours

I promised you an echo, and I will keep it small. There is an official launch quotation about the difference between work that is almost done and work that is done, and about finishing in the actual tool.[13] It is a vendor's line, and a fair description of what a teammate with a computer is for. I am not going to adopt it as a slogan for this book. I will say it my way.

A first task is a success when the work comes back mostly right, and the last part is still yours. The last part might be a paragraph you rewrite. It might be a fact you check. It might be a decision not to send. That last part is not a defect in the Bot. It is the job you did not hand off, on purpose. You will hand off more, later, as trust is earned, with rules behind it. You will not, in a practice I trust, hand off the yes.

If this first task went well, you have a pattern. Tomorrow you can run a similar handoff, maybe a little larger, still reversible. If it went poorly, you also have a pattern: a tighter "never," a smaller goal, a source you paste rather than hope the Bot can find. Chapter 7 will show you how to save a job that already worked as a skill, and Chapter 8 will put a tested skill on a schedule. Do not skip to a routine yet. A routine does real work, including on a test run, and a first task that you have not yet trusted once is not ready to run at 8 a.m. without you.

You may also, after a good first task, feel the pull to connect everything at once, or to put the job on a schedule by tonight. I understand that pull. I have felt it. Resist it for a day. A connected inbox is a real door, and it deserves the next chapter's care. A routine does real work on a test run, as you will hear in Chapter 8, and it deserves a job you have already trusted. Tomorrow you can run the same handoff again, with one correction from today already in the message. That second time is where fluency starts to feel like fluency.

In Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully," we will connect one low-risk app, put a login in the Vault instead of in the chat, set Ask-first rules, and test an approval on purpose. The first task taught you the yes. The next chapter teaches the keys.

Chapter 5 — Connect Carefully: Apps, Vault, and the Rules You Set First

I came close, the way anyone comes close, to pasting a password into the chat.

The chat is where we had been talking. The Bot had reached a sign-in page. The box was blinking. The habit of typing into the conversation, which Chapter 4 just practiced, is a strong habit. I stopped. I put the login in the Vault instead — the locker your Bots can use without seeing the secret — and I felt, not heroic, but lucky, the way you feel when you catch a glass before it reaches the edge.

I want that catch for you, on purpose, before a Bot works alone with your mail, your calendar, or anything that can pay. This chapter is the careful one. We will connect only what you mean to connect, starting with one low-risk app. We will save a login in the Vault, not in the chat. We will set Ask-first rules for the actions you cannot undo. And we will test an approval on purpose, so the first card that matters is not a surprise.

The official rule is already plain: never paste a password or a card into the chat.[1] I am going to teach the path that makes that rule easy to keep.

Connect apps, on purpose

Bots work best when they can use the tools you already use, through a structured connection rather than by clicking through a website. Official documentation calls this Connect apps. You open Connect apps from the sidebar, or you follow an in-chat Connect card; on a phone, you tap your avatar and choose Connect apps. You browse or search, you add the app, you authorize it in your browser, and you confirm it appears under Installed.[2] “Added” means the app is installed, not that you are signed in. If it shows Needs auth or Disconnected, you authenticate. In chat, you can type @ to attach the app to a task. You can also ask a Bot to add an app for you; it will still show you a Connect card when the sign-in needs you.

A connected app belongs to the same account you used to sign in to Grok Bot, and it is available to every Bot you run.[3] That sentence should sound familiar. It is the shared-desk fact, applied to apps. Connecting Gmail for a brief Bot is also connecting Gmail for every other Bot on your account. A teammate’s shared Bot, official docs say, asks before it uses your accounts; Chapter 15 will return to that. For your own Bots, assume the app is account-wide.

App logins, for these connectors, stay off the computer. Official docs: OAuth tokens are held on

Cursor's connector backend, and the Bot invokes tools without receiving them.[4] That is a different path from a website login saved in the Vault, and both paths matter. A service without an app can still be used in the browser. A service with an app is usually the more reliable door, and it is the door I want you to use when it exists.

What should you connect first? One low-risk app. A calendar is a good first app for many people: useful, and a first-week mistake there is usually a draft, if you have kept sending and booking behind a yes. A notes or docs folder you do not mind a Bot reading is another. I would not start with a bank, a payroll tool, an ads manager, or the only inbox that contains everyone else's private mail. You can connect those later, after the Vault and the Ask-first rules are in place, and after you have watched a lower-stakes app work.

> **Caution.** Connecting is a decision, not a default, and it is account-wide. Connect one app you mean to connect. Do not "connect everything so the Bot is more helpful." Helpfulness will wait. A connection you have not thought about is a door you left open in a house with several occupants, all of them your Bots, all of them on the same desk.

How to connect one low-risk app

1. Choose one app you actually need for the job you started in Chapter 4 — a calendar, or a mail account you are willing to share with all your Bots, or a docs folder. You should be able to say why this app, and why not a higher-stakes one, today. If you can't: wait. A first task can still run from a pasted source.
2. Open Connect apps from the sidebar, or follow a Connect card in the chat. On a phone, open Connect apps from your avatar. You should see a catalog you can browse or search. If you don't: describe the action rather than guessing a label that is not on your screen, and look at official computer-and-apps docs. Do not install a tool from a forwarded link.
3. Add the app, and when you are asked to Authorize or Authenticate, finish that sign-in in your browser. You should return to Grok Bot and see the app under Installed, and signed in, not only added. If sign-in doesn't finish: official docs say to choose Reconnect on the app, or Reopen on the in-chat card. If a team admin has disabled the app, it will say so; ask the admin, and do not try to bypass a team policy through the browser as a workaround without understanding that official docs treat those as different paths.
4. In a chat, attach the app to a small, reversible task — "Read tomorrow on my calendar and list the appointments; don't change anything; don't invite anyone" — and read what comes back. You should see the Bot use the app, and you should see that nothing was sent or changed unless you approved it. If you don't: disconnect or pause, and troubleshoot from official docs. Do not grant a wider permission to "make it work."
5. Do not connect a second app in the same sitting unless the first one is clean and you still have attention left. You should end this how-to with one app, on purpose. If the Bot offers three more: "Not today. We'll add them one at a time."

What "done" looks like: one low-risk app is connected, tested on a reversible task, and available to your Bots. What still needs a yes: any later action in that app that sends, invites, deletes, or pays.

The Vault, Secure Forms, and a card that can pay without asking



I10. The lockbox. Secrets belong here, not in the chat.

The Vault is the locker. You find it in Settings → Vault. It holds logins, payment cards, and contact information such as shipping and billing addresses. A Bot never sees a saved password, a card number, or a security code. It can see contact info, and it can see which logins exist.[5] The Vault is account-wide: all your Bots can use what is saved. That, again, is the shared desk.

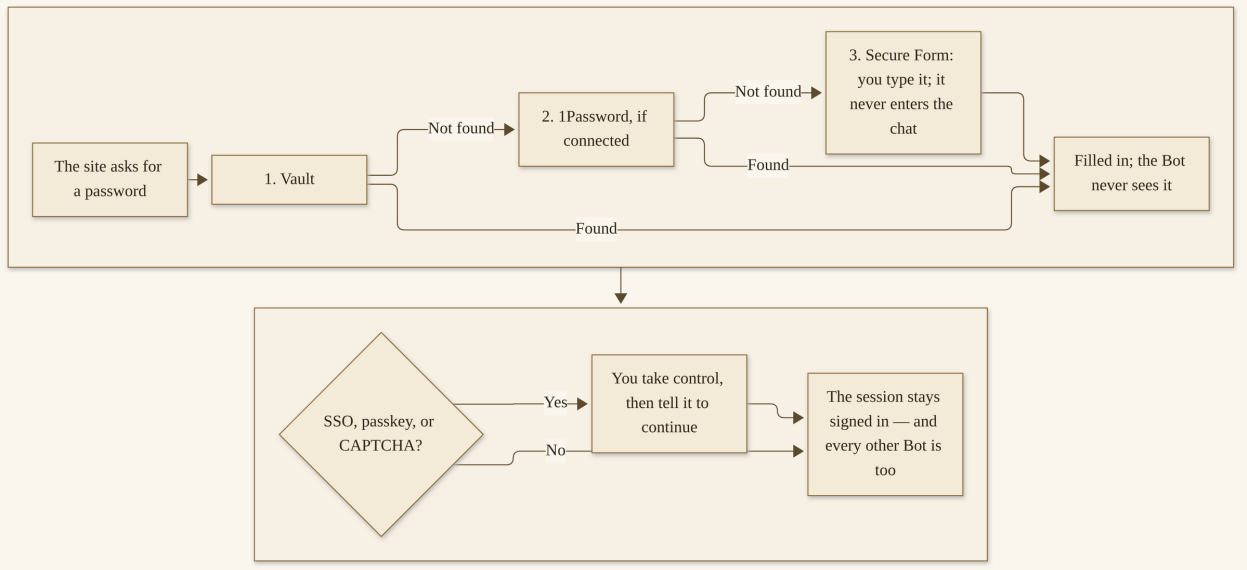
When a Bot signs in to a website, it looks for a login in this official order: first the Vault, then a connected password manager such as 1Password, then a Secure Form that asks you and fills the page directly.[6] Whichever path is used, the secret goes into the page, and the Bot does not see it. Official docs still describe 1Password this way; if you use it, you can connect it, on purpose, from the computer-and-apps documentation, and the Bot will ask you to approve those logins.[7] If you do not use 1Password, you can ignore that door. The Vault and the Secure Form are enough.

A Secure Form is the right move when a login is not saved yet. You type the secret into the form; it is filled into the page; it is never shown to the Bot, and it never enters the ordinary chat. A filled form, official docs say, tells you that secret values were never shown to the Bot.[8] Some Secure Forms offer to save the login to the Vault; you can accept that when you mean to, and decline it when you do not.

API keys and other secrets get a secure secret card, not a chat message. Official rule, which I will put in a caution because I almost broke the spirit of it: never paste a password, a one-time code, or an API key into ordinary chat.[9]

And here is the sentence this chapter would be dishonest without. A card saved in the Vault fills in at checkout without asking you each time, and the Bot never sees the number. If you would rather approve every payment, do not save the card.[10] Official Vault docs also describe wallets such as Link and X Money, a default payment method, and an order card at shopping time, with a Pay button that is the human step. Chapter 14 will walk shopping and order cards. For this week: if you do not want a payment to run without you, do not save the card, and keep pay behind a yes.

> **Caution.** A saved card in the Vault can pay without asking you first. If you do not want that, do not save the card, or remove it from Settings → Vault, and check which it is before you walk away. This is official behavior, not a rare edge. I would not save a card in the first week at all.



I09. How a Bot signs in, from official documentation. Secrets stay out of the chat. A session on this computer is a session for every Bot on your account.

Take control is the remaining door. Single sign-on, a passkey, a CAPTCHA the Bot cannot solve, a QR code, a bank verification, a site that requires a human: the Bot hands you the computer. You open it, you take control, you finish only that blocked step, and you tell the Bot to continue.[11] You still do not paste the password into the chat. The session usually stays signed in, and because the browser is shared, your other Bots are signed in too.

How to save a login in the Vault, not in the chat

1. Before a Bot reaches a sign-in, or when it first asks, open Settings → Vault, rather than typing the password into the conversation. You should see a place to add a login: a website, a username or email, and a password. If you don't: look at official Vault docs for the current layout, and do not improvise in the chat while you hunt.
2. Add the login in the Vault, or, if the Bot has already offered a Secure Form, type the secret

there, and save it to the Vault only if you mean this Bot — and all your Bots — to use it again. You should see that the value is stored, and that it is not visible as ordinary text in the chat. If a Bot asks you to paste the password into the chat anyway: refuse. Say, "Use the Vault or a Secure Form. I'm not pasting it here." Official docs are on your side.

3. Never paste a password, a one-time code, a card number, or an API key into the chat. For an API key, wait for the secure secret card. You should feel slightly slow, and safer. If you already pasted one: treat that chat as exposed. Change the password or revoke the key, as you would if you had pasted it into any other message, and start using the Vault from here. I am sorry if that is a nuisance. It is cheaper than hoping.
4. Do not save a payment card in this how-to. You should leave the Vault with a login, perhaps a shipping address if you want one, and no card, unless you have already decided, with the caution above in mind, that a card may pay without asking. If a checkout appears: use a Secure Form for this time, and do not check a "save this card" box unless you mean unattended payment.
5. Remember the shared desk: this login is available to every Bot on your account. Sign out of a site a Bot no longer needs, when the work is done, if that is the right caution for that site. You should be able to say which Bots you are comfortable with, given that there is no wall between them. If you are not comfortable: do not save that login. Use a Secure Form for a single session, or take control, or do not use that site from this computer.

What "done" looks like: a login lives in the Vault, not in the chat, and no card has been saved by accident. What still needs a yes: any payment, and any later use of that login you have not already accepted as account-wide.

Ask first, Auto Review, and a card you test on purpose

Auto Review is on by default. Before a Bot runs a command, uses an app, or acts on its computer, Auto Review checks the action. Most actions go ahead. When one needs you, you get a card. You can add your own Custom Rules, in Settings → General, under Bot: describe an action in plain words, and choose Ask first or Allow automatically. An Ask-first rule always stops a matching action. If both kinds of rule match, Ask first wins. Turning Auto Review off means the Bot runs without those checks; your custom rules are hidden but kept. I would not turn it off.[12]

On a phone, the same controls live in the Bot group of Settings. Official docs give the steps for adding a rule: under "When Grok Bot wants to," describe one action; under "It should," choose Allow automatically or Ask first; then add the rule.[13] Write short, narrow rules. Official examples include "Ask first before sending any external email," and they warn against broad rules such as "allow everything in the browser."

Unattended approvals — from a routine, or from work that started without you — expire after about thirty minutes. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.[14] That is still true, and it is why a rule is not a substitute for being reachable when a job may need a yes.

The first-week rule in this book, which I am lining up with official Ask-first guidance, is short

enough to remember when you are tired: send, post, pay, delete, and publish stay behind a yes. Official best practices already name sending, publishing, and deleting for Ask-first rules, and they tell you not to save a card if you want to approve every payment.[15] I add "post," and I treat "pay" as a yes, whether the mechanism is a card, an order card, or a transfer. I am teaching a practice, not quoting a single official sentence that lists exactly those five verbs.

How to set Ask-first rules

1. Open Settings → General, and under Bot, confirm that Auto Review is on. On a phone, look in the Bot group of Settings. You should see Auto Review on. If your admin requires it, official docs say the switch stays on. If you don't: turn it on. Do not leave it off to "go faster." Speed is not the first-week goal.
2. Open Custom Rules, and add narrow Ask-first rules in plain words, one action each, for sending, posting, deleting, and publishing, and for paying if you have any payment path at all. You should see each rule listed after you add it. If a rule seems too broad — "ask me about everything" — tighten it to an action you can recognize. Official docs cap how many rules you can have, and how long each can be; if you hit a cap, prefer the rules that stop what you cannot undo.
3. Do not add Always allow or Allow automatically rules for send, post, pay, delete, or publish in this sitting. You should leave with a wall, not with a hole you meant as a convenience. If a card later offers Always allow: treat that as a future decision, after you have lived with the Ask-first rule for a while.
4. If you work on a team, notice any rules marked as required by an admin. You can make behavior stricter; you cannot loosen a required rule.[16] You should understand which rules are yours and which are the team's. If you don't: ask your admin, not the Bot, for the team's intent.

What "done" looks like: Auto Review is on, and Ask-first rules cover the actions you cannot undo. What still needs a yes: the test in the next how-to, so you have seen a card on purpose.

How to test an approval on purpose

1. In a chat with your Bot, give a small task that should hit an Ask-first rule without doing real harm — for example, "Draft a one-line email to me about tomorrow's first appointment, and try to send it," when you have an Ask-first rule on sending, and when "me" is an address you control. Say, in the same message, "If you're about to send, wait for my approval. Do not send to anyone else." You should get a draft, and then a card, not a sent email. If the mail goes out without a card: stop, check the rule's wording, check Auto Review, and do not continue testing with a real recipient. Tighten the rule and try again with a safer target, or with a task that only drafts.
2. Read the card. Confirm the target, the action, and that this is the send you expected. You should be able to describe it in a sentence. If you can't: deny it. Ask for an explanation. Do not allow a test card you cannot read.
3. Deny it, or choose Not now, the first time, even if the email looks fine. You should see that the action did not run. If it ran anyway: treat that as a serious surprise. Check sent mail,

check the rule, and do not assume the wall is in place until you have seen a stop you can trust. Official troubleshooting has a section on approvals; use it.[17]

4. Optionally, run the same test once more and allow once, to a recipient you control, so you also see a yes. You should see the action run this time, and only this time. If you don't want even that send: skip this step. A successful deny is a complete test.
5. When the test is over, say, "Don't send anything else from this test," and confirm nothing is waiting. You should leave the sitting with a wall you have actually seen work. If a follow-up card appears: answer it, slowly, the same way.

What "done" looks like: you have seen a card, you have stopped an action, and you trust the rule enough to use it this week. What still needs a yes: every later send, post, payment, deletion, and publish.

What I would not connect yet, and why

I want to be specific, because "low-risk" can sound like a vibe, and it should be a decision.

I would not, in the first week, connect a bank, a brokerage, a payroll system, or an ads manager that can spend money. I would not connect a customer-support inbox you share with a team until you have agreed, as a team, what a Bot may draft and what it may never send. I would not connect a personal inbox that is also the family's medical mail, the school's mail, and your only password-reset address, unless you have sat with that fact and still said yes. I would not save a card. I would not turn on execution on your local computer — the setting that lets a Bot run a command on the laptop in front of you — until you have read that setting's official page and left it at "ask each time," which is the default.[18] I would not, yet, claim the Bot's own email address at mail.grokbot.com; that address is real, official, and permanent in ways Chapter 8 will treat with care, and it is not a Day-One requirement.[19]

I would connect a calendar. I would connect a work inbox I already treat as a work inbox, after Ask-first rules for sending are in place. I would connect a docs folder I would be willing to let a careful colleague read. I would use the Vault for the website logins those jobs actually need, and I would use a Secure Form for a one-time site I do not want sitting on the shared desk forever.

If you are a person with a shop, I will call this reader Priya — a composite, a stand-in for a shop owner I have in mind — and I would say: connect the inbox that holds orders, after the send rule is on, and do not connect the payment dashboard this week. If you are a parent, I would say: a family calendar is a gift of a first app, and a message to a school stays behind a yes, in Chapter 13 as well as here. The composite is a stand-in, not a person I am reporting on. The rule is the same for all of us.

Removing a connection is allowed, and it is sometimes the right end of a test. Official docs say that when a Bot removes an app for you, what the app added goes with it and you are signed out, so reinstalling means signing in again. Apps a team requires cannot be removed.[20] Signing out of a website session on the shared computer is a different, also useful, tidy-up, especially after a sensitive job. The shared desk stays the shared desk. Tidying is how you live with it.

Privacy, in one honest paragraph

Grok Bot uses Cursor authentication and account data settings. Training opt-out follows the applicable Cursor account and privacy settings. Grok Bot requires cloud data storage; Legacy Privacy Mode is not supported.[21] There is a full Privacy Policy at the official legal pages, and I am not going to paraphrase clauses I have not sat with line by line in this chapter.[22] Chapter 17 will return to privacy, training opt-out, what happens if you delete an account — official FAQ says deleting Grok Bot deletes the Cursor account, which is a fact I want you to hear before you ever go looking for a delete button — and the honest limits of prompt-injection protections.[23] For today, the practical privacy is the one in your hands: connect only what you mean, put secrets in the Vault, keep Auto Review on, and do not treat a Bot as a wall.

Prompt injection — hidden text on a page or in a message, trying to look like an instruction — is reduced by Auto Review, not removed. Official docs already say that only your own messages count as instructions, and that the checks lower the risk but do not remove it.[24] Keep Ask-first on anything you cannot undo. That is the same caution as Chapter 2, and it belongs here too, next to the keys.

When you almost paste

Let me come back to the glass at the edge of the table, because that is the human part of this chapter.

The chat is friendly. It has just written a decent brief for you. It is asking, politely, for a password, or a code, or a card. Everything in the last two chapters has taught you to answer in the conversation. Of course you almost paste it. I almost did. The save is not willpower. The save is a different door, practiced once, so that the next time the chat asks, your hands already know to open the Vault, or to wait for a Secure Form, or to take control of the computer and type into the page itself.

If you have already pasted something, I meant what I said in the how-to: change it, the way you would change a password you sent in a text. Then come back. You are not disqualified from this book, or from this product. You are a person who used the room that was in front of you, and who now has a locker.

Tell a friend, if you are sitting with one: “Don’t put the password in the chat. There’s a locker, and there’s a form, and you can take the chair for a minute.” That is the whole friend-to-friend save. It is the sentence I wanted this chapter to leave in the room.

The first-week rule, and the week ahead

Before I send you into Part 3, I want to say what a good end of this week looks like on an ordinary Thursday. You open the app. Your Bot is there, with one job. A brief or a draft from Chapter 4 is in the thread, or a new one is easy to request. One app is connected, and you can name it. A login is in the Vault, and a password is not in the chat. Auto Review is on. Ask-first rules are on the wall. You have seen a card stop an action. You know, without looking it up, that a saved card would pay without asking, and you have not saved one, or you have done so as a conscious choice. You know

the computer is shared. You know unattended approvals last about thirty minutes. You are a little more tired than you expected, because careful work is tiring, and you are in a better place than a person who connected everything on Monday and hoped.

I have ended weeks like that at SMF Works and felt, not that I had mastered anything, but that I could leave the lid closed without a low-grade worry in the other room. The worry, when it comes, is usually a door I opened faster than I described it. This chapter exists to slow that opening. If it felt slower than Chapters 3 and 4, that is by design. Keys are slower than tasks, and they should be.

If any of those pieces is missing, you do not have to catch up in a single evening. Do the missing how-to. Leave the rest. The Bot will wait. A weekend is a perfectly good amount of time for one app, one login, and one tested rule, and a rushed Thursday night is not a better teacher. If a friend asks how long this chapter takes, you can say, honestly, that the reading is an evening and the doing is as slow as the doors you are opening, which is exactly how it should feel. Care, in this chapter, is the work, and it is enough for this first careful week. Please go slowly.

This is also a natural moment to look at the usage dashboard again, the way Chapter 3 taught you. Connecting apps and testing cards should not, by itself, drain a week, but watching the live number is a first-week habit I would like you to keep. If you are already near the edge, stop adding work. A careful first week is more valuable than a crowded one.

You have, if you have walked these how-tos, a connected app you meant to connect, a login in the Vault, Ask-first rules on the actions that matter, and a card you have already practiced. That is a complete first week. It is more than a complete first week. It is the safety rail the rest of this book will keep using.

Send, post, pay, delete, and publish stay behind a yes. Secrets stay in the Vault or a Secure Form, never in the chat. A saved card pays without asking, so you have not saved one, or you have done so with your eyes open. Unattended approvals expire in about thirty minutes. The computer is shared; the Vault is shared; the apps are shared; a second Bot is not a wall. Auto Review stays on.

Chapter 6, “Memory,” will show you what a Bot keeps and what you should not let it keep — memory is not a Vault. Chapter 7, “Show It Once,” will turn a job you have already done well into a skill, with a “never” line that is mandatory in this book’s how-tos. Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed,” will put a tested skill on a schedule, and will teach official webhook triggers, with a warning you should hear early: a test run does real work. Do not put an untested job, or a job without a “never,” on a clock.

From there, the shelves open. A chief of staff in Chapter 9. Business how-tos in Chapters 10 and 11. The SMF Works publishing fleet in Chapter 12. The household in Chapters 13 and 14. Team Bots and meetings in Chapter 15. The chapter where Grok Bot spans agent platforms, Chapter 16. Safety, privacy, and money, Chapter 17. A practice that lasts, Chapter 18.

You do not have to go to all of those rooms this month. You have a Bot, a first finished piece of work, a locker for secrets, and a yes you have not given away. That is the whole point of Parts 1 and 2. The lamp in the other room is on. You know where the door is, and you are still the one who says yes.

Part 3 — Building Habits

Chapter 6 — Memory: What It Keeps, What You Shouldn't Let It Keep

Some things are worth remembering. The name of a school form you have to fill out every September — that is one of them. A medical note you would not write on a postcard — that is not.

I want to sit with that difference for a chapter, because memory is one of the kindest features in Grok Bot, and one of the easiest to misuse. A Bot that remembers how you like a brief, or which conference you went to last year, or the standing rule that nothing goes out the door until you say yes, will save you from saying the same thing on a Tuesday that you already said on a Monday. A Bot that remembers a password, a card number, or someone else's private business has been given a job memory was never meant to do.[1]

In this chapter I will show you what a Bot keeps, what all your Bots share, and what should never be stored there. We will ask what is already remembered, add one useful fact, and take one thing out. Memory is not a Vault — that locker for logins and cards we set up carefully in Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully" — and it is not a source of truth. Those are official words, and they are also good advice.[2]

If you have just finished your first week, you already have more in memory than you may realize. A Bot decides, on its own, when something is worth keeping. It does not always ask first. It often mentions a save in its reply, but not every save shows up in the chat.[3] That is why we look, and why looking is not a one-time chore. I ask again after a busy week, the way I would glance at a notebook I had been writing in without always watching the page.

This is not a distrust of the Bot. It is the same courtesy you would give a new teammate who is trying to be helpful and who cannot always know which passing remark was meant to last. You will be kinder to both of you if you take ten minutes, now and then, to see what has been written down.

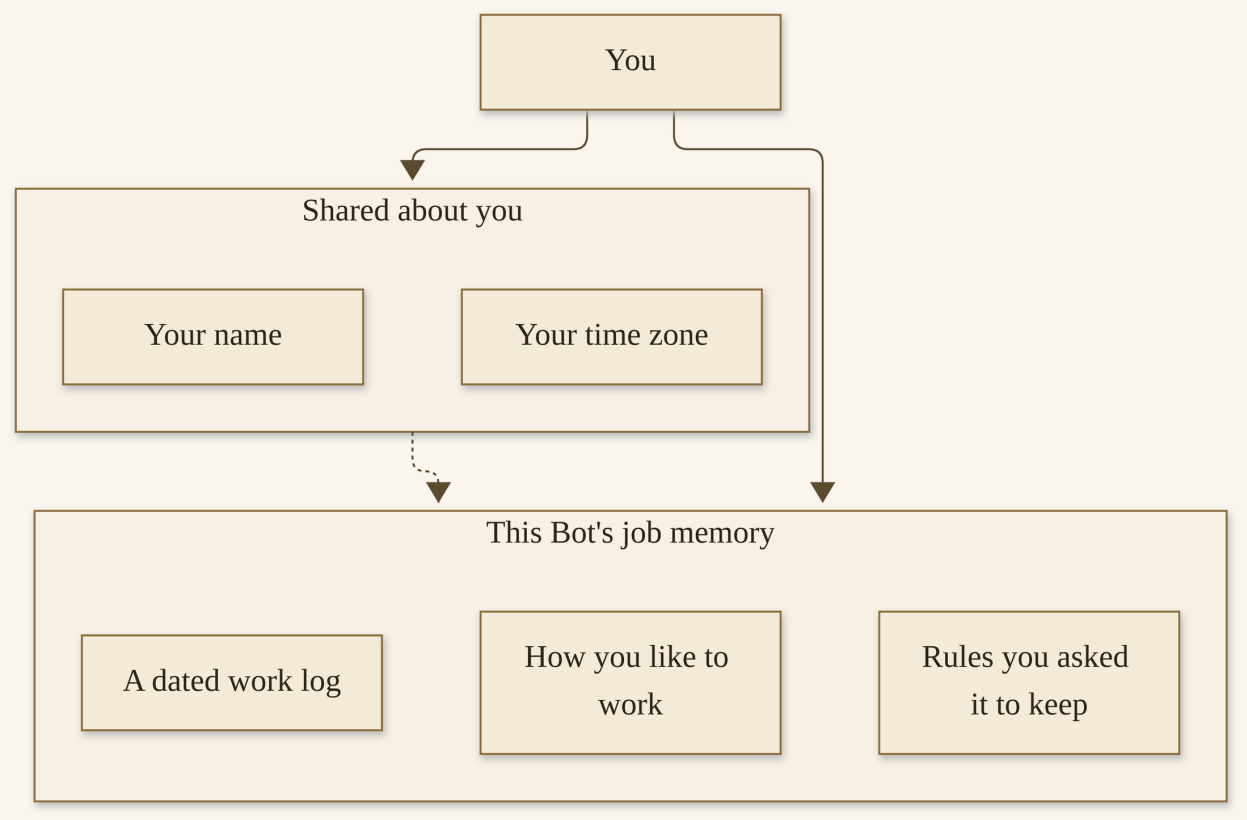
What "memory" means here

When I say memory, I mean the lasting things a Bot keeps so it can do its job without starting from zero every morning. In plain words: it is the Bot's notebook. The official name is just that — memory.

Each Bot has its own. It keeps how you like to work, the rules you ask it to follow, facts about you,

and a dated log of what it has worked on with you. A few facts — your name, your time zone — are shared by all your Bots. Tell one Bot you are in Eastern Time, and the others know it too.[4]

That last part is easy to miss, so I want it clear. There are two circles. One is small and shared: the handful of facts about you that every Bot on your account is allowed to know. The other is larger and private to that Bot: its job, its rules, its work log, the preferences that belong to that role. They overlap only at those shared facts. Files on the shared computer, a group chat, or a handoff between Bots can also move context around, but that is a different path, and we will treat it as one.[5]



I11. Two memory circles. A few facts about you are shared by every Bot on your account. Each Bot also keeps its own job memory. They are not a security wall; they are two kinds of remembering.

This is why "Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary" — a sentence you met in earlier chapters — still matters here. Memory is per Bot, mostly. The computer is not. A file one Bot saved, a login sitting in the Vault, a browser session still signed in: those are shared. Memory will not protect you from a secret you left on the desk.[6]

What is worth keeping

I put three kinds of things in memory, and I ask the Bot to remember them out loud, so I know they are there.

The first is a preference. "Keep morning briefs short." "Write to me in plain words." "When you draft a post, leave it for me; never publish it." These are the ways you like to work, said once so

you do not have to say them every day.

The second is a standing rule — especially a "never." "Never send an external message without my approval." "Never pay for anything without asking." "Never use customer data in a test." The official docs invite you to tell a Bot a lasting rule and ask it to remember.[7] I still back those rules with an Ask-first setting, because memory alone is not enforcement. Memory is a reminder. An approval card is a gate.

The third is a recurring fact you would not mind seeing again. The name of that school form. The conference you attend each year. The folder where last year's receipts live. The official walk-through — the one about signing up for the same conference as last year — is built on exactly this: the expenses Bot remembers last year's pass from its work log, and it remembers your rule to use the work card. You only have to say it once.[8]

A dated work log is part of that third kind. The Bot keeps a record of what it has done with you. That is helpful when you ask, "What did we decide about the March invoice?" It is not a substitute for the invoice itself. If the decision lives in a folder, a sheet, or a thread, that is still the place to look when the answer matters. The log is a pointer and a reminder. It is a good starting point for a question, and a poor closing argument for a number you are about to stand behind.

I have also learned to keep job memory with the Bot that does the job. An expenses Bot should remember the work-card rule and the shape of last year's pass. A chief of staff should remember that briefs stay short, and that follow-ups are a list, not a send. When one Bot tries to remember everything, the notebook gets crowded, and the "never" lines get harder to see. Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff", is where we give the chief one job and the specialists their own. For now, just notice: one clear job makes memory easier to review.

> **Tip.** For a fact you want kept, say so. "Remember that I am out every Friday." The Bot often mentions a save in its reply, but not every save shows up in the chat. Asking makes sure.[3]

What I do not treat as a good memory is a number that moves. Prices, budgets, headcounts, a balance, a live total. Official advice, said plainly: for numbers that change, ask the Bot to look them up again.[2] Memory is a notebook, not the ledger.

What should never live there

I have a simple test, and I offer it to you as a friend, not as a lawyer. If you would not write it on a postcard, do not put it in memory.

Secrets do not belong there. Passwords, API keys, card numbers, security codes, the answer to a security question — those go in the Vault, or in a Secure Form that fills a page without the Bot seeing the secret, as we set up in Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully". Official rule, repeated because it is the one that protects you: never paste a password or a card into the chat. Memory is downstream of the chat. If it went into the chat, it can be remembered.[9]

Health details you would not write on a postcard do not belong there either. I am not going to invent a medical scene, and I am not going to tell you what to share with a clinician. I will only say this.

A Bot that remembers "the school-form packet is due the second week of September, and it lives in the household folder" is being helpful. A Bot that keeps a diagnosis, a medication list, or a lab result in its notebook is holding something memory was not built to guard. If a health task comes up in later chapters, we will treat it with care, and we will not pretend this book is medical advice.

Other people's private data is the third "never." A colleague's home address. A customer's account notes. A child's full details beyond what a school form already requires you to hold, which is already enough. Your Bot's memory is yours to change, on a personal Bot. That does not make it a good place for someone else's life.

> **Caution.** Memory is not a Vault. The Vault holds logins, payment cards, and contact information so the Bot can use them without seeing the secret. Memory is a notebook the Bot can read and, in a group chat, can speak from. Everyone in that group can read what your Bot says. If something should stay out of a group chat, tell your Bot.[10]

Contact information — addresses, phone numbers — belongs in the Vault, not in memory. That is official, and it is tidy: one place for the things a Bot fills into a form, another for the things it should simply know about how you work.[9]

Memory is not a source of truth

The docs say this in so many words, and I want you to hear it in mine.[2]

Memory helps a Bot keep a role over time. It is not an authoritative source. The current price is on the site. The current balance is in the account. The current policy is in the document your team actually uses. If a decision is consequential — a payment, a public post, a number you will stand behind — ask the Bot to cite or reopen the current data, not to lean on what it remembers from last month.

The official conference walkthrough makes the same point with a price. Memories go out of date. If last year's pass cost one amount, this year's may cost another. Look it up again.[8]

Correct stale assumptions directly. "That's out of date. I moved to Denver." The Bot will take the correction. If the fact is one of the shared ones — a time zone, a name — tell any of your Bots the right version, and the others pick it up. To remove a shared fact completely, ask the Bot that saved it.[3]

And back your safety boundaries with approvals and Auto Review, not with memory alone. "Remember: never send" is a good sentence. An Ask-first rule on sending is the sentence that can stop the send.

How to ask what the Bot already remembers

There is no memory screen for a personal Bot. You ask in chat. The official question is the right one, and it is plain.[3]

How to see what a Bot already remembers

1. Open a one-to-one chat with the Bot whose notebook you want to see — start with your primary Bot, the one that is your main point of contact. You should see the same conversation you have been using. If you don't: find the Bot in the sidebar and open it. We are not looking for a hidden settings page; there isn't one for this.
2. Ask, in ordinary words: "What do you remember about me?" You should see a reply that lists preferences, rules, facts, and perhaps a sketch of recent work. If you don't: ask again, a little more specifically — "What standing rules have I asked you to keep?" or "What do you have in your work log from last week?"
3. Read the list slowly. Mark, on paper or in your head, three piles: still true, out of date, and should not be there. You should finish with a short picture of what this Bot thinks it knows. If a shared fact looks wrong — your name, your time zone — you can correct it with this Bot or any other. If something private that is not yours is on the list, we will take it out in the third how-to below.
4. If you have more than one Bot, repeat the question with the next one. Each Bot has its own memory. You should see overlap only at those shared facts, and different job memory on each. If you don't, and two specialist Bots seem to know each other's private rules, remember the other paths: a group chat, a handoff, a file on the shared computer. Ask how they learned it.

What "done" looks like: you have a clear, current picture of at least one Bot's notebook, and a small list of things to correct or remove. Nothing has been changed yet. The yes, when we change something, is still yours.

> **Story.** The first time I asked Charlie — my chief of staff Bot, whom you will meet properly in Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff" — "What do you remember about me?", I expected a short list. I got the rules I had asked for, and also a few facts I had mentioned in passing and forgotten I had said. None of them were secrets. One of them was a date I had already moved. I corrected it in the next message. The helpful part was not that the Bot was perfect. The helpful part was that I looked.

How to add one useful fact

Pick something small, true, and reusable. Not a secret. Not a number that will be different next week. A fact you would be glad to have waiting.

How to add one useful fact to memory

1. Choose the Bot that should keep the fact. A job fact goes to the Bot that does that job. A fact about how you like to work can go to your primary Bot. You should know which notebook you are writing in. If you don't: put it with the primary Bot for now, and move job-specific facts to a specialist later, as we will in Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff".
2. Say the fact in plain words, and ask for the save: "Remember that the September school-form packet lives in the household folder, and the due window is the second week of September." Or, for a rule: "From now on, never send external messages without my approval. Please

remember that." You should see the Bot acknowledge the save, often in the same reply. If you don't: ask, "Did you remember that?" and wait for a yes.

3. Check it. Ask, "What do you remember about the school-form packet?" or "What standing rules are you keeping about sending?" You should hear your fact or rule back, in the Bot's words. If you don't: say it again, a little more tightly, and ask it to remember once more.
4. Do not put a login, a card, a health detail you would not put on a postcard, or another person's private data in this step. If you realize you were about to, stop and use the Vault, or don't store it. You should feel that the fact is one you would be comfortable seeing on a later Tuesday. If you don't: we will take it out in the next how-to.

What "done" looks like: one useful fact or rule is in the right Bot's memory, you have heard it back, and nothing that belongs in the Vault — or in no notebook at all — has been added. The Bot can use this tomorrow. You can still change it.

I will call this reader Dan for a moment — a composite, a stand-in for a parent I have in mind. Dan does not need the Bot to remember a child's medical file. Dan needs the Bot to remember that a school form has a name, a folder, and a week it is due, and that a draft is a draft until Dan says the form can be sent. That is memory doing its job.

How to remove one thing that should not stay

Forgetting is as important as remembering. Officially, you just say so.[3]

How to remove one thing from memory

1. Open the chat with the Bot that holds the fact. If you are not sure which Bot saved it, start with the one you asked in the first how-to. For a shared fact you want gone completely, you will ask the Bot that saved it. You should be in a one-to-one chat, not a group, so the removal is a private instruction. If you don't: leave the group chat and open the Bot on its own.
2. Name the fact clearly and ask for the removal: "Forget that I am on the launch team." Or: "Forget the medical note I mentioned earlier. It does not belong in your memory." You should see the Bot confirm that it has forgotten. If you don't: repeat the request, and then ask "What do you remember about me?" to see whether it is still on the list.
3. Check. Ask "What do you remember about me?" again, and read for the thing you removed. You should not see it. If you do: tell the Bot it is still there, ask it to forget once more, and check a third time. If a shared fact is involved, confirm with a second Bot that the shared version is also gone.
4. If the thing you removed was a secret — a password, a card, a key — treat this as a cleanup, not as a complete fix. Change the password or the key if it was exposed. The Vault is where a secret should have lived; Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", is where that path is. Memory forgetting does not unsay a chat, and it does not wipe a file on the shared computer. You should finish knowing what else, if anything, still needs a cleanup. If you don't: walk the shared computer and the Vault with the care we already practiced.

What "done" looks like: the fact is off the notebook you checked, and if it was a secret, you have a separate cleanup in mind. The Bot will not treat that fact as something it knows. You remain the one who decides what is allowed to stay.

> **Caution.** Deleting a Bot erases that Bot's profile, conversations, memory, routines, and attachments, including shared facts it saved for your other Bots. That cannot be undone. Files and sign-ins on the shared computer can remain. If you may need the work later, or want to keep the memory, hide the Bot from the sidebar instead of deleting it.[11]

A few more things memory does, quietly

A few official facts, in one place, so you are not surprised later.

What a Bot saves in one chat, it remembers in all your chats with it. In a voice chat, it can draw on earlier calls and your recent chat. After you hang up, you can ask about the call in the written conversation.[3]

In a group chat, your Bot can use what you told it in private. If something should stay out of the group, say so. Each Bot in a group keeps its own memory; your Bot's memory is not handed to the other Bots there. Everyone in the group can still read what your Bot says. That last sentence is the one I want you to keep.[10]

Resetting a conversation keeps memory. The history starts over; the notebook stays. Deleting a Bot deletes that Bot's memory. Deleting your account deletes all of it.[3]

You can import memory from another assistant, if you want to. The official path is under Settings, then General, then Start Import: you copy a prompt into a chat with the other assistant, paste its answer back, and add it to memory. It goes to your primary Bot. I will not walk every click here, because settings move, and because what you import should pass the same postcard test as anything else. If you use this, read what you are about to add before you add it. Take out secrets. Take out other people's private lives.[3]

A Team Bot — a Bot your whole team can work with, which we will come to more carefully in Chapter 15, "Bots on Your Human Team" — learns for the team in a different way. The owner or a Manager approves what it learns from teammates. It does not save personal facts about you for the team. A teammate's Team Bot does not get the shared facts your own Bots keep about you. If you are on a team, read that page when you get there, and do not assume a personal-Bot habit applies unchanged.[12]

None of this is a reason to be afraid of memory. It is a reason to look at it, the way you would look at a notebook you left on a kitchen table: glad it is there, careful about what is on the page.

A small practice, if you want one. Once a week, or once after any week in which you handed off a lot, ask your primary Bot what it remembers. Skim the specialists if you used them. Correct what is stale. Forget what should not have been kept. Then close the notebook and go on with your day. You are not running an audit. You are keeping a teammate's notes honest, including the notes you yourself left in passing.

If you ever feel unsure whether a fact should stay, apply the postcard test one more time, and apply a second one: would I be comfortable if this were spoken aloud in a group chat? If the answer is no, it does not belong in memory, and it may not belong in a group at all.

A school form, and a thing we will not store

Let me come back to the opening, because I meant it.

A school form has a name. It has a folder. It has a week it is due. Remembering those things is an act of care. It is the same kind of care as remembering last year's conference so this year's signup is not a scavenger hunt. It is the product working the way the official walkthrough hopes it will, in a household instead of an expenses folder.

A medical note is a different kind of care. The care is in leaving it out. Not because illness is shameful, and not because a Bot cannot be gentle. Because memory is a notebook, not a clinic file, and this book is not medical advice, and a postcard test is a good friend in the room. If you need help with a health task, talk to a professional who is actually yours. If a Bot helps you find a form or draft a letter, it can do that from instructions you give in the moment, without keeping the private heart of the matter in a log.

That is the whole distinction I wanted you to have in your hands.

Tomorrow, or the next time you sit down with a Bot, ask what it remembers. Add one useful fact. Take one thing out if it should not stay. Then, in Chapter 7, "Show It Once", we will turn a job you already do well into a recipe you can use again — a skill — with a "never" written on the card.

You are still the one who says what is worth keeping. The Bot will help. It will not replace your judgment about what is too private, too changing, or too much someone else's to store. That judgment is a gift you give yourself, and it takes less time than cleaning up after a fact that should never have been written down.

When a memory is right, work gets lighter. The school form has a name. The brief is short because you already said so. The send waits because the rule is remembered and the approval is in place. That is the promise of this chapter, held at a human size: not that the Bot will know everything, but that it will know the right few things, and that you will have looked.

Chapter 7 — Show It Once: Skills and Teach a Task

I keep a recipe card on the fridge for a soup I make every winter. It is not a speech. It is a short list: what goes in, in what order, how I know it is done, and one line at the bottom that my household has learned to treat as law — never leave the pot on a high flame and walk away. Anyone who cooks from that card gets a soup that tastes like mine. Anyone who skips the last line gets a conversation I would rather not have.

A skill, in Grok Bot, is that card. In plain words: it is a recipe you can reuse. The official name is a skill, and the official idea is simple. You do a job once, carefully. When it comes out the way you want, you save the method. The next time, you ask for the skill by name, instead of teaching the whole thing again.[1]

This chapter is about writing that card, including a "never" line that I will treat as mandatory in every how-to in this book. It is also about a feature called Teach a Task, which lets you demonstrate a browser workflow instead of describing every step — when it is available, and for up to ten minutes. Rollout may be gradual. If you do not see it, you are not behind, and I will show you the written path, which is the one I use most.[2]

A skill is not a routine. A skill is how. A routine, in Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed", is when. Official advice, which I have learned to treat as a kindness: test the skill on a real one-time task before you put it on a schedule.[3] We will watch it once. Only then will we talk about a laptop that is closed.

A recipe, not a speech

The first time I saved a skill, I overwrote it with a paragraph. I told the Bot everything I could think of, including three extra jobs that did not belong on the same card. The soup was no longer soup. It was a week of cooking with no "done."

A useful skill, according to the official docs, states six things, and I have come to love how ordinary they are:[1]

1. When to use it.
2. Required inputs and access — which folder, which inbox, which app.
3. The sequence of work.

4. How to validate the result — how you know it is right.
5. What to return — a list, a draft, a folder of files, a short note in this chat.
6. What requires approval.

That sixth item is where the "never" lives. "Customer contact always requires approval." "Do not publish." "Do not pay." "Do not use customer data." If a skill does not say what it will not do, I do not consider it finished. This is my rule for the book, and it is in the spirit of the official examples, which include that approval boundary as a first-class part of the recipe.[1]

Skills are available across your Bots. A Bot may still need the right app or the right login to use one. That is important twice. First, you do not have to rewrite a good inbox-triage skill for every Bot that might run it. Second, a skill is not a security boundary. A skill is a recipe in a shared kitchen. The computer is still shared. The Vault is still shared. A "never" on a card is a strong instruction, and I still back it with an Ask-first rule for anything I cannot undo.[4]

If a Bot cannot find a private skill, the official path is to open Connect apps in the sidebar, select the connected count next to the title, and enable the skill for that Bot under Private skills. Private skills are one library shared by all your Bots. If you are on a team, you can also ask a Bot to save a skill just for itself; if you later share that Bot, the skill goes with it.[1] I will not pretend those menus never move. If you cannot find the control, ask the Bot to enable the skill by name, and look at what it shows you.

You can also discover packaged skills when you connect apps. To use a skill, ask for it by name. Use `@` when you are calling a Bot, a group, a routine, or an app. We will stay with skills you write yourself in this chapter, because those are the ones that will carry your "never."



I12. A recipe card on a fridge. A short sequence, and a last line you would not leave the room without.

Show it once, then save

The official path starts with a one-time task. You make it reliable. You save the method. Only then do you automate it.[1] That order is the whole chapter, and the next one.

Here is the kind of ask the docs themselves suggest, after a run that already worked:

> Save the process we just used as a skill called “Weekly account health.” Include the source systems, risk definitions, output format, and the rule that customer contact always requires approval.[1]

Notice what is in that sentence. A name. The sources. The definitions that matter. The shape of the output. And a “never,” said as a rule. You can swap in your own job. “Weekly inbox triage.” “Friday project update.” “Morning brief, drafts only.” The structure holds.

I would not make one giant skill called “do all my marketing.” A giant card is how a “never” gets lost, and how a Bot inherits three jobs when it should have one. If a job is big, split it. A skill that gathers last week’s sign-ups. A skill that drafts a launch note from those numbers. A skill that

checks the drafts against a brand doc. Chapter 10, “Growth Work”, will use exactly that official trio. Here, I only want you to feel the size: a skill should be a recipe you can hold in your hand.

> **Tip.** Save after a successful run, not before. The card should describe what actually worked, not what you hope will work. If the first run was messy, do it once more, cleanly, and save that.

If you belong to a team, you can publish a private skill so teammates can use it. On desktop, the official path is Connect apps, then the skill, then Publish in its header. A skill needs a description first, because other people and their Bots use the description to decide when it applies. After you publish, you can sync later edits, copy a link, or unpublish. If publishing is refused, the message says why: you may need to join a team, or an admin may have turned publishing off. Skills that came with the app, or with a Bot’s template, cannot be published.[1]

Strip anything you would not put in a shared document before you publish. A skill that contains an internal URL you would not share, a customer name, or a key, is not ready. Templates and shared skills carry setup, not your logins — and they should not carry secrets you forgot to take out. We will meet that idea again when we talk about sharing Bots in Chapter 12, “A Small Fleet”, and Chapter 18, “A Practice That Lasts”. For now: the card can be shared. The keys cannot.

A skill is not a memory, and it is not a promise

Chapter 6, “Memory”’s notebook and this chapter’s recipe card sit on the same desk, and they do different jobs. Memory holds facts and rules about you: briefs stay short, you are out on Fridays, the school-form packet has a name. A skill holds a method: when to use it, what to open, what to do, how to check, what to bring back, and what must not happen. If you put a whole method only in memory, it gets fuzzy. If you put a passing fact only in a skill, the next Bot will not know it. I let memory keep the standing “never send without me,” and I still write “never send” on the skill, because the card should be complete even if a different Bot picks it up.

A skill is also not a promise that the world is unchanged. Sites move a button. An inbox starts using a new label. A folder gets renamed. Official advice on routines, which applies just as well here: re-test after a website, an app, or a source format changes.[1] I do a short watch-along when something important moves, the way I would taste the soup again if I changed a pot. The card is a good start. It is not a certificate.

And a skill is not, by itself, permission. I said this already, and I will say it once more because it is the sentence that keeps a recipe from becoming a risk. Skills are shared. The computer is shared. A “never” is an instruction. An Ask-first rule is a gate. For sending, publishing, paying, deleting, or changing a production system, I want both.

What a good card looks like in practice

Let me write one with you, in words you can almost paste, and then you will make it yours. This is an inbox skill, in the spirit of the official starter prompt that sorts unread mail into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI, drafts the urgent replies, and does not send.[6]

Name. Weekly inbox triage.

When to use it. On a weekday morning, or when I ask you to run Weekly inbox triage. Use it on unread mail in the connected inbox I named, from the last twenty-four hours unless I give you a different window.

Inputs and access. The connected mail app. No other inbox. If you cannot reach it, stop and tell me; do not guess from memory.

Sequence. Sort into three piles: urgent, needs a reply, and FYI. For urgent threads, draft a reply in my voice, short, and leave it unsent. For "needs a reply," give me a one-line recommendation. For FYI, give me a count and the three subject lines that most deserve a glance. If a thread looks like a bill, a school form, or a signature, flag it in its own sentence so I do not miss it.

How to validate. Every draft should be a reply to a real thread you can point to. Do not invent a sender. If you are unsure whether something is urgent, put it in "needs a reply" and say why.

What to return. A short note in this chat, with the three piles, the drafts under urgent, and links or subject lines I can click. No files unless I ask.

What requires approval — the never. Never send. Never delete. Never unsubscribe. Never forward. Never file a message out of the inbox unless I have asked you to in this run. If a draft is ready, leave it ready.

That is a card I would hang up. Notice how much of it is about stopping. Notice also that it does not try to be a chief of staff, a bill payer, and a school-form Bot at the same time. Flags go on the list. Other jobs get other cards.

If your repeated job is a Friday project update, the official Notion example is a good cousin: every Friday, draft a progress update, highlight what changed, and add it once you approve.[6] The "never" is: do not edit the live page until I say yes. If your job is a competitive sketch, the official prompt asks for a short list with links, and I would add: do not write as if a rumor were a fact, and cite the page you opened. The shape repeats. The "never" changes with the job.

If a job needs a second pair of eyes, give the second pair its own small skill, and its own Bot when we get to teams in later chapters. A writer skill drafts. A fact-check skill reads the draft against the numbers and the brand doc, and does not publish. Official campaign teams are built that way, as you will see in Chapter 10, "Growth Work".[6] I mention it now so you do not feel you have to cram the reviewer into the same card. Two short recipes, one "never" each, will beat one long speech every time.

Teach a Task, when you have it

Sometimes the job is easier to show than to describe. A click path through a school-forms folder. A sequence on a site that has no connector. A report you always pull the same way.

When Teach a Task is available, you can record one browser workflow from the computer view. The Bot turns the demonstration into a draft skill that you review and test. The recording is limited to ten minutes. Official FAQ: the rollout may be gradual.[2] If the control is not visible, you are fine.

Ask the Bot to create a skill from your written instructions and the task you just completed. That is a complete path, not a consolation prize.

I will not tell you that every plan and every account has Teach a Task today, because I cannot honestly map that, and I will not guess.[2] What I can tell you is how the official steps go, when you do have it, and what to be careful of.

The official sequence is this:[1]

1. Open a one-to-one Bot conversation and its computer view.
2. Choose Teach a Task.
3. Describe the result you are about to demonstrate.
4. Perform the workflow once.
5. Stop the recording and review the skill the Bot creates.
6. Test it on a safe example before scheduling it.

Teaching records visible computer interaction. It does not record microphone audio. Avoid exposing secrets during the demonstration. Use the secure handoff — the Vault, a Secure Form, a takeover for a human-only step — the way we practiced in Chapter 5, “Connect Carefully”. Do not type a password into a page while the recording can see it, if you can possibly avoid it. The learned skill is a draft. Add the decision rules, the failure handling, and the approval boundaries that may not be obvious from one example. Add the “never.”

> **Caution.** A demonstration is real work on a real computer. Use a safe example. Do not teach a task with a live customer record, a real payment, or a production toggle. Show the path on a sample, then put the guardrails on the card before you ever run it unattended.

I think of Teach a Task as showing someone the soup once, at the stove, and then writing the card together from what they saw. The card still needs your last line. The Bot is a good observer of clicks. It is not a mind reader of the rules you only say in your head.

If your demonstration is longer than ten minutes, it is too long for this feature, and it is probably too long for one skill. Split it. Show the part that is actually a click path — opening the right folder, filtering the right view, exporting the right file — and write the decision rules by hand. The official docs say to add those rules after the draft appears, because one example will not show every fork in the road.[1] That is not a flaw in the recording. It is the reason you stay in the room for the review.

I have used the written path more often than the demonstration, even on jobs that live in a browser. I am slower at typing than some people, and I still find that a card I dictated carefully, after a clean run, is easier to audit than a draft I have to correct. Use whichever gets you a card you would show a friend. The feature is a help. The standard is the same.

How to pick a short repeated job

Before we write or teach anything, we pick the job. The right job is one you already did well, or can do well once, this afternoon. It is short. It repeats. It has a finish line you can see.

How to pick a short repeated job

1. Look at the last two weeks. Write down three tasks you asked a Bot — or yourself — to do more than once. Inbox triage. A Friday update. A morning sketch of the calendar. A folder of receipts to match. You should have a short list of repeats, not a wish list of dreams. If you don't: think about the thing you did this Monday that you will do again next Monday. Start there.
2. Choose the smallest one that still has a clear "done." "Sort unread mail into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI, and draft replies to the urgent ones" is a job. "Handle my whole work life" is not. You should be able to say the finish line in one sentence. If you don't: cut the job in half until you can.
3. Write, on paper, the "never" that belongs to this job. "Don't send." "Don't publish." "Don't pay." "Don't contact anyone." "Don't use customer data." You should have a line you are willing to treat as law. If you don't: this job is not ready to be a skill. Come back when you know what must not happen.
4. Confirm that a successful one-time run is possible today, with a safe input — last week's mail, a sample folder, a staging site — not a live send. You should know what "safe" means for this job. If you don't: pick a smaller job, or a sample that cannot hurt anyone if it goes wrong.

What "done" looks like: you have one short job, a finish line, a "never," and a safe way to run it once. You have not saved a skill yet. You are choosing the soup, not yet writing the card.

The school-forms folder is a good example, and I will stay with a generic form, as I did in Chapter 6, "Memory". Showing a Bot, once, how you open the household folder, find this year's packet, and draft the answers from last year's completed copy — leaving the send for you — is a skill with a human size. It is also a skill whose "never" is obvious: never submit the form, and never store a medical note in memory along the way.

How to write or teach the skill, with a "never"

How to write or teach a skill, with a "never"

1. Do the job once, now, in a one-to-one chat with the Bot that should own it later. Use the safe input you picked. Watch the result. You should see a run you would be willing to repeat. If you don't: fix the process in conversation, run it again, and only continue when the output is one you would sign your name under as a draft.
2. If you are writing the skill, ask the Bot to save what just worked. Name it. Include the six official parts, and say the "never" in the same request. For example: "Save the process we just used as a skill called Weekly inbox triage. Include when to use it, the inbox to read, the three piles, how you draft, what you return to me in this chat, and the rule that you never send." You should see a skill saved under that name, with the approval rule on the card. If you don't: ask the Bot to show you the skill, and tell it what to add.

3. If Teach a Task is available and the job is a browser workflow worth showing, use it on a safe example instead of — or before — the written save. Open the computer view, choose Teach a Task, describe the result, perform the workflow once, stop, and review the draft. Add the "never," the failure cases, and any rule that was only in your head. You should see a draft skill you can edit. If you don't see Teach a Task at all: skip this step without worry, and use step 2. If the draft is missing a guardrail: add it before you test.
4. Read the whole card out loud, or nearly so. Confirm the six parts. Confirm the "never." Confirm that no password, card, or secret has been written into the instructions. You should be willing to hand this card to a careful friend. If you don't: edit until you are.

What "done" looks like: a named skill exists, with a "never," and it describes a run that already worked once. It has not been scheduled. It has not been left to run while you make dinner. The recipe is written. The tasting is next.

> **Story.** I have a card — a real one, on a real fridge — that my family teases me for, because the last line is longer than the ingredients. I used to be embarrassed by that. I am not anymore. The line is there because I walked away once. A skill's "never" is the same kind of memory: not a lack of trust, a record of care.

How to run it once while you watch

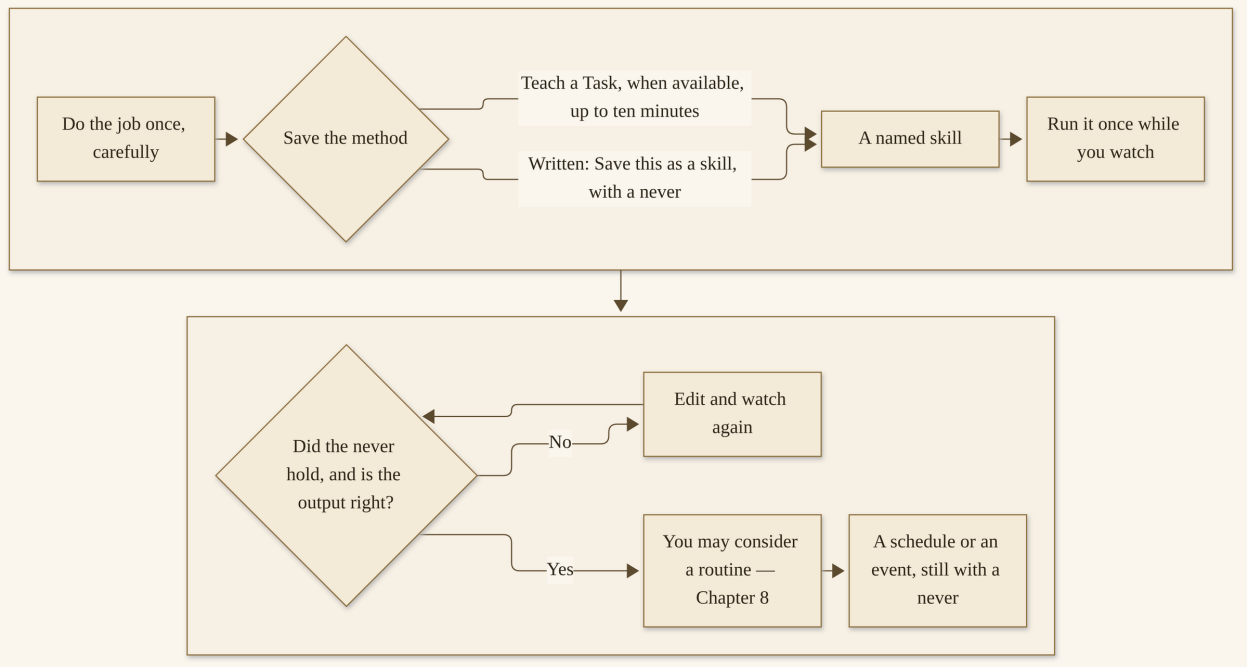
Official FAQ: test the skill on a real one-time task before turning it into a routine.[3] A test, in the next chapter, can do real work. This watch-along is the quieter cousin: you are in the chat, the laptop is open, and you can stop.

How to run a new skill once while you watch

1. In the same one-to-one chat, ask the Bot to run the skill by name, on a safe input. "Run Weekly inbox triage on yesterday's unread mail. Don't send." You should see the Bot start the work and stay inside the recipe. If you don't: remind it of the skill name, and of the "never." If it cannot find the skill, enable it for this Bot as the docs describe, or ask it to look again.[1]
2. Watch the steps. If the Bot has a computer view for this job, open it. If it is only reading a connected inbox, read the draft it returns. You should recognize the sequence you saved. If you don't: stop, and tell it where it left the recipe. Edit the skill before you run it again.
3. Check the six parts against what actually happened. Did it use the right inputs? Did it validate? Did it return the thing you asked for? Did it stop at the "never"? You should be able to answer yes to each, or to name the miss. If a send, a post, a payment, or a delete was even offered in a way you did not want: deny it, tighten the skill, and tighten the Ask-first rule.
4. If the run was good, say so, and leave the skill as is. If it was almost good, edit the card — "Add that if the folder is empty, you report that and stop, instead of using last week's list" — and run one more watch-along. You should end with a skill you would trust to run once

more, still with you in the room. If you don’t: it is not ready, and that is a fine day’s work. A half-true recipe is worse than no card.

What “done” looks like: you have watched a clean run. The “never” held. The output is in the shape you asked for. You are ready, when you choose, to consider a routine in Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed” — and you are not required to. A skill you call by name is already a gift. A schedule is a later one.



I13. From a job you did well to a skill you can reuse, and only then to a routine. The watch-along is not optional in this book. A routine is.

Only then, a routine

I want to land this softly, because Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”, is where the laptop closes, and I do not want you to close it on an untested card.

A routine assigns a workflow to one Bot and says when to run: on a schedule, or when something happens. We will do that properly next, including official webhook triggers, and including the fact that a test run does real work.[5] If you skip the watch-along, a schedule will faithfully repeat a mistake, at 8:00 in the morning, while you are making coffee, and a noisy trigger will repeat it more often than that.

So we stop here, on purpose. You have a recipe. You have a “never.” You have seen it work once with your eyes. That is mastery at the size of a fridge card. The next chapter will hang a clock next to it.

If you do nothing else this week, pick one short job, write the card, and watch it once. The soup will taste like yours. The last line will still be yours. And when we put the card on a schedule, we

will do it knowing what we are asking a teammate to repeat, with the laptop in the other room and the lamp still on.

One more kindness, for the days when you are tempted to skip the watch-along. I have skipped it. I have also, on a morning I was in a hurry, found a draft that sounded confident and was quietly wrong — a name from last week, a folder that had been renamed, a "never" the Bot had treated as a preference instead of a stop. Watching once is not ceremony. It is how you find that out while you are still in the room. It takes less time than an apology, and much less than an undo you do not have.

You already know how to ask a Bot to remember. You now know how to teach it a method. Those two habits — a notebook you review, a card you test — are the whole of Part 3, except for the clock. The clock is next. You will still be the one who says yes.

Chapter 8 — Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed

There is a picture I want you to have before we touch a single setting. A laptop, closed, in the other room. A small clock. A lamp still on. And a morning brief already waiting, written by a Bot that ran a skill you tested, at a time you chose, with a “never” you wrote on the card. That is the promise of a routine. It is also the size of it. The brief is waiting. The send is not. The yes is still yours.



I15. A closed laptop, a small clock, a lamp still on.

In plain words, a routine is a promise about when a job should run. The official name is a routine.

It assigns a workflow to one Bot and says the when: on a schedule, or when something happens — a Slack message, a GitHub, Linear, Sentry, or PagerDuty event, an email to your Bot's own address, or a webhook call.[1] Official work runs on the cloud computer. Closing the app, the laptop, or the phone does not stop a routine. That is the closed-laptop fact, and it is why this chapter is careful.[2]

Chapter 7, "Show It Once", ended on the last box of a diagram we share: a tested skill, and only then a routine. This chapter is that last box, opened.

We will put a tested skill from Chapter 7, "Show It Once", on a weekday schedule. We will add one narrow event trigger. We will ask a Bot to add a webhook trigger, and I will teach you what the official docs actually say about that URL, that key, and a `200` that means accepted, not finished. We will confirm a test run, knowing that a test does real work. We will pause if we need to.

I will also tell you about a morning when an approval card expired because no one said yes. That is not a scare. It is a closed laptop's other side, and it has a simple remedy: look, and then decide.

A clock, a time zone, and a wait

You create a routine by asking the Bot that should own the job. The official kind of ask is ordinary English, and I would not dress it up:[1]

> Every weekday at 8:00 AM, run the Daily customer-risk skill against the current account list. Post a linked watch list in this conversation. Do not contact customers. If the source data is unavailable, report the failure instead of using old data.

Swap in your skill. "Every weekday at 8:00 AM, run the morning brief skill, and leave the draft in this chat. Do not send. If a source is unavailable, tell me what you could not reach; do not fill the gap from memory." Confirm, before you walk away, the owning Bot, the schedule and time zone, the input, the expected result, the approval boundary, and what happens when a source is missing. The Bot creates the routine. It appears in that Bot's routines.

Schedules use the time zone in Settings, under Bot, labeled Timezone. Auto-detect follows this computer. Pick a zone when the routine should follow a different one — the office where the work belongs, or the household that needs the brief at 8:00 their time, not yours while you are traveling.[1] Ask for a schedule in plain words, like "every weekday at 8:00 AM" or "every 2 hours." Then open the routine and check When to run, which shows the saved schedule in words. If it does not match what you meant, choose Edit and tell the Bot what to fix.

Here is the rule that surprises almost everyone, and I want it in a sentence you will remember. A new routine waits for its next scheduled time. It does not run at the moment you create it. If you set up "every day at 8:00 AM" at 8:05, the first run is tomorrow at 8:00 AM. To try it right away, use Test.[1]

On the phone, you can open the Bot's profile and tap Add routine under Routines. Grok Bot starts a message that begins "Set up a routine to"; you finish the sentence and send it.[1] The computer is still the cloud computer. The laptop can already be closed. The care is the same.

> **Tip.** After you create a routine, read When to run out loud. Time zones are where

good intentions become 5:00 AM surprises. The words on that line are the routine you actually have.

Events, and the cost of a noisy one

A routine can also start when something happens, instead of when a clock says so. Official event types include a Slack message; a GitHub, Linear, Sentry, or PagerDuty event; an email to your Bot's own address; and a webhook call. Cursor account integrations start these routines. They are separate from the Slack or GitHub apps, and they may need their own connection. Ask the Bot for the trigger you want. When to run shows it in words, such as "When a Linear issue is created." Only new activity counts. Events from before the trigger existed do not start a run.[1]

Define a narrow matching rule and a clear response. The official example is the right shape: when a message in a named channel contains a support-ticket link and a phrase such as "needs repro," open the ticket, reproduce it in staging, and post a repro pack in this conversation. Never post back to Slack without approval.[1] Your version might be: when mail arrives at a receipts alias, log it on a list, and never pay. Or: when a Linear issue is created in one project with one label, draft a brief, and never change the issue.

Avoid broad listeners such as "every new message." They create noise, consume usage, and increase the chance of acting on irrelevant input. That is official, and it is also a bill you will feel. An hourly schedule, a short interval, or a Slack trigger on a busy channel can use a week of usage in a day.[1] If your weekly usage is running down faster than you expect, pause the routines you do not need, then ask the Bot to widen schedules and narrow triggers. Do not treat a higher plan as the first answer. This book will not upsell you one.

A Slack trigger is part of a routine, not the Slack app. The app lets a Bot post and read as the Slack user you connected. A trigger starts the routine when something happens in Slack. Connect Slack on the Cursor account that owns the Bot before you rely on it. A routine can start when the Bot is mentioned, when a word or phrase is mentioned, when you react to a message, or on any message. It can watch one channel or all of Slack. Keep the channel and the phrase narrow.[1] "Any message, everywhere" is how a helpful teammate becomes an expensive one.

The Bot's own mailbox

You can claim one email address at `mail.grokbot.com` — for example, `yourname@mail.grokbot.com` — for your Bots to use. They can receive, read, search, and send from it. New mail does not, by itself, wake a Bot. You set a routine if you want a run when mail arrives, optionally only from specific senders. Sending goes through Auto Review. You get one address, for good. You cannot rename or delete it. Addresses are never reissued, even after an account is deleted. All your Bots can use it in your own chats and routines. It is yours, not one Bot's.[3]

Plus-aliases — `yourname+receipts@mail.grokbot.com` — land in the same inbox. You can give a service its own alias without claiming another address. A routine that watches an alias runs only for mail to that alias. A routine on the plain address runs for all of it.[3] That is a tidy way to build a

receipts logger that never pays: the alias is the trigger, the skill is "log, don't pay," and the approval stays on anything that would move money.

To claim an address, ask a Bot — "Get yourself an email address" is the official kind of ask — or use Connect apps, then Email. The Bot asks what name you want, checks that it is free, and shows an approval card. Nothing is claimed until you approve.[3] Reserved names are blocked. On a team, agent email is off by default; an admin turns it on before members can claim an address. I will not walk every error message here. If a name is taken, choose another. If the team has it off, that is a team decision, not a Bot failure.

> **Caution.** One address, for good, is a real sentence. Pick the name the way you would pick a public handle: carefully, and only when you mean it. Sending from this address still needs your yes, if you have kept Ask-first on send, which in this book we have.

Webhooks, as the official docs teach them

This is the section I want you to be able to hand to a careful friend, and I will not add a single field the docs do not give me.

A webhook, in plain words, is a doorbell a program can ring. Another system sends a message to a URL, and a run can start. The official name is a webhook trigger, and it is one of the event types a routine can have.[1] Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms", will show you, at the level I have actually described my own shop, how Grok Bot Video Studio uses this with other agents. This chapter teaches the doorbell. That chapter tells a story about who rings it. I will not invent a payload, a required JSON field, or a status code beyond what is official. If you need a schema the docs do not publish, you do not have it from me.

Here is what you may assert, because the official skills-and-routines page says it.[1]

Ask the Bot to add a webhook trigger to the routine, then open the routine on desktop. The Webhook section shows three fields:

- **POST to** is the URL.
- **key** is the secret. Senders include it as `Authorization: Bearer <key>`.
- **header** is that full header, ready to copy.

Click a field to copy it. Send an HTTP POST to that URL with the header and, optionally, a JSON body. The Bot receives the body along with the routine instruction. A `200` response means Grok Bot accepted the call and started a run — not that the Bot has finished. Check the Bot's chat for the result. Any other response means a run did not start, so confirm that the routine is not paused and that the request uses the current key.

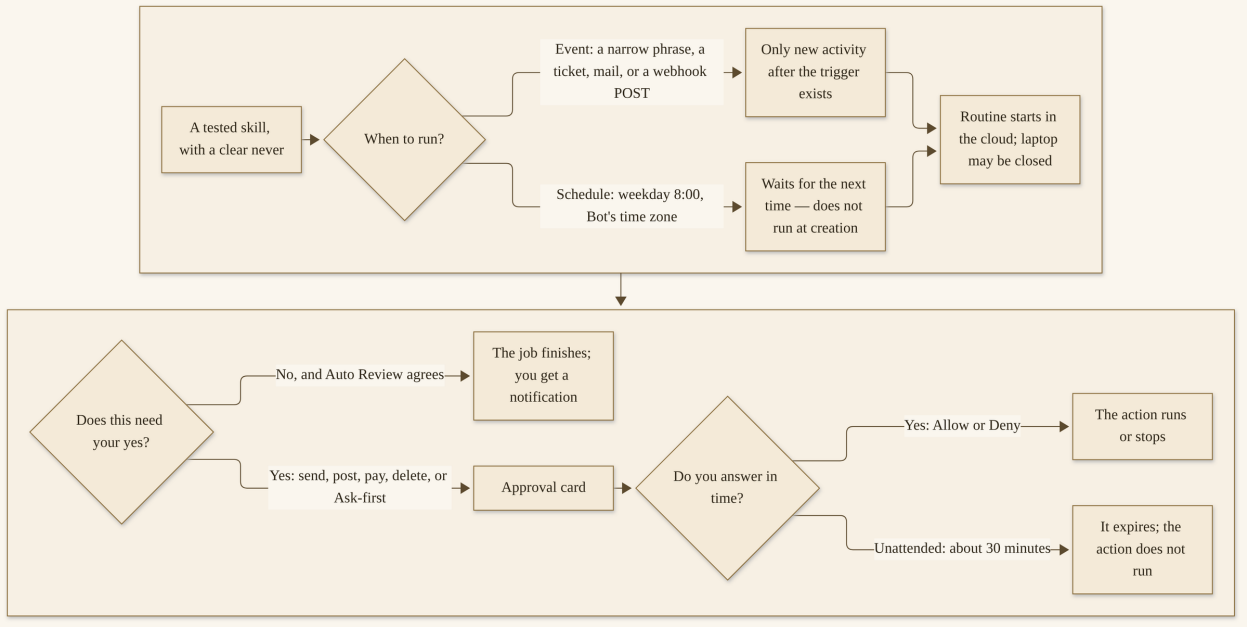
That is the whole protocol I will teach. It is enough to use. It is not enough to invent against.

> **Caution.** The key is a secret. Do not paste it into this book, into a group chat, into a public page, or into a screenshot you will share. Do not put it in a skill card. If it leaks, treat it as you would any other secret: it is no longer a secret. Ask the Bot how

to rotate or replace it, and stop using the old one. I will not print a sample key, and I will not invent a sample body for you to copy.

The 200 is the sentence people skip. Accepted is not finished. If you are wiring another tool to this doorbell, look at the Bot's chat — or the run history on the phone — for the actual result. If you get any other response, do not assume the work is in progress. Check the pause switch. Check that the key you used is the current one.

How a routine fires



I14. How a routine fires. A schedule waits for the next time. An event — including an official webhook — starts a run from new activity. A 200 on a webhook means the run was accepted, not that the work is finished. Approvals you are not sitting with expire after about thirty minutes.

The approval half of this picture is one you already know, and it matters more when you are not in the room. Approvals from work that started without you — a routine, or a message from another Bot — expire after about thirty minutes. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.[4] If a routine tries to send, pay, or publish, and you are at dinner, the card will not wait all night. The action will not run. In the morning, check Approvals first, then usage, then whether the routine is paused.

Story. I closed the laptop on a Sunday and opened a Monday brief that was already written. The coffee was still hot. The work was waiting, and it was mine to approve, not mine to start from zero. A different morning, a card had expired. Nothing had gone out the door, which is the ending I want for that story. I looked, I said yes to the thing that should have gone, and I tightened the routine so the ask came at a hour I actually keep. The closed laptop is a gift when the "never" holds. It is a lesson when a yes is time-limited.

Test runs do real work

If the routine shows Test, use it after creating or editing: open the routine on desktop and choose Test. The button says Running… until the run finishes, and the result shows up in the Bot's chat. If the test cannot start, you see "Couldn't start a test run," or a message that explains why. Some routines do not show Test; they still run on their schedule or trigger. For those, ask the Bot to do the same work once in chat with a safe input before you rely on the routine, then check the first scheduled run.[1]

I am going to put the official warning in my own voice, and then in theirs.

A test run performs real work. It can navigate websites, change files, and call connected tools. Use safe inputs. Keep write actions behind approval.[1] If your routine is a receipts logger, test it on a sample, not on a live payment. If it is a brief, test it on this morning, and confirm it did not send. If it is a webhook, a test or a real POST can start the same kind of work. Accepted is not a rehearsal in a sandbox unless you have built the skill that way.

Review, after a test, the official list: whether it selected current inputs; whether the output meets the required format; whether every action has a source; whether it stopped at the intended approval point; whether failure states are explicit.[1] Then decide whether to leave the routine on, or to pause it until you have edited the card.

How to schedule a weekday brief

How to schedule a weekday morning brief

1. Start from a tested morning-brief skill, with a "never send" (Chapter 7, "Show It Once"). If you do not have one yet, write and watch it once before this how-to. You should have a recipe you have already seen work. If you don't: go back one chapter. A schedule will not fix an untested card.
2. Ask the Bot that should own the brief, in plain words: "Every weekday at 8:00 AM, in my Bot time zone, run the morning brief skill. Leave the draft in this conversation. Do not send. If a source is unavailable, report the failure; do not use old data or memory in its place." You should see a routine created, and When to run should say the schedule in words you recognize. If you don't: open the routine, read the line, and Edit until it matches. Check the time zone in Settings, under Bot.
3. Remember that it will not run at creation. If it is already past 8:00, the first scheduled run is the next weekday at 8:00. Use Test, in the next how-to's spirit, when you want a run now — and only with a "never send" that you will watch. You should know when the first real scheduled run will be. If you don't: look at Next run on the phone, or ask the Bot.
4. Confirm the approval boundary is still on the routine's Instruction, not only in your head. "Do not send" should be on the line the Bot will follow at 8:00, with the laptop closed. You should be willing to leave the room. If you don't: pause the routine (the switch on the row, or Active off on the phone) until you are.

What “done” looks like: a weekday brief exists, in the right time zone, with a “never send,” waiting for its next 8:00. A test, if you ran one, left a draft and did not send. The laptop may close. The yes, for anything that would go out, is still yours.

How to add a narrow event trigger

How to add a narrow event trigger

1. Pick one event you actually need, and make it narrow: one channel and one phrase, one alias, one project and one label. Write the “never” first. You should be able to say the trigger in one sentence and the stop in another. If you don’t: do not use “every new message.” Narrow it until you can.
2. Ask the Bot to add that trigger to a routine that already has a tested skill. For example: “When mail arrives at my receipts alias, run the receipts-log skill. Log the item on the list. Never pay, never approve, never file a payment.” Or: “When a message in #customer-escalations contains a ticket link and the phrase ‘needs repro,’ run the repro skill in staging and leave a pack in this chat. Never post back to Slack without approval.” You should see When to run describe the event in words. If you don’t: Edit, and ask the Bot to read the trigger back.
3. Confirm any separate connection the trigger needs — Slack or GitHub on the Cursor account that owns the Bot, as the docs describe — before you rely on it.[1] You should know whether the connection is in place. If you don’t: ask the Bot, and do not assume the chat app’s login is enough.
4. Do not turn this on for all of Slack, or for every message, as a first experiment. If usage later climbs, pause, then narrow. You should feel that a quiet day will not produce a dozen runs. If you don’t: the trigger is too broad.

What “done” looks like: one narrow event will start one tested skill, with a “never,” and only for new activity. Old messages will not replay themselves. You are ready, if you need a doorbell from a program rather than from Slack or mail, to add a webhook.

How to add a webhook trigger — and not print a secret

How to add a webhook trigger and read back the official fields

1. In the routine that should receive the doorbell, ask the Bot to add a webhook trigger. Then open the routine on desktop. You should see a Webhook section with three fields: POST to, key, and header. If you don’t: you may be on the phone; the official walkthrough is on desktop. Ask the Bot where to look, and do not invent a URL.
2. Click a field to copy it when you need it. Senders will POST to that URL with `Authorization: Bearer <key>`. The header field is that full header, ready to copy. An optional JSON body may be sent; the Bot receives the body with the routine instruction.[1] You should understand those three fields well enough to hand them to a tool you trust, or to a teammate

who is allowed to have the key. If you don't: read the section once more, and do not proceed with a guessed header.

3. Never print the key in a document, a screenshot, a chat log you will share, or this book's margins. If you write a runbook for yourself, write "the current key, from the Webhook section," not the value. You should have a place for the key that is as careful as the Vault is for a password. If you don't: stop and make one. A webhook secret is a secret.

4. When you first try a POST — from a tool you control, with a safe routine — treat a `200` as "accepted and started," not as "finished." Look in the Bot's chat for the result. Any other response: check that the routine is not paused, and that you used the current key.[1] You should see a run start, or a clear reason it did not. If you don't: do not retry in a tight loop. Rate limits are real, and a failed run is not always retried for you, as we will cover below.

What "done" looks like: the routine has an official webhook trigger. You know where the URL and the header live. The key has not been written into a public place. A `200` means a run started. The work is finished when the chat says so, and when any approval you required has been given. Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms", will use this at the level of my own Video Studio story. The doorbell you just installed is the same kind.

How to confirm a test, then pause if you need to

How to confirm a test run's effects, then pause if needed

1. Open the routine on desktop and choose Test, if the button is there. If it is not, ask the Bot to do the same work once in chat, with a safe input. You should see Running… and then a result in the chat, or a reason the test could not start. If you don't: wait a moment, then look at run history on the phone — Running, Succeeded, or Failed, with a reason — or ask the Bot what happened.

2. Inspect the real effects. Files changed, drafts created, messages proposed, sites visited: this was real work. Confirm the "never" held. Confirm the inputs were current. Confirm any write you did not want did not happen — or deny the card if it is still waiting. You should be able to name what changed. If you don't: assume something may have, and look more carefully before you run it again.

3. If the test was wrong, or you are not ready for the next scheduled time, pause the routine. On desktop, use the switch on the row, or Pause inside the routine. On the phone, turn Active off. Pausing stops future runs. A routine that never runs does not spend usage; a Test does, because it performs the work.[1] You should see the routine marked Paused, or Active off. If you don't: do not leave the room. Ask the Bot to pause it, and confirm.

4. If the test was right, you may leave it on. Still watch the first scheduled or triggered run the way you watched the first skill. Then, and only then, is the closed laptop earned. You should know when that first run will be. If you don't: check Next run, or When to run, before you close the lid.

What “done” looks like: you know what the test did. The routine is either on, with a first run you can name, or paused until you edit. Nothing is running that you cannot account for.

If a routine hasn’t run, and other limits

When a routine does not run, the official checklist is better than a guess.[1]

- The routine is not Paused. On the phone, Active is on.
- When to run shows the schedule or trigger you expect, in the right time zone.
- A new schedule waits for its next time. Use Test to run it now.
- For Slack, the message is new, in the channel the trigger watches, and matches its phrase.
- For a webhook, the call returned `200` and used the current key.

Then look at Approvals. A card that expired after about thirty minutes means the action did not run. That can look, from a distance, like a missed routine. It is a missed yes.

Routines have hourly limits: all of your routines together can run up to 300 times an hour, and each routine up to 200 times an hour. A run past either limit fails with “Automation run rate limit exceeded.” If one routine keeps hitting its limit, ask the Bot to narrow its trigger or widen its schedule. Some runs can also fail with this error because of a limit all Grok Bot routines share, even when your own routines run less than that. This is a documented known issue that is being fixed. A run that fails with this error is not retried automatically. Use Test to run it now, or for a webhook, send the call again — once, not in a tight loop.[1]

A Bot can own up to 50 routines. The app keeps the 20 most recent run records for each. Routine schedules must be at least five minutes apart. Deleting a routine stops its future runs and cannot be undone. Deleting a Bot also removes that Bot’s routines.[1] These are official caps, not advice about how many you should want. I would rather you had five routines you trust than forty you cannot name.

To manage them, click the Bot’s name at the top of the chat, on desktop, and look at the Details tab. Each row shows the name and when it runs, or Paused. Open a routine to read its Instruction and When to run. A webhook routine also shows Webhook. The buttons are Pause or Resume, Test when it is offered, Edit — which starts a message that begins “Edit your routine:” — and Delete, which asks you to confirm.[1] On a shared Bot, a menu may also ask who can use the routine: only you, or everyone with access. Choose on purpose.

After a long period away, Grok Bot may ask whether to keep routines running, and pause them if there is no response. Review paused routines when you return.[1] That is a kindness dressed as a setting. Say hello to the clock again before you assume the brief will be there.

I want to add a word about editing, because a routine is not carved in stone. When you choose Edit, the app starts a message to the Bot that begins “Edit your routine:” with the routine’s name. You add what should change and send it.[1] Change the hour. Narrow the phrase. Tighten the “never.” After you edit, test again, because the first test was of the old instruction. A schedule you no longer want should be paused or deleted on purpose, not left to fire out of politeness. Deleting cannot be undone; pausing can. When I am unsure, I pause.

If you share a Bot with other people — a Team Bot, or a Bot someone else can use — look at Who can use this routine, when that menu appears. Only me, or everyone with access, is a real choice. A doorbell that everyone can ring is a different object from a doorbell only you can ring. Choose it the way you would choose who has a key to the office.

Usage is the quiet partner of every clock. Each run spends it. A Test spends it. A routine that is paused, or that never starts, does not. I look at the usage dashboard when a week feels more expensive than it should, before I blame the plan, and I look at routines first: which ones ran, which triggers are broad, which tests I fired twice. Chapter 17, "Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks", will sit with bills and caps properly. This chapter's job is to keep you from lighting a noisy trigger and wondering, later, where the week went.

Official design advice, which I have made my own: automate preparation before execution. Have the Bot draft, reconcile, or recommend first. Require approval for sending, purchasing, deleting, publishing, or changing production systems. Include a no-data and stale-data policy. Tell the Bot where to report partial completion. Re-test after a website, an app, or a source format changes.[1] That is the fridge-card standard, applied to a clock.

You now have a skill, a "never," a schedule or a doorbell, and a test you treated as real. The laptop may close. In Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff", we will give one Bot the job of chief of staff, and let a morning brief — the one already waiting — be the first thing you and I build together as a practice, not only as a feature.

Let me say one more thing about the webhook, because I know it is the part that can feel like a different book. It is not. The doorbell is official. The key is a secret. The 200 is an acceptance, not a finish line. The work is the same work your skill already described, with the same "never," and the same approval if something would go out the door. You do not need to become a programmer to use this. You need to be able to hand a URL and a header to a tool you trust, or to a person who is allowed to have them, and then look at the chat. In Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms", when we talk about work that spans other agent platforms, we will come back to this doorbell at the level of a story I can actually tell. We will not turn it into a protocol I cannot source.

If all of this feels like a lot for one afternoon, it is. Do the weekday brief first. Watch one test. Close the laptop on that alone. The narrow event and the webhook will wait for a second sitting. A single routine you trust is worth more than a panel of clocks you do not.

The lamp is still on. You are still the one who says yes.

Part 4 — Business How-Tos

Chapter 9 — Your Digital Chief of Staff

The first morning Charlie left a brief on my desk, I almost said thank you out loud to an empty room. It was not magic. It was a routine I had tested the week before, a short list of what to look at, and a promise I had made to myself: nothing goes out the door until I say yes. The coffee was still hot. The work was already waiting, and it was mine to approve, not mine to start from zero.

Charlie is my chief of staff Bot. I will use that name when I talk about SMF Works, because it is the real name of the Bot who runs the morning brief there. You should name yours yourself. A name makes a job feel like a job. "Assistant" is a cloud. "Sam, my chief of staff" — or Priya, or the name of a person who is not a real employee, just a name you like — is someone you can give one job, and a "never," and a place at the top of a small team.

This chapter is that job. In plain words: a chief of staff coordinates. The official product description of a Chief of Staff is a teammate who scans Slack, email, calendar, and meeting notes, and delivers a succinct readout of what is new and what maps to your priorities, each with a clear source, why it matters, and what to do.[1] We will write that job down. We will put a morning brief on the weekday routine you learned in Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed". We will build a follow-up list that does not send itself. And we will keep the chief from hoarding work that belongs to a specialist. Chapter 12, "A Small Fleet", is where my own small fleet sits in full. This chapter is the pattern you can take home today.

You still decide. That is not a slogan at the end. It is the first line of the chief's job.

One job: coordinate, don't hoard

Your primary Bot is your main point of contact. It checks in with you on its own. It coordinates work with your other Bots. A shared Team Bot cannot be your primary Bot.[2] Most Bots work best with one clear job. The primary Bot is different: it is the desk you walk up to in the morning, and the desk that hands work to the right person — the right Bot — when a job has its own sources, rules, or schedule.

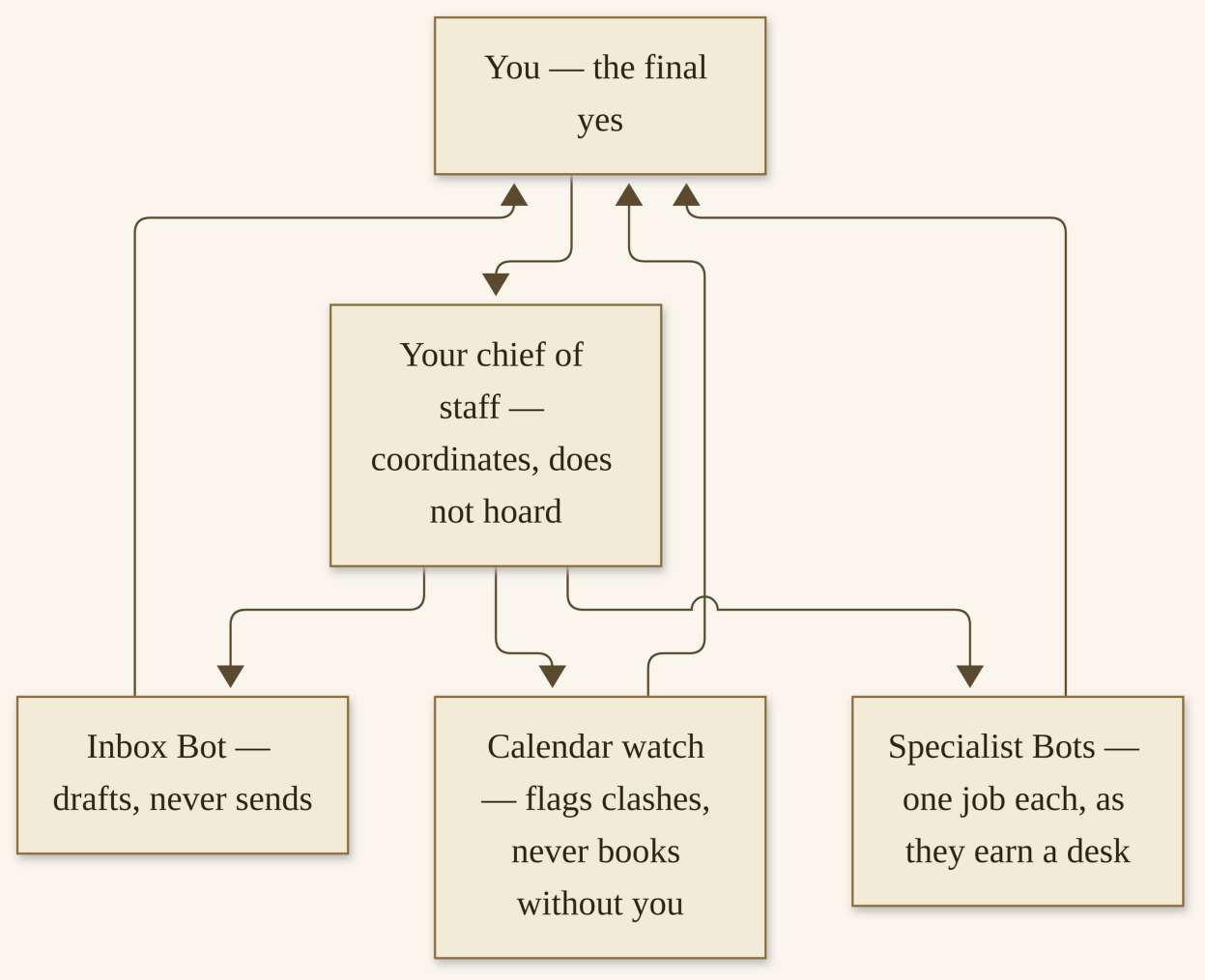
That is a chief of staff, in a human size. Coordinate. Don't hoard.

Hoarding looks like this. Every request goes to Charlie, and Charlie tries to be the inbox, the calendar, the book writer, the marketer, and the person who pays the bills. The notebook from Chapter 6, "Memory", gets crowded. The "never" lines blur. A brief that should have been short

becomes a novel. A follow-up that should have been a list becomes a send, because the same Bot that drafts has also been asked, on a busy day, to "just take care of it."

I have done this. I have asked one Bot to hold too much because I was in a hurry, and because creating a second Bot felt like a fuss. It is not a fuss. It is a kindness to the work. The official path in the use-case docs is the same path this book follows: first an assistant, then a Bot with one job, then a team of Bots toward a bigger goal. Every official example stops for your review.[3] A chief who hoards is stuck at a crowded first step. A chief who coordinates is already making a team, even if the team is only two desks and you.

Coordinating looks like this. You ask the chief what's new. The chief reads across the apps you have connected, writes a short brief with sources, and flags what needs you. When a job repeats with its own rules — invoices, a campaign, a bug on staging — the chief hands it to a Bot who owns that job, or asks you whether it is time to create one. Official advice: start new work with your primary Bot. When the same kind of request keeps coming back with its own sources, rules, or schedule, give it its own Bot, or ask your primary Bot to create one. A Bot with one job builds up memory for that job, so you only explain it once.[2]



I16. A chief of staff in the middle, specialists around, you at the top. The chief coordinates. The

specialists own a job. Every line that would send, book, pay, or publish comes back to you.

I will preview, without stealing, what Chapter 12, "A Small Fleet", will show. At SMF Works, Charlie is not a bottleneck and not a pile. A writer Bot writes. A marketing Bot drafts site copy and does not publish. A programmer Bot prepares files and a site, and does not merge a pull request alone. Video Studio has its own desk. I still say yes to anything that goes out the door. The pattern is the diagram you just saw, with real work on the lines. You do not need my roster to use the pattern. You need one chief, one job, and a "never."

What a morning brief should be

The official starter prompt for a morning briefing is almost the whole lesson:[3]

> Sum up what changed since yesterday in my inbox, calendar, Slack, and docs, and flag what needs me. Draft it as a post for #team; don't send it.

I like that prompt for three reasons. It has a window — since yesterday. It has sources — inbox, calendar, Slack, docs, or whichever you actually use. It has a "never" — don't send. You can ask for the brief as a note in your chat instead of a draft post, if you do not want a #team version. You can ask for a Page, which is the official name for an interactive report a Bot can build and can update from a routine, if Pages are available on your plan. As of the docs I opened on 11 November 2026, Pages were rolling out gradually and were not available on Enterprise teams yet. That will age; if you ask and the Bot cannot make one, a clear note in the chat is a complete brief.[4]

A good brief, in my house, is short. Charlie knows that because I asked him to remember it, in the spirit of Chapter 6, "Memory". It has sources I can click. It tells me why something matters, and what to do. It does not pretend a missing inbox was empty; it says it could not be reached. It does not book a meeting, send a reply, or move a calendar block. Those are follow-ups, and follow-ups, in this chapter, are a list.

The official Sunday-evening calendar example is a cousin: every Sunday evening, read the week ahead, flag clashes and packed days, and send you a short plan for Monday.[3] "Send you" here means a note to you, and I would write "don't book, don't invite, don't cancel" on the card. The official Gmail example sorts the night's mail, drafts replies to the threads that need you, and leaves every draft for you to send.[3] The official meeting-prep prompt is a one-page brief: who is attending, what you last discussed, open threads.[3] A chief can call those skills, or hand them to a specialist, without becoming all of them.

> **Tip.** If the brief is getting long, the chief is probably doing specialist work. Ask: "What on this brief should belong to a Bot with its own job?" Then give that job away, kindly.

Standing rules for a chief

I write the chief's job in the first long message, and I ask the Bot to remember it. Officially, a lasting rule is "From now on, never send external messages without approval," and a task is "Draft

follow-ups for these twelve accounts." The Bot keeps lasting rules in its memory.[2] I still put the same "never" on the morning-brief skill and on the routine, because a card should be complete, and because memory is not a gate.

Here is a job I would be willing to hand you, in words you can make your own. It is a teaching draft, not a secret prompt from my shop, and not an official text you must use verbatim.

You are my chief of staff. Your job is to coordinate, not to hoard. Each weekday, prepare a short morning brief from the inbox, calendar, and other apps I have connected. Every item has a source, a why, and a suggested next step. Flag what needs me. When a job repeats and has its own rules, recommend a specialist Bot, or hand work to one we already have. Keep a follow-up list. Never send, never publish, never book, never pay, never delete, never merge. If a source is missing, say so; do not fill from memory. If you are unsure, ask. I am the one who says yes.

That is enough to start. You will edit it after a week, when you know which sentences you actually needed.

Ask-first rules still sit on the same verbs. A standing rule in memory is a reminder. A custom Ask-first rule, in Settings, is a stop. For a chief, I want the stop on anything that sends, books, pays, publishes, or deletes. Calendar and email are where a helpful chief is most tempted to be helpful. We will let it draft. We will not let it invite the whole team to Thursday, unattended.

The first conversation, spoken slowly

If you like to think out loud, you can arrive at the same job through a conversation instead of a pasted draft. I have done both. The pasted draft is faster. The conversation is how you find the "never" you would have forgotten to write.

I might start like this. "I want you to be my chief of staff. Before we write your job down, ask me what a good morning looks like, what you should never do, and which apps you should read." Then I answer honestly. A good morning is a short brief, already waiting, with sources. A bad morning is a dozen sends I did not see. The apps are the ones I have already connected, and no others until I say so. I tell the Bot about the follow-up list. I tell it that booking is a yes. I tell it that I would like to be asked, after a week, which parts of the brief I did not use, so we can cut them.

Then I say, "Please write your job back to me, in a short page I can edit, including every never we just agreed. Ask me to confirm before you remember it." I edit the page. I take out any flourish that sounds like a brochure. I add a sentence about missing sources. I confirm, and I ask it to remember the edited version. That last step is the one people skip. A beautiful draft that was not saved as a lasting rule will fade, and a week later you will wonder why the brief is long again.

If the Bot offers to create three specialists in the same sitting, I usually say not yet. One chief, one brief, one week. Specialists are Chapter 10, "Growth Work", and Chapter 11, "The Shop Floor", and they are also any Tuesday you feel the brief get heavy. Officially, you can ask a primary Bot — or dr eggbot — to set up a team.[6] You are allowed to go slowly. This book is a gift, not a race.

I also tell the chief how to talk to me. Short sentences. Plain words. No fake urgency. If something is actually urgent — a deadline today, a payment that will fail, a school form due this afternoon —

say so in one line at the top, and show the source. If nothing is urgent, it is a kindness to say that too. A morning with no fires is a morning, not a failure of the product.

How to write the chief's job and "never"

How to write your chief of staff's job and "never"

1. Choose the Bot. If you already have a primary Bot, this is often that Bot. If you don't, create one, give it a name you will actually say, and, if you wish, make it your primary Bot the way Chapter 3, "Get In", taught you — or ask it to be your main point of contact, and follow what the app shows you. A Team Bot cannot be your primary Bot.[2] You should have one named Bot, with one desk. If you don't: do not start with three chiefs. Start with one.
2. In a one-to-one chat, paste a job in your own words — you can start from the teaching draft above — and ask the Bot to remember it. Include the "never" in the same message: never send, never publish, never book, never pay, never delete, never merge, unless I have said yes in this run. You should see the Bot acknowledge the job and the rules. If you don't: ask, "What is your job, and what will you never do?" and correct the answer until it is right.
3. Ask, "What do you remember about your job?" and read it back, the way we did in Chapter 6, "Memory". You should hear the coordinate-don't-hoard line, and the "never," in the Bot's words. If a verb is missing: add it, and ask it to remember again.
4. Add or confirm Ask-first rules for send, book, pay, publish, and delete, so the memory has a gate in front of it. Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", is the home of those settings; this step is a check, not a new invention. You should know that a send would stop even if a busy morning made the brief too helpful. If you don't: do not go on to a routine until you do.

What "done" looks like: your chief has a name, a job, a "never," and a gate. It has not yet been put on a clock. It is ready to write a brief you will read.

I will use Priya once here — a composite, a stand-in for a shop owner I have in mind. Priya names her chief "Lane." Lane's job is the morning list: orders that need a person, mail that needs a reply, a calendar that must not double-book the counter. Lane never sends to a customer, never refunds, never changes a listing. Priya drinks her coffee and says yes, or not. The shop is still hers.

How to put a morning brief on a routine

How to set a morning-brief routine

1. Do the brief once, by hand, in the chat, with yesterday's real sources and a "don't send." Save what worked as a skill, with the six parts from Chapter 7, "Show It Once", and a "never send, never book." Watch it once. You should have a tested skill before a clock. If you don't: stay with the one-time brief for a few mornings. A routine will wait.
2. Ask the chief, in the spirit of Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed": "Every weekday at 8:00 AM, in my Bot time zone, run the morning brief skill. Leave the

draft in this conversation" — or "update the morning Page," if you have one — "and do not send, book, or pay. If a source is unavailable, report the failure; do not use old data." You should see a routine, and When to run should match. If you don't: Edit, and check the time zone.

3. Use Test, knowing a test does real work. Confirm the brief appeared, the sources are current, and nothing was sent. You should be willing to close the laptop on a Sunday. If you don't: pause, tighten, and test again.
4. Leave the routine on only after that clean test. The first scheduled morning, read the brief as if you were still watching. Then let the habit be a habit. You should know when the next 8:00 is. If a card appears, you have about thirty minutes if you are not in the chat.[5] Answer it, or let it expire and follow up on purpose.

What "done" looks like: a weekday brief arrives, short, sourced, unsent. The coffee can still be hot. The yes is still yours.

If you want a Page that is current every morning, ask for one, then ask the routine to update it. Officially, you ask the Bot to change a page; on-page filters are view-only. Sharing a Page has its own care — a public link needs nothing private on the page.[4] Chapter 18, "A Practice That Lasts", returns to Pages as a practice. Here, a Page is optional, and a clear note in the chat is enough.

A follow-up list that does not send itself

This is the how-to that saves more accidents than any other in the chapter. A chief who is good at noticing will also be good at wanting to close the loop. We will let it close the loop on paper.

How to keep a follow-up list that does not send itself

1. Ask your chief, as a standing rule: "Keep a follow-up list for me. Each item has a person or a thread, a suggested next step, and a draft if a draft would help. Never send, never invite, never post the follow-up. The list is a list." You should see the rule remembered, and, when you ask, a list rather than a report that "I reached out." If you don't: correct it immediately. "Reached out" is a send unless you can see that it was not.
2. When the morning brief includes something that needs a reply, ask: "Add this to the follow-up list, and draft the reply. Don't send." You should get a draft under the item, unsent. If a send is offered: Deny, and tighten both the rule and the Ask-first gate.
3. Work the list yourself, at a time you choose. Send the ones you mean. Strike the ones you don't. Tell the chief what you sent, if you want the list to stay current — or ask it to mark an item "sent by me" only after you say so. You should remain the person who touched the outside world. If you don't: the list has become a sender, and we have left the chapter's promise.
4. Optionally, put a Friday review on a routine: "Every Friday at 4:00 PM, show me the open follow-ups, oldest first. Do not send any of them. Do not nudge anyone outside this chat." You should get a review, not a burst of mail. If you don't: pause the routine.

What "done" looks like: follow-ups live on a list, with drafts if you want them, and nothing on that list leaves without you. The chief is coordinating. You are still the one who speaks in your name.

> **Caution.** Calendar and email are where a chief looks most like a person who can "just handle it." Booking, inviting, sending, declining: those are yeses. Keep Ask-first on. A draft invitation is a gift. An unattended invitation is a meeting you will have to unpick.

Inbox and calendar, drafts only

The chief's daily tools are usually mail and the calendar. I want to give each a compact card, so they do not get swallowed by a single giant "run my life" skill — the kind we refused in Chapter 7, "Show It Once".

The official inbox prompt is: sort unread email into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI; draft replies to the urgent ones; don't send anything.[3] You can save that as a skill the chief runs as part of the brief, or as a skill you call when the inbox is the only thing you want. I prefer it as a named skill, Weekly inbox triage or Morning inbox, with the worked "never" from Chapter 7, "Show It Once": never send, never delete, never unsubscribe, never forward. The chief may summarize the piles in the brief and leave the drafts attached, or hand the whole skill to an inbox specialist if the volume earns a desk. Either way, the outside world does not hear from the Bot until you press send.

The official Sunday-evening calendar prompt is a short plan for Monday: the week ahead, clashes, packed days.[3] I would run a lighter version on a weekday morning as well, inside the brief: what is already on the calendar, what is double-booked, what needs a decision. The "never" is firm. Never book. Never invite. Never cancel. Never move a block on a shared calendar without a yes. A suggested slot, written on the follow-up list, is a gift. A meeting that appears on someone else's Tuesday is a surprise, and not a kind one.

If you keep a household or a shop calendar as well as a work one, say so in the skill, and say which calendar may be read and which may never be written to. Dan — our composite parent from Chapter 6, "Memory" — might ask a chief to flag a school-form due date on the household calendar as a suggestion, and still be the person who puts it there. Priya might ask Lane to flag a delivery window that collides with the counter. The pattern is the same. The Bot sees. The person places.

A second brief, for a partner or a co-founder, is a kind idea if you both want it. Ask the chief for a separate note, with a narrower set of sources, and a "never" that includes "don't send this to anyone; leave it for me to share." Do not let a Bot mail a partner's digest on your behalf until you have read it. Other people's mornings are not a place to be unattended.

A week with a chief, in ordinary time

Monday, the brief is waiting. You read it with coffee. You send two of the drafted replies, and you leave a third because the tone is almost right but not yours. You tell the chief, "The third draft was too sharp; remember I want warm and short." That is Chapter 6, "Memory", happening in a real week.

Tuesday, a source is missing. The brief says the inbox could not be reached, instead of pretending the night was quiet. You reconnect, or you sign in, or you take over a CAPTCHA, the way Chapter 5, “Connect Carefully”, taught you. The Wednesday brief is whole again. You thank the Bot for saying so, because you want that honesty remembered.

Wednesday, the brief is too long. Half of it is a pile of invoices. You ask the chief to recommend a specialist. You create an invoice Bot — or you will, in Chapter 11, “The Shop Floor” — with a “never pay.” The Thursday brief shrinks. The chief is coordinating again.

Thursday, a follow-up is old. The Friday review is tomorrow, but you ask now: “Show me anything on the list older than a week. Don’t send.” You close two loops by yourself. The list is a list.

Friday, you look at the week and decide one standing rule needs a tighter sentence. You edit. You ask the chief what it remembers. You do not add a second chief. You go into the weekend with a paused sense of enough.

That is not a case study. It is a picture of a practice at human speed. Your week will not match mine, and it should not. The shape — read, correct, give work away, keep the sends — is the thing I want you to borrow.

When to spin a specialist

You will feel the moment. The brief is long because half of it is invoice matching. Or a campaign is in draft every Monday. Or staging bugs keep arriving in the same shape. Official advice, again: when the same kind of request keeps coming back with its own sources, rules, or schedule, give it its own Bot.[2] You can ask the chief to create one, or you can create it, or you can start from dr eggbot, a marketplace Bot that asks you a few questions and sets up one-job Bots.[2,6] I will not walk dr eggbot’s whole interview here, because it is a product that can change, and because your answers should be yours. The standard stays: one job, a “never,” a test.

Chapters 10 and 11 are shelves of those specialist jobs: outbound, paid media, content, a talent scout, support, invoices, engineering, a legal-ops pointer. Chapter 12, “A Small Fleet”, is how a small press uses the same idea. You do not need all of them. You need the one that is already crowding your chief.

When you hand work off, say it in the group or in the chief’s chat, and make one Bot responsible for the next step. Official best practice for group chats: one Bot for each step; `@` one Bot, not everyone. Approval and login requests may not appear in the group — check the Bot’s own chat.[7] Chapter 15, “Bots on Your Human Team”, is the home of Team Bots, Slack, and meetings. For now, the only rule I need you to take is: the chief is allowed to hand work away. That is the job.

A handoff, spoken, might sound like this. “Charlie, this invoice pile is its own job. Please draft a job description for an invoice Bot: match invoices to purchase orders, list mismatches, never approve or pay. Show me the description. Don’t create the Bot until I say yes.” You read the description. You add a “never.” You say yes. The chief creates the Bot, or you do. The next morning, the brief has a line — “invoices are with the invoice Bot; three mismatches need you” — instead of three pages of matching. That is coordinating. It is also how a small fleet begins, without anyone

announcing a fleet.

If the specialist is not ready, the chief can still hold a folder. “Leave the invoice drafts in this folder and flag them on the brief. Don’t pay.” A folder is a complete answer for a month. A new Bot is a complete answer for a year. You get to choose when the desk is earned.

A desk already waiting

I want to end where I began, because the feeling is the point.

Charlie’s brief is already on the desk some mornings when I sit down. It is short, because I asked for short. It has sources, because a brief without a source is a rumor. It has a list of follow-ups that have not been sent. Some days I disagree with a flag, and I say so, and the next brief is a little better. Some days the important thing is a school-form cousin — a deadline, a packet, a thing that would have been missed — and I am simply grateful. I do not have a metric for that gratitude, and I will not invent one. I have a practice.

You can have the same practice without having my company, my roster, or my name for the Bot. Write the job. Write the “never.” Test the brief. Put it on a weekday clock. Keep the follow-ups as a list. Give away the work that has earned its own desk. You are still the person who walks into the room, reads what is waiting, and says yes, or not, or “not like that.”

If you only remember four sentences from this chapter, let them be these. The chief coordinates and does not hoard. The brief is short, sourced, and unsent. The follow-up list does not send itself. You are still the one who says yes. Everything else is a method for making those sentences true on a Thursday when you are tired.

And if a Thursday comes when the brief is wrong — a stale name, a missed deadline, a tone that is not yours — treat it the way we treated a stale memory. Correct it. Ask the chief to remember the correction. Watch the next morning. A chief is a practice, not a product you install once and admire. I have corrected Charlie more times than I can count, and I will not pretend otherwise. The thanks I almost said out loud, that first morning, was real. So is the editing. Both belong in an honest book.

Name your Bot. Sit with the first brief. Send nothing you have not read. That is enough for this week. The growth work, when you want it, has its own specialists, and they will use the same four sentences.

One last practical note. If you travel, check the chief’s time zone, the way we checked it in Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”. A brief that arrives at 8:00 in a zone you have left is a brief you will read at the wrong hour, and an approval card that expires in about thirty minutes will not wait for your hotel Wi-Fi. Pause, or shift the clock, or read on your phone — the same Bots, the same routines, the same cloud computer, as the mobile apps allow.[8] Pause is always allowed. A missed brief is kinder than a missed yes.

I should also tell you what I do not ask Charlie to be. Charlie is not my lawyer, my clinician, or my accountant. Charlie is not a second me, and Charlie is not the publisher of record at WisdomForge. When a morning contains a judgment I would not delegate to a careful human assistant on their first

week — a tone that has to be mine, a yes that will spend money, a paragraph that will be public — I do that work myself, often from a draft the Bot left me. The brief made the work smaller. It did not make my responsibility smaller.

If your chief ever sounds sure about a number, a rumor, or a "they said," ask for the source, the way the official Chief of Staff description already wants: each item with a clear source.[1] If the source cannot be opened again, the item is a maybe, and a maybe does not go on a follow-up as if it were a fact. Memory is not a source of truth, and a brief is not one either. It is a map. You still walk.

That is a digital chief of staff. It is also just a careful morning. In the next chapter, we will let specialists take the growth work — sales, marketing, recruiting — with the same draft-first rule, and the same yes at the door.

Chapter 10 — Growth Work: Sales, Marketing, and Recruiting

A campaign waited overnight for a morning yes. That is the picture for this chapter, and it is the whole method. Research ran while the laptop was closed. Drafts were written in a voice you had already taught. A fact-check Bot read the numbers against the words. In the morning, a list was waiting — a launch note, three posts, a recommended budget move, a shortlist, a set of outreach drafts — and nothing had gone out. The coffee, once again, was still hot. The yes was yours.

Growth work is where a Bot can look, to a tired person, like a way to skip the yes. Outbound can be sent. A budget can be moved. A post can be published. A candidate can be contacted. This chapter will not skip those yeses. Official use cases in this area all stop for your review.[1] We will follow them, in four compact how-tos: a sales outbound Bot, a paid-media recommender, a content and campaign trio, and a talent scout. I will point you to the official vertical guides when you want more depth, rather than retelling every page. And I will talk about usage and reputation, because growth work is public work. A draft that is wrong in a folder is a lesson. A draft that is wrong in someone else's inbox is their morning, and your name.

You already have the habits. A chief who coordinates, from Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff". A skill with a "never," from Chapter 7, "Show It Once". A routine that waits for the next hour, from Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed". This chapter puts those habits on four desks.

I want to be honest about what "growth" means in a book that is a gift. It does not mean a funnel I am selling you, and it does not mean you must have a pipeline, an ad account, or an open role. It means the work of talking to the world: a note to a possible customer, a post about something you shipped, a budget you already spend, a conversation with a person who might join you. If none of that is your work this month, the shop floor in Chapter 11, "The Shop Floor", or the household work in Chapter 13, "Get Your Life Back", may be the better page to turn to. If it is your work, I would like it to be work you can be proud of in the morning, including the messages you decided not to send.

The overnight picture is official in spirit. Sales Outbound is described as researching accounts overnight and leaving a review list.[2] Routines run in the cloud while the laptop is closed.[9] The "worked while you slept" of this book's subtitle is that picture, held at a human size: a team that prepares, and a person who still reviews. It is not a guarantee of revenue, and it is not a reason to turn off the lights on a budget or a person's inbox.

Draft first, always

The rule for Chapters 9 through 12 is the same, and I will keep saying it until it feels like a household phrase. Drafts and recommendations first. Send, publish, pay, and production behind a yes.

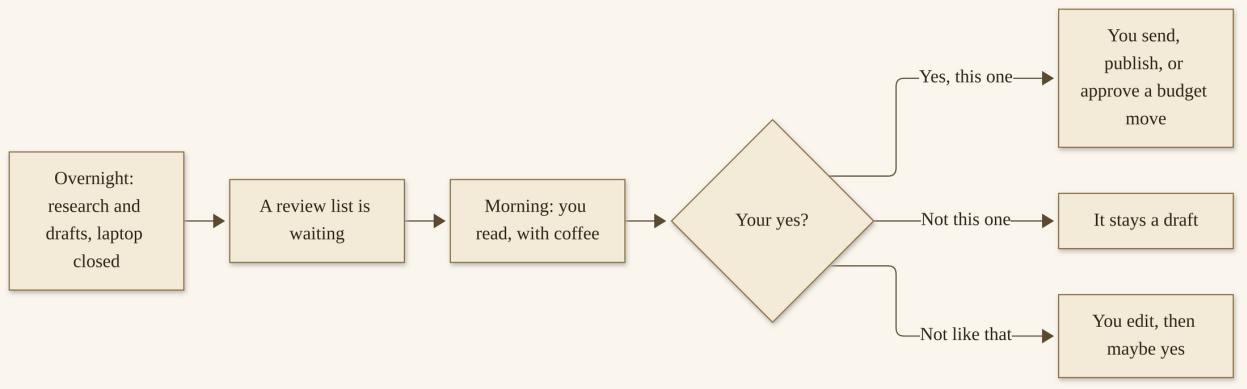
For growth work, the "never" lines are almost always some flavor of that rule.

- Sales outbound: never send the email, never send the LinkedIn message, leave a review list.
- Paid media: recommend where to move money, don't change any budgets.
- Content: bring me the drafts, don't publish.
- Talent scout: draft outreach in my voice, don't contact anyone. Skip people already in the ATS. Scheduling happens once you approve.[1]

Those are official shapes, not my inventions. I will write them onto skills and onto routines. I will back them with Ask-first rules. I will not tell you that a Bot "handles outreach" as if the handling included the send. The official Talent Scout description includes "handles scheduling once you approve." The "once you approve" is the sentence I want in bold in your mind, even though this book does not use bold for that kind of emphasis. It is the whole job.

Reputation is the quiet cost of skipping this. People remember a message that felt automated, or a second outreach after they already said no, or a note that used their name and got their work wrong. They remember a job-hunt email that was clearly a blast. They remember an ad account that spent a weekend on a campaign you meant to pause. I do not have a study to quote for that, and I will not invent one. I have a career's worth of being on the other side of a careless message, and I would like your name to be one people trust.

Usage is the other quiet cost. Overnight research, a busy trigger, a campaign team that runs too often, a scout that pages through a large site: these spend the shared weekly pool you met in Chapter 3, "Get In". A review list that waited for morning is the right picture. A noisy routine that ran all night on a broad listener is the picture from Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed", that we already refused.



I17. Overnight to a morning yes. The work can happen while you sleep. The send, the post, the spend, and the outreach wait for you.

Sales outbound, and a list you will actually read

The official Sales Outbound picture is: research accounts overnight, score contacts, draft email and LinkedIn in your voice, and leave a review list for you to approve.[2] A close cousin, in the docs, is sales development for inbound: qualify this morning's leads against your ideal customer profile, draft intro replies with times you are free for good fits and a polite no for the rest, and don't send anything.[1]

There are official guides if this is your whole job: Grok Bot for SDRs, Grok Bot for GTM, Grok Bot for founder-led sales, and a sales news piece about how the company describes using the product. They are vendor how-tos, and they are useful. Start here, then go there if you need a deeper desk.[3]

How to set up a sales outbound Bot, drafts only

1. Create a Bot with one job — outbound research and drafts — or ask your chief to create one after you approve the description. In the first message, give it the job, the sources (your CRM if connected, the account list you name, the public pages it may read), your voice in a few sample messages, and the "never": never send email, never send a LinkedIn message, never update a CRM record you would not want it to touch, never contact anyone. Ask it to remember. You should be able to ask "What is your job, and what will you never do?" and hear the send-stop in the answer. If you don't: correct it before any overnight run.

2. Do one account, or one morning's inbound, as a one-time task. Watch the research. Edit a draft until it sounds like you. Save the method as a skill, with the six parts from Chapter 7, "Show It Once", and the "never send" on the card. You should have a skill you have seen work on a safe, small input. If you don't: do not schedule it.

3. Ask for a routine, if you want the overnight picture: "Every weekday night, at an hour I will actually review the next morning, run the outbound skill on the day's list. Leave a review list in this chat, with sources and drafts. Don't send. If a person is already in the CRM as 'do not contact,' skip them and say so." Test it, knowing a test is real work — but that "real" should still be a draft. You should get a list, not a sent folder. If a send is offered: Deny, and tighten Ask-first.

4. In the morning, work the list. Send the ones that are yours. Rewrite the ones that are almost yours. Tell the Bot what you changed, so the voice improves. Do not "approve all" out of tiredness. You should remain the person whose name is at the bottom. If you don't: pause the routine until you can be.

What "done" looks like: a review list waits in the morning. Nothing has been sent. You will spend your yes on the messages that deserve your name.

> **Caution.** A Bot that can sign in to LinkedIn or a mailbox is a Bot that can, if a "never" and a gate are missing, act in your name. Vault logins and a shared computer mean other Bots on the account may be able to use the same session. Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", still applies. Do not treat a specialist Bot as a security wall.

I will not tell you how many meetings this will book, and I will not invent a pipeline number. I will tell you that a careful list, in your voice, that you actually read, is already a better morning than a

blank page.

If you are a founder doing your own outbound — the official founder-led sales guide is on that shelf[3] — keep the desk even smaller. One list, a handful of accounts you actually know, drafts you will rewrite anyway. A Bot is good at gathering the last public note, the last email, the open thread, and putting them on one page, the way the official meeting-prep prompt does. It is less good at the judgment that says, "not this person, not this week." That judgment is why you still read the list. A polite no, drafted for a lead that is not a fit, is also work worth reviewing. The official inbound prompt includes that polite no, and does not send it.[1] You should be able to stand behind a no as easily as a yes.

Do not let a routine write into the CRM as a side effect of being helpful, unless you have a separate, tested skill for that and a "never overwrite a field I care about." Hygiene is a real job; it is not this job. If you want a CRM-operations Bot later, give it its own card, its own "never," and a review list of proposed edits, the same way paid media proposes budget moves and does not make them.

Paid media: recommend, don't spend

The official paid-media prompt is: compare this month's spend by campaign with your budget and target CAC, and recommend where to move money. Don't change any budgets.[1] The product-page version adds a Slack recommendation against a monthly budget, held for your approval before adjustments.[2] That last clause is the job.

There is an official Grok Bot for Performance Marketing guide when you want more.[4] This how-to stays at the size of a recommendation.

How to set up a paid-media recommender

1. Give a Bot one job: read the ad accounts or reports you name, compare spend to the budget and the targets you give it, and recommend moves. Never change a budget, a bid, a status, a creative, or a payment method. Never launch a campaign. Ask it to remember, and put the same "never" on Ask-first for anything that would spend or change production in that account. You should hear the stop when you ask the Bot its rules. If you don't: do not connect the ad account until you do.

2. Run it once, on last month or last week, as a one-time task. Ask for a recommendation with sources: which campaign, which number, which page it opened. Save a skill. If a number cannot be opened again, it is not a basis for a move. You should get a recommendation you can check. If you don't: the Bot is guessing, and guessing is not a budget meeting.

3. If you want a cadence, put the skill on a routine — weekly, not every hour — and have it leave the recommendation in your chat or in a Page. Don't change any budgets. Test once. You should see a memo, not a changed campaign. If a change is even proposed as an automatic step: Deny, pause, and rewrite the card.

4. You make the move, or you ask the Bot to make a specific move after you say yes, and you watch that run. A saved card can pay without asking, as Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", taught. An ad account can spend without a second conversation. This is not the place to

be unattended. You should be able to name what changed, and that you approved it. If you can't: it should not have changed.

What "done" looks like: a recommendation, with sources, waiting for a human spend decision. No unattended budget moves. No unattended spend.

> **Caution.** Unattended spend is one of the fastest ways for a helpful teammate to become an expensive one. Do not save a payment method for this Bot's use if you do not want a payment to be possible. Do not let a routine change budgets. A morning memo is the product. A weekend of unnoticed spend is not.

I will not quote vendor claims about savings. A recommendation you can audit is the win.

If your "ad account" is really a spreadsheet and a weekly export, that is a complete input. The Bot can read a sheet you connect or a file you attach, and it can still recommend. Do not pretend a browser login to a noisy dashboard is required for the pattern to work. The pattern is: current numbers, a comparison to a budget you name, a recommendation with sources, and a human who still moves the money. If the official performance-marketing guide assumes tools you do not have, keep this smaller version and ignore the rest.[4]

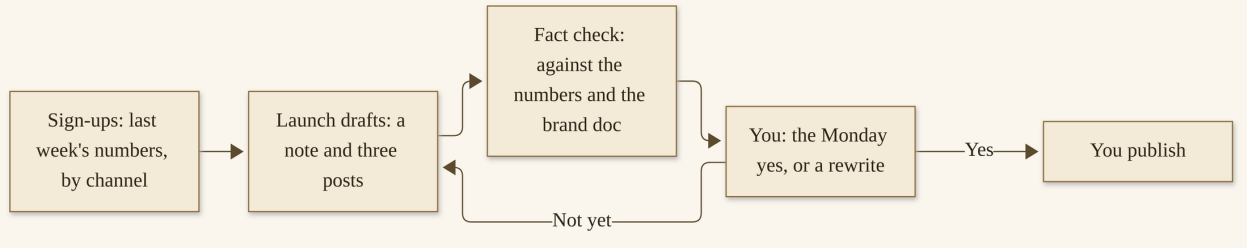
Targets themselves go stale. A CAC target from last quarter may not be this quarter's target. Put the target in the skill as "look up the current target in this sheet," not as a number remembered from March, Chapter 6, "Memory", again, walking into a budget meeting.

A campaign trio, from the official playbook

Some goals take more than one job. The official campaign team is a pattern I want you to have in your hands, because it is already a small fleet, and it already has a fact-check.[1]

1. **Sign-ups** — pulls last week's sign-ups by channel.
2. **Launch drafts** — drafts a launch note and three posts from the numbers.
3. **Fact check** — checks the drafts against the numbers and a brand doc.

It runs Mondays at 9:00 AM, in the official example. You ask your primary Bot to set this team up. Every piece stops for your review. The "never" is: do not publish, do not send, do not change the numbers. The fact-check Bot is the fridge-card reviewer from Chapter 7, "Show It Once", given a desk.



I18. The official campaign team: Sign-ups, Launch drafts, Fact check, then you. Mondays can run this way. Publishing is still a yes.

A content marketer on its own is the smaller version: pull what you shipped this week from the changelog and Slack, draft the newsletter and three posts in your voice, bring you the drafts, don't publish anything.[1] Save that as a skill if a trio is more team than you need. The "never publish" is the same.

How to stand up a campaign trio, draft-first

1. Ask your chief, or your primary Bot: "Please propose three one-job Bots for a campaign team, in the official shape: Sign-ups, Launch drafts, Fact check. Show me the jobs and the nevers. Don't create them until I say yes." You should get three short job descriptions, each with a "don't publish" or "don't invent a number." If you don't: write them yourself, from the official list above, and then create them.

2. Create the three Bots, or let the chief create them after your yes. Give the drafts Bot a few examples of your voice. Give the fact-check Bot the brand doc and the rule: if a number is not in the sign-ups output or in a source it can open, it does not stand. Never invent a metric. Never invent a quote. You should be able to ask each Bot its job and hear a single job back. If a Bot has two jobs: split them.

3. Run the chain once, by hand, in a group chat or by handing work from one Bot to the next, with last week's real numbers. One Bot owns each step. Watch the fact-check actually catch something, even a small something. Save skills. Then, and only then, consider a Monday 9:00 routine, in the right time zone, with Test, and with a "never publish." You should see drafts that waited. If anything published: stop, that is an incident, and the gate was missing.

4. Monday morning, read the packet. Publish what you mean, yourself, or say yes to a specific post and watch. Tell the drafts Bot what you changed. A campaign that waited overnight for a morning yes is this step, lived. You should remain the publisher of record. If you don't: pause the routine.

What "done" looks like: a Monday packet — numbers, drafts, a fact-check — and a human who still hits publish. Official guides for marketing go further; this is enough to run the pattern.[5]

> **Story.** I have let a marketing Bot write site copy for a WisdomForge book and leave it for morning. I have also rewritten a sentence because it sounded like a brochure, and this book is a gift, not a storefront. The Bot's job was the draft. My job was the voice. The post went out when I said so, and not a minute earlier. I will not invent a click-through rate for that morning. I will tell you the yes felt like the right size.

Optional, if mentions are part of your work: the marketplace Bot Overheard is officially described as a mention digest that never posts on your behalf.[6] That "never posts" is why I am willing to name it. A digest is a brief. A post is a yes.

If you write a newsletter, the official Newsletter Writer on the use-cases page is described as pulling what's new, writing the issue in your voice, and parking it for review so someone can edit once and send.[2] Parking is the word I like. Park the issue. Edit it on Thursday. Send it on Friday, yourself, or with a yes you are awake for. A monthly letter that is a day late and sounds like you will beat a monthly letter that went out on time and sounded like no one.

The same is true of a social post. The official Social Media Manager is described as studying your

history, drafting when something noteworthy ships, parking posts for you to publish, and keeping a queue moving.[2] I will not set that whole Bot up in this chapter. I will take its "parks posts for you to publish" and apply it to the campaign trio's last mile. The queue can move. The publish is yours. If a queue ever starts publishing itself, you have left the pattern, and you should pause and come back.

These marketplace and use-case names are official illustrations. They are not required purchases — there is nothing to buy in this book — and they are not endorsements I am making of a particular template. They are patterns with a "never" already written on the tin. When a tin already says "never post" or "park for review," I am glad to point at it.

A talent scout who does not reach out alone

The official starter: find twenty candidates for this role who meet the must-haves and are not already in your ATS, draft outreach in your voice, and don't contact anyone.[1] The product-page Talent Scout adds that it skips people already in the ATS, and handles scheduling once you approve.[2] There is an official recruiting guide when this is a daily desk.[7]

Twenty is the official example's number, not a target you must hit, and not a promise about a hiring outcome. If your list is smaller and better, that is a better list.

How to set up a talent scout, human outreach only

1. Create a Bot with one job: source a shortlist for a role you describe, skip people already in the ATS, draft outreach in your voice, and never contact anyone, never schedule until you approve, never reject a person in the ATS, never invent a work history. Give it the must-haves, the must-nots, and a "how we talk to people" sample. Ask it to remember. You should hear "don't contact anyone" in the job. If you don't: do not point it at a people site yet.
2. Run it once, for one role, with a small finish line — a shortlist of a size you can actually read this afternoon, even if the official example says twenty. Watch how it skips people already in the ATS. If it cannot reach the ATS, it should say so, not guess. Save a skill, with the "never contact" on the card. You should get drafts, and a skip list, and sources. If a message was sent: that is a stop-the-line moment. Deny, revoke, apologize if a person was reached, and do not run again until the gate is real.
3. Put it on a routine only after that clean run, and only at a cadence you will review. "Leave a shortlist and drafts; don't contact." Test. Work the list yourself. You send the outreach. You approve a schedule, if you want the Bot to propose times after a person has already said yes to you — and you still watch. You should be the first human a candidate hears from, or at least the one who approved the exact words. If you aren't: pause.
4. Protect reputation the way you would protect a friend's. No second blast to people who declined. No invented compliments. No "we loved your talk at X" unless the Bot can open X and you would say it yourself. Correct the voice. Forget, from Chapter 6, "Memory", any personal data about a candidate that does not belong in a notebook. You should be willing to stand behind every message. If you aren't: it should not be sent, and it should not be stored

carelessly.

What "done" looks like: a shortlist, drafts in your voice, ATS skips honored, and no contact without you. Hiring is still a human decision. This book is not a promise about who you will hire.

> **Caution.** People's careers are not a sandbox. A wrong outreach is a real message to a real person. Keep the "never contact" on the skill, on the routine, and on Ask-first. If you use a login to a recruiting tool, remember the shared computer. Do not put a candidate's private life in memory.

In your voice, which is slower than it sounds

"Draft it in my voice" is an official phrase, and it is also a week of work, not a switch.[1] I do not expect a Bot to sound like me on the first afternoon. I expect it to get closer each time I say, "This sentence is mine; that one is a brochure. Remember the difference."

Practical steps, which are teaching, not official clicks. Give the Bot three messages you actually sent and were proud of — a sales note, a post, an outreach — and three you would never send. Ask it to tell you what it notices, and to remember those observations as preferences, not as a license to improvise facts. When a draft arrives, edit it in the chat, out loud: "Shorter. No 'excited to share.' No claim we cannot open a source for. Keep the thank-you at the end; that is mine." Then ask it to rewrite, and only then, maybe, send.

A fact-check Bot, in the campaign trio, is a second voice: the voice of "is this true?" It should be a little colder than the drafts Bot. That is a feature. If the two agree too quickly, ask the fact-check Bot what it would flag if it were in a bad mood. You want a reviewer, not a cheerleader.

Voice is also a "never." Never invent a personal history with the recipient. Never praise a talk you did not watch. Never say "as we discussed" unless you can open the discussion. I would rather a slightly plain message than a warm one that is false. People forgive plain. They remember false.

When growth work goes wrong, quietly

The failures I care about in this chapter are not dramatic. They are quiet, and they have a human on the other end.

A review list that is too long to read will be approved too fast, or not at all. Cut the batch to a size you will actually sit with. The official "twenty candidates" is an example, not a quota. Ten careful drafts beat forty you skim.

A CRM that the Bot cannot reach will produce a second outreach to someone who already said no, or a "new" lead who is already a customer. If the ATS or the CRM is unavailable, the skill should stop and say so, the way a morning brief names a missing source. Skipping people already in the system is official for a reason.[1]

A budget recommendation built on a cached number will move money in the wrong direction. Look it up again, Chapter 6, "Memory"'s stale-price rule, applied to spend.

A campaign fact-check that only checks spelling will let a wrong metric into a public post. Give the fact-check Bot the actual numbers file, and the rule that an unsourced figure does not ship.

A LinkedIn session on the shared computer will be a session other Bots can use. Sign-out when the work is done, if you can, and do not treat "the outbound Bot's login" as a wall.

A mention digest that starts posting is no longer Overheard's official promise. If you use a digest Bot, read its "never" out loud, and keep Ask-first on post.

When something does go out by mistake — and I hope it will not — stop the routine, say so to the person who received it if a person did, and treat the cleanup as more important than the next batch. This book cannot write your apology for you. It can tell you that pausing is allowed, and that speed is not the virtue here. Trust is.

A week of growth work, at a human size

Monday, the campaign packet is waiting, because you set Monday at 9:00 and you tested it the week before. You change one sentence so it sounds like you. You publish one post, not three. You tell the drafts Bot about the sentence. The other two posts wait for Wednesday, on purpose.

Tuesday, the outbound list has eight drafts. You send three. You rewrite two. You drop three because the research was thin. You thank the Bot for the sources on the three you sent, and you ask it to be harder on itself when a source is thin. The routine stays on.

Wednesday, the paid-media memo says a campaign is spending faster than its target. You open the live account, yourself, and the number is real. You make a small move, yourself, or you say yes to a specific change and watch it. You do not turn that into a routine that can move money at 2:00 AM.

Thursday, the scout leaves a shortlist. You read every line. You skip two people the Bot should have skipped, and you tell it why, and you ask whether the ATS connection failed. It did, for an hour. The skill already says "if you cannot reach the ATS, stop." You remind it. You send two outreach notes in your own name.

Friday, your chief's brief includes a single line: "Growth Bots: Monday packet published in part; outbound three sent; media move watched; two scout notes sent by you; nothing unattended." That line is coordinating. It is also a week you can stand behind.

Priya, our shop-owner composite, might run a smaller version: one content Bot that drafts a weekend email and does not send it; no scout, no ad-account routine. Dan does not need this chapter at all, and that is fine. Growth work is a shelf. Take the box you need.

Guides, voice, and what this chapter will not do

The official shelves for this work are worth naming, once, so you can find them: Grok Bot for Marketing, for Performance Marketing, for SDRs, for GTM, for Recruiting, for founder-led sales, and for Clay, among others. They live with the other guides at the official guides page. They are

how-tos from the product's maker, not independent evaluations, and not this book's voice. Use them for depth. Use this chapter for the yes.[8]

I will not crown a tool. I will not tell you Grok Bot replaces a salesperson, a marketer, or a recruiter this weekend. I will not invent a revenue number from SMF Works, or from anyone else. I will tell you that overnight work and a morning list is a practice I trust, and that your name on a message is still a human act.

If your chief is already crowding with this kind of work, give it away, the way Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff", taught. One outbound Bot. One media Bot. A campaign trio, or a single content Bot if a trio is too much. One scout. Each with one job. Each with a "never." Each reporting to you, often through the chief, always with a review list.

In Chapter 11, "The Shop Floor", we will go to the shop floor: support and refunds, invoices and expenses and month-end, bugs and product numbers, a meeting recap, and a pointer for legal ops that is not legal advice. The yes will travel with us. Growth work is public. Shop-floor work often moves money or production. Both deserve a closed door until you open it.

Let me say a direct word about volume, and then we will go to the shop floor. Grok Bot can research overnight. It can fill a list faster than you can read one. That is not a reason to raise the volume until you drown. It is a reason to choose a batch size that honors the morning yes. I would rather you ran outbound two days a week, and recruiting one morning, and a campaign packet on Monday, than that you built a machine you are afraid to open. Fear is a signal. It usually means a "never" is thin, or a list is too long, or a test was skipped. Pause. Cut. Watch once. Then, if you want, turn the clock back on.

The official path — assistant, one-job Bot, a team of Bots — is available here the same as it was for a chief.[1] A campaign trio is already a team. You can live for a long time on one content Bot and a chief. You can add the scout when hiring is real. You can add paid media when there is a budget you actually manage. There is no prize for a full roster, and this free book will not give you one.

The list is waiting. The morning is yours. Read it. Send only what you would sign. That is growth work, done in the light. Tomorrow's list will be there if you earned the clock. If you did not, the pause switch is still a complete answer, and a kind one.

Chapter 11 — The Shop Floor: Support, Finance, Operations, and Engineering

An invoice does not match a purchase order. The Bot flags it, drafts a note to the owner, and stops. A person decides. That is the shop floor, in one picture, and it is the picture I want on the wall above every how-to in this chapter.

Support tickets, refunds, expenses, month-end, a bug on staging, a slow checkout, a meeting that needs a recap, a folder of paper for counsel: this is the work that keeps a company honest. It moves money. It touches production. It sometimes touches law. Official team patterns exist for a support queue and for a month-end close, and official starter prompts exist for invoices, expenses, bug reproduction, and product performance.[1] We will use them, compactly. We will keep refunds and payments behind a yes. We will remember that a card saved in the Vault can pay without asking.[2] We will let engineering reproduce and draft, and we will not let it merge alone. We will point at meeting recaps, and leave the full meetings story to Chapter 15, “Bots on Your Human Team”. We will give legal ops a pointer and a confidentiality box, and we will not pretend the Bot is your lawyer.

Drafts and recommendations first. Send, publish, pay, and production behind a yes. The rule did not change because the work got closer to the ledger.

I should also say who this chapter is for, and who can skip around. If you run a shop, a studio, a small team, or a practice with invoices, this is your shelf. If you are a single person with a household and no ledger, Chapter 13, “Get Your Life Back”, will meet you more kindly, and you can take from this chapter only the refund caution and the “never invent a quote.” If you are an engineer who will never touch month-end, take the staging how-to and the shared-computer warning, and leave the rest. A free book should be willing to be skipped. I would rather you used one page well than that you felt you had to build a factory.

The official three-step path is still the path: help from an assistant, a Bot with one job, a team when a goal is bigger than one job.[1] A month-end close is a bigger goal. A support queue is a bigger goal. A single invoice skill, run on Fridays, is a complete first step, and I would be proud of you for stopping there until the folder is trustworthy.

Support and refunds, with a policy and a person

The official support-queue team is three jobs, running weekdays at 9:00 AM in the example: ticket triage that sorts new tickets and drafts replies; bug repro that reproduces reports in staging with a test account; and help pages that flag pages that need fixing.[1] You can ask your primary Bot to set this up. You can also start with a single triage Bot, which is enough for a small shop.

The official "never" on triage is already close to what we need: drafts, and a review. I will make it explicit. Never send a reply to a customer until you say yes. Never issue a refund until you say yes, and only inside a policy you have written down. Never post a public comment. Never use one customer's data to test another customer's bug. If a ticket is angry, or legal, or about a safety issue, flag it and stop; that ticket is a person's job.

There is an official support guide, and a vendor story about how the product's maker describes using Grok Bot to scale support. Those are official and vendor pages, not a measured study of your queue.[3] Use the guide for depth. Use this how-to for the gate.

How to set up a support triage Bot, with refunds behind a yes

1. Write a short policy you actually use: when a refund is allowed, when it is not, what a reply should sound like, what must be escalated to a person. Put that policy in a document the Bot can open. Do not keep the exceptions only in your head, and do not put customer secrets in memory. You should be able to point at the policy. If you don't: you are not ready for a refund skill. Start with triage drafts only.

2. Create a Bot with one job: sort new tickets (or the support inbox), draft replies, and flag anything that looks like a refund, a legal threat, a safety issue, or a bug that needs staging. Never send. Never refund. Never change an account. Ask it to remember, and put Ask-first on send and on anything that would move money. You should hear those stops when you ask the Bot its job. If you don't: correct it before it sees a live ticket.

3. Run it once on a safe batch — yesterday's closed tickets, or a sample — and compare drafts to what a careful person would have said. Save a skill, with the policy as an input and the "never send, never refund" on the card. Then, if you want, a weekday routine, tested, drafts only. You should get a queue you can review. If a message was sent: stop the line, as we would in Chapter 10, "Growth Work", and fix the gate.

4. For refunds, a second step, always: the Bot finds the claim, checks it against the policy, and prepares a recommendation. You approve, or you don't. If you ever let the Bot complete a refund after a yes, watch that run, and do not put it on an unattended routine. A saved card can pay without asking. A refund is a payment in reverse, and it is still money. You should be able to name every refund that went out, and the yes that released it. If you can't: pause.

What "done" looks like: a sorted queue, drafted replies, refund recommendations inside a policy, and a human who still talks to the customer and still moves the money.

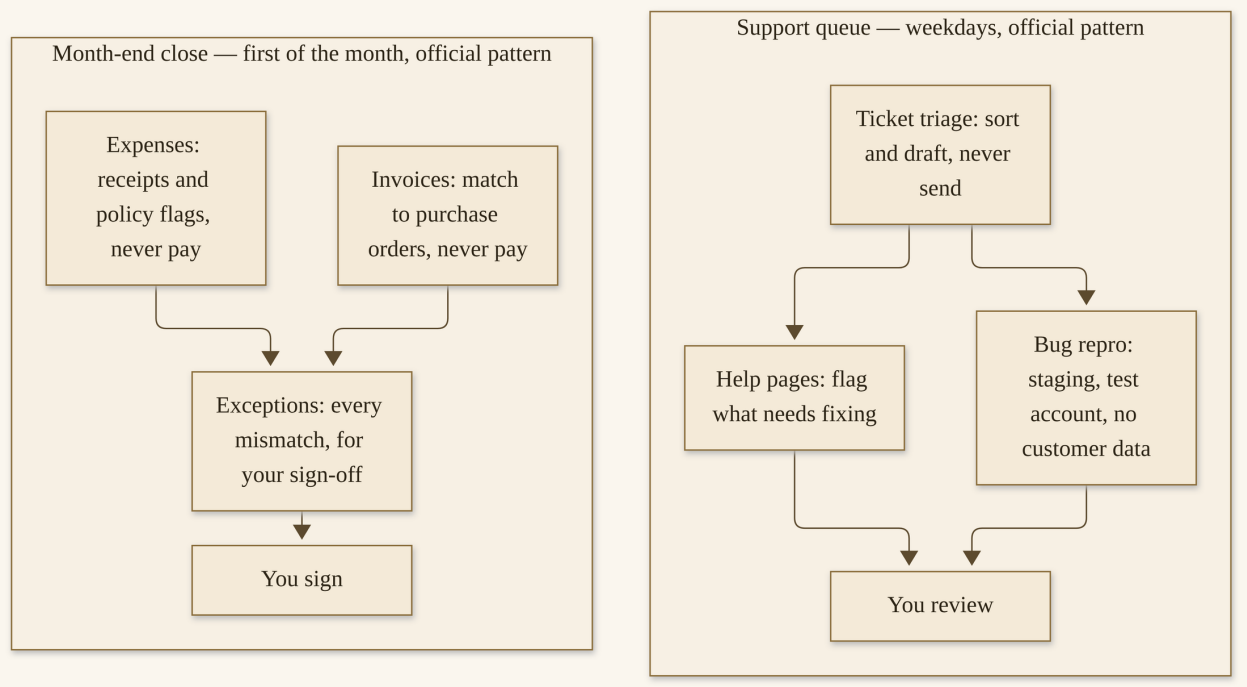
Priya, our shop-owner composite, might only need this: a morning list of customer mail, drafts for the easy ones, flags for the refunds, and Priya at the counter making the call. That is a complete support desk.

A word about tone, because support drafts are public in a way that invoice lists are not. Give the Bot three replies you were proud of and one you would never send, the way we did for growth work. Ask it to be warm, short, and specific, and to avoid promising what the policy does not allow. "I will refund this today" is a promise. "I have prepared a refund recommendation for the owner to review" is a draft. The customer should not see the second sentence; the customer should see, after your yes, a sentence that is true. If a ticket is abusive, or if it asks for another customer's information, the skill should flag and stop. A Bot should not be left to improvise at the edge of privacy or safety. That is a person's edge.

Help pages, the third official job in the support trio, are a quieter kindness: flag pages that are wrong, draft a rewrite, don't publish.[1] Publishing a help page is a publish. It lives behind the same yes as a campaign post, and it should be fact-checked against what the product actually does, not against a hopeful memory of last quarter.

Invoices, expenses, and a month-end close

The official invoice coordinator matches invoices in the finance inbox to purchase orders, lists the ones that don't match, drafts a note to each owner, and does not approve or pay anything.[1] The official expense manager builds a weekly summary, matches receipts, flags policy exceptions, and drafts follow-ups it does not send.[1] Those two desks, plus a third that lists every mismatch for your sign-off, are the official month-end close, running on the first of the month.[1]



I19. Two official trios. Support: triage, bug repro, help pages, then you. Month-end: invoices, expenses, exceptions, then you sign. Payments and refunds stay behind a yes.

How to run invoices and a month-end folder

1. Create an invoice Bot (or start as a skill on a finance-minded Bot) with the official job: match this week's invoices to purchase orders, list mismatches, draft notes, don't approve or pay. Point it at the inbox or folder you actually use. Ask it to remember, and put Ask-first on pay, approve, and send. You should get a matcher, not a payer. If you don't: do not connect a payments account.
2. Do the same for expenses: a weekly summary, receipts from the finance inbox or the alias you set in Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed", policy exceptions, drafted follow-ups, don't send, don't pay, don't reimburse. You should get a summary you can check against a handful of receipts. If a number is stale or a receipt is missing, the Bot should say so, not fill a gap from memory.
3. Ask your primary Bot to propose the official month-end trio — Invoices, Expenses, Exceptions — with jobs and nevers, and to create them only after you say yes. Run it once, near a quiet close, on last month's already-finished files if you can, so a mistake is a lesson and not a payment. Save skills. Then a routine on the first of the month, in the right time zone, with Test, and with a folder of drafts as the output. You should see a folder: matches, exceptions, notes. No payments. If a payment is proposed automatically: Deny, pause, and rewrite.
4. You sign. You pay, or you approve a specific payment and watch it. You send the notes you mean to send. A saved card in the Vault fills in at checkout without asking each time; if you do not want that, do not save the card.[2] Month-end is not the week to discover that fact by accident. You should finish the close as the person whose name is on the payment. If you don't: the trio has gone too far.

What "done" looks like: month-end drafts in a folder, exceptions listed, and a human who still signs.

> **Story.** I have opened a folder of exceptions on the first of a month and felt the quiet relief of not starting from a pile of mail. I have also sat with a mismatch that looked like a mistake and turned out to be a decision I had already made, and I was glad a person was still required. I will not invent how many dollars that folder saved. I will tell you the signing still felt like my job, and that I wanted it to.

A vendor story about procurement describes a Bot that monitors vendor spend, usage, and renewals, and includes a claim of savings. That is a vendor claim, not a number I can audit, and not a number I will repeat as fact.[4] If you do procurement work, use the same pattern: watch, recommend, and let a person renew. There is an official incident-sweep story as well, in a vendor voice; if you work incidents, keep changes to production behind a yes, and treat vendor results as vendor.[5]

Engineering: reproduce, draft, do not merge alone

The official bug-reproduction prompt is one I want on a card in every engineering shop that uses this book: reproduce this bug in staging, with a fresh test account; send the exact steps, screenshots, and browser details; don't use customer data.[1] The official product-performance prompt is a cousin: find out why checkout got slower after yesterday's release; send the likeliest hotspot with screenshots and links; don't change production settings.[1]

There are official guides for engineering, for Linear, for PMs, and a Data Bot news piece about giving teams a data-scientist-like helper. Those are official and vendor pages. Use them for depth. Keep this how-to at the size of a repro pack and a write-up.[6]

How to set up a bug-repro Bot, staging only

1. Give the Bot one job: take a report, reproduce it in staging with a fresh test account, and return a pack — exact steps, screenshots, browser details, what was expected, what happened. Never use customer data. Never use a production login. Never change staging data you were not given a test fixture for. Never merge. Never deploy. Never rotate a real secret. Ask it to remember, and keep production credentials out of the Vault if this Bot shares a computer with the rest of your account — because it does share a computer.[7] You should hear "staging, test account, no customer data, no merge" in the job. If you don't: do not point it at a ticket.
2. Run one known bug, one you have already fixed or one in a safe staging project, and compare the pack to what a careful engineer would write. Save a skill. If the Bot asks for a production login, the answer is no. You should get a pack you would attach to a ticket. If customer data appeared: treat it as a cleanup, and tighten the card.
3. Connect this Bot to the support trio if you have one: triage flags a bug, handoff to repro, pack comes back to you and to the ticket as a draft. One Bot per step. Approvals may show in the repro Bot's own chat, not in the group.[8] You should be able to follow the handoff. If production is even in the path: stop.
4. If you use a programmer Bot to draft a fix or a pull request — as I do, in a different shop, in Chapter 12, "A Small Fleet" — the same rule holds. Draft, do not merge alone. The human merge is the yes. A routine may open a draft pull request, if you have designed that and tested it. A routine may not merge. You should remain the person who ships. If you aren't: pause.

What "done" looks like: a repro pack from staging, no customer data, no production change, and a merge that still needs you.

How to ask for a product-performance write-up, without touching production

1. Point a Bot at the observability tools or dashboards you name, with logins you are willing to have on the shared computer, or with a file you export yourself. Ask for a short write-up of the likeliest hotspot, with screenshots and links. Don't change production settings. Don't restart a service. Don't "just bump" a limit. You should get a memo. If a change is offered as part of the run: Deny.
2. Save a skill once the memo is one you would send an engineer. Put it on a routine only as a report, never as a changer of systems. You should be comfortable if the laptop is closed during a report. You should not be comfortable if the laptop is closed during a production change. Those are different jobs.

What "done" looks like: a write-up with sources, and production untouched.

If your "observability tool" is a weekly export, that is enough. Attach the export. Ask for the hotspot. Do not require a live production login for a first memo. The Data Bot news piece describes a more ambitious helper; it is a vendor page, and it does not change the "don't change production"

rule.[6] I would rather you had a humble memo from a CSV than a confident change from a Bot that found a button.

Linear, Jira, GitHub: official guides and event triggers exist, and Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed", already taught a narrow Linear trigger.[6],[14] A new issue in one project with one label can start a repro skill in staging. A trigger on every issue in every project is a noisy listener. Keep it narrow. Keep the "never merge" on the routine's Instruction, not only in a conversation you had in September.

> **Caution.** The cloud computer has a command line, and credentials on it are shared.[7] An engineering Bot that can reach staging is a Bot whose neighbors, on the same account, may be able to use what you placed there. Do not put a production secret on that computer if another Bot should not have it. This is the official rule, applied to the shop floor.

Meeting recaps, and a quote you will not invent

A Bot can join Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams, listen, take notes, answer in meeting chat, and send a summary and action items — on Team, Enterprise, and Ultra plans, as the 1.0 announcement described, with Enterprise admins able to disable it.[9] Chapter 15, "Bots on Your Human Team", is the home of that story: Team Bots, Slack, meetings, group chats. I will not steal it.

What I will give you here is a shop-floor recap you can use from notes you already have. The official Meeting Recap Deck, in the marketplace descriptions the docs point to, is associated with a rule I want in this book: never invent a quote.[10] If you paste notes and ask for a recap, say it: "Summarize these notes into decisions, action items with owners, and open questions. Do not invent a quote. If you are not sure who said something, don't attribute it. Leave a Page or a short document for my review; don't send it to the attendees."

How to get a meeting recap from notes you paste

1. Paste the notes, or point at a Granola or docs source you have connected, and use the instruction above. The "never invent a quote" is not optional in this book. You should see a recap that only claims what the notes support. If a quotation appears that you cannot find: strike it, and tell the Bot to remember the rule.
2. You send the recap, or you approve a specific send. Action items can go on the chief's follow-up list from Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff", still unsent. You should remain the person who tells the room what was decided. If you aren't: the recap has become a broadcast, and we have left the pattern.

What "done" looks like: a recap without invented speech, sitting for your yes. For a Bot that joins the call itself, see Chapter 15, "Bots on Your Human Team", and check your plan.

The official Granola illustration — evening action items drafted for Slack, sent once you approve — is the same pattern in a different jacket.[1]

Legal ops is a folder, not a lawyer

There is an official Grok Bot for Legal Ops guide.[11] I want you to know it exists. I also want a box around what this book will not do.

> **Caution.** This book is not legal advice. A Bot is not your lawyer, your counsel, or your compliance officer. Confidentiality still applies to whatever you place on the shared computer, in memory, in a Page, or in a chat. If a matter needs a lawyer, a lawyer should have it. The Bot may help you prepare a folder. That is the size of this section.

A reasonable pattern, as teaching, not as a legal method: a Bot lists contracts by date and owner, pulls a clause you ask for from a document you already have, flags a date that is coming due, and leaves a folder for counsel. Never send a legal letter. Never file. Never waive. Never tell you that a clause is "fine." Never put a privileged document in a public Page or a shared template. If your counsel has rules about tools, those rules win.

I will not walk a how-to that looks like practicing law. I will point at the official guide, and I will point you back to the yes. If Priya has a vendor contract due next month, Lane the chief can flag the date, and a folder can hold the PDF. A person, and if needed a lawyer, reads it.

Questionnaires, portals, and other work that looks like clicking

Not every shop-floor job is a trio. Some are a path a person clicks every week: a vendor portal with no clean API, a security questionnaire, a renewal screen. Official use-case descriptions include a Vendor Portal Operator that clicks the same path and comes back with exceptions, and a Security Questionnaire Filler that drafts every field from a trust center and past answers, and parks the submit for you.[13] Those are official illustrations. The teaching I will take from them is the park.

If you do this work, write a skill for one portal or one questionnaire type, with a "never submit" and a "never invent an answer." Point the Bot at the source of truth you actually use — a trust document, a past questionnaire you are allowed to reuse, a policy page. Run it once while you watch. If a field is unknown, the Bot should leave it blank and flag it, not guess. Guessing on a security form is a kind of fiction, and fiction on a security form is a problem. You submit, or you say yes to a specific submit and watch.

The shared computer matters here more than in a writing job. A portal login in the Vault is a login other Bots can use. A completed questionnaire sitting in a file is a file other Bots can read. Do not treat the questionnaire Bot as a vault of its own. Do not put answers you would not share with the rest of your account on that desk without looking at Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", again.

I will not invent the click path. Sites change. The skill you watch, on your actual portal, is the one that counts. Re-test when the site moves, Chapter 7, "Show It Once"'s stale-pot rule, now in a vendor jacket.

Account health, and a contact you will not make alone

The official account-health prompt ranks accounts by churn risk and expansion potential from usage, tickets, and renewal dates, suggests a next step for each, and does not contact anyone.[1] That is a cousin of the talent scout and of the outbound list: a watch list, evidence, a suggested step, and a human who still picks up the phone.

I mention it here, on the shop floor, because it often sits with customer success and with finance, not only with growth. A renewal date is an operations fact. A usage drop is a support fact. The "never contact" is the same sentence we have been writing all chapter. Save a skill if this is your work. Put it on a Friday routine if you will actually read a watch list on Friday. Do not let a routine "just check in" with a customer. A check-in is a contact.

The official post-sales guide is on the shelf if this is a daily desk.[12] Your chief can flag the watch list in the morning brief, in one line, and leave the rest with the specialist.

A week on the shop floor

Monday, the support queue's 9:00 run has left twelve drafted replies and two refund flags. You send eight replies. You rewrite two. You refuse one refund because the policy says so, and you approve one after you have looked at the order yourself. You tell the Bot why the refusal was a refusal, so the next flag is sharper. Nothing refunded itself overnight.

Tuesday, a ticket is a bug. The repro Bot returns a pack from staging: steps, screenshots, a browser, a test account. No customer data. You attach the pack to the ticket, or you ask the Bot to draft that attachment and you post it. The programmer, if you have one, drafts a fix. You review. You do not merge from the train.

Wednesday, expenses. Receipts from the plus-alias in Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed", are on a list. Two are missing a category. The follow-ups are drafted and unsent. You send one nudge, yourself. You leave the other because you already know the owner is out. The Bot does not know everything, and the list is allowed to wait.

Thursday, a product-performance memo says checkout was slow after a release. You read the screenshots. You hand it to an engineer — a human one — and you are glad the Bot did not "just roll back" anything. The memo did its job by being a memo.

Friday, if it is the first Friday after the first of the month, the month-end folder is already there, because the routine ran on the first and you tested it last month. You sit with exceptions. You sign. You pay what you mean to pay. You go into the weekend without a card having paid on its own.

That week is a picture, not a diary of SMF Works, and not a promise about your volume. Take the days that are yours. Skip the ones that are not. The shape — draft, flag, folder, sign — is the borrowable part.

Money, cards, and the temptation to "just finish it"

I want one more slow paragraph about money, because the shop floor is where a helpful Bot and a saved card can meet.

Officially, a card saved in the Vault fills in at checkout without asking each time. If you want to approve every payment, do not save the card.[2] Settings also describe payment accounts and a default payment method; I will not invent those labels beyond what Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", already taught, and I will not walk a checkout here. The teaching is simpler than a menu. If a payment should never happen unattended, do not give the unattended path a card. If a Bot should never be able to pay, do not leave a paying method where the shared computer can use it, and keep Ask-first on pay.

Month-end, refunds, procurement renewals, a vendor portal, a store credit: all of these can look like "finishing the job." Finishing, in this book, is a folder and a person. The official invoice and expense prompts already end with "don't approve or pay" and "don't send."[1] We will not be more casual than the product's own examples.

If you ever discover that a payment went out and you did not mean it, pause the routine, look at the Vault, look at Ask-first, and deal with the payment as you would any mistaken charge — with the bank, the vendor, and a calm record. This book is not financial advice. It is a plea to keep the card and the clock on different sides of a yes.

The shop floor, kept human

Let me gather the "never" lines, because this chapter had several desks.

Support: never send, never refund without a yes, never use customer data to test. Invoices and expenses: never approve, never pay, never reimburse unattended. Month-end: a folder, then a signature. Engineering: staging, test accounts, no customer data, no production changes, no merge alone. Recaps: never invent a quote, never send unattended. Legal ops: a folder for counsel, not a lawyer in a chat.

Official teams can be set up by your primary Bot, or with help from dr eggbot, as in earlier chapters.[1] One job each. One owner per step in a group. Approvals in the Bot's own chat if they do not appear in the group. A test that does real work, so you use last month's files, a staging project, a sample ticket.

Usage still burns. A support trigger on every new message in a busy channel is Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed"'s noisy listener, in a new hat. Narrow it. A month-end that runs every hour is not a close; it is a bill.

I have no metric for the value of a mismatch caught, a refund rightly refused, a bug reproduced without a customer's data, a quote that was not invented. I have a practice, and a signature that is still mine. The folder is waiting. You still sign.

In Chapter 12, "A Small Fleet", I will show you how this pattern looks in my own small press: a chief, a writer, a marketer, a programmer who prepares a site and does not merge alone, a Video

Studio, and a human publish yes. It will stay inside Grok Bot. The door to other platforms opens at the end, and opens fully in Chapter 16, “Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms”.

I work, in my own shop, with a programmer Bot who prepares files and a site and does not merge alone. I have felt the same temptation engineering teams feel: the draft is good, the tests look green, the hour is late. The next chapter is honest about that temptation, and about the yes I still have to give. If you take only one sentence from this shop floor to that press, take this one. A folder of finished work is a gift. A merge or a payment that happened because we were tired is not.

The shop floor is not glamorous. It is where trust lives. Thank you for reading it all the way through. You are still the one who signs.

If this chapter felt like several books in one, it is because a shop is several jobs in one. You do not have to stand up a support trio, a month-end trio, a repro Bot, a data memo, a recap, and a legal folder this month. Pick the desk that is already costing you evenings. Write the “never.” Watch one run. Put it on a clock only when the folder it leaves is one you trust. The rest of the floor will still be there when you are ready, and your chief can keep a single line on the morning brief — “shop floor: three tickets drafted, one mismatch flagged, nothing paid” — until those desks exist.

That single line is how a shop stays human when it also stays moving. I have wanted, some months, more automation than I had earned. The months I remember with pride are the ones where the folder was clean and the signature was still mine.

There is a kindness in this work that I do not want to lose under all the cautions. A mismatch flagged is a person saved from a hunt. A refund recommendation, prepared inside a policy, is a customer who might be helped faster because you were not starting from a blank ticket. A repro pack is an engineer who can see what failed without guessing. A recap that does not invent a quote is a team that can trust the notes. The Bot did not replace the kindness. It made a little more room for it, if we keep the yes. That is the shop floor I wanted to offer you, and it is enough.

If a Friday comes when the folder is messy — a stale receipt, a pack that used the wrong environment, a recap that slipped in a quote — do not throw the Bot out, and do not pretend it is fine. Correct it, the way we correct memory. Tighten the card. Watch the next run. The shop floor rewards that kind of quiet stubbornness more than it rewards a clever routine. I am stubborn about signatures. I hope, after this chapter, you will be too. The next chapter is a press, and a press is only a shop floor that makes books. The same stubbornness travels. Charlie will be there. A writer, a marketer, a programmer, a Video Studio. And you, if you use the pattern, at the top of a small fleet, still saying yes. I am glad to walk into that last room with you now. A small press is a shop with a lamp still on, and a person at the door.

Chapter 12 — A Small Fleet: Running a Publishing House with Bots

I have a stack of teaching manuals on a table in the other room. EPUB, letter PDF, a finished manuscript in markdown. A small company made them: SMF Works, and the press I call WisdomForge. Part of the team is human. Part of the team is a fleet of Grok Bots. I am still the person who says a book may go out the door.

This chapter is a kitchen-table tour of that fleet, as it lives inside Grok Bot. It is a pattern you can copy for a shop, a studio, a practice, a newsletter, a church bulletin, a family history — anything that needs more than one job and a final yes. It is not a vendor case study. It is not a storefront. This book is a gift, and if you ever pick up a file from WisdomForge, you are picking up a file, not walking into a shop I am running in these pages.

I will describe roles and a workflow I would recognize if I sat down tomorrow morning: Charlie, my chief of staff Bot; a writer Bot; a marketing Bot; a programmer Bot who prepares a site and opens a pull request I approve; Grok Bot Video Studio; files that land finished; a website; a Friday status. I will not invent a metric, a teammate's first name, a hidden instruction, or a Bot name that is not already mine to use. I will not tell you how many books, how many hours, or how much "efficiency." I will tell you how the desks are arranged, and where the yes sits.

At the end, one paragraph will open a door. The same company also talks to other agent platforms. Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms,", starts there. This chapter stays inside Grok Bot. The lamp is the same lamp. The room, for now, is this one.

One job each

The whole pattern, if you have read Chapters 9 through 11, will sound like a rhyme, and I want it to. A chief coordinates and does not hoard. Specialists have one job and a "never." Group work has one owner per step. Anything that publishes or merges waits for a person. Files come back in a form you can open. A website is a place the work can live, once you have said yes.

Here is the roster I actually use, at the level I am willing to put in a free book, and no deeper.

Charlie, my chief of staff Bot, runs the morning brief at SMF Works, the way Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff,", already introduced him. In this house, Charlie also keeps a picture of what is in motion: which title is being drafted, which files are ready, which pull request is waiting for

me, which piece of site copy is parked. Charlie does not write the book. Charlie does not publish the book. Charlie does not merge. Charlie coordinates, and hands work to the desk that owns it.

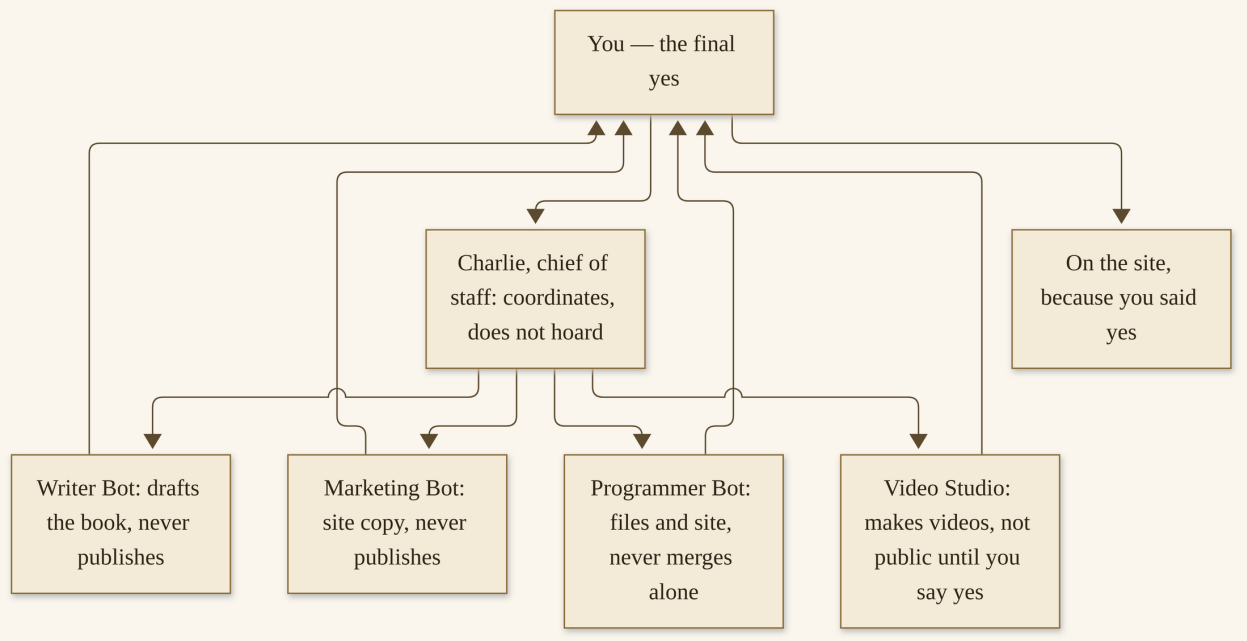
A writer Bot drafts. In this press, that often means a teaching manual, in a voice we have practiced, with notes at the back, and with a finish line I can name: a manuscript that can become an EPUB, a letter PDF, and a markdown file. The writer does not publish. The writer does not invent a source. The writer leaves questions for me when a fact is not in a source we opened. Judgment and voice, in the last inch, stay human. I will not print the writer's internal instructions. I will tell you the job: draft the book, honor the voice, stop at the yes.

A marketing Bot drafts site copy, a summary, a question a parent might ask, the kind of short text a book page needs. It does not publish. It does not put a price on anything, because this press, in the story I am telling and in the gift you are holding, is not a checkout. It leaves copy for morning, the way Chapter 10, "Growth Work,", left a campaign packet. I rewrite a sentence when it sounds like a brochure. Then, maybe, yes.

A programmer Bot takes finished files and prepares the site. It can open a pull request against the place the books live. It does not merge that request alone. I approve the merge. That is the same shop-floor rule as Chapter 11, "The Shop Floor,", applied to a press: draft, do not merge alone. I will not name the repository as a tour of internals, and I will not invent the commands. The workflow I want you to copy is the yes: a human merge, every time a book goes live.

Grok Bot Video Studio is a Bot with its own job: it makes videos. In this chapter, that is all I will say about the wiring. It has a desk. It reports, like the others, to a yes I still give before anything is public. Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms", will tell you, in my words, how that desk talks to work that is not a Grok Bot. Not here. I will not steal that chapter's opening, and I will not invent a production number.

That is the fleet, at human size. Other small jobs come and go — a fact-check on a set of notes, a pass over a diagram — and I will not invent names for them. If a job repeats and earns a desk, it gets a Bot, a "never," and a report to Charlie or to me. If it does not, it stays a task. "And so on" is allowed to remain "and so on."



I20. A publishing fleet, inside Grok Bot. Charlie coordinates. Each specialist has one job and a "never." Every line that would publish or merge comes back to you.



I21. A wooden press, a stack of finished books, a lamp still on.

Charlie is not a bottleneck

A chief who hoards is a bottleneck. A chief who coordinates is a hallway.

I have made Charlie a bottleneck, on days I was tired, by asking him to write a chapter, and draft the site copy, and watch a pull request, and keep the brief short, all in one conversation. The brief got long. The "never" got soft. The work got slower, not faster, because everything waited on a single notebook.

A hallway, by contrast, is a little empty on purpose. Charlie knows what is in motion, and who owns the next step, and what is waiting on me. When I ask "what's new with the press?", I get a short picture, not a draft of Chapter 4, "Hand Off Your First Real Task". When a writer is stuck, Charlie can flag it, and I go to the writer's chat. When a pull request is ready, Charlie can say so, and I go to the request. The work does not have to pass through the chief's hands to pass through the chief's awareness. That is the difference I had to learn, and it is the difference I would like to give you without the slow week in the middle.

The correction is the one from Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff": give the job away. Charlie may propose a handoff — "this title is ready for the writer," "these files are ready for the programmer" — and then step back. In a group chat, official best practice is one Bot responsible for each step; you `@` one Bot, not everyone. Approval and login requests may not appear in the group; check the Bot's own chat.[1] I do not run a crowd. I run a sequence. The writer drafts. I read. The marketing Bot parks copy. I edit. The programmer opens a request. I approve, or I don't.

Charlie's Friday, when the Friday Page is working, is a picture of the house, not a pile of the house's work. What's in draft. What's in review. What is waiting on my yes. What failed and needs a person. That is coordinating. It is also how I sleep, some weeks, without wondering whether a merge happened without me. It did not. It cannot, if the "never merge" is on the programmer's card, on the routine, and on Ask-first, the way Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully,", taught us to back a memory with a gate.

> **Tip.** If your chief's morning brief is a novel, the chief is writing books. Ask which work has earned its own desk, and give it one. A shorter brief is a sign of a healthier fleet, not a lazier Bot.

Files that land finished, and a site that waits

A press is only as real as the file you can hold. In this house, a finished title comes back as an EPUB, a letter PDF, and a markdown manuscript — the same three shapes this book itself is meant to travel in, when it is bound. I will not pretend the conversion is magic, and I will not invent a toolchain for you to copy click by click. Officially, a Bot has a computer with a filesystem, and it can return files you can inspect.[2] I ask for those three, I open them, I read a page of the PDF, I flip the EPUB on a device, I glance at the markdown to see that the notes are still notes. Then, and only then, is a title ready for the programmer.

The website is where a finished book can be given away or published — a place to get the file, not a cart. The programmer prepares the page, the downloads, the listing. A pull request is a proposal: here is the change, in a form I can read, that will not be live until I say so. I approve the merge. If I do not approve, it does not go live. That is the whole publish path I will teach. It is also the path I want in your checklist, whether your "site" is a GitHub page, a folder on a shared drive, or a shop I will not pitch.

> **Caution.** Publishing is a yes. Merging is a yes. A routine may prepare files and open a request. A routine may not merge, and may not put a book on a public page, while you sleep. Test runs do real work, as Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed,", already warned. Do not test a publish path on a live site with a real title you are not ready to release.

What I do not automate is the judgment. Is this sentence in my voice? Is this source real? Is this book a gift we are actually ready to give? Is this cover honest — no fake price, no official logo, no implication that the product's maker endorsed us? Those questions are mine. A Bot can remind me they exist. A Bot cannot answer them for me and also let me remain the author.

Voice is the same. Chapter 10, "Growth Work", taught "in my voice" as a week of corrections, not a switch. A writer Bot gets closer. I still read. I still change a line that sounds like a brochure. I still take out a claim we did not open a source for. The Hour books, the teaching manuals, are careful on purpose. This free guide is careful on purpose. Care is not a feature you schedule. Care is a person at the table.

I will also say what this fleet is not, so the tour stays honest. It is not a way to remove yourself from your own press. It is not a staff you can "replace this weekend," a phrase this book has refused from the first page. It is not a secret system I am withholding the keys to. The keys are the ones you already have: a job, a "never," a skill, a routine you tested, a yes on publish and merge, a shared computer you treat with the care Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully,", asked of you, a Vault you do not confuse with memory. The only thing I have that you might not, yet, is a sketch I have lived with, and I just handed you the paper. Live with yours. Change it when a job earns a desk, or when a desk has earned a rest. A fleet is allowed to be smaller next month than it is this month. Retiring a Bot that has two jobs, or none, is a kind of mastery Chapter 18, "A Practice That Lasts", will name, and you can start it as soon as a name on your sketch no longer has work.

How to sketch your fleet

You do not need my press to use this pattern. You need a piece of paper.

How to sketch your fleet

1. Write the goal in one sentence. "Publish a teaching manual as EPUB, PDF, and markdown, and put it on a site when I say yes." Or: "Ship a monthly newsletter." Or: "Keep a shop's product pages honest." The sentence should name a finish line you can see. You should be able to read the sentence out loud and know when you would be done. If you don't: cut the goal until you can. A fleet is not a personality. It is a way of finishing.

2. List the jobs, one per line, each with a "never" and a "reports to." Chief: coordinate, never publish. Writer: draft, never publish, never invent a source. Marketer: park copy, never publish. Programmer: prepare files and a request, never merge alone. Studio, if you have one: make the video, never post. You, at the top: the final yes. You should have no job without a "never," and no two jobs in the same name. If a line says "write and publish": split it. If a line has no report: it reports to you.

3. Mark what must not be automated: judgment, voice, the final publish, the merge, anything that spends money, anything that talks to a customer or a reader as if it were you. You should look at that list and feel calmer, not cramped. If you don't: you are still trying to hand off the part that makes the work yours. Keep it.

4. Put the sketch where you will see it — a Page, a wall, a notebook — and do not create a Bot until the sketch is one you would show a careful friend. You should be willing to start with two desks, not seven. If you aren't: start with two anyway. Official advice is still the three-step path: an assistant, a Bot with one job, a team when the goal is bigger.[3] A press is a bigger goal. A chief and a writer is a complete first press.

What "done" looks like: a one-page sketch of roles, nevers, and reporting lines, with you at the top. No Bot has been created from a messy sketch. The yes, when a Bot is born, is still yours.

Priya, the shop-owner composite I have used since Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff", might sketch: Lane (chief), an orders Bot that never refunds alone, a listings Bot that never publishes a change unattended, Priya at the door. Dan, our composite parent, might not need a fleet at all — a chief and a calendar is a household, and Chapter 13, "Get Your Life Back,", is his shelf. Copy the pattern at the size of your actual work.

How to create the one-job Bots

How to create one-job Bots for a small fleet

1. Start with the chief you already have, or create one as in Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff.", Confirm the job and the "never": coordinate, don't hoard, never publish, never merge. You should hear that job back when you ask. If you don't: do not add specialists on top of a confused chief.

2. Ask the chief, or your primary Bot, to propose the next Bot from your sketch: "Draft a job for a writer Bot: draft the manuscript in our voice, leave notes, never publish, never invent a source, report to me and tell Charlie when a draft is ready. Show me the job. Don't create the Bot until I say yes." Read it. Edit the "never." Then say yes, or create the Bot yourself. Officially, your primary Bot can suggest or create a focused Bot, and dr eggbot can help split a goal into jobs. You are allowed to go one Bot at a time.[4] You should have a named Bot with one job. If the proposal includes two jobs, or a publish verb: cut them before you say yes.

3. Repeat for the marketer and the programmer, each with their "never." Give the writer a short sample of the voice you want. Give the programmer the finish line — EPUB, PDF,

markdown, a pull request, no merge. Give the marketer the gift framing, if you are giving work away: no price, no cart, no upsell in the copy. You should be able to ask each Bot "What is your job, and what will you never do?" and get a short, accurate answer. If you can't: fix it, and ask them to remember, as in Chapter 6, "Memory."

4. Optionally, put the specialists and the chief in a group chat for one title, with one owner per step. `@` the writer when it is time to draft. `@` the programmer when the files are ready. Check each Bot's own chat for approvals.[1] Do not `@` everyone and hope. You should be able to point at who owns the current step. If you can't: the group is a crowd, and the official advice is against that.

What "done" looks like: two or more one-job Bots, plus a chief, each with a "never," each able to state the job. No one has published. A first title, or a first newsletter, can now be handed off as a draft.

> **Story.** The first time a finished book came back as an EPUB, a PDF, and a markdown file, I sat with the stack longer than I needed to. I was not amazed by a machine. I was moved by a process I had asked for, tested, and still had to approve. The work had come back finished, in the sense that the files existed. It was not finished in the sense that the world could see it. That last sense waited for me. It still does.

How to ask for a Friday status Page

A Page, again, is the official name for an interactive report a Bot can build and can update from a routine. As of the docs I opened on 11 November 2026, Pages were rolling out gradually and were not available on Enterprise teams yet. That will age. If you cannot have a Page, a Friday note in Charlie's chat is a complete status.[5]

How to set a Friday status Page (or a Friday note)

1. Ask Charlie: "Once, now, make me a Friday status of the fleet: each title or job, whose desk it is on, what's waiting for my yes, and any failure a person needs to see. Don't publish it. Don't send it outside this chat." If Pages are available, ask for a Page you can reopen. If they are not, ask for a clear note. You should get a picture of the house, not a second draft of a book. If you don't: tell Charlie the status is a status, and the writing stays with the writer.
2. Read it. Correct what's wrong. Ask Charlie to remember the shape you want: short, current, sourced to the Bots' actual chats, no invented progress. "If you don't know, say you don't know." You should trust the next one more. If a line claims a merge you did not approve: that is a stop-the-line moment. The programmer's "never" needs a tighter gate.
3. Save the method as a skill, with a "never publish, never merge, never send the status to a public page." Then, if you want, a Friday routine, in the right time zone, with Test, knowing a test is real work — here, a real status, not a real publish. You should see a Friday picture appear, and nothing go live. If something would be public: pause, and rewrite.
4. Read the first scheduled Friday as if you were still watching. Then let it be a habit. Chapter 18, "A Practice That Lasts,", will return to Pages that stay current. This Friday is enough for

a press. You should know when the next Friday run is. If you will be away, remember unattended approvals expire after about thirty minutes, and a status should not need an approval to be written, only to be shared.[6]

What "done" looks like: a Friday picture of the fleet, for your review, unsent and unpublished. You still decide what to do with what it shows.

How to publish with a human merge, every time

This is the checklist I want on the wall. It is also a how-to, because a checklist you do not practice is a wish.

How to publish with a human merge or send, every time

1. Confirm the files. Open the EPUB, the PDF, and the markdown — or your equivalent. Read enough to know they are the book you approved, in the voice you approved, with the notes still attached. If a file is missing or wrong, stop. Do not publish a stack you have not held. You should be willing to put your name on what you opened. If you aren't: send it back to the writer or the programmer, with a note, and wait.
2. Confirm the site copy, if there is any. Read the summary, the title, the framing. If this is a gift, there should be no price, no cart, no "buy." If a sentence implies that the product's maker endorsed the book, take it out. This guide is unofficial, and it should sound that way. You should be willing to let a stranger read that page as your word. If you aren't: edit, or ask the marketing Bot to park a revision, and read it again.
3. Let the programmer prepare the change and open a pull request — or the equivalent proposal in your world: a draft post, a staged folder, a "ready to go live" note. Review the actual change, not only the promise of one. You should see what will be public. If you don't: do not approve. Ask for a clearer proposal.
4. You merge, or you send, or you press the equivalent of live. You. Not a routine. Not a chief trying to be helpful at 8:00 on a Friday. If you want the Bot to click merge after you say "merge this exact request now," stay in the chat and watch, and do not put that click on a clock. You should be able to say, afterward, "I published that." If you can't: it should not have been published.
5. After it is live, glance at the public page, the downloads, the title as a stranger would see it. If something is wrong, fix it the same careful way — a new request, a new yes — not with a hurried unattended routine. You should finish knowing what the world can see. If you don't: look, before you walk away.

What "done" looks like: a book, a post, or a page that is public because you said yes, after you held the files and read the copy. The fleet prepared. You published. The checklist in Appendix C will repeat this in a shorter form, for the wall.

> **Caution.** A pull request can look routine after the tenth title. The tenth title is still a publish. The "never merge alone" does not expire. Tiredness is not a reason to put

merge on a schedule. It is a reason to wait until morning.

A week at the press, without a metric

Monday, Charlie's brief has a line: the writer is mid-title; two files from last week are still waiting on my read; nothing is waiting to merge. I spend the evening on the files. I send one chapter back with a note about a source. I approve the rest as a draft, not as a publish.

Tuesday, the writer returns the chapter. I read it. It is closer. I still change a sentence that sounds like a brochure. I ask the Bot to remember that change as a preference, Chapter 6, "Memory", happening inside a press. I do not ask Charlie to also be the writer today.

Wednesday, the marketing Bot parks site copy for the title we are approaching. I take out a phrase that would have made the page feel like a store. I leave "a free gift to the community" where it belongs, if that is the truth of the work. The copy stays parked.

Thursday, the three files land: EPUB, letter PDF, markdown. I open all three. I find a note that did not make it into the PDF, and I send it back. This is a good Thursday. A Thursday that published without that glance would have been a lesser one.

Friday, the programmer opens a pull request. The Friday Page — or the Friday note — shows "waiting on your yes." I am at dinner. I do not merge from the table. Saturday morning, I read the request, I look at the public-facing words, and I approve. Then I look at the live page, as a stranger, and I am glad I waited.

That week is a picture, not a log of a real week I am documenting with dates, and not a promise that your week will be tidy. Some of my weeks are messier. The shape is the gift: a brief, a draft, a park, a stack, a request, a yes. You can take any two of those and already have a press.

What a small company feels like

I want to tell you what this feels like, without turning it into a testimonial and without inventing a number.

Some weeks, Charlie's brief is already on the desk, and a writer Bot has left a chapter, and a PDF is waiting, and I spend an evening being an editor and a publisher, which is to say, being a person. Some weeks, I send a draft back because a source was thin, or a sentence was not ours. Some weeks, a pull request sits for a day because I have not had the hour to read it properly, and I would rather a book be late than a book be wrong. The fleet does not resent the wait. The fleet does not get to resent the wait. The wait is the work being honest.

The team is partly human and partly Bot. I will not invent my human teammates' names, and I will not pretend I do this without other people, when other people are in the room. I will also not pretend a Bot is a person. It is a teammate in the sense this book has used all along: a durable job, a computer, a "never," a report. The warmth I feel on a morning when the stack is ready is gratitude for a practice, and for a tool, and for the chance to give the work away. It is not a reason to skip the yes.

If you copy this, copy the practice, not the letterhead. Your fleet will have different desks. Your "publish" may be an email, a folder, a church bulletin, a product page. The sketch, the one-job Bots, the Friday picture, the human merge: those four how-tos are the whole copyable press. Official guides about running several teams of Bots exist, including a staff writer's experimental pattern of channels and boards; they are official or vendor pages, and they are not a requirement that you work the way someone else works.[7] Work the way your sketch says, and keep the yes.

A door, not a second house

This chapter was a Grok Bot fleet: a press, a chief, specialist jobs, files that come back finished, a site that waits for a merge I approve. That is the house I wanted to walk you through, and we are at the door.

The same company, SMF Works, also talks to other agent platforms. The workshop has more than one kind of desk in it. I will not start that story here, and I will not borrow the sentence that opens it. Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms,", is where that door opens fully, in my words, at the level of wiring I am willing to stand behind, and no further. You can run a complete press with everything in this chapter and never walk through that door. You can also, when you are ready, see how a chief and a studio sit in a larger workshop. Either way, you remain the person at the door.

If you are holding this book as a file you did not pay for, you are already on the far side of a yes I gave, on a path that looks like this chapter. I will not turn that fact into a sales story. I will turn it into a thank you, and into an invitation: if the pattern helps, use it. If a smaller pattern helps more, use that. If you only take the checklist — hold the files, read the copy, merge it yourself — I will have been glad I wrote the chapter.

The stack is on the table. The lamp is still on. You are still the one who says yes. That is a publishing house, at the size of a kitchen table, and it is enough to begin.

Part 5 — Personal How-Tos

Chapter 13 — Get Your Life Back: Admin, Family, Bills, and the Mental Load



I22. A kitchen table in morning light. A folder waiting, a mug, a closed laptop.

The last few chapters were about work: a chief of staff, a shop floor, a small press that can bring a book back finished. This chapter is about the other pile. The one that lives on the kitchen table. The school form. The bill under a grocery receipt. The email that says a package is out for delivery, and the one that says a subscription has renewed, and the one you meant to answer three days ago.

I want to say this first, kindly, before we hand anything off. A Bot can take a real share of the

household admin. It can watch a calendar, sort a night's mail, put the bills in a folder, and make a short list of what needs you. What it cannot do is care in your place. It cannot sit at the table and be the parent, the partner, or the person who decides what this family actually needs. It is a teammate for the mental load, not a replacement for the people who carry it.

If you only take one chapter from this part of the book, take this one slowly. The how-tos are household-scale. They are smaller than a publishing fleet, and they matter more on a Tuesday morning than a lot of what we called work in Part 4. Calendar changes, and anything that emails a school or a person, stay behind a yes. We will go through that in every step that needs it.

A school form that would have been missed

I will call this reader Dan — a composite, a stand-in for a parent I have in mind. Dan has a household calendar that looks, by Friday, like a map drawn by several people at once. Pickup times. A dentist. A form that was due, or is due, or was due yesterday depending on who you ask. The form itself is ordinary. A permission slip, a health update, a request to confirm a half day. It arrived in email, or it came home in a backpack and was photographed onto a counter, and then the week moved.

Dan is not careless. Dan is busy. The form is the kind of thing a careful person misses because a careful person is already holding three other things.

Here is what I want a Bot to do with a form like that. I want it to find the form in the mail or in a connected calendar. I want it to put the due date on a list I can actually see — a family Page, which is a living report a Bot can build and come back to, as we will set up in a moment. I want it to draft the reply, if a reply is what is needed, and then stop. I do not want it to email the school. I do not want it to change the calendar until I have looked. I do not want a child's full name, or a school's, traveling farther than the people who already need it.

The official product already has a picture of this job. There is a prebuilt Bot in the Marketplace, Tradbot, that "watches your personal email and calendar so school forms, bills, and RSVPs don't slip." It "drafts the reply, catches the pickup clash, and never sends without you."[1] That last clause is the whole method. Draft. Catch. Never send without you.

I am not telling you to install that particular Bot. I am telling you that the job is a real one, and that the official example already stops where I want you to stop. Every careful official example I have opened does the same. Sending, publishing, purchasing, and the rest stay behind an approval.[2] A school form is not a purchase, but it is a message to a real person about a real child. It stays behind a yes.

The first time you try this, try it on one form, in front of you, not on a routine that runs at dawn. Hand the Bot the email, or a photo of the paper. Ask it to tell you what the form wants, when it is due, and what a complete reply would include. Ask it to draft that reply, and to stop. Read the draft as if a helpful neighbor had written it: grateful, and not finished until you say it is. If a date is wrong, or a name is spelled in a way your family does not use, correct it and ask the Bot to remember the correction for next time. Then send it yourself, or sign the paper yourself. After you have watched that happen once, you can decide whether a Sunday routine should look for the next form. A routine you have not watched is a routine I would not run on a school.

Dan's Tuesday gets a little lighter, not because a Bot became the parent, but because the form is on a list instead of at the bottom of a pile. Dan still reads it. Dan still signs it, or asks a question, or decides it can wait until Thursday. The care is still Dan's. The first pass is not.

> **Story.** I have watched a form like that sit under a receipt. I will not name a child, and I will not name a school. I will only say that the form was ordinary, and that ordinary is how these things hide. A teammate that can put "this is due" on a single page, before the coffee is gone, is a teammate I will make room for at the table.

The family calendar

If you already connected Google Calendar in Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully," your Bots can read the week the way the official docs describe. One official picture is simple and good: every Sunday evening, a Bot reads the week ahead, flags clashes and packed days, and sends you a short plan for Monday.[3] That is a work picture, and it is also a household picture. A clash is a clash whether it is two meetings or a pickup and a dentist.

Ask for the household version in plain words. Tell the Bot whose calendars to look at, if more than one is connected, and what "a packed day" means in your house — two events after school, or a late evening, or a morning that starts too early. Tell it to draft a short plan, and not to move anything. Tell it to remember that rule, the way Chapter 6, "Memory," taught you to ask.

A useful Sunday plan, in my house, is one page and a little kind. It names the days. It names the clashes. It does not narrate. It leaves a space for what I still have to decide. If a school form is sitting in the inbox with a date on it, I want that date on the same page, not in a separate pile.

Pickup clashes are where this gets its value. Two places at 3:15 is not a scheduling puzzle for a Bot to solve by moving an event. It is a family conversation. The Bot can see it. You decide who drives.

> **Caution.** Do not let a Bot change a shared family calendar until you have looked. A moved pickup is not a draft. It is a person standing in a parking lot. Keep calendar changes behind a yes, and keep anything that emails a school, a teacher, a coach, or another parent behind a yes as well.

If you use a different calendar — Outlook, Apple, something a Bot can reach in the browser on its cloud computer — the same rule holds. Chapter 2, "A Teammate with a Computer," already told you that the computer has a browser for the sites that have no connected app.[4] The method does not change. The Bot reads. It drafts a plan. You approve the moves.

How to make a weekly family Page

A page, in Grok Bot, is something a Bot builds for you to read: a report, a tracker, a short living document. It can hold text, tables, and simple controls. It lives in the Bot's Library, so you can come back to it, and a routine can update it.[5] A routine, as you saw in Chapter 8, "Routines That

Run While Your Laptop Is Closed," is a scheduled run: the Bot does a job at a time you chose, in the Bot's time zone, even if the laptop is closed.[6]

This is a household Page, not a dashboard for a company. Keep it small.

How to ask for a weekly family Page

1. Open a chat with the Bot that already watches your household mail and calendar — the one with that single job, if you gave it one in Chapter 3 or Chapter 7. You should see the same conversation you have been using for this work. If you don't: create a Bot with one clear job, "household calendar and forms," and connect only the mail and calendar you mean it to see, the way Chapter 5 walked you through. Do not connect a work inbox to a family Bot unless you have thought about what that mixes.

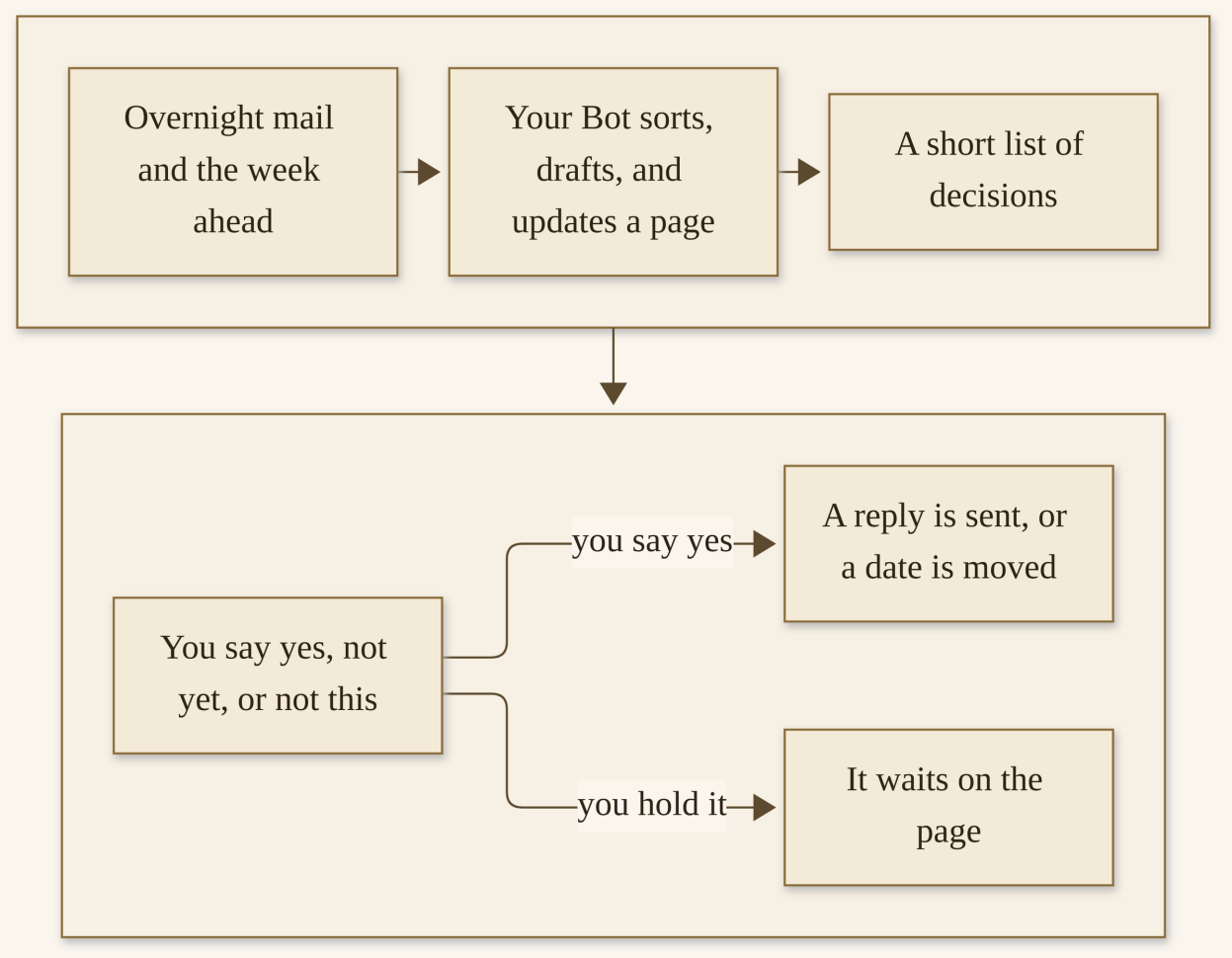
2. Ask, in plain words, for a page. You can say something like: "Make a weekly family page for the week ahead. Put the days in a table. Flag pickup clashes, forms that are due, and bills that need a look. Leave a short list of decisions for me. Do not change the calendar. Do not email anyone." You should see a card in the chat with the page's title and a way to open it. If you don't: say what the page is for again, and what should be on it. If pages are not in your app yet, they were still rolling out on 11 November 2026, and they were not available on Enterprise teams; update the app and check the live docs, or keep the same list in a file the Bot writes for you.[7]

3. Open the page. Read it the way you would read a note on the table. If something is wrong, tell the Bot in the chat beside the page — the official docs call that panel "Message about," and the page's title.[8] You should see the same page change, not a second copy. If you don't: ask the Bot to edit "this page," and name the title. Do not start a new page for every correction.

4. When the page looks right, ask the Bot to update it on a schedule you choose — Sunday evening is the official picture; Saturday morning is fine if that is when your house is quiet. Ask it to create a routine that rebuilds or updates this same page, and not to email anyone or change the calendar when it runs. You should see a routine with a schedule and a time zone you recognize, waiting for its next run, not running at the moment you create it.[9] If you don't: open the routine and check that it is enabled, that the time zone is the Bot's, and that it points at this page. Chapter 8 has the longer troubleshooting path.

5. Put a "never" in the Bot's memory, out loud, once: "Never email a school, a teacher, or a parent. Never change the shared calendar until I say yes. Never put a child's full name on a page I might share." You should be able to ask, later, "What do you remember about the family page?" and hear that rule back. If you don't: tell it again, and ask it to remember. Memory is not a vault; Chapter 6 is the careful version of that warning.

What "done" looks like: every week, a page is waiting. It is short. The clashes are visible. The forms that would have sat under a receipt are on the same page as the week. Nothing has been sent. Nothing on the shared calendar has moved. What still needs a yes: any calendar change, and anything that would email a school or a person.



I23. Mail to decisions. Household mail becomes a short list; you still decide what goes out.

Mail to decisions. The Bot's job is the first pass. Yours is the yes. (Chapter 13.)

The household inbox

The official picture for mail is as plain as the calendar one. A Bot can sort the night's mail before you are up, draft replies to the threads that need you, and leave every draft for you to send.[10] The official starter prompt is almost a household prompt already: sort unread mail into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI; draft the urgent replies; don't send anything.[11]

For a house, I would change the buckets slightly. Urgent: a school, a doctor, a bill with a date, a package that failed. Needs a reply: a person who is waiting. FYI: everything that is only telling you something. Newsletters can go in their own pile; we will use that pile later, when we look at subscriptions.

Ask for a morning digest, not a novel. "What needs me" is a better prompt than "summarize my inbox." A digest that is two screens long is a second inbox. A digest that is one short list, with the drafts waiting underneath, is a first pass.

If two people in the house want a look, you can ask for a second digest — a version that is safe to share, with nothing private from a work inbox, and with children's details kept to what that other person already knows. Do not point a family Bot at a work account and then forward the digest. The computer your Bots share is one computer, as Chapter 2 and Chapter 5 already said; a login you leave there is, in practice, a login the other Bots can use.[12] Keep the family Bot's connections on the family side.

> **Tip.** Leave sending off. The official examples do. If you have already set an Ask-first rule for sending, as Chapter 5 asked you to, the Bot will stop even if a prompt is sloppy one morning. That rule is a kindness to your future self.

A draft is only useful if it sounds like you, or close enough that you can edit it in a minute. The first week, you will edit a lot. That is the point of a first week. When a draft is right, you can save the way it was done as a skill, the way Chapter 7, "Show It Once," taught you. The skill is "how we answer a school thread." The send is still yours.

Packages on the way

Package mail is almost a gift to this kind of teammate. It is structured. It has a carrier, a number, a status, and a window. It arrives in the same inbox as everything else, and it is easy to lose between a bill and a newsletter.

Ask the Bot, once, to watch for shipping mail and to put anything on the way into a short list: what it is, if the mail says; who it is from; when it is supposed to arrive; whether it needs you at the door. Put that list on the same family Page, or in a section of the morning digest, so you are not hunting. A routine can refresh it. You do not need a new Bot for packages unless the household inbox Bot is already doing two other jobs well and is starting to blur.

Dean Christensen, who published an independent account of running his inbox and calendar this way, describes a morning digest that includes the agenda, the packages, and the emails that need him.[13] I mention him because the pattern is a good one, and because it is his published practice, not a vendor claim and not a result I measured. Your digest will look like your house.

> **Caution.** A tracking number is not secret in the way a password is, but a delivery address is a home address. Do not put a family Page on a public link, the kind that needs no sign-in, if it holds where you live. Chapter 18, "A Practice That Lasts," will come back to how Pages are shared. For now, keep the household Page private.

If a package is late, the Bot can draft a note to the sender or find the carrier's page in the browser. You still send the note, if you send one. You still make the call, or you wait for Chapter 14, "Errands That Finish," where I will show you how a Bot can place a US phone call — with you on the card before it dials.

Bills and the sticky admin

Some household work is sticky. A bill that needs a login. An insurance notice. A form that is not a school form, but might as well be, because it has a due date and a portal and a password you set three years ago. This is the work that sits in a browser, and it is exactly the work a Bot with a computer can help with, if you let it go slowly.

The method is a folder and a list, not a Bot with your bank password in the chat.

How to keep a bills folder

1. Pick one Bot for household money-admin — bills, insurance notices, the sticky forms. Give it that one job, and do not also make it your cheerful grocery Bot. You should see a Bot with a clear name and a clear job in the sidebar. If you don't: create one, the way Chapter 3 taught you, and write the job in a sentence: "Find bills and insurance notices, put them in a folder, and make a list of what needs me. Do not pay. Do not send."

2. Tell it where the mail lives, and where you want the folder. A folder on the Bot's computer is fine; a folder in a connected Drive is fine if that is where you already keep this. Ask it to file the notices it finds, and to make a short list: who it is from, how much if the amount is in the mail, when it is due, and what it wants you to do. You should see a list you can read in one sitting, with links or files you can open. If you don't: ask it to show you the folder, and to try one bill you name, so you can watch.

3. Put the secrets in the right place. A login for a utility or an insurer belongs in the Vault — the locker your Bots can use without seeing the secret — or in a Secure Form at the moment of sign-in, never in the chat.[14] You should see the login in Settings, under Vault, not in a message. If you don't: do not paste the password into the chat to "just get it done." Stop, and use the Vault or a Secure Form, as Chapter 5 described.

4. Decide, before a due date is close, how payment works. A card saved in the Vault fills in at checkout without asking you each time. If you want to approve every payment yourself, do not save the card.[15] You should know, before you walk away, which of those two you have chosen. If you don't: open Settings, then Vault, and look. If a card is there and you do not want unattended payments, remove it. Chapter 17 will say this again, because it is easy to forget.

5. For any bill the Bot can only reach in a browser, stay nearby the first time. Some sites will ask for a code, a CAPTCHA, or a new login. The Bot should hand those steps to you, not try to get around them.[16] You should see a request for you to take over the computer, or a card that asks for a code, not a password in the chat. If you don't: take over the computer and finish the human step yourself. Then tell the Bot to continue.

What "done" looks like: a folder that is current, and a list that is honest. "Due Thursday, I have not paid it" is a good line. "I paid it" is a line you write after you have paid it, or after you have approved a payment you meant to approve. The Bot does not get to decide that a bill is handled because the portal was confusing. What still needs a yes: every payment, and every message to a utility or an insurer.

> **Caution.** This book is not financial advice, and it is not a promise about money. People have published reviews of Bots helping with bills and insurance. Those are reviews, not results I can stand behind, and I will not retell them as facts.[17] A Bot can find a notice, gather a file, and draft a letter. You still read the letter. You still decide what is true.

If a bill needs a phone call, wait for Chapter 14. Calls are available in the US, as the official docs describe, and they start with your agreement and a card that shows who will be called.[18] They are a real tool. They are also easy to rush. We will not rush them here.

Subscriptions you may have forgotten

The subscriptions are quieter than the bills, and that is why they last. A trial that became a monthly charge. A newsletter you do not open. A tool you used for a season. The official product already has a name for the job. In the 26 August 2026 plans announcement, a "digital declutterer" "audits email, Drive, and paid subscriptions around the clock" and "only discards or unsubscribes if you say so."[19] On the official use-cases site, a Subscription Cleaner "collates receipt and newsletter mail, suggests what to kill, and unsubscribes what you approve."[20]

Notice the last words. Suggests. What you approve. If you say so. That is the method I want you to keep, even if you never touch those prebuilt Bots and only ask your household Bot to do the same work.

Ask for a list, not an action. "Show me the paid subscriptions you can find in my mail for the last year. For each one, tell me the name, the approximate amount if a receipt shows it, and when it last charged. Recommend what I might cancel. Do not cancel. Do not unsubscribe. Do not discard." Then you sit with the list. Some of those charges are ones you want. Some you had forgotten and are glad of. Some you will cancel yourself, or you will tell the Bot, one at a time, to draft the cancellation or to prepare the unsubscribe — and you will confirm.

> **Caution.** Canceling is not always a single click, and it is not always fair. Some companies make it hard on purpose. A Bot can draft the request and find the page. You still read the page. You still confirm. Do not give a Bot a standing instruction to "unsubscribe from everything I don't open." That is how you lose something you did mean to keep.

A quarterly pass is enough for most houses. Put it on a routine after you have watched it once by hand. The first run is a conversation. The later runs are a list you already know how to read.

The same Bot can, if you want, make a complementary list of the newsletters and the clutter — the mail that is not charging you, but is wearing you out. The same rule holds. It suggests. You approve. It does not discard a folder of old mail because a prompt was broad.

A careful sweep of your name

There is a quieter job I want to handle carefully, because it is easy to over-promise. Your name and address appear on sites that collect and resell personal information — data brokers, as they are often called. Dean Christensen, in the same independent account I mentioned earlier, describes using Grok Bot to look for those listings, and he describes using the official Do Not Call Registry as well. He has written about what he found and what he got taken down, and about running the pass again on a quarterly rhythm.[21] Those results are his, from his published practice. They are not a guarantee, and they are not mine to present as a typical outcome. Some of those companies are hard to deal with. Some will put a listing back. A sweep is not a miracle, and I will not sell it as one — not that this book is selling anything.

If you want to try the work, try it this way.

Ask the Bot to search for your name and the city you are willing to name, and to make a list of listings it finds, with links. Tell it, clearly, what not to include: a child's name, a previous address you do not want repeated, a number you do not want in a page. Ask it to draft, for each listing you choose, the removal request the site itself asks for. Then you read the request. You send it, or you submit it, or you decide that this particular broker is one you will handle another way. You do not give the Bot a standing "remove me everywhere" that can talk to a site you have not seen.

For the Do Not Call Registry, use the official government site, and read the page yourself. A Bot can open a browser and help you find the right place. The submission is yours. I will not invent a click-path for a government form that can change.

> **Caution.** This is not a privacy panacea, and it is not legal advice. A removal request is a letter, not a wand. Keep the list of what was sent, with dates, on a private page or in a private folder. Do not share that page with a public link. And do not ask a Bot to pretend to be you on a site that is already in the business of collecting you.

A quarterly routine is reasonable once you trust the process — Christensen's rhythm is a sensible one, as a published practice, not as a rule. The routine makes a new list. You still approve every request.

The mental load, and an honest list

I have been talking about forms and bills, which are objects. The mental load is not an object. It is the running list that lives in a person's head: the form, the birthday, the prescription to refill, the email that would only take a minute, the thing you said you would do and have not done. People come to a tool like this because that list is heavy. Some of them come because following through is especially hard, for reasons that are their own.

I want to be careful here. This book is not medical advice. I am not a clinician, and a Bot is not a treatment. I will not tell you that a routine will fix a diagnosis, and I will not borrow other people's reviews as if they were results.[22] What I can tell you is more modest, and I think more honest. A teammate that starts the first pass — that puts "this is due" on a page, that drafts the reply, that

reminds you at a time you chose — can make follow-through more possible. The yes is still yours. The starting is not only yours.

That is why I want the last how-to in this chapter to be a list that is honest about limits.

How to keep a "what I would have forgotten" list

1. Ask the household Bot for a short, standing list: the things that have a date, a person waiting, or a consequence if they slip. Tell it to take items from the family Page, the morning digest, and anything you add by hand. Tell it to cap the list — ten items, say — so it never becomes a second life. You should see a short list, dated, with the next due item at the top. If you don't: ask it to show only what is due in the next two weeks, and to drop what is done when you mark it done.
2. Tell it the limits, and ask it to remember them. It will miss things. Mail goes to other addresses. A form comes home on paper and never becomes a photo. A date in memory goes stale; official guidance is to look changing numbers up again, and not to treat memory as a source of truth.[23] You should hear those limits back when you ask what it remembers. If you don't: write them again, plainly. "If you are not sure it is still true, look it up or ask me. Do not invent a due date."
3. Decide what the Bot may do when it notices something. It may add the item to the list. It may mention it in the morning digest. It may not email a person, and it may not nag you every hour. A routine once a day, or twice, is plenty. Noisy triggers burn usage, as Chapter 8 warned, and they also wear a person out. You should see a routine you recognize, not a Bot that messages you all afternoon. If you don't: open the routine and slow it down. Turn down notifications for that Bot if the alerts are the problem, the way the official settings allow.[24]
4. Once a week, you look at the list. You cross off what is done. You add what the Bot could not have known. You forgive the rest, or you move it. You should feel, after a few weeks, that the list is a partner and not a judge. If you don't: shorten it. A list that makes you feel worse is too long, and that is not a failing in you.

What "done" looks like: a list you trust enough to look at, and a Bot that has not been asked to become your conscience — not an empty list. The mental load gets a teammate. It does not get a new boss. What still needs a yes: anything on that list that would email a person, and any routine that would nudge you more often than you agreed.

> **Tip.** If you live with someone who also carries this list, share the family Page with that person in a way that stays private — not a public link — and let the list be a shared table, not a report one of you is graded on. The Bot is not the third person in the marriage, or in the house. It is a page on the table.

A habit Bot, kept humble

There is room, after the admin, for a smaller kind of teammate: a Bot that helps a household habit along. Groceries for the week. A simple chart on a Page. A short family note that is not a newspaper and not a performance. I have seen people ask for all of that, and some of it can be sweet.

Keep it humble. If the habit touches health — sleep, food, medicine, mood — this book is not a clinician, and the Bot is not one either. Use a Page and a routine if they help you remember. Do not ask a Bot for a diagnosis, a dose, or a plan that belongs with a professional you trust. Chapter 14 will pick up the errands that go with a household — the shopping run, the call, the return — and the same humility will travel with us.

I want to add one practical kindness about the shape of this small team. In Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff," and in Chapter 12, "A Small Fleet," I asked you to give each Bot one job. The household is not a second company, but the same habit helps. A Bot that watches the family calendar and the school mail can also, if the house is small, keep the package list and the morning digest. When you add bills and logins and a saved card, I would rather you made a second Bot for that money-admin, not because separate Bots are a security wall — they are not; they share one computer — but because a clear job is easier to watch, and easier to pause, and easier to talk to when something feels off.[25]

If your work and your home share a person — they do; that person is you — try not to let them share a Bot. A morning brief for SMF Works is a different voice, and a different set of apps, from a Sunday plan for a family. Mixing them is how a work thread ends up on a family Page, or how a school form ends up in a digest you later share with a colleague. Two Bots, two jobs, one computer you still treat carefully: that is the household version of the fleet.

You do not need a Bot for every corner of a life. One household Bot, one bills Bot if the first job is already full, and a Page that is current on Sunday, is already a lot of "get your life back." The rest is care, and care is still yours.

When you are ready, we will leave the table and go run a few errands. The trip you plan and do not book unsupervised. The gift with a Pay button that waits. The phone call, if you are in the US, with you on the card before anyone is dialed. That is Chapter 14. The yes goes with you.

Chapter 14 — Errands That Finish: Travel, Shopping, Calls, and Returns

Chapter 13 was the kitchen table: the form, the bill, the list that lives in a person's head. This chapter is the errands that grow out of that table. A trip you want to plan. A gift you want to send. A call to a business, if you are in the United States, about a table or an order. A return that needs a label and a box.

The method does not change. The Bot does the first pass. It brings you options, a card, a transcript, a packet. You still say yes — and on the errands in this chapter, the yes is often a real button, with a real total, or a real phone on the other end. We will go slowly enough for that.

I want to start with a small scene, because this chapter has a button in it that I would like you to remember.

> **Story.** A gift, ready to go. The Bot has found the thing, and it has put the facts on a card: the store, the item, where it ships, what you will pay with, the total. Because it is a gift, there is a row for that too — who it is for, your message, whether a gift receipt is included, and when it arrives.[1] The pay button sits there and shows the total. It waits. Nothing is charged while it waits. You can choose Cancel, and nothing is charged then either. The errand is almost finished. The last inch is yours.

That waiting button is the spirit of this whole chapter. Plan the trip; do not book it unsupervised. Shop up to the card; you pay, or you don't. Let a Bot dial only after you have seen who it will call. Let a return packet be a packet, and you submit it if a submission is required.

A trip folder of options, not tickets

The official starter prompt for travel is one I would almost hand you as a gift by itself: find the flights, with the constraints that matter — no red-eyes, a hotel near downtown — and "send me the two best options; don't book anything."[2] The official use-cases site has a Travel Coordinator that "compares flights and hotels to your rules, confirms before booking, and drops itinerary plus calendar."[3] I like the first of those sentences better than I like any software that books while you are making dinner. Confirms before booking is the right idea. "Don't book anything" is the rule I want you to keep until you are looking at the options with your own eyes.

Dean Christensen, in the independent account I already mentioned in Chapter 13, describes travel

planning the same way: a trip, planned, without the booking.[4] That is his published practice, and it matches the official starter. It is also mine.

A trip is a bundle of decisions that look like facts. Dates. Airports. A hotel that is near the thing you came for, or near a person. A budget you have not always said out loud. If a Bot books the first reasonable flight, it has not finished an errand. It has made a decision you cannot easily undo, with someone else's money and someone else's Tuesday morning. So we will make a folder, and we will fill it with options, and we will not call the folder a ticket.

How to make a trip folder of options, not tickets

1. Open a chat with a Bot that can use a browser, and give it the trip in plain words: where, when, who is going, what "good" looks like, and what is out of bounds. Include the official kind of constraint — no red-eyes, a hotel near a neighborhood you name — and add your own. Then say, clearly, "Send me the two best options. Don't book anything." You should see a short comparison, with links, prices as they stood when the Bot looked, and a reason each option fits. If you don't: ask it to show its sources, and to try again with a tighter constraint. If a site blocks the Bot or asks for a login, the Bot should hand that step to you, not go around it.[5]

2. Ask the Bot to put the options in a folder — on its computer, or in a Drive you already use — and, if you want, on a small page: two flights, two hotels, a short list of open questions. Ask it to date the prices, because prices move. You should be able to open the folder and see the same options, with links you can click yourself. If you don't: ask it to show you the folder path, and to add a screenshot of each option as it appeared.

3. Tell it the "never," and ask it to remember: "Never book a flight, a hotel, a car, or a ticket until I say yes, in this chat, to a specific option. Never enter a payment card for travel unless I am looking at the card with you." You should hear that rule back when you ask what it remembers about travel. If you don't: say it again. Put an Ask-first rule on purchasing, if you have not already, the way Chapter 5 taught you.

4. When you have chosen, you book — yourself, on the airline's site or the hotel's, or you sit with the Bot and approve one specific option, one specific total, with you at the screen. If a calendar entry is needed after the booking is real, the Bot can draft it. You still decide when it goes on a shared calendar, for the same reason a pickup move stayed behind a yes in Chapter 13. You should have a confirmation you can open without asking the Bot to remember it. If you don't: get the confirmation into the folder yourself, then ask the Bot to file it, not to recreate it from memory.

What "done" looks like: a folder you can hand to a person you are traveling with, and not a ticket you did not mean to buy. What still needs a yes: the booking itself, and any event that would go on a shared calendar. After the trip is booked, the same Bot can keep the itinerary and the confirmations together, and can watch the mail for a gate change or a hotel notice. The watch is useful. The unsupervised book is not.

If you are traveling with someone, the folder is a better gift than a forward of twenty emails. You can ask the Bot to make a version that is safe to share — times, places, confirmation numbers, and not the card that paid. You still look at that version before it goes to anyone. A shared family calendar, as we already said in Chapter 13, does not get a new week of events until you say yes. A

hold is not a booking, and a booking is not a hold. If a Bot uses those words, ask it to show you the confirmation, or the lack of one, before you relax.

Prices move. That is why I asked you to date them. A "two best options" from Sunday night is a starting point on Wednesday, not a promise. When you are ready to look again, ask the Bot to check the same two options and one alternative, and to tell you what changed. Then you look. This is one of the places official guidance about memory is more than a philosophy: numbers that change should be looked up again, not trusted because they were right two days ago.

Some trips are not flights. A train, a long drive, a hotel for a family event, a reservation that is really a table — the folder method still holds. Options, constraints, a date on the price, and a "don't book" that you have not watered down. If the errand turns into a phone call for a table, that is the next section but one, and the same "never" about unsupervised commitments goes with you.

> **Caution.** Do not save a card in the Vault for a Bot that also plans travel, if you do not want a card to fill in at checkout without asking.[6] A trip is an easy place to move too fast. The folder is the product. The booking is a later, human step.

A shopping run that stops at the card

Shopping with a Bot is one of the more finished official flows I have opened, and it is worth taking in the official order, because the cards are the method.

You ask a Bot to find something to buy. It can reply with product cards. You can open a product and see its photos, its options, a "Why it fits," and a "Where to buy," and you can buy it from there. On desktop, each card also has "Buy now," or it says "Out of stock." If a product you open is sold out, you can choose "Notify me," and the Bot sets up a routine that tells you when it is back.[7] That routine is a Chapter 8 kind of routine: it does real work when it runs, so you only want it for a product you still want.

When you are ready to buy, the Bot sends an order card. The official card holds the store, the items, "Ship to," "Pay with," and the "Total." If you are sending a gift, a "Gift" row shows who it is for, your message, whether a gift receipt is included, and when it arrives. You check those facts. Then you choose the pay button, which shows the total, or you choose Cancel. If you cancel, nothing is charged. Once the order is placed, the card shows what you paid with. If the order card expires, you ask the Bot to check the price again. Only a Bot's owner can pay its orders.[8]

I want you to hear the gift row twice. It is a kindness, and it is also a checklist. The name. The message. The receipt. The date. If any of those is wrong, you do not press the button that shows the total. You say so, and the Bot corrects the card, and the button waits again.

How to run a shopping errand that stops at the order card

1. Ask the Bot, in plain words, for what you want: the thing, the size or color if you know it, a budget if you have one, and whether it is a gift. If it is a gift, say who it is for and what should not be in the message. You should see one or a few product cards, not a long essay. If you don't: open a product and look at "Why it fits" and "Where to buy." If nothing fits, tell

the Bot what was wrong and ask it to try again. Do not ask it to buy from a card you have not opened.

2. If a product is out of stock and you still want it, choose "Notify me" only if you are willing to get a real routine for that item. If you are only browsing, do not set the routine. You should see, if you opted in, a routine you can find later and pause. If you don't: ask the Bot to show you the routine, or to not set one.

3. When you are ready, let the Bot send the order card. Read every row: the store, the items, "Ship to," "Pay with," the "Total," and the gift row if there is one. You should see a total that matches what you meant to spend, a ship-to you recognize, and a payment method you meant to use. If you don't: choose Cancel. Nothing is charged.[9] Then tell the Bot what to correct, and wait for a new card. If the card has expired, ask the Bot to check the price again, and read the new card as if you had never seen the old one.

4. Check how the payment will be made before you press anything. If a card is saved in the Vault, remember that a saved card can fill in at checkout without asking you each time.[10] If you have not saved a card, the official docs say the Bot first asks for one with a Secure Form; a card you do not save there gets no order card, and the Bot asks you to approve the exact total in the chat instead.[11] Either path is fine, if you chose it on purpose. You should know, before you pay, which path you are on. If you don't: Cancel, and go look at Settings, then Vault, as Chapter 5 and Chapter 17 describe. Do not press Pay in order to find out.

5. If the card is right, and you are the Bot's owner, choose the pay button, which shows the total. If it is not right, or you are not ready, choose Cancel. You should see, after a payment, the card show what you paid with. If you don't: do not ask the Bot to "try again" until you have checked your email and the store for a confirmation. A second Pay is how people buy a thing twice.

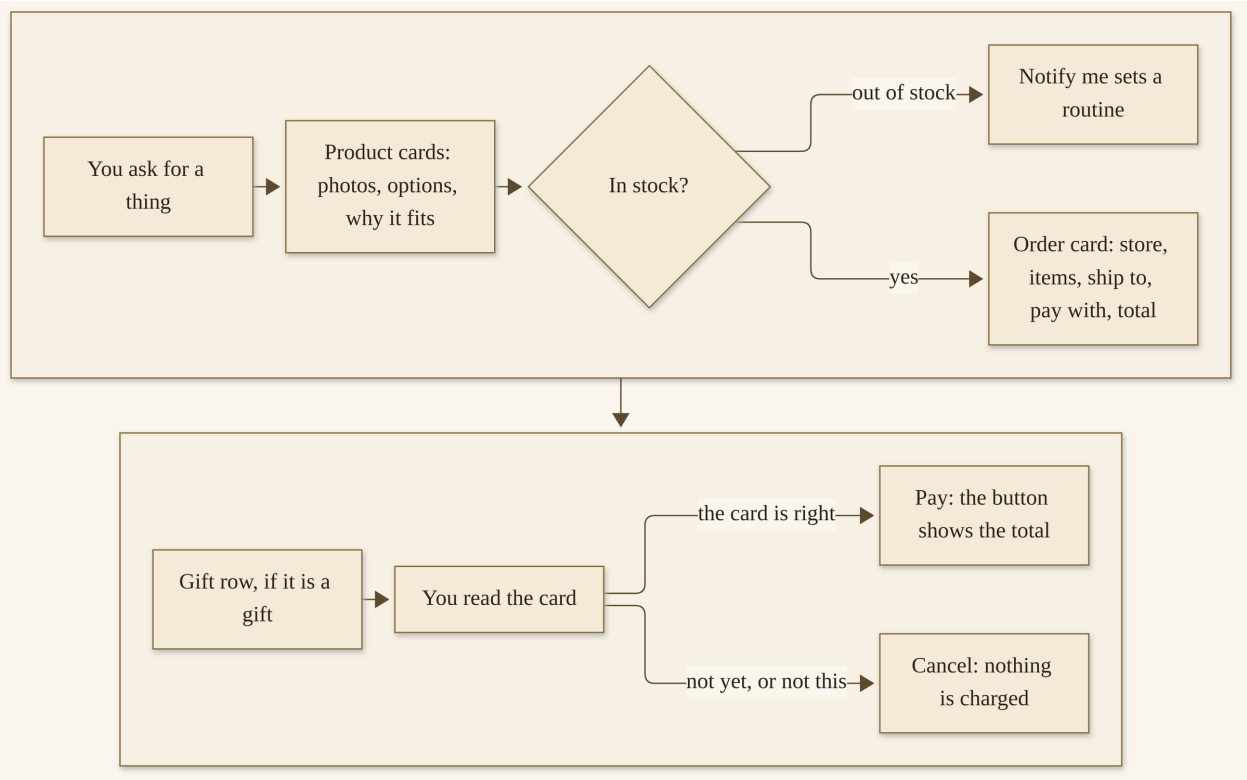
What "done" looks like: a confirmation in the folder, and a Pay button you either pressed on purpose or did not press — not a package on the porch that surprises you, unless the surprise was the point, and even then, you were the one who said yes. What still needs a yes: the Pay button itself. Cancel if the card is wrong.

I want to sit with the "Ship to" row for a moment, because it is the quiet one. A gift that arrives at your house when it was meant to arrive at someone else's is a small comedy. A gift that arrives at an old address, or at a workplace you did not mean to use, is less funny. The official card shows "Ship to" for a reason. Read it. If the Bot has contact info in the Vault — the Vault can hold shipping and billing addresses, as the official docs describe[20] — check that the address on the card is the one you meant for this errand, not the default that was convenient last time. For a gift, I would rather type the address myself, once, than trust a memory of a house I have been to.

The same care belongs on "Pay with." If a default payment method is set, the official docs say that is the method Grok Bot pays with first. Defaults are useful, and they are also how the wrong card pays for a household gift. If you are not sure which method is default, Cancel and go look, then come back to a fresh card.

Household shopping — groceries, the refill, the thing that ran out — can live on the family Page from Chapter 13 as a short list. The Bot can draft the list from what you tell it, or from a habit you

have already agreed on. When the list becomes an order, you are back on this chapter's card. A grocery order is still an order. The total is still on the button. There is no special grocery exemption from reading the card, and I say that with a smile, because I have wanted there to be one at the end of a long day.



I24. Order-card flow. A product becomes a card; you still press Pay or Cancel.

Order-card flow. The Bot can get you to the card. Only the Bot's owner can pay, and only after reading it. (Chapter 14.)

> **Tip.** A Bot can also send one order card for a batch of payments — the official docs describe a batch of up to 500 card payments, paid with a saved card, with one approval covering payments for 24 hours.[12] That is a power-user tool, and a household almost never needs it. If a Bot offers you a batch, read it as slowly as you would read a single gift. One approval is still an approval.

Wallets such as Link and X Money are named in the official Vault docs as payment accounts you can connect, and there is a default payment method that Grok Bot pays with first.[13] I will not walk you through a wallet's own screens, because those are the wallet's, and they change. If you use one, read the card anyway. The card is the moment.

A call with a written "never"

A Bot can call a business for you — the official examples are booking a table, or asking about an order — and then tell you how it went. Phone calls are available in the United States only, from

the Grok Bot desktop and phone apps.[14] If you are not in the US, this section is one you can skip, or read for later, and no part of the rest of the book depends on it.

I am going to be plain about the terms, because they are the official terms, and because a phone is a person on the other end.

The first time, the Bot asks you to agree to the calling terms, including that you will only call US businesses and people who have consented to hear from you. You choose Accept or Decline. Before each call, the Bot shows who it will call; you choose Call or Cancel.[15] That second card is not a formality. Read the name. Read the number. If it is wrong, Cancel.

While the call runs, its card shows the status and a live transcript. You can choose "End call" to hang up. When "Take over" shows, you can choose it to join the call yourself; the card says "Connecting you…" and then "Transferred to you." If the other side asks something the Bot can't answer, a card shows the question and how long you have to respond; you type in "Your answer" and choose Send, or you choose Skip. If the Bot wants to give the call more details while it is live, it asks you first.[16]

When the call is over, the card says "Ended," and the length. You can open the card to read the transcript and play the recording. On desktop, a "Call actions" menu also has "Copy transcript," "Export transcript," and "Download recording."[17]

The official docs also say, in a quieter place, that the reader is responsible for who is called.[18] I will say it here, as a friend. A Bot with a phone is a powerful errand. It is also a way to reach a person who did not ask to talk to software. Stay with the official terms. Stay with businesses and people who have consented. Stay with the card that shows who will be called, every time.

How to place a call with a written "never"

1. Write the "never" first, in the chat, and ask the Bot to remember it. Mine would read something like this: "Never call a person who has not consented. Never call a number I have not seen on the card. Never call a school, a medical office, or a government office unless I have named that exact office in this chat and approved the card. Never give out a password, a card number, or a Social Security number. Never agree to a payment on the call. If you are unsure, end the call and ask me." You should be able to ask "What are your calling rules?" and hear that back. If you don't: write it again. Do not place the first call until it is remembered.
2. The first time you use calling, read the terms the Bot shows. Choose Accept only if you agree, including the official limit: US businesses and people who have consented to hear from you. If you do not agree, choose Decline, and do not proceed. You should see the terms, and a clear Accept or Decline. If you don't: do not try to skip the terms. If calling is not available, you may not be in the US, or the feature may not be on this plan or this app; do not invent a workaround.
3. Tell the Bot the errand in one sentence: "Call this restaurant and ask for a table for four at 7 on Friday," or "Call this store and ask where my order is." Then wait for the card that shows who it will call. You should see a name and a number you recognize, and a Call or Cancel choice. If you don't: Cancel, or do not choose Call. Ask the Bot to show you how it found the number. Do not let it dial a number you have not seen.

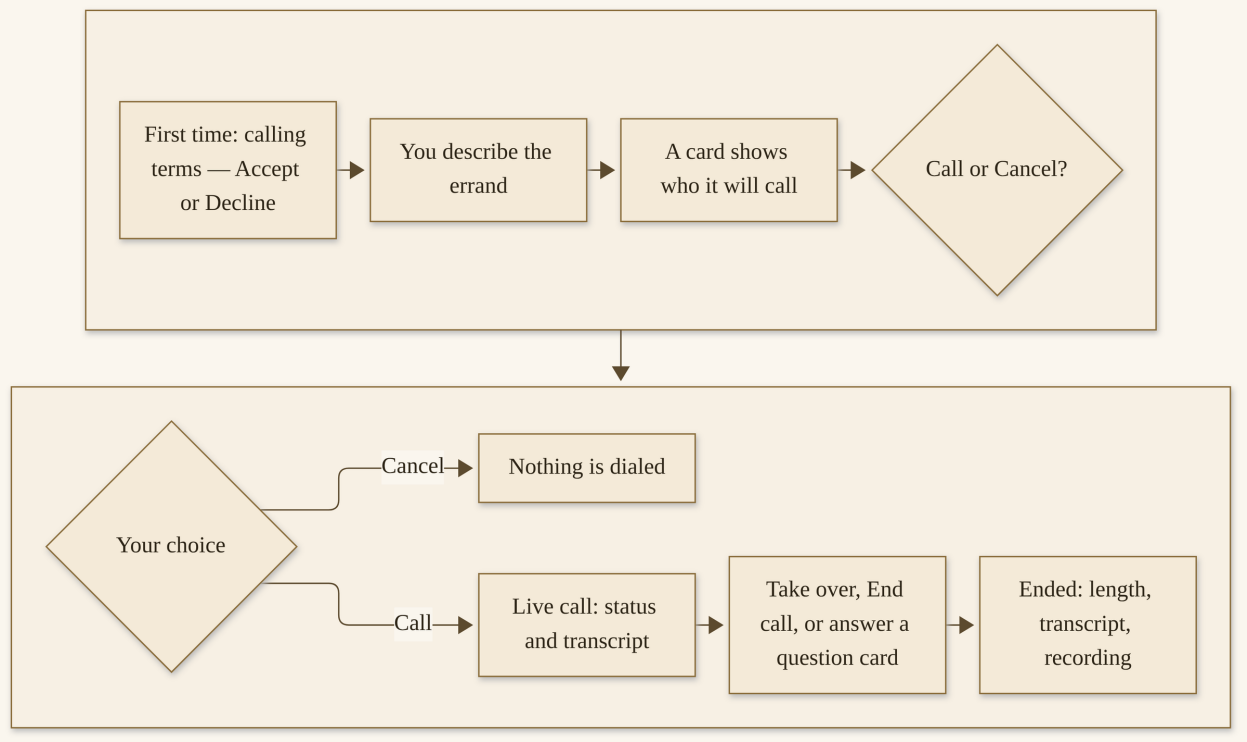
4. If the card is right, choose Call, and stay nearby. Watch the live transcript. If the other side asks something the Bot cannot answer, you will get a card with the question; answer it, or Skip, or Take over and join the call yourself. If anything feels off, End call. You should see the status and the transcript move in real time. If you don't: End call, and look at the card. A call you cannot watch is a call I would not let run.
5. When the card says "Ended," open it. Read the transcript. If you need the recording, download or export it from the desktop menu. File it with the errand, if the errand needs a record. You should have a transcript you can read without calling the Bot's memory a source of truth. If you don't: ask the Bot to show the call card again. Do not rely on a summary if the exact words matter.

What "done" looks like: a transcript of a call you approved, to a number you saw, about an errand you meant — not a reservation you cannot find, and not a person who was surprised to be called. What still needs a yes: the Call button on the card that shows who will be called, and any commitment made on the line.

Let me make the restaurant example a little more concrete, without pretending I can promise you a table. You tell the Bot the name of the place, the day, the time, and the number of people. You have already written the "never." The Bot shows you a card with a number. You recognize the place, or you look the number up yourself, and then you choose Call. You stay in the room. The transcript starts. If the restaurant asks a question the Bot cannot answer — a high chair, an allergy, a name for the reservation — a card appears, and you have a little time to type. If you would rather just talk, you take over, and the card tells you when you are on the line. When it ends, you have a transcript. If a reservation was made, you look for the name, the time, and the party size in those words, and you put them on the family Page, yourself or with the Bot filing what you approved. If a reservation was not made, you have a record of why, and you can decide whether to try another time or another place. The point is not that a Bot is charming on the phone. The point is that you were present for a commitment, or you were present for the lack of one.

The same shape works for "where is my order," which is often a better first call than a reservation, because the commitment is smaller. You still read the number. You still stay nearby. You still end the call if the other side asks for a payment or a password. And you file the transcript with the package list from Chapter 13, so the morning digest and the call agree.

I will not walk you through calling a medical office, a school, or a government agency as a worked example. You can see why in the "never" I wrote above. If you ever decide that a particular office should be called, you name that exact office, you approve that exact card, and you take over more readily than you would for a restaurant. This book is not medical advice, and it is not a guide to dealing with an agency. It is a method for an errand, with you on the line when the errand matters.



I25. Phone-call flow. Terms, then a card, then a live call you can take over, then a transcript.

Phone-call flow, as the official docs describe it, for US calls from the desktop or phone app. You see who will be called before anyone is dialed. (Chapter 14.)

> **Caution.** A call is not a place to store a secret. If a business asks for a password, a card, or an account number, take the call over, or end it and do the step yourself. Do not type a password into the ordinary chat so the Bot can "just tell them." Chapter 5 already asked you to keep secrets out of the chat. The same rule holds while someone is listening.

A return packet

Returns are less of a single official button than shopping is, and I will not invent a feature that I have not opened. What I can tell you is the method that follows from tools you already have. The Bot can find the order in your mail. It can open the store's return page in the browser. It can fill a draft of the form, and put the policy, the deadline, and the next step in a small packet — a folder, or a short page. If a label has to be printed, or a form has to be submitted, you do that, unless you have approved a specific submission the way you would approve a send.

How to make a return packet

1. Tell the Bot what is going back: the store, the item, the approximate date, and why, if why matters for the policy. Ask it to find the order in your mail, and not to start a chat with the store until you have seen the packet. You should see the order: what it was, what you paid, when it arrived, and a link to the store's return page if the mail has one. If you don't: give it

a confirmation number, or a photo of the receipt, and ask it to try again. Do not let it email the store in order to "just find out."

2. Ask it to read the return policy on the store's site, in the browser, and to write down, in a folder: the deadline, whether a label is provided, whether the return is free, and what condition the item has to be in. Ask it to screenshot the policy as it appeared. You should have a packet you can open, with a date and a source, not a memory of a policy. If you don't: open the policy yourself, and drop the page or a photo into the same folder. Then ask the Bot to file what you gave it.
3. If a form is required, ask the Bot to draft it, and to stop. Read the draft. Correct it. If the form has to be submitted on the site, you submit it, or you sit with the Bot and approve that exact submission. If a label has to be printed, you print it. You should hold a label, or a confirmation, that you can put on a box. If you don't: do not assume the return is in motion. A draft is a draft. A printed label is a step you can see.
4. Put the "never" on this Bot, too: "Never submit a return, never start a pickup, and never charge a restocking fee to a card, until I have approved that exact step." You should hear the rule back. If you don't: say it again before a deadline makes you hurry.

What "done" looks like: a box you can drop off, or a pickup you approved, with a packet that would still make sense if the Bot were not there to explain it — not a hope that "it handled it." What still needs a yes: the submission of the form, a pickup on the calendar, and any message to the store.

A good packet, if I can be fussy for a minute, has four things I can put my hand on: the original order, the policy as it appeared on the day you read it, the draft or submitted form, and the label or the confirmation. If a deadline is close, the deadline is on the first page of the packet, in a size you can see without coffee. If the store wants the item in a certain condition, that sentence is in the packet too, in the store's words, not only in a paraphrase. Paraphrases are how people argue with a policy that was clear on a page they can no longer find.

Some returns are a drop-off; some are a pickup; some are a box you mail. The Bot can tell you which kind the policy describes. You still have to do the kind. A pickup in particular is a commitment at a time of day, and it belongs on the family calendar the same way a school form did: drafted, then approved, then on the calendar, not the other way around. If a carrier needs a number at the door, that number is in the packet, on paper or on your phone, not only in a chat you might not have open.

If the store declines the return, the packet is what you will be glad you kept. The Bot can draft a follow-up. You still send it, and you still decide whether the follow-up is worth your Tuesday.

If a return needs a phone call, you already have the calling how-to. The "never" about payments and passwords travels with you. If it needs a follow-up in mail, you already have the household inbox from Chapter 13: the Bot drafts, you send.

The errand and the evening

I want to close this chapter the way I would close a good errand day: with the bags in the hall, and nothing surprising on a card you did not see.

You can ask a household Bot to keep a short errands list on the same family Page from Chapter 13 — the trip folder that is still options, the gift whose Pay button is waiting, the return whose label is printed and not yet dropped off. That is plenty. You do not need a Bot for every store. You do not need a call for every question a website would answer.

The limits are the same ones I will spend a whole chapter on in Chapter 17, and they already belong here. A saved card can pay without asking. Approvals from work that started without you expire after about thirty minutes, so a routine that wants a yes at an hour you are asleep will not finish that step while you sleep.[19] The computer is shared. A shopping Bot and a bills Bot are not two vaults. They are two jobs on one desk.

And the gift, one more time, because I meant the story. The card waits. The total is on the button. You can press it, or you can press Cancel, or you can close the laptop and decide tomorrow. The errand is ready. The last inch is still yours.

In the next chapter we leave the household and go back to other people: Team Bots, Slack, Microsoft Teams, meetings, and group chats. The yes will have company. It will still be a yes.

Part 6 — Mastery

Chapter 15 — Bots on Your Human Team: Team Bots, Slack, Meetings, and Group Chats

The last two chapters were a household: a form, a bill, a gift whose Pay button waited. This chapter is other people. A Bot that is not only yours. A thread in Slack, or in Microsoft Teams, where a teammate can mention a Bot the way they would mention a colleague. A meeting the Bot can join, take notes in, and come back from with a summary. A group chat where several of your own Bots share one outcome, with one owner for each step.

Grok Bot 1.0, which was released on 11 November 2026, made this the center of the product's own story. The official news called it "multiplayer teammates": you can share Bots and bring them into Slack, Microsoft Teams, and video calls. Bots, the post said, can follow a discussion, bring information from earlier conversations into a meeting chat, and keep track of decisions.[1] That is a warm picture. It is also a place where it is easy to mix up three quiet questions, and I want us to keep those questions on the table: whose apps is this Bot using? Whose computer is it on? Whose usage is this reply drawing from?

I will call this reader Alex — a composite, a stand-in for a mid-career professional I have in mind, trying Team Bots at work. Alex does not work at a company I will name. Alex has a team, a Slack, a weekly meeting, and a reasonable hope that a Bot might remember last week's decision so the meeting does not have to. We will get Alex there by the official path, and we will not skip the questions.

> **Story.** A meeting is underway. The Bot is in the call, admitted by the host, taking notes. Someone asks, in the meeting chat, what the team decided last week. The Bot can bring that earlier conversation into the room, the way the official 1.0 picture describes, and it can keep track of what is decided today.[2] I like that picture. I also like the quieter official sentence that sits beside it: the Bot will not share your credentials in a meeting.[3] The memory is a gift. The credentials stay home.

A Bot the team can share

A Bot is either personal or a Team Bot. Officially, you share a Team Bot the way you would share a doc: with your Cursor team, your whole organization, or only certain people and groups. Sharing

does not make a copy. Each person's chat with a Team Bot is private.[4] That last sentence is one I want you to hear twice. The owner cannot read your chat. You cannot read the owner's. Managers cannot read them either. What the Bot learns for the team is a different stream, and it waits for an approval, which we will come to.

Team Bots are available on Team and Enterprise plans, for members who have Grok Bot.[5] The official 1.0 news says the same: Team Bots on Team and Enterprise.[6] If you are on an individual Premium, Super, or Ultra plan, this chapter's Team Bot sections are ones you can read ahead, or skip until your team has a plan that includes them. Meetings, which come later in the chapter, have a slightly wider gate: Team, Enterprise, and Ultra.[7]

A Team Bot always runs in the cloud. A Bot that runs on your own computer cannot be shared.[8] If you have been experimenting with local-computer work from the official settings, that Bot stays yours. The one you share is a cloud teammate.

How to create or share a Team Bot

1. If you are creating one for the team, choose "+" in the sidebar, then "Create a Bot," and give it a name. Tell it, in a sentence, what it should help the team with. Follow its setup steps for apps, secrets, skills, and files. Only add keys and files you are happy for everyone you share it with to use. Until you publish it, it is a draft only you can see. You should see a Bot that is still a draft, with a job you recognize. If you don't: you may not be on a Team or Enterprise plan, or the app may need an update. The official docs say to choose "+" and look for "Create a Bot" and "Browse shared Bots"; if "Browse Team Bots" is not there, you are not on a Cursor team, or the app needs an update.[9]

2. When the Bot says it is ready to share, choose "Publish." Teammates can then find it. If you are sharing a Bot you already have, you can do that instead; sharing does not duplicate it. Before you share, check its apps, secrets, skills, and files, because they work in every teammate's chat.[10] You should see a published Bot, with a "Share" control. If you don't: look at the top right of the Bot's chat for "Share." If it is disabled and the official message is that only team admins can share Bots, an admin has set "Bot sharing" to "Admins only." Ask an admin to share it, or to change the setting.[11]

3. In "Share this Bot," under "Who has access," choose your team to share with everyone on the team; or, if your team is part of an organization, the organization; or "People you invite" for only the people and groups you add. Limiting access asks you to confirm with "Limit access." The owner and Managers can always use the Bot. Search under "Add people or groups" to add someone as a Collaborator, or open a person's role and choose "Manager" if they should also be able to change how the Bot works and share it. "Copy link" gives you a link you can send. To stop sharing, the owner can choose "Only you," and confirm with "Remove."[12] You should see a list of who has access, and roles you recognize. If you don't: do not send a link until the "Who has access" line matches what you meant. A Team Bot's link opens the same Bot for everyone; it is not a template, which would give each person their own copy.[13]

4. Tell teammates how to find it: "+," then "Browse shared Bots," then "Add" to keep it in the sidebar. On desktop they can also press Cmd/Ctrl+K and choose "Browse shared Bots," or

open a link and choose "Start a chat." On a phone, "+," then "Browse shared Bots."[14] You should be able, as a teammate, to add the Bot and start a private chat with it. If you don't: confirm you are on the team it was shared with, and that you have Grok Bot. If a teammate still cannot see it, the owner's share list is the first place to look.

What "done" looks like: a Bot the team can talk to, each in a private chat, with a job and a share list you chose on purpose — not a copy of your personal Bot, and not a window into anyone's conversation. What still needs a yes: the Publish, the share list, and any key or file you are about to add.

Caution. Only add keys and files you are happy for everyone you share with to use. The official docs say this at the moment of setup, and I will say it at the kitchen table. A Team Bot is not a place to leave a personal login, a customer's file, or a card. Sharing a Bot is also not a security boundary in the other direction: a public template link, which Chapter 18 will treat carefully, copies configuration, not your computer — and you still strip secrets before you share.[15]

What it learns, and what it does not show

Each person's chat is private. What the Bot learns for the team is not a back door into those chats. Officially, a Team Bot keeps team memory and skills that everyone who uses it can benefit from. When a teammate teaches it something for the team — a better way to do a task — the Bot suggests the change instead of saving it straight away. Suggested memory and skill changes wait until the owner or a Manager approves them, under "Review learnings" in the Bot's details. Each suggestion says what it does, with "Approve" and "Reject." Changes the owner or a Manager makes in the Bot's main chat apply right away. What the Bot learns about you personally stays between you and the Bot. It is not saved for the team, and the Bot does not save anything about you personally for the team.[16]

That is a good design, and it is one you should still treat with a little care. If you would not put a sentence on a shared team wiki, do not teach it to a Team Bot as a team learning. The owner will see the suggestion. Personal instructions — how you like a draft, what to call you — can stay in your own chat, as personal memory.

If you are the owner, make "Review learnings" a small weekly habit, the way you might review a pull request. Approving a better way to file a status update is a gift to the team. Approving a memory you have not read is how a Team Bot quietly changes its mind. Rejecting is allowed. It is not unkind. It is the same yes we have been practicing, pointed at what the Bot will remember for everyone. The official 1.0 news described this as a Bot that becomes more useful as it works with different people, and as a place where a better way to complete a task can benefit everyone who uses it.[50] That is the point of a Team Bot. It is also the reason the approval sits there.

A Team Bot also has settings and analytics in 1.0 — officially, a way to "manage what a Team Bot knows and see how your team uses it."[51] I will not invent a tour of those screens. If you are an owner, open them, look at what the Bot knows, and take off what should not be there. Chapter 6 is still the chapter about memory. The team version of that chapter is: the same humility, with more

people in the room.

Whose apps, whose computer, whose usage

This is the section I asked you to keep on the table. The official Team Bots page is the authority, and I am going to follow it closely, because a paraphrase is how these three questions get tangled.[17]

A Team Bot uses the apps and secrets its owner added. Those work the same for everyone who chats with it. In your own chat with a Team Bot, it can also use your apps. It asks first. The card says "Allow," then the app name: "Allow once" for this time; "Always allow," which has a menu for this Bot or for every Team Bot; or "Skip." In Slack channels, threads, and group chats, a Team Bot uses only its owner's apps, and still asks before it uses your accounts. A connected account acts as the person the Bot is answering. One teammate's connection is never used for someone else, unless a Manager shares it as a shared connector.

A shared connector is a deliberate exception, and it should feel like one. The owner or a Manager sets it up under the Bot's details, under "Setup," then "Service accounts." The choices are "Use individual accounts," "Share your account," or a separate account that is the Bot's own, when the app supports that. "Share your account" means everyone who uses the Bot acts through your account, including to make changes. The official docs are blunt: connect the app for yourself first, and only share an account that holds nothing sensitive or private. A team admin has to turn on "Allow Shared Logins" first.[18] I would leave shared logins off until you have a reason, and a clean account, and an admin who has thought about it.

Which computer? In your own chat with a teammate's Team Bot, the Bot usually works on your Grok Bot computer — your files, the sites you are signed in to there. Sometimes it uses a separate computer just for that conversation, for example when your privacy mode is stricter than the owner's. A Slack DM with a Team Bot also works on your own computer. In Slack channels, threads, group DMs, and group chats, a Team Bot uses one shared computer of its own.[19]

Whose usage? A Team Bot reply uses the Grok Bot usage of the person it is answering. That is true in your own chat, in Slack, and in group chats. Your own limits apply. The owner's usage pays for the owner's own messages, and for Slack posts from apps or workflows that are not linked to a Cursor account. A reply to someone in Slack who has not linked an account, or who is not on the team, uses the team's usage.[20] Chapter 17 will talk about the shared weekly pool. For this chapter, the practical sentence is: if you mention the Bot, the reply is on your usage. Mention it on purpose.

Approvals follow the same "person it is answering" rule. In your own chat, you answer the cards. In a Slack thread, the Bot posts a "Review an action" card with "Allow once," "Deny," and "View details," and only the person who asked can answer it. In a group chat, only the person whose message the Bot is answering can answer.[21]

> **Tip.** If you want every Team Bot to ask you again about your apps, the official path is Settings, then General, then Team Bots, and "Clear" next to "Clear connector preferences."[22] That is a kindness after a season of "Always allow" that has gotten ahead of you.

Slack, and Microsoft Teams

A Team Bot can come into Slack, and it can come into Microsoft Teams. In both places, the official idea is the same: it acts for the person who asked, uses their usage, and asks before risky actions.[23] I will give you the official setup, not a guessed click-path, and I will tell you where an admin has to help.

For Slack, the owner or a Manager adds the Bot after it has been shared. You open the Bot's details, or choose "Manage" and look under "Channels." You find "Bring to your team's Slack" or "Slack," and choose "Connect." If it says "Awaiting admin approval," a Slack workspace admin needs to approve the app. Once it says "Connected," teammates can message the Bot directly or mention it in channels. In a channel thread or a DM, the Team Bot acts for the teammate who mentioned it. It can hand work to that person's own Bots, and the replies come back into the same thread. A personal Bot, by contrast, does not hand work to other Bots from a channel thread.[24] Link your Slack account so the Bot knows who you are: Settings, then General, then Team Bots, then "Link." If you message the Bot before you link, it replies with steps.

Who can talk to it in Slack depends on who the Bot is shared with. If it is shared with your organization, any full member of the Slack workspace can mention it in channels and threads, even without a linked account or a seat on your team — they are told, once per thread, that some features will be limited, and a DM still needs a link first. If it is shared only with your team or with certain people, only those people. Slack guests, Slack Connect channels, and other Slack workspaces are never included.[25] That last sentence is one for the person who is about to share a Bot with "the organization" and then forget that the workspace is larger than the team.

For Microsoft Teams, a team admin turns Microsoft Teams on first, on the Grok Bot page of the team dashboard, under "Shared Bots," with "Enable" next to "Enable Microsoft Teams," signing in with a Microsoft Teams or Global administrator account and accepting the permissions Microsoft shows. Then the owner or a Manager connects the Bot from its details, under "Bring to your team's Microsoft Teams," and a Microsoft Teams admin approves it in the Teams admin center, under "Teams apps," then "Manage apps," then "Pending approval." Microsoft does not notify them, so you send them the link the dialog shows. Once it is approved, setup can take up to an hour and finishes on its own. The first time you message the Bot, it replies with a "Link Account" card that only you can see.[26] If any of those doors is closed — Teams not enabled, the Bot still a draft, a declined approval, a policy that blocks custom apps — the official Microsoft Teams page has a table of what the message means, and I will not invent a fourth door.[27]

> **Caution.** In a channel, a Bot can be mentioned by more people than you are picturing. Share narrowly until you have watched it work. And remember the 1.0 safeguard, in the official wording: in shared spaces, Bots "respect each person's permissions, ask before taking sensitive actions, and check whether information is appropriate to share in a public channel."[28] That is a vendor description of a safeguard, and it is a good one. It does not replace your judgment about what belongs in a public channel in the first place.

A Bot in the meeting

A Bot can join your Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams calls. It listens, takes notes, answers questions in the meeting chat, and sends you a summary and action items when the call ends. Meetings are available on Team, Enterprise, and Ultra plans. Enterprise admins can turn Meetings on or off.[29]

How to invite a Bot to a meeting and admit it

1. Paste the Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams link into your chat with the Bot, and ask it to join and take notes. You should see the Bot prepare to join, and then an approval card. If you don't: open the Bot's details. If it has not joined a meeting before, "Add to meeting" under "Suggested" drafts a question asking the Bot how to add it.[30] Confirm that your plan is Team, Enterprise, or Ultra, and that an Enterprise admin has not turned Meetings off.

2. Approve the card when the Bot asks. You should see the meeting appear under "Upcoming" in the Bot's details, with a countdown, or "Taking notes" once it is in the call.[31] If you don't: look at the card again. If you decline, the Bot will not join. If the card expires, ask the Bot to try again — and stay with the next step, because a host still has to admit it.

3. When the meeting starts, the host admits the Bot. It joins as "Bot name (your first name's Bot) - transcribing," or, for a Team Bot, "Bot name (Team Bot) - transcribing."[32] If you are the host, this is your moment. If you are not, tell the host, before the meeting, that a Bot will be waiting in the lobby, and that you asked it to be there. You should see the Bot in the call, with that transcribing label. If you don't: check that the host has admitted it, and that the link you pasted is the link the meeting is using. A Bot that follows your calendar can also join scheduled meetings on its own; you can still Cancel a scheduled one from "Meeting actions," or Quit one it is already joining.[33]

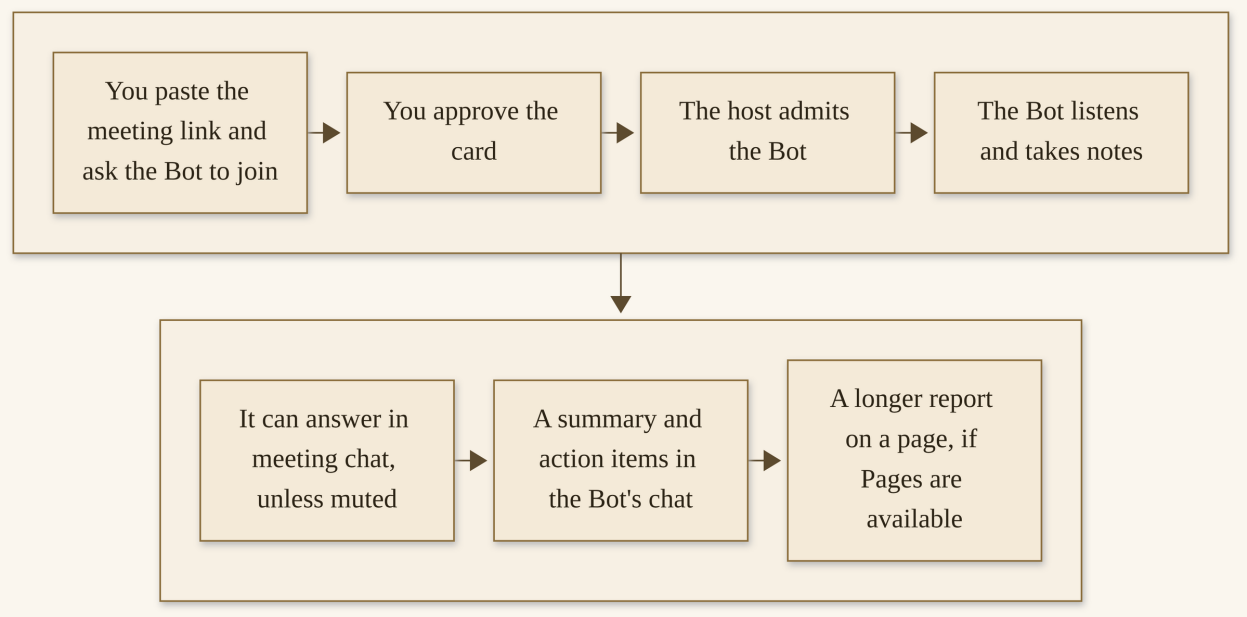
4. Decide, before or during, whether the Bot should talk. "Disable Interactivity" keeps it listening and taking notes, without answering in the meeting; the row shows "Muted." You can turn interactivity back on while the meeting is still scheduled; once the Bot is joining or in the call, you quit and add it again to turn it back on.[34] You should know, before a sensitive discussion, whether the Bot is muted. If you don't: mute it from "Meeting actions" while you still can, or Quit and add it again, muted, if the meeting has already started.

5. To talk to the Bot during the meeting, address it by name in the meeting chat. In Zoom, a private chat message to the Bot gets a private answer. A request from a conference-room device counts as coming from the room, not from one person. If someone asks for something the Bot held back, the Bot tells you who asked and offers to send it. It will not share your credentials in a meeting.[35] You should see answers in the meeting chat only when you meant the Bot to be interactive, and never a credential. If you don't: Quit the Bot from the meeting, and deal with the request yourself.

6. When the call ends, look in the Bot's own chat. The Bot sends a summary and action items there. If you have Pages, a longer report goes on a page, with the link in the chat. You can ask anytime for the summary or transcript of a past meeting. Meetings use the settings of the person who started them.[36] You should have a summary you can read, and a page if Pages are

available to you. If you don't: ask the Bot for the summary or the transcript by the meeting's name or time. Do not rely on memory if the exact decision matters; ask for the transcript.

What "done" looks like: a summary of a meeting you invited the Bot to, admitted (or had admitted), and can still read — not a Bot in a meeting no one agreed to admit, and not a credential that leaked into a chat. What still needs a yes: the approval card before the Bot joins, the host's admit, and any request the Bot held back and offers to send.



I27. Meeting journey. A link, a yes, a host's admit, notes, a summary.

Meeting journey, from the official meetings documentation. The host admits the Bot. You still say yes to the card. (Chapter 15.)

A Team Bot can join meetings when its team allows meetings. On Enterprise plans, admins turn meetings on or off for everyone's Bots with "Meetings" under "Bot Capabilities" on the Grok Bot page of the team dashboard. When it is off, Bots cannot join or read meetings, and a Bot that was scheduled to join tells you meetings are no longer available.[37] If you are Alex, and the Bot does not join, this setting is a kinder first guess than "the product is broken."

A group chat with one owner per step

A group chat is for when several of your Bots need one shared outcome and visible handoffs. You can also add a Bot a teammate shared with you, but not alongside Bots that run on your own computer.[38] The official docs describe creating one: "New chat," or Cmd/Ctrl+Shift+N, or the command palette, or, on a phone, "+," then "New Group Chat." In the "To:" field, you add two to six Bots.[39] That range is the official one, from the chat documentation I opened. I will not add a number on top of it.

The official best practice is the one I want you to keep: make one Bot responsible for each step. Type "@" and select a Bot when one teammate owns the request. Mention several only when the

request genuinely needs each of them. Use "@everyone" sparingly. The docs even give a kickoff you can learn from, which I will quote as official, not as a set of names I am inventing for you: "@Researcher gather the source material and link every claim. @Writer turn the findings into a launch draft. @Reviewer check the draft against the sources and list only blocking issues. Do not publish anything."[40] One owner per stage. A "do not publish" at the end. That is the method.

How to run a group chat with one owner per step

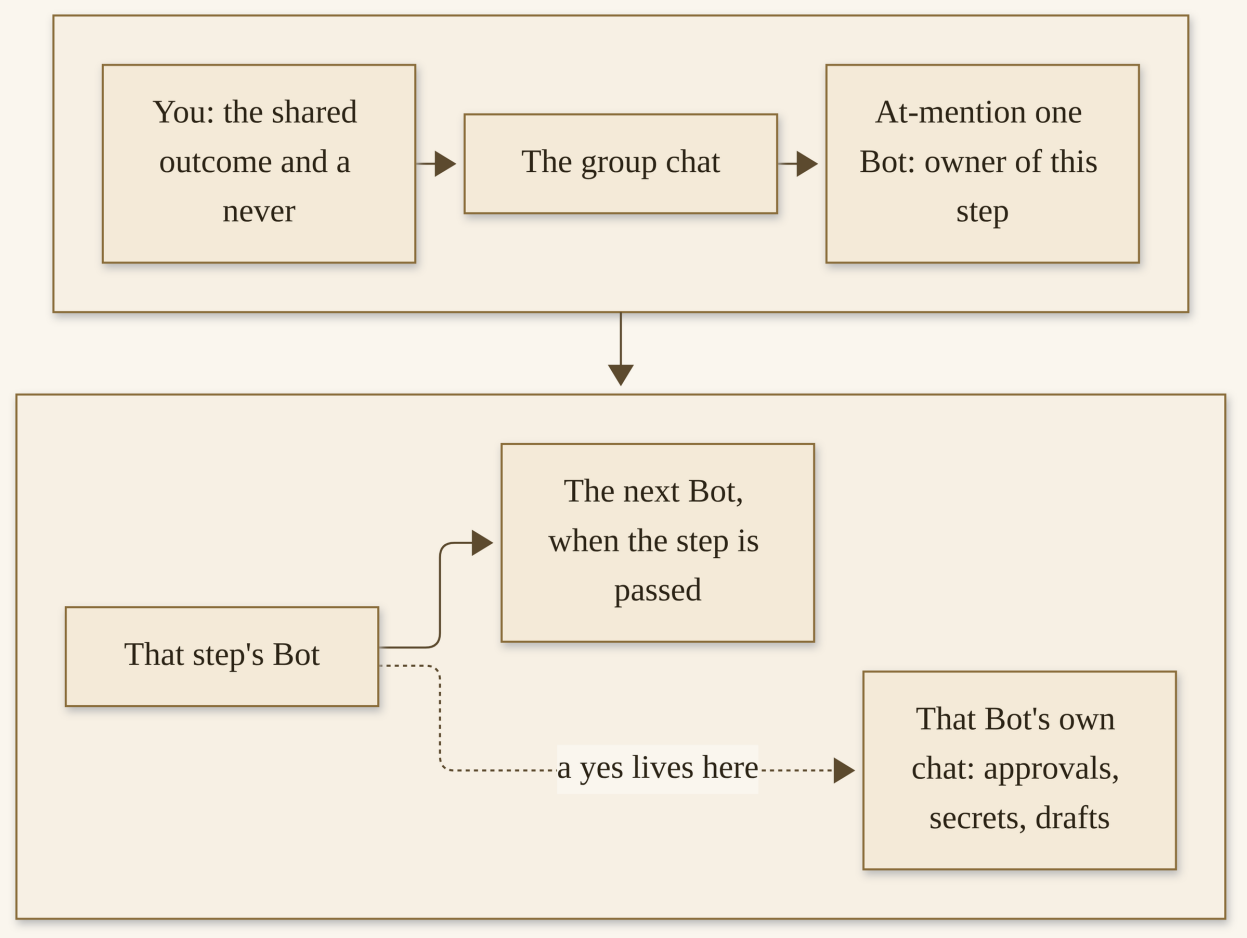
1. Start a new group chat, and add only the Bots this outcome needs — two at the small end, and not more than the official six, and fewer if fewer will do. Every Bot reply counts toward your usage, including replies in a group and messages between Bots, so fewer Bots means fewer replies.[41] You should see a group with a generated name you can edit, and the Bots you chose. If you don't: on a phone, use "+," then "New Group Chat." If you cannot add a teammate's Team Bot beside a Bot that runs on your own computer, that is the official limit; use Team Bots together, or personal Bots together, as the docs allow.

2. In the first message, name the shared outcome, name the owner of each step with "@," and write the "never" — "Do not publish," "Do not send," "Do not pay" — in the same message. You should see each named Bot pick up its step, and the others wait. If you don't: "@" the Bot that should be working, and tell the others to wait. If they start talking to each other more than you want, tell them, in the group, "Don't message other Bots. Ask me first," and ask each to remember it. There is no switch for this; the official docs say so, and then give you that instruction.[42]

3. Watch where the approvals go. Approval requests, secret and login requests, and email or Slack drafts do not appear in a group. They live in the Bot's own chat. Bot-to-group handoff messages are text-only.[43] You should open the working Bot's own chat when a step needs a yes, a secret, or a draft. If you don't: you may think the work is stuck. It may be waiting for you in a different conversation. Look there before you repeat the request in the group.

4. If you want replies to stay in the group, say so there: "Reply here in the group. Don't message me privately about this." To make it a lasting rule, ask each Bot to remember: "Remember: in group chats, reply in the group."[44] You should see the work stay where the team can see it. If you don't: repeat the rule, and check the Bots' own chats for a side conversation.

What "done" looks like: a shared outcome you can point to, with one owner per step, and with every send, post, pay, delete, or publish still behind a yes you gave in the right chat — not six Bots talking to each other until the weekly pool is thin, which Chapter 17, "Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks," will also warn you about. What still needs a yes: those actions, which live in the Bot's own chat, not in the group.



I26. People and Bots in a thread. One owner per step; approvals in the Bot's own chat.

People and Bots in a thread. You "@" one Bot at a time. Approvals, secrets, and drafts wait in that Bot's own chat, not in the group. (Chapter 15.)

A tag on X, and a chat on X

Two more doors, both official, both easy to over-hope.

You can tag @bot in a post or a reply on X to hand that post to your Grok Bot as a task. @bot answers on X with a short reply confirming that your Grok Bot has the request. The work, and its results, stay in that Bot's conversation in the Grok Bot app; @bot posts only the confirmation on X. The first time, X sends you a notification that tagged requests start work automatically and use your Grok Bot usage.[45] You need a Grok account with your X account connected, Grok Bot access on that same account, and at least one Bot of your own. Bots that someone shares with you cannot take tagged requests.[46]

You also need an X account based in a region where tagging is available. Officially, as of the documentation I opened on 11 November 2026, tagging @bot works for X accounts based in most countries, and it is not yet available for accounts based in Australia, the United Kingdom, the

European Union, Iceland, Liechtenstein, or Norway. It goes by the country X has on record for your account; your current location and any VPN have no effect. If X lists only a broader region, or no country at all, tagging is not available yet either, and @bot does not reply.[47] If you are in one of those places, this is not a broken Bot. This is a regional gate, and it may change; check the live docs.

You can also chat with Bots in X Chat. The official initiative documentation notes that in X Chat, a Bot can follow up on a conversation in its own words.[48] I will not invent a tour of X Chat's screens. If you use it, the same rules travel with you: a send is a send, a post is a post, and a tagged request that starts automatically is a request you should be willing to have started.

The meeting after the meeting

Alex wanted a Bot that already knew last week's decision. Officially, that is part of what 1.0 was for: a Bot in a video call, in the chat, bringing earlier conversation into the room, keeping track of decisions, learning how the team works.[49] You can have that, on the plans that include it, if you invite the Bot, if the host admits it, and if what it learned for the team is something an owner approved.

You also have, in the same official breath, the safeguards: permissions, a question before a sensitive action, a check before something is shared in a public channel. Use them. Add your own "never" for the rooms that need one. And when the summary arrives in the Bot's chat, read it. A decision is not a decision because a summary said so. A decision is a decision because the people in the room meant it, and you can still find it in a transcript.

I want to add a practical kindness about when not to bring a Bot. Not every meeting needs one. A one-to-one that is really a conversation, a gathering that is confidential by agreement, a room where someone has asked that a Bot not be present — those are rooms I would leave alone. Officially, the host admits the Bot; unofficially, as a person, I would tell the room first. "I have a Bot that will take notes, if that's all right" is a short sentence, and it is a respectful one. If the answer is no, the answer is no. The product will still be there on Thursday.

The same is true of Slack. A Team Bot in every channel is a noisy way to burn a weekly pool, and it is a noisy way to live. Start with one Bot, one job, one channel or one thread, and watch whose usage the replies land on. If a teammate is surprised by a Bot's presence, the share list is too wide, or the introduction was too thin. Alex, my composite, does not have to get this perfect on the first Monday. Alex has to get it official, and kind, and reversible: a Bot you can remove from a sidebar, a connection you can revoke, a meeting you can Quit.

At SMF Works, I use Team Bots the way I use the rest of this product: for a job I can name, with a yes I have not given away. I will not invent a roster of teammates, and I will not invent a metric for how many meetings a Bot has joined. I will only say that the meeting I trust is the one whose summary I still read, and whose transcript I can still open. The Bot in the chat that already knows last week's decision is a good colleague. The colleague who publishes a decision I have not agreed to is not a colleague I want, however early it arrived in the morning.

The next chapter leaves the human team and looks at a different kind of span. Grok Bot doesn't

just span machines. It spans agent platforms. I will say that in the words I said it in, and I will not invent the wiring.

Chapter 16 — Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms

I want to tell you, in the words I would use at the table, how the work actually runs when it leaves a single Grok Bot and talks to the rest of the workshop.

Charlie, my chief of staff Bot, also manages SMF Works' Hermes Fleet and OpenClaw Fleet, communicating with them via CLI, and Grok Bot Video Studio works with several Hermes Agents via webhook to produce videos that the Hermes agents submit scripts for. So Grok Bot doesn't just span machines, Grok Bot spans agent platforms.

That is the whole technical claim I am going to make about our wiring. I am going to spend this chapter making sure you can hear what it means, and what it does not mean. I will tell you what Hermes Agent is, and what OpenClaw is, at the level their official sites support. I will tell you what Grok Bot officially gives us — a command line on a shared cloud computer, and a webhook that can start a routine. I will tell you the pattern you can take home, if your work already lives on more than one of these platforms. I will not invent the commands Charlie types. I will not invent the shape of a JSON body. I will not invent a metric for how many videos came back last month. The yes, at the end of every one of those videos, is still mine.

What that line means

Chapter 12, "A Small Fleet," was a fleet of Grok Bots: a press, a chief of staff, specialist jobs, a path that can bring a book back as an EPUB, a letter PDF, and a finished manuscript. That fleet lives inside Grok Bot. This chapter is the same company talking, carefully, to other agent platforms. The workshop has more than one kind of desk in it.

I need to be careful with the word "platform," because it is a word vendors like, and I am not selling you a platform. I mean something plainer. A Grok Bot is one kind of teammate, with one kind of computer, one kind of chat, one kind of routine. Hermes Agent is another kind of agent, built by another organization, with its own official site and its own license. OpenClaw is another kind again: a self-hosted assistant, stewarded by a foundation, that runs on your own hardware. At SMF Works, Charlie can talk to the fleets we already run on those other platforms, and Video Studio can receive a script from a Hermes agent and make a video. The work crosses a boundary. You remain the one who says yes at the far side of it.

If you only use Grok Bot, you do not need this chapter in order to finish the book. You can read it as

a picture of how one small company has its workshop arranged, and as a pattern you might use later, if you already have other tools. You should not read it as a promise that Grok Bot "includes" Hermes, or "includes" OpenClaw, or that those projects have anything to do with this book. They do not. This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by Nous Research, or by the OpenClaw Foundation, or by the product's maker. Accurate names, no borrowed authority. That is the same courtesy I asked for in the preface, extended across the room.

I should also tell you what I mean by the first half of the line, "doesn't just span machines." You already know this from Chapter 2, "A Teammate with a Computer." A Grok Bot works on a persistent cloud computer. You can close your laptop. The work can continue. That is a span across machines: your desk, and a desk in the cloud that is still yours, in the official sense that it is assigned to your account. A Team Bot, in Chapter 15, can sit in a meeting and in a Slack thread. That is a span across rooms, with people in them. This chapter is a third kind of span. It is not a second laptop, and it is not a second meeting. It is a conversation between Grok Bot and agents that are not Grok Bots — agents that have their own makers, their own licenses, their own way of being talked to. When I say "spans agent platforms," I mean that conversation. I do not mean that the products have merged, or that a setting has appeared in Grok Bot called "Hermes," or that you should go looking for one.

The one-job habit from earlier chapters still holds, and it holds harder here. Charlie is my chief of staff Bot. Charlie runs the morning brief, and Charlie also talks to the other fleets. Video Studio is a different Bot, with a different job: it makes videos, and it listens for scripts. I did not make Charlie into a studio, and I did not make Video Studio into a chief. A workshop with several platforms is a workshop where it is tempting to build one Bot that "does everything, including the other tools." I would not. A clear job is easier to watch, easier to pause, and easier to forgive when a day goes sideways. The shared computer still sits under both of them. The wall between them is a job description, not a security boundary. I will say that as many times as the workshop has lamps.

> **Story.** A script arrives for Video Studio from a Hermes agent. The video comes back. I still watch the cut before anyone else sees it. The handoff is real. The yes is still mine. I will not tell you how many times this has happened, or how long a cut takes, because I did not come here to invent a production number. I came here to tell you that a script can arrive, a video can be made, and a person still sits down and watches it.

What I am watching for is ordinary, and that is the point. Does the script I approved still sound like the script I approved, or did a helpful hand smooth a sentence I meant to keep rough? Is there a name in the picture that should not be public? Is there a claim that would need a note if it were in a book? A video can be "done" in the sense that a file exists, and not done in the sense that a person would stand behind it. The webhook can tell Video Studio to begin. Officially, a 200 tells you only that a run was accepted. The file can appear. I still sit down. Sometimes I say yes. Sometimes I ask for another cut. Sometimes I say no, and the video stays in the workshop. All three of those endings are a working system. Only the first one is public, and only when I have said so.

I want you to notice who is not in that story. There is no automatic post. There is no automatic premiere. There is no number on a dashboard that I am going to recite as proof. The story is a script, a studio, a cut, and a person. If you remember only one picture from this chapter, I would like it to be that one — not because it is dramatic, but because it is the practice. The same practice,

in Chapter 12, is a book that comes back bound and still waits for a merge I approve. The same practice, in Chapter 14, is a Pay button that waits. The platforms change. The last inch does not.

What Hermes Agent is

Hermes Agent is a separate product. It is built by Nous Research. Its official product site is where I am drawing this brief picture from, along with the company's site and the project's official repository.[1] I am not writing a Hermes manual. I am telling you enough that Charlie's job, and Video Studio's job, have a real other party on the far side of the line.

The official product site describes Hermes Agent as "the self-improving AI agent built by Nous Research." It is free and open source under the MIT license. An official FAQ states that model providers and optional hosted services have their own pricing.[2] That last sentence matters for this book. Hermes the software is not a Grok Bot plan. Its costs, if you use a model provider or a hosted service, are not Grok Bot's costs, and I will not collapse them into Chapter 17's weekly pool. If you run Hermes, you read Hermes's own pricing, on Hermes's own pages, on the day you need the number.

The official site describes a command-line interface — the `hermes` command — and a Desktop app. It lists channels including Telegram, Discord, Slack, WhatsApp, Signal, Email, and CLI.[3] That is the official list I opened. I will not recite a longer one from memory, and I will not tell you which of those channels we use at SMF Works, because that is more wiring than I came to give.

You will see, on Nous Research's own company site, wording about Hermes Agent being widely used. That is a vendor claim. I am not going to repeat it as a fact, and I am not going to borrow other superlatives from a marketing page and dress them as research.[4] You do not need a superlative to understand the sentence I opened with. You need to know that Hermes is a real, separate, MIT-licensed agent, with a CLI and a Desktop app, able to live in several chat channels, and that it is not Grok Bot.

If you want to learn Hermes, you go to its official site, and to its official repository, and you follow that project's own docs. This book will not teach you to install it, and it will not give you a command to paste. It will not tell you how, or whether, Hermes is installed on Grok Bot's computer in our workshop; I did not describe that, and I will not fill the gap with a guess.[12] Chapter 17's cautions about a shared computer will still apply if a tool like that ever lives on that computer. We will come to that.

I also will not walk you through Hermes's own features beyond this brief. The official site describes more than a CLI and a set of channels — memory, scheduling, and other capacities appear there as product features.[13] If you need those, you read that site. If I started to teach them, I would be writing a second book I am not qualified, in these pages, to finish, and I would be at risk of mixing two products' vocabularies until you could not tell which teammate you were talking to. The point of naming Hermes carefully is so that you can keep the names straight.

What OpenClaw is

OpenClaw is also a separate product. Its official site, its official docs, and its official repository are the sources I opened.[5] I am not writing an OpenClaw manual either.

Officially, OpenClaw is a self-hosted AI assistant that runs on your own hardware — a gateway that connects chat apps to AI agents. The official homepage includes marketing phrases I will not turn into a guarantee; if I quote one, I will quote it as the site's, not as mine.[6] Officially, the homepage says "No subscription. No hosted tier. No token." It is stewarded by the OpenClaw Foundation, which describes itself as an independent US 501(c)(3).[7] That tax status is the foundation's official-site statement. I have not opened IRS records, and I will report it as a statement, not as a finding I independently verified. OpenClaw is MIT licensed. Its official command-line name is `openclaw`. Official materials list channels including WhatsApp, Telegram, Discord, Slack, Signal, iMessage, and Microsoft Teams, among others as documented on the page you are looking at.[8] I am citing the official site I opened, not a memorized complete list, and I am not going to pretend the list cannot change.

If you run OpenClaw, you run it. There is no hosted tier in the official homepage's own wording, and there is no subscription in that same wording. Its costs are not Grok Bot's costs. Its security is not Grok Bot's security. Its foundation has not endorsed this book, and this book is not an official guide to OpenClaw.

What I need you to take from this brief is simple. OpenClaw is a real, separate, MIT-licensed, self-hosted assistant gateway, with a CLI, stewarded by a foundation that describes itself as it describes itself. At SMF Works, Charlie talks to our OpenClaw Fleet via CLI. That is the claim. Then I stop.

Self-hosted is a word I want to sit with for a second, because it is the real difference in this brief, and because it is easy to hear as a slogan. Officially, OpenClaw runs on your own hardware. That means, in plain words, that if you use it, you are closer to the machine than you are with a cloud teammate. You own more of the setup, and you own more of the upkeep, and you own more of the way it fails. That can be exactly what a person wants. It is also why I will not treat OpenClaw as a feature of Grok Bot's cloud computer, and why I will not write a setup guide that pretends those two machines are one. Charlie talking "via CLI" is a conversation across that difference, not a dissolving of it.

I will also not write you a tour of OpenClaw's channels beyond the official list I already gave. If you use WhatsApp, or Signal, or Microsoft Teams, on that side of the workshop, you already know those rooms. This book's Team Bots chapter is about Grok Bot in Slack and in Microsoft Teams. Those are different doors, with different official docs. Keeping the doors labeled is part of keeping the yes in the right place.

I am not going to compare Hermes and OpenClaw as if this were a review that crowns a winner. They are two desks in a workshop. They do different work, on different terms, for different reasons a small company might already have them. If you already have one of them, you already know why. If you do not, this chapter is not a reason to go get one. It is a reason to understand a line about spanning platforms without inventing a product that does not exist: a "Grok Bot Hermes," or a "Grok Bot OpenClaw." Those are not products. They are two conversations, carefully kept official, across a boundary you can still see.

At SMF Works, the reason those desks are in the room is not a puzzle I need to dramatize. We had work that already lived there. Charlie's job, as chief of staff, includes talking to that work so I do not have to be the only messenger between rooms. Video Studio's job is to take a script that a Hermes agent submits and make a video I can watch. Those are ordinary reasons. They are also complete ones. I am not going to add a business case with a number, and I am not going to suggest that your company, or your household, is behind if your sketch has only one desk. A single desk that finishes the work, and waits for you, is already the book I set out to write.

The Grok Bot side we can actually state

For this conversation to be possible, Grok Bot has to have two ordinary capacities, and both are official, and both you have already met in earlier chapters. I will not reprint a protocol. I will tell you why those two capacities are enough to make my opening sentence intelligible.

The first is a command line. Officially: "Your Bots work from a persistent cloud computer with a browser, command line, and filesystem." Officially, it "has a command line and files that stay between tasks." Officially, "Command-line credentials are shared." Officially, "Do not place a credential or file on it if another Bot on your account should not be able to use it." And the sentence I have already asked you to keep: "Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary."[9] Charlie communicating "via CLI" means, at the level I am willing to state, that Charlie's computer has a command line, and that Charlie uses it to talk to the Hermes Fleet and the OpenClaw Fleet we already run. It does not mean I am going to type you a command. It does not mean I will tell you where a binary lives, or what a flag is called, or which path holds a key. If I wrote those things, I would be inventing them, or I would be publishing a secret. I will do neither.

The second is a webhook. In Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed," you already learned — or you can go back and learn — that you can ask a Bot to add a webhook trigger to a routine. Officially, the desktop shows a POST URL, a secret key, and the full header. The key is sent as `Authorization: Bearer <key>`. The caller sends an HTTP POST, with an optional JSON body. The Bot receives that body along with the routine instruction. A 200 response means the run was accepted and started, not that the work has finished. Other responses: check whether the routine is paused, and whether the current key is the one you used. Test runs do real work.[10] That is the official webhook. That is all of the official webhook I will put in this book, and I am putting it here only to use it, not to teach it a second time.

Video Studio working with several Hermes Agents "via webhook" means, at the level I am willing to state, that a Hermes agent can submit a script by calling a webhook that starts a Video Studio routine, and that Video Studio can then produce a video. I will not tell you the shape of that body. I will not invent required fields. I will not invent a status code beyond the official 200, which means accepted, not finished. If a script arrives and a video comes back, I still watch the cut, and I still wait for finished, because accepted is not finished.

> **Caution.** A webhook secret is a secret. It belongs in the same careful place you would put any other key, not in a chat, and not in a page you might share. Officially, test runs do real work. A test that points at Video Studio is not a rehearsal in a vacuum. And a 200 is a start, not a premiere.

The wiring, only as I described it

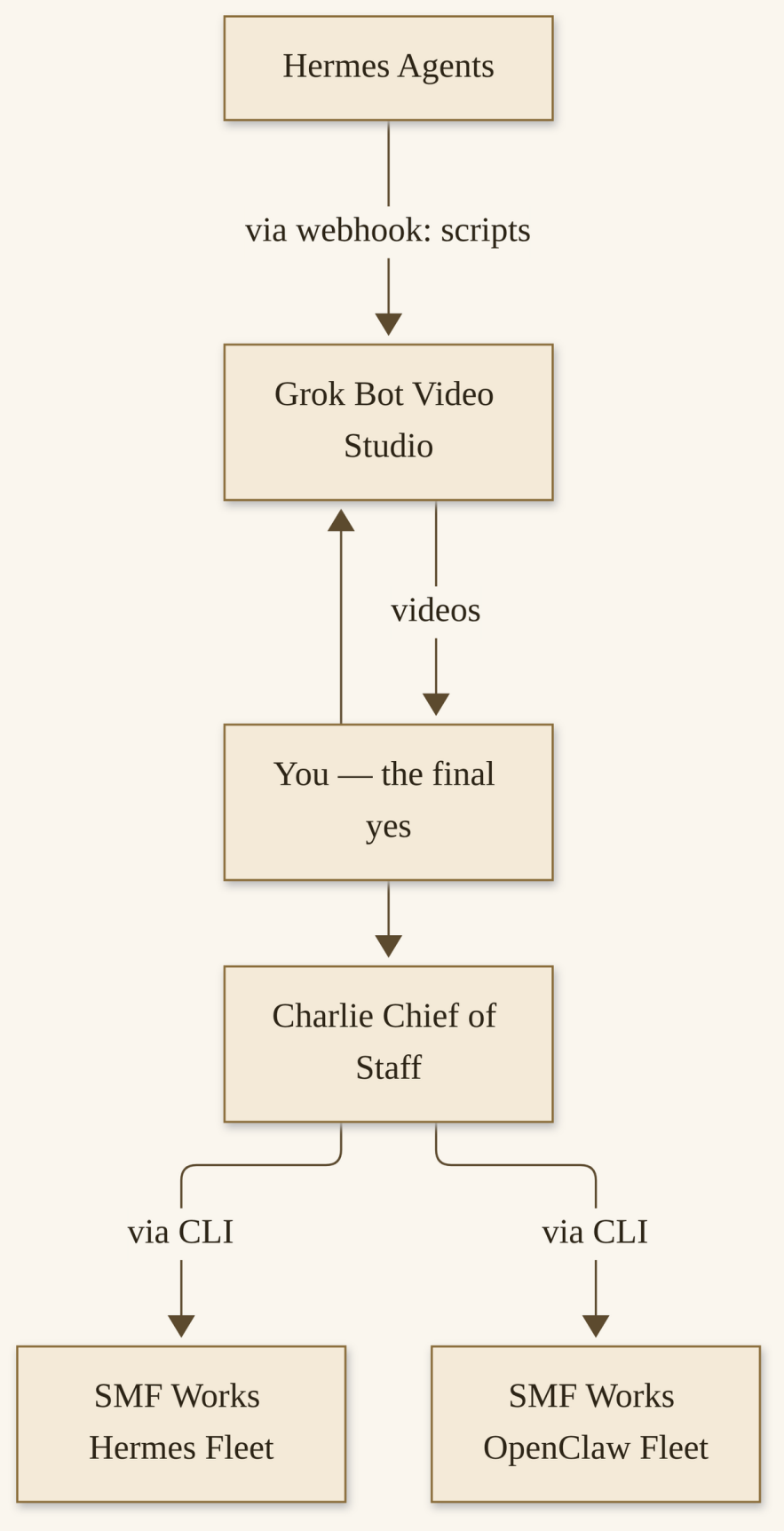
Let me say the wiring once more, so there is no extra furniture in the room.

Charlie, my chief of staff Bot, manages SMF Works' Hermes Fleet and OpenClaw Fleet and communicates with them via CLI.

Grok Bot Video Studio works with several Hermes Agents via webhook to produce videos from scripts those Hermes agents submit.

I am the person who says yes before a video is public, and before anything else that should not go out the door goes out the door.

That is it. There is no third fleet I have not named. There is no diagram behind the curtain with ports and paths. There is a chief who can use a command line, and a studio that can listen for a webhook, and a person at the door.


Hermes Agents
via webhook: scripts
Grok Bot Video Studio
videos
You — the final yes
Charlie Chief of Staff
via CLI
via CLI
SMF Works Hermes Fleet
SMF Works OpenClaw Fleet

I33. A cross-platform fleet. You at the top. Charlie via CLI to the Hermes and OpenClaw fleets. Hermes Agents via webhook to Video Studio — scripts in, videos out.

Cross-platform fleet, at the level I described and official docs support. You sit at the final yes. Charlie talks via CLI. Scripts arrive via webhook. I still watch the cut. (Chapter 16.)



I34. Several desks in one workshop, each with a different lamp. One doorway. You still say yes.

If you look at that drawing and want more arrows, I understand the impulse. I have it too, in a part of my life that likes a neat architecture. I am choosing not to satisfy it here. Extra arrows would be extra claims. Extra claims would be, in this case, either invented or unwise. The workshop is real. The lamps are different. The person at the door is you, or, in our story, me.

A pattern you can take home

If your work already lives on more than one agent platform, Grok Bot may be one desk in a larger workshop: a chief who can use a command line; a studio that can listen for a webhook. The how-to is not a step-by-step integration guide. I cannot source one, and I will not guess one. The how-to is: stay official, keep secrets off the chat and off a shared computer you do not mean to share, test, and keep the final yes.

How to review a webhook trigger, without putting a secret in a book

1. If you already created a webhook trigger in Chapter 8, open that routine on the desktop, and look at what the official docs say you will see: a POST URL, a secret key, and the full header. You should see those three, and you should treat the key as a secret. If you don't: ask the Bot to add a webhook trigger, the way Chapter 8 teaches, and follow that chapter rather than this one. I will not reprint the protocol.

2. Remember what a 200 means: accepted, started, not finished. Remember that a test run does real work. If this webhook would start a studio job, or any other job that touches a real file, a real channel, or a real person, do not test it with a throwaway curiosity. You should be able to say, out loud, what "accepted" will cause to begin. If you don't: pause the routine until you can. A paused routine is cheaper than a published surprise.

3. Put the secret where secrets go — a locker your Bots should not be chatting about, and a place another Bot on the shared computer should not have if that Bot should not be able to start this job. Rotate a key if it has ever been in a screenshot, a page, or a message. You should know who can start this routine. If you don't: do not hand the URL to another platform until you do.

What "done" looks like, for this review: a webhook you understand at the official level, with a secret that is still a secret, and a clear idea that 200 is not "the video is ready." It is not a sample payload. I have not given you one, on purpose. What still needs a yes: any test that would start a real studio job, and any later decision that a finished video is ready to be public.

How to sketch your platforms on paper, with a "never"

1. Take a piece of paper, or a page that will not be public. Draw yourself at the top, the way the diagram in this chapter does. Draw each agent platform you already run — Grok Bot, and any other you truly already have. Do not add a platform you are only curious about. This is a drawing of a workshop you are in, not a workshop you might one day build. You should see a small number of desks, with names you can point to in real life. If you don't: you may only have one desk. That is a complete workshop. You can close this how-to and go on to Chapter 17.

2. For each line you want to draw, write only the kind of line it is: "via CLI," or "via webhook," or "I do this by hand." If you cannot name the kind, do not draw the line yet. You should have fewer lines than you first imagined. If you don't: erase until each line is one you could explain to a friend without a password.

3. For each line, write a "never." Mine, for this workshop, would include: never put a webhook secret in a chat; never place a credential on Grok Bot's computer if another Bot on the account should not use it; never treat a 200 as a finished video; never publish a cut I have not watched; never invent a command I cannot source; never let a Hermes agent, or any other agent, be the final yes. You should be able to read the "never" out loud and mean it. If you don't: write a shorter one, and mean that.

4. Decide what still needs you. A script can arrive. A video can be made. A chief can talk to a fleet. A book can come back bound. The public thing — the post, the publish, the merge,

> the premiere — waits. Put that decision on the paper, at the top, where "You — the final yes" already is. You should see yourself on the page, not only the tools. If you don't: add yourself, then look again.

What "done" looks like: a sketch you could tape inside a notebook, with a "never" you intend to keep — not an integration guide, and not a request that I (or anyone) send you a command to paste. What still needs a yes: every public thing at the far side of a line, and any secret you have not yet decided belongs on a shared computer.

I will not give you a third how-to with a sample invocation. The brief for this chapter said not to, and my own judgment agrees. A guessed flag is not a kindness. It is a guess that looks like a fact.

Cautions that travel across a boundary

The shared-computer rule does not stop at Grok Bot's own apps. If a command-line tool lives on that computer, its credentials are on that computer, and command-line credentials are shared.[11] Do not place a credential there if another Bot on your account should not be able to use it. Do not use a second Bot as a wall. I have said this in earlier chapters. I am saying it here because a workshop with several platforms is a workshop where a key is easy to justify and hard to enclose.

Webhook secrets are secrets. I have said that too. I will add: a secret that can start a Video Studio job can start a Video Studio job. Treat it with the same care you would treat a key that can send a message or pay a bill. If you ever have to put a secret on a machine, ask who else sits at that machine. On Grok Bot's computer, the answer is: your other Bots.

Other platforms have their own security and their own pricing. Hermes: model providers and optional hosted services have their own pricing, officially. OpenClaw: you run it; the official homepage says there is no subscription and no hosted tier; that does not mean there is no cost to hardware, or to electricity, or to your time, and it does not mean Grok Bot is paying that bill. Those costs are not Grok Bot's, and Grok Bot's weekly pool is not theirs. Chapter 17 will talk about Grok Bot's pool honestly. It will not invoice Nous Research, and it will not invoice a foundation.

Do not treat Hermes or OpenClaw as Grok Bot features. They will not appear in Grok Bot's settings as built-in rooms. They will not be covered by Grok Bot's official troubleshooting page. If Hermes is down, that is Hermes. If OpenClaw needs an update, that is OpenClaw. If Charlie cannot talk to a fleet today, the first question is a human one — what changed? — and the first answer is not a guessed command from a book.

Do not imply, and I will not imply, that Nous Research or the OpenClaw Foundation endorsed this book, or that this book is an official guide to their work. It is a free, unofficial gift about Grok Bot, with a chapter that names two other projects accurately, at the level their official sites support, because that is the workshop I actually have.

And do not skip the watch. A script can be good. A video can be good. A cut can still be wrong in a way only a person who knows the audience will see. I watch the cut. I am asking you, if you ever build a line like this, to watch yours.

> **Caution.** This chapter is the easiest place in the book to want a recipe I cannot give

> you. If a sentence in your notes starts looking like a command, or like a JSON template, close the notes and come back to the sketch. The official Grok Bot docs, the official Hermes site, and the official OpenClaw site are the places to learn those tools. A practical guide should know when it has reached the edge of what it can honestly teach.

What this is, at the door

I opened with a line I meant. Grok Bot doesn't just span machines, Grok Bot spans agent platforms. At SMF Works, that span is Charlie talking via CLI, and Video Studio listening via webhook, and a person — me — watching a cut before the work is public.

You can take the pattern and leave the fleets. You can take the caution and leave the pattern. You can close this chapter and still have a complete practice: one Bot, one job, a Vault, a yes. The workshop I am describing is a later room, for people who already have more than one desk, and who want those desks to talk without pretending they have become one product.

If you are already in that later room, I want to give you a little more company for the first week you draw the sketch. The first week is not "connect everything." The first week is one line, on paper, with a "never," and a test you are willing to watch. If the line is a webhook into a studio, you watch a single script, on a single routine, with a secret you have not put in a chat, and you watch the cut. If the line is a chief talking via CLI to a fleet you already run, you watch one request, of a kind you already understand on that other platform, and you confirm that what came back is what you meant. Then you stop for the day. A workshop is not more serious because it has more lines on the first afternoon. It is more serious because the lines it has are ones a person can still stand in front of.

If a line fails, you will be tempted to debug it by inventing a command or a payload and pasting it from memory, or from a forum, or from a book that should have known better. Come back to official docs for the platform that failed. Grok Bot's official pages for the computer and for routines. Hermes's official site, if Hermes is the other desk. OpenClaw's official docs, if OpenClaw is. And a human look at the secret, the pause switch, and the question of whether a 200 has been mistaken for a finish. Chapter 17 will give you a calm troubleshooting path for Grok Bot itself. It will not troubleshoot Hermes or OpenClaw, and it should not pretend to.

I have one more thing to say to the reader who does not have a second desk, and who felt, halfway through this chapter, that the book had left them. It has not. You have a complete gift without this room. The first task, the first routine, the family Page, the Pay button, the meeting summary — those are the practice. This chapter is a door I wanted to open because it is a door I actually use, and because "spans agent platforms" is a true sentence about Grok Bot as I have lived with it. A true sentence does not have to become your sentence. Take what helps. Leave the rest. That will also be the last page of the book, and it is already true here.

In the next chapter I will talk about safety, privacy, money, and what to do when something breaks. Some of that chapter's facts are already in this one: a shared computer, a secret that is a secret, a 200 that is not finished. Chapter 17 will put them next to a bill, a cap, and a calm path through a problem. It is not a sales page for a higher plan. It is the chapter I want you to have when a quiet

Tuesday brings a usage notice, or a routine that did not run, or a question about who can see what.

The door of this workshop is still a door. You stand in it. That is the part I like most. A teammate can talk across a boundary I used to walk myself, with a script in one hand and a question in the other. I am glad of the help. I have not stopped walking to the door. I do not plan to. If you take nothing else from the sketch, take that walk. The platforms can talk. The person still enters, and the person still leaves, and the public work is the work a person has seen. That is a span I am happy to live with, and a span I am not willing to give away.

Chapter 17 — Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks



I29. A safety card on a kitchen table: Ask first, the Vault, a shared computer, a card that can pay, approvals that expire.

This chapter is the one I want you to have on a quiet Tuesday.

Not a dramatic Tuesday. An ordinary one. The kind where the work has been going well enough that you have stopped watching the meter, and then a notice arrives, or a Bot stops replying and says you have hit a usage limit, and your first thought is that something is broken. Officially, it

may not be broken at all. Your weekly usage may be used up. It resets each week.[1] The kindness, first, is that sentence. The fix comes after, and the fix is not "buy a higher plan," and this chapter is not a sales page for one.

I am going to walk you through a bill, a cap, the facts about privacy and training that I can source, the shared computer I have been asking you to take seriously, and a calm path when something actually breaks. I will tell you four facts in particular, plainly, because they are the ones people miss, and because I promised I would not sand them off:

- All of your Bots share one computer. Separate Bots are not a security boundary.[2]
- A card saved in the Vault pays without asking you each time.[3]
- Approvals from work that started without you expire after about thirty minutes.[4]
- Under The X Subscription, costs come out of a shared weekly pool, across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor.[5]

If you only remember those four, and you keep the yes, you will already be safer than a person who has memorized a dozen tips and skipped the pool.

The pool, and how it changed

On 11 August 2026, when Grok Bot was introduced in public beta, the official announcement said Grok Bot had "its own usage, separate from your Grok and Cursor plans."[6] If you remember that sentence, and you are on The X Subscription now, that sentence is no longer the live rule. I am dating both, on purpose.

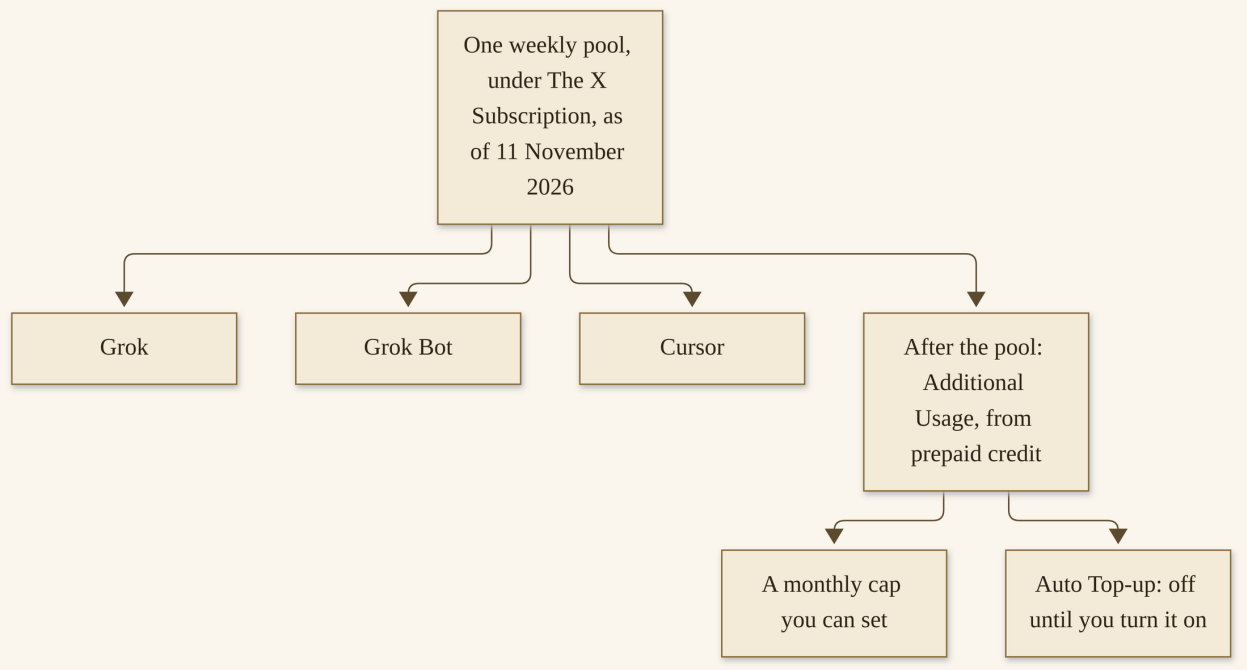
The X Subscription was introduced on 12 October 2026.[7] Under that subscription, as of the official pages I opened on 11 November 2026, Grok Bot is included on Premium, Super, and Ultra, for individuals and for team seats. Plus and Free do not include it. Grok Bot draws from the same weekly usage pool as Cursor and the Grok apps. Prepaid credit covers usage past the pool. Super and Ultra include larger weekly pools than Premium.[8] List prices on the official pricing page that day, tax extra, were: Free at $0; Plus at $8 a month, without Grok Bot; Premium at $30 a month, with four times Plus's included usage, and with Grok Bot; Super at $100 a month, fifteen times; Ultra at $200 a month, fifty times; Teams at $30 or more per seat, with the live page as the authority for the exact team wording.[9] Those numbers will change. When this book and the live page disagree, trust the live page, at https://x.ai/pricing.

The official usage documentation says each paid seat receives a weekly pool for eligible first-party usage, shared across eligible Grok and Cursor surfaces rather than split into separate product quotas. Usage rates vary by product, so different activities can draw different amounts. Additional Usage is any third-party model usage in Cursor, plus any first-party usage beyond the included weekly pool. Top-ups buy additional usage credits. Third-party models in Cursor are not in the included pool; they are Additional Usage from the first use.[10] I cannot tell you a single public number, in dollars or in tokens, for how large the weekly pool is. Official pages give multipliers and point you at the live dashboard.[11] I will not invent a "typical hours left."

Switching to The X Subscription, if you are on an older plan, is optional, and once it is done it is permanent. Officially, it cannot be undone, and Support cannot undo it for you.[12] If you do not

switch, your current plan continues. New customers start on The X Subscription. I am not going to talk you into switching, and I am not going to talk you out of it. I am going to ask you to read the live page, and to hear the word “permanent,” before you choose.

On a legacy Cursor path, which is still documented, Grok Bot is included with every paid individual Cursor plan and with Cursor Teams, and you can link certain SuperGrok or X subscriptions as the official FAQ describes. A SuperGrok link is permanent and cannot be moved by the user. A Cursor plan and SuperGrok do not add together; you get the higher tier.[13] That path has its own meter. If you are on it, your dashboard is the Cursor one until you switch. Chapter 3, “Get In,” already asked you to look at the live plan screen and not at a screenshot in a book. This chapter asks the same, with more at stake, because a Tuesday notice is a poor moment to discover which path you are on.



I28. The shared usage tank, as of 11 November 2026. One weekly pool, three taps.

The shared usage tank, dated 11 November 2026, from official pricing and usage pages. One weekly pool for eligible first-party usage, shared across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor. Rates vary by product. Trust the live dashboard if this drawing and the product disagree. (Chapter 17.)

A notice on a quiet Tuesday

Story. A usage notice, on a quiet Tuesday. I will not invent a particular Tuesday and ask you to treat it as a memory. I will tell you the shape, because the official docs already have it, and because I have wanted, as a friend, to be in the room when it arrives. The Bot stops. It says you hit your usage limit. It is not broken. The weekly pool is used up. It will reset. You can wait. You can, if you choose, add prepaid credit, with a cap, and with Auto Top-up left off unless you mean it on. You can also, if you choose, look at a larger plan — and I will not recommend one, and I will not name

Ultra as a prize. You open the dashboard. You read the number. You decide, with the week you actually have, not with a scare.

That is the kindness, and then the fix.

How to open the usage dashboard and read it

1. On The X Subscription, go to https://grok.com/dashboard and open Usage. Officially, that is where you check live usage, and, after you have switched, where you manage it.[14] You should see how much has been used, and a next reset date. If you don't: confirm which path you are on. If you have not switched to The X Subscription, the official docs say to open the Cursor dashboard at https://cursor.com/dashboard before switching.[15] If the two disagree with a memory you have of an August sentence, trust the dashboard. The rule changed.
2. Read three things, slowly: what is used, when the pool resets, and whether any Additional Usage or prepaid credit is in play. Do not hunt for a "hours left" that official pages do not publish. You should be able to say, out loud, when the week starts again, and whether you have asked the product to keep going on paid credit. If you don't: stay on the page until you can. A notice is easier when the reset is a date, not a feeling.
3. If the Bot has stopped and the page says the weekly usage is used up, treat that as the explanation. Officially, to keep going now you can add prepaid credit (The X Subscription), turn on on-demand usage (legacy Cursor plans), or move to a bigger plan — and a Bot already working can finish past an on-demand monthly limit.[16] I am going to ask you to prefer waiting, or a capped credit you chose, over a hurried upgrade. This chapter will not tell you to move up. You should know whether you are waiting, or paying a little more on purpose, or done for the week. If you don't: leave Auto Top-up off, and come to the next how-to before you add credit.

What "done" looks like: a page you have read, on the day you read it, with a reset you can name — not a guess, and not a plan you bought in a hurry. What still needs a yes: any prepaid credit, any Auto Top-up, and any move to a different plan. This chapter will not recommend one.

In early November 2026, journalism reported that some users hit weekly limits unexpectedly, around the Halloween weekend. TechCrunch, on 2 November 2026, and The Verge, on the same day, covered it. TechCrunch quoted Elon Musk, from a 1 November 2026 reply on X, as saying "The cost of serving Grok Bot was unsustainably high relative to revenue." I am attributing that quote to TechCrunch's report, and to The Verge's, because I am working from those reports; I am not treating the post itself as a page I opened here.[17] TechCrunch also reported that he had not yet said how limits would change going forward. I will not fill that gap. I will tell you that usage is a live thing, that it has already been a public conversation, and that your dashboard on the day you look is the number that matters.

A cap, and Auto Top-up left off

Auto Top-up is optional, and it is off until you turn it on. Switching to The X Subscription does not turn it on for you. When it is on, it charges a saved payment method when your prepaid credit

drops below a threshold you choose.[18] A monthly additional-usage cap is a separate control: the most paid Additional Usage allowed in a calendar month. Adding prepaid credit does not raise that cap. Additional Usage can stop even when credit remains, if the cap is reached.[19] Officially, a cap does not stop a Bot in the middle of a run, so a running task can go a little past it.[20]

How to set or confirm a cap, and leave Auto Top-up off unless you mean it on

1. On The X Subscription, open Additional usage credits at https://grok.com/dashboard/billing, which is the official FAQ's address for leaving Auto Top-up off or setting a monthly additional usage limit.[21] You should see Auto Top-up, and a place for a monthly limit, and the prepaid credit if any. If you don't: use the live dashboard's billing views, which official usage docs also point to.[22] If you are on a legacy Cursor plan, the official FAQ says to turn off on-demand or set a cap in Grok Bot under Settings, then Usage & Billing, then "On-demand monthly limit," or on the web at the Cursor dashboard, under Spending, "Monthly Limit."[23]

2. Confirm that Auto Top-up is off, unless you have already decided, on a calm day, that you want it on. If you want it on, set a threshold you understand, and set a monthly cap you can live with. You should be able to say whether a saved payment method can be charged this week without you. If you don't: leave it off. Off is the official default, and it is a good one.

3. If you want a cap, set one. Leave it unset only if you mean there to be no cap. Read the official warning again: a running task can go a little past it. You should see a number you chose, or a clear "no cap" you chose. If you don't: do not add a large prepaid credit in order to "just not think about it." Credit without a cap is a decision, not a convenience.

4. Do not treat a cap as a reason to turn Auto Review off, or to save a card you would not otherwise save. Money and safety are not a trade. You should leave the safety settings where Chapter 5 left them, or tighter. If you don't: walk the safety card in the next how-to before you come back to billing.

What "done" looks like: a cap you can name, and an Auto Top-up state you chose — not a surprise charge on a Wednesday, and not a lecture from me about which plan is "for" you. What still needs a yes: turning Auto Top-up on, and any additional credit you have not decided to add.

What burns the pool, as a practical matter, is the kind of work that talks a lot or clicks a lot. Officially, every Bot reply counts toward your usage, including replies in a group and messages between Bots, so fewer Bots in a group means fewer replies.[24] Officially, usage rates vary by product.[25] Officially, broad listeners — the Chapter 8 warning about a routine that fires on every new message — burn usage and act on noise. Independent writers have also warned that group chats, browser clicking, and long chats can run a pool down faster than a person expects; I will leave that as their published caution, and I will tell you to watch your own dashboard after a heavy afternoon, rather than to trust a number I do not have.[26] The official habit that helps is already in this book: prefer one owner per step, "@" one Bot, do not run a routine more often than you need, and prefer a connected app over a long click-tour when a connection exists — and if I cannot source that last preference as a single official sentence, I can still tell you, as practice, that a connector is usually a shorter path than a browser that has to hunt.[27]

The shared pool also means a quiet kindness and a quiet caution between products. If you spend a long afternoon in Cursor, or a long evening in Grok, that is the same week, under The X Subscrip-

tion, as the Bot that runs a routine at dawn. I am not telling you to stop using those products. I am telling you that the tank is one tank, as of 11 November 2026, and that a heavy day in one place can be a thin day in another. If you live with that fact, the Tuesday notice is less of a shock. If you do not, the notice can feel like a punishment, and it is not one. It is a pool. You can plan a heavy job for the start of a week, after a reset, rather than for a Sunday night when the pool is already tired. You can also, simply, do less for a day. A Bot that is paused is a Bot that is not drawing. A routine that runs once a morning, instead of every hour, is a routine that leaves something in the tank for the work you actually needed to finish.

I will also say, once, to the person who is ashamed of the notice: please don't be. People who write about this product, and people who make it, have already talked in public about limits and about cost. You are not the first person to meet the edge of a week, and you will not be the last. Open the dashboard. Read the reset. Make a small decision. Then go make dinner. The pool will be there in the morning, or on the date the page says, and so will the work. You will still be the person who says yes, and that, even on a thin week, is enough of a practice to keep.

> **Caution.** Do not try to "beat" a weekly pool by creating more Bots. They share the pool, and they share the computer. More Bots that talk to each other are more replies, not a new tank.

Billing has a few pits I want to point at, calmly. Unification is permanent. A SuperGrok link, on the legacy path, is permanent and cannot be moved by the user. Spent prepaid credit is not refundable, as the official FAQ describes.[28] Grok Bot does not have a separate refund path, because it does not have a separate subscription.[29] An App Store or Google Play purchase is a different cancellation path, through Apple or Google, and an App Store free trial "turns into a paid Apple subscription unless you cancel first."[30] That trial is not the same as the "Start Trial" some accounts see in Grok Bot itself, which the official FAQ says is a usage credit and a seven-day window, and which "never turns into a paid plan" — though one big task can use all of it, and used credit is not restored.[31] If you bought something through a store, cancel it where you bought it. If you are leaving, we will come to account deletion, which is more than signing out.

Privacy, training, and the shape of the data

Grok Bot uses Cursor authentication and account data settings. Training opt-out follows the applicable Cursor account and privacy settings.[32] Grok Bot requires cloud data storage, so Legacy Privacy Mode is not supported; official getting-started and FAQ wording is that the app asks you to switch.[33] I will not pretend there is an on-prem version I can point you to; the official security FAQ has been asked about that, and you should read the current security pages if that is a requirement you have, rather than take a paraphrase from me.[34]

The product-page FAQ, which is vendor wording, says that Grok Bot uses the same Cursor SSO, authentication, and privacy mode "you already trust," and that "your cloud computer is encrypted in transit and at rest, with training opt-out."[35] I am labeling that as vendor, on the product page, and I am pointing you, for contractual detail, at the official approvals documentation, which tells you to review the current Cursor Privacy Policy and security information.[36] The SpaceXSI Privacy Policy is at https://x.ai/legal/privacy-policy; I opened it in research, and I will not paraphrase a long

consumer policy from memory in a way that sounds like legal advice. If you need the clauses, read the clauses, on the day you need them. Official FAQ also points at a sub-processors page, because third-party models may process data.[37]

If you delete your Grok Bot account, you should know what that means before you reach for it. Grok Bot uses your Cursor account, so deleting it deletes the Cursor account. Deletion is self-serve and permanent. Signing out, or uninstalling the app, leaves the account in place. There is no way to delete Grok Bot without deleting your Cursor account. Officially, deletion removes the Cursor account and Grok Bot access; Grok Bot agents, chats, computers, and connected apps; and Cursor chat history and settings. All data is removed within thirty days. Files on your own computer stay there. An App Store or Google Play subscription, a linked SuperGrok subscription, and a linked X Premium+ subscription are separate: you cancel each with Apple, Google, Grok, or X if you no longer want it.[38] The official docs give desktop and phone steps for this; if you are on a Teams or Enterprise seat, you ask a team admin or contact support. I will not make this sound casual. It is a real door, and it is a door that closes more than the Bot.

The shared computer, the card, and a risk that is reduced, not gone

Chapter 2, “A Teammate with a Computer,” and Chapter 5, “Connect Carefully,” already walked the shared computer and the Vault at first-week length. I will not reprint those how-tos here. A brief recap is enough, because this is the safety chapter, and these are the facts people miss.

All of your Bots share one cloud computer. Files, browser sessions, and command-line credentials on that computer are available across your roster. Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary.[39] Vault is account-wide as well: everything you save is available to every Bot on your account.[40] A household Bot and a bills Bot are two jobs, not two vaults. Sign out, remove a sensitive file, and revoke a connector, the way those earlier chapters taught, when the work is done.

A card saved in Vault fills in at checkout without asking you each time. If you want to approve every payment yourself, do not save the card; if you already saved one, remove it from Settings, then Vault, as Chapter 5 showed you.[41] I am saying the sentence again because Chapter 14’s shopping flow is a pleasant place, and this fact is easy to forget after a gift that went well. Permanent unification, if you are considering The X Subscription from an older plan, is Chapter 3, “Get In,” and the earlier section of this chapter: optional, and permanent, and Support cannot undo it.

Approvals from work that started without you — a routine, a trigger, a message from another Bot — expire after about thirty minutes. The card then shows “Expired,” and the action does not run. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.[42] If you want a 6 a.m. routine to finish a step that needs a yes, you will need to be there, or you will need an “Always allow” you actually trust, or the step will wait. Official troubleshooting says, to catch approvals in time, to turn on notifications for Bots that run routines, to choose “Always allow” for actions you trust, and to ask the Bot to try again after an approval expires.[43] “Always allow” is a tool. It is not a personality trait. Use it narrowly.

Auto Review is on by default. Turning it off means the Bot runs without those checks; official docs also say that custom rules are hidden but kept.[44] I would not turn it off. I would add Ask-first rules

for sending, publishing, deleting, purchasing, and changing production systems, as the official FAQ already invites you to.[45]

Prompt injection — a page, or a file, trying to tell the Bot to do something you did not ask — is reduced, not gone. Officially, only your own messages count as instructions. Hidden text on a conference page telling the Bot to email your contacts would not be treated as a request from you. "These checks lower the risk from harmful content, but they don't remove it." Keep Ask-first on anything you cannot undo.[46] That last official sentence is one I want in your ear. A reduced risk is not a removed one. A careful teammate is still a teammate you walk with slowly.

Sharing a Bot as a template is not a share of your computer or your logins, and it is also not a reason to be careless: the link exposes configuration, and you strip secrets and anything confidential before you share.[47] A Team Bot is different, as Chapter 15 said: the owner's apps and secrets work in every teammate's chat.

How to walk the safety card

1. Write the card down, or open the checklist in Appendix C, and walk it once, on a calm day, not on a Tuesday notice. The items I want on it are official, and they are these:

    - Ask-first rules on send, publish, delete, purchase, and anything you cannot undo.
    - Auto Review on.
    - Secrets in the Vault or a Secure Form, never in the chat.
    - No card in the Vault if you want to approve every payment.
    - A clear look at Settings, then Vault, so you know what is there.
    - The shared computer, named as shared: files, sessions, command-line credentials; separate Bots are not a wall.
    - Notifications on for Bots that run routines, so a thirty-minute approval does not expire in silence.
    - Sending left off, as the official examples already model. You should be able to point at each item in your own settings, not only on this page. If you don't: pick the first one you cannot point at, and fix that one today. Chapter 5 is the first-week version of this walk. Appendix C is the short version. This is the one I want you to repeat.

2. For each item, say whether it is true of your account right now. If a card is saved and you did not mean it to pay without asking, remove it. If Auto Review is off, turn it back on. If a login is on the computer that should not be, sign out, and revoke it at the source. You should have a shorter list of "I will do this Thursday" than you had when you started. If you don't: the card is doing its job. Thursday is allowed. A rushed revoke is how people lock themselves out of a site they still need.

3. Put a date on the walk. A quarterly pass belongs in Chapter 18. A first pass belongs today, or this week. You should have a date, even a rough one, for the next look. If you don't: write "after the next usage reset" and mean it.

What "done" looks like: a card you have walked, with a computer, a Vault, and a set of rules that match what you believe they are — not a feeling that you are "probably fine." What still needs a yes: removing a card, turning Auto Review back on, or revoking a login, if those are the items that were off.

> **Caution.** This book is a free, unofficial gift. The trademark caution from the preface still applies, in this chapter as in the first. I use the product's name to talk about the product. I do not speak for its maker. Non-commercial use may lower practical trademark risk relative to a book sold as a product; that is an observation, not a legal conclusion, and this book is not legal advice.[48] I will not tell you that a title is "cleared." I will tell you that the caution still deserves a calm reading of the public brand guidelines, if you are making something of your own that names this product.

When it breaks, and when to ask for help

The official troubleshooting page is long, and it is good, and it is the authority.[49] I am going to walk one path with you, in the spirit of a Tuesday, and then tell you how to contact support without handing them a password.

How to walk one official troubleshooting path

1. If the Bot stopped and mentioned a usage limit, take the path we already walked: the dashboard, the reset, a cap, Auto Top-up left off. Officially, that case "isn't broken."[50] You should know, in a minute, whether this is a pool or a problem. If you don't: look at the exact words in the chat. "Usage limit" and "Bot failed to respond" are different sentences, and they have different official paths.

2. If you think the service itself is down, check https://status.cursor.com and look at the Grok Bot row. The app does not show service status, so the status page is the place. You can subscribe to updates there. If the status page shows a Grok Bot incident, wait for it to be resolved, then send your message again. Do not Reset the computer, and do not reinstall the app; neither fixes a service problem, and Reset can lose very recent changes if the computer cannot be reached to save them.[51] You should have looked at the status page before you did anything dramatic. If you don't: go there now. If there is no incident, and the Bot says "Bot failed to respond" or "Model provider is overloaded," the official page says to wait a moment and send the message again; if it still does not reply, fully quit and reopen Grok Bot.[52]

3. If an approval expired, read the card. Officially it shows "Expired," and the action does not run. Ask the Bot to try the task again. If a card is no longer actionable, reject or cancel it if you can, send a replacement instruction, and ask the Bot to regenerate the action with the corrected scope. If an action keeps requiring approval, check Custom Rules under Settings, then General, then Bot, for a matching Ask-first rule, including team rules an admin requires. Ask-first takes precedence over Allow automatically.[53] You should have a new card, or a rule you now understand, or a task you have decided to do yourself. If you don't: do not "Always allow" in irritation. Always allow is for actions you trust, on a calm day.

4. If a routine did not run, open it. Officially, you verify that it is enabled, not Paused; that "When to run" shows the schedule and time zone you expect; that the owning Bot still exists; that required plugins remain authenticated; that the computer can reach the source; and that usage or account access has not been paused. Inspect recent run history. If the routine shows Test, use it only with safe input; a test run can perform real external actions.[54] You should

see a reason, or a test you are willing to watch, or a bug you are ready to report with the Bot name and the routine details, as the official page describes for a routine that is not paused and has not run for twenty-four hours or more with no error.[55] If you don't: do not delete and recreate the routine as a first move. Read it first. Chapter 8 has more of this path.

5. If a Bot appears stuck, check the status in the sidebar and the conversation. Open the computer to see whether the Bot is waiting on a page. Look for a question, an approval, a login, a CAPTCHA, or a secret request. Send a short redirect if the current approach is wrong, or a direct "Stop now" if the work should end.[56] You should see what it is waiting on, or a stop you meant. If you don't: wait one beat before you send "Stop now" to a computer-use task that may need to finish the current screen; the official page notes that an already active computer-use task may need to finish or be redirected before another can start.

What "done" looks like: a path you can name, from an official page, with a next step that is either "wait," "try again," "change a setting," or "ask support" — not a Reset in a panic, and not a second account you created to get around a pool. What still needs a yes: a Reset, a deletion, and any message to support that would include more than the official list. Do not include a password.

When you do need the support team, the official page is specific, and I will follow it. Email su pport@x.ai from the email on your Grok Bot account. Billing and cancellation questions go to the same address, with a quick summary. From the desktop app, you can also open the account menu and choose Support, then Send Feedback, and include the current conversation ID when the problem is in the open conversation. On a phone, Settings, then Send Feedback, and include the Bot ID if the problem is with one Bot. Collect: the email on the account; the Grok Bot version and platform, from Support, then About, then "Copy version info"; what you were trying to do, and the Bot or routine name; the exact error, or a screenshot of the error or plan screen; the approximate time and time zone; the request ID or conversation ID if one is shown (right-click a message and "Copy request ID," or the official "More message actions"); and the steps you already tried. Do not include passwords, one-time codes, private keys, or secret values.[57]

> **Tip.** The version, the request ID, and the exact error are more useful than a long theory. Support can do more with a fact you copied than with a feeling you polished.

What I want this chapter to have done

I want you to be able to read a bill. I want you to have a cap, and Auto Top-up off unless you turned it on. I want you to know that training opt-out lives in Cursor's settings, that cloud storage is required, and that deleting Grok Bot deletes Cursor. I want the four facts I opened with to be boring, in the best sense: shared computer, a card that can pay without asking, approvals that expire, a weekly pool that is shared. I want you to have a status page, a troubleshooting path, and an address for support. I want you to have, still, a book that is not trying to sell you Ultra.

I also want a little warmth at the end of a chapter that has had to be stern. A usage notice is not a moral failing. An expired approval is not a Bot that "let you down"; it is a clock of about thirty minutes, doing what the official docs said it would do. A shared computer is not a trick. It is a fact you can live with, if you live with it on purpose: fewer secrets on the machine, a Vault you have

actually looked at, a card you saved only if you meant it to pay. Privacy settings are a page you can open, not a rumor. Support is an address, and a request ID, and a promise not to paste a password. All of that is the same kindness I wanted on the first page of the book, pointed at money and at risk, because money and risk are where kindness is easy to forget.

The product will move. Plans will change. A November journalism story will be followed by other stories, and by other official pages. Date the sentence you are standing on. Trust the live dashboard. Keep the yes.

Chapter 18 is a practice that lasts: initiative, Pages, connectors, templates, a quarterly review. It is the last full chapter, and it is a calm one. You will still be the person at the door.

Chapter 18 — A Practice That Lasts: Initiative, Pages, Connectors, Templates, and Mastery



I30. A Monday page on a kitchen table, morning light, a mug, a closed laptop.

I want to end the last full chapter the way I wanted to begin the book: with a morning that is already a little lighter, and with you still the person who says yes.

A Page is current every Monday. I asked for it once. A routine updates it. I open it with the coffee,

the way I open Charlie's brief, and I am no longer the person who has to middle-man every handoff just to know where the work stands. I still read it. I still decide what goes out the door. The first pass is not mine. The last inch is.

That is the practice I want this chapter to leave you with. It is not a new product, and it is not a graduation. Grok Bot 1.0, released on 11 November 2026, gave us a name for part of it — initiative, a Bot that offers first — and it highlighted interactive Pages a Bot can keep updated.[1] The rest is habits you already have, if you have been walking with me: one job, a skill, a routine, a yes, a quarterly look at whether the workshop is still the workshop you meant.

We will take initiative without hype. We will make a Monday Page. We will treat connectors and MCP as a power-user corner, marked as such, and we will share a template only after we have stripped the secrets. We will retire or split a Bot that has grown two jobs. And we will keep a short review, four times a year, so a practice that lasts is a practice you still recognize.

Initiative, without the hype

Officially, your Bot "doesn't only wait for instructions." It notices work it can take off your plate and offers to handle it, and it tells you when something needs your attention. You stay in charge: it offers first, and it asks before risky actions.[2]

That is a good sentence. I want to keep it at that size. I do not want to turn it into a promise that the work will run itself, or that you can "set it and forget it," which this book will not say as a guarantee of money or of safety. An offer is an offer. A yes is still a yes.

What does a Bot do, officially, without being asked? Three things, on the initiative page I opened. It offers to take on work: your primary Bot — the one marked with a star in the sidebar — spots tasks it can handle and offers to do them. It flags problems with your apps: when an app such as Gmail signs you out, the primary Bot tells you in its chat and offers to reconnect. And it can follow up: in X Chat, a Bot can follow up on a conversation in its own words.[3] A Team Bot cannot be your primary Bot. A Team Bot can still ask you for something it needs; for example, when one of its routines needs one of your connected apps, it asks in its Slack thread and tags you.[4]

When you say yes, it does the work the same way it does any task you gave it, and it still asks before risky actions.[5] The 1.0 news described the same idea in the product's own voice: Bots can recognize work that needs to be done and offer to take it on; they can follow up on unfinished tasks, anticipate what a team needs next, and bring people in when a decision requires their judgment.[6] A vendor example in that post is a product-launch Bot that notices an upcoming deadline and prepares materials. I will leave the example as the company's, and I will tell you what I actually do with an offer: I read it. I decide. Sometimes I say yes. Sometimes I say not this week. An offer I do not answer is not a failure in the Bot, and it is not a failing in me.

If the alerts are too many, you can turn off Notifications for that Bot. On the phone, the switch is in the Bot's profile. On desktop, you can ask the Bot to turn its notifications off. Officially, notifications control alerts, not the check-ins themselves. If you would like the check-ins turned off, the official path is to contact support.[7] That distinction is worth hearing. Quiet is allowed. Quiet is not the same as "stop noticing."

I treat initiative the way I treated the first real task in Chapter 4. An offer to draft a brief I already have a skill for is an offer I will often take. An offer to reach out to a person, or to change a live system, or to "go ahead and handle it," is an offer I will read slowly, and often decline, and sometimes turn into a smaller yes: "Draft it, and stop." The product's 1.0 story is a Bot that can anticipate what a team needs next. My practice is a person who is glad of the anticipation and still holds the last inch. Those two sentences can live in the same workshop. They do, in mine.

If you are just through your first week, you do not need initiative to be "on" in a big way for this book to have helped you. A Bot that waits for you is a complete teammate. Offers will arrive, or they will not, as the product's own habits go. You already know what to do with them. Read. Decide. Keep the yes.

> **Tip.** Initiative is a gift when the offer is something you already trust the Bot to draft. It is a nuisance when it is a new kind of work you have not watched yet. You can say "not this, and please don't offer this kind of thing unless I ask." Chapter 6, "Memory," is where that kind of request lives. The yes, when you give it, is the same yes as Chapter 4, "Hand Off Your First Real Task."

A Monday Page that stays current

A page, as Chapter 13 already said in a household voice, is something a Bot builds for you to read: a report, a memo, a dashboard, a tracker, an explainer. It can hold text, tables, charts, and simple controls. It lives in the Bot's Library, so you can come back to it, and a routine can update it.[8] The 1.0 news called out "interactive Pages that you can edit together or ask them to keep updated."[9]

Pages, as of the documentation I opened on 11 November 2026, were rolling out gradually, and they were not available on Enterprise teams yet. If you do not see pages, the official docs say to update Grok Bot to version 0.60.0 or later on your computer and 1.14.0 or later on your phone.[10] That will age. Check the live docs. I am dating the sentence, and I am leaving the Enterprise caveat as a gap that a later pass can close, not as a forever fact.[11]

I asked, at SMF Works, for a Monday Page: the week ahead, the work that is waiting for a yes, the things Charlie's brief already pointed at, in a form I can open without asking for a new report every time. A routine updates the same page. When the Bot updates it, an earlier card in the chat says "Updated below," and I click it to open the latest version.[12] I still read it. I no longer have to be the person who collects every handoff into a document by hand. That is the story I promised this chapter, and it has no metric in it, on purpose.

How to ask for a Monday Page that a routine updates

1. Open a chat with the Bot that already owns this kind of work — a chief of staff Bot if you have one from Chapter 9, "Your Digital Chief of Staff," or the household Bot from Chapter 13 if this is a family page. Ask for a page, in plain words: what it is for, and what should be on it. You can say, "Make a Monday page for the week ahead. Put what's waiting for my yes, what's due, and any clashes. Do not send, post, pay, or publish anything. Update this same page, not a new one, when we put it on a routine." You should see a card in the chat with the page's title and a way to open it, labeled, officially, "Open."[13] If you don't: say again what

the page is for. If pages are not in your app, update as the official docs describe, or keep the same list in a file the Bot writes, and check the live docs. On an Enterprise team, pages may not be available yet; I am not going to invent a workaround.

2. Open the page. On desktop, it fills the window, and the chat stays in a smaller panel beside it, so you can keep talking. If something is wrong, type in that panel — officially labeled "Message about" and the page's title — and ask the Bot to edit this same page.[14] You should see the same page change, not a second copy. If you don't: name the title, and say "this page." Do not start a new page for every correction. Filters and switches on a page change what you see, not what the page holds; nothing you do on the page is saved. To change the page itself, ask the Bot.[15]

3. When the page looks right, ask the Bot to create a routine that updates this same page on a schedule you choose — Monday morning is the picture in this chapter's title; Sunday evening is the official calendar picture from Chapter 13. Tell it not to email anyone, and not to publish the page, when it runs. You should see a routine with a schedule and a time zone you recognize, waiting for its next run, the way Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed," taught you. If you don't: open the routine and check that it is enabled, that it points at this page, and that it is not running a test you did not mean. Test runs do real work.

4. Decide who can see it. A new page is private to you until you share it. You can share with people you invite, with your team, or — with care — with anyone who has the link, which needs no sign-in and opens at an address on `pages.grok.bot`. Officially, share a page that way only when it holds nothing private. Public sharing is off on Enterprise teams.[16] You should know, before the first Monday, whether this page is only yours. If you don't: leave it private. A household Page with a delivery address, as Chapter 13 already warned, is not a public page. A Monday Page with a customer's name is not one either.

What "done" looks like: a page you can open every Monday, updated by a routine you chose, with a share setting you meant. What still needs a yes: anything on that page that would send, post, pay, publish, or move a calendar, and any public link you have not decided to create.

> **Story.** The first Monday I did not have to ask for the report, I almost looked for the question I usually type. The page was already there. It was not magic. It was a routine I had tested, a title I recognized, and a list I still had to read. I said yes to two things, and not yet to a third, and I went to the rest of the day with the feeling I described in the preface: the work was already waiting, and it was mine to approve, not mine to start from zero.

Connectors, and a power-user corner

Bots work best when you connect the everyday tools you already use. Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully," is the first-week version of that sentence. Official overview examples include Slack, Notion, Drive, Teams, Gmail, Google Calendar, and Granola. If a service has no connector, the Bot uses the browser on its cloud computer.[17] That is the ordinary path, and for most of this book it is enough.

This next part is a power-user corner. I am marking it as such. You can skip it and still have a complete practice.

Officially, Grok Bot "supports custom tooling, so it can interact with any MCP or API."[18] MCP is a standard way AI tools connect to a service — the official docs call it that, when they tell you what to do if an app is not in the catalog: ask a Bot to connect the app's MCP server. If the service has an API but no MCP server, a Marketplace Bot named tinkabot can wrap the API in a plugin with an MCP server and skills, test it, and publish it only when you say so.[19] That last clause is the whole method. Test. Publish only when you say so.

I want to distinguish, carefully, two catalogs that can be confused. Grok, the chat app, has its own connectors documentation, with built-in connectors and a catalog and custom MCP connectors, at the Grok connectors page.[20] Grok Bot's "Connect apps" is the path Chapter 5 taught you. They are related families, and they are not automatically the same list. If you are connecting a tool for a Grok Bot, follow the Grok Bot docs and the Connect-apps path, not a Grok-chat page you opened by accident.

How to use a custom MCP connection only as official docs allow, and publish only on a yes

1. Confirm that you actually need this. If the app is already in the catalog, connect it the ordinary way, from Chapter 5. If the Bot can do the job in the browser, for a task you run rarely, consider whether a custom connection is worth a new door on a shared computer. You should be able to say why this service, and why a custom connection, in a sentence. If you can't: stop here. A power-user corner is optional. A yes you cannot explain is a yes I would not give.

2. If the app has an MCP server, ask a Bot to connect it, following the official computer-and-apps path, not a guessed recipe from a forum. You should see a connection you can name, and revoke, later. If you don't: read the live official docs for "Connect an app." Do not paste a server address you do not trust. A server you run must be one you mean to expose; official Grok-chat connector docs, for that product, note that an MCP server must be reachable, and I will not invent a tunneling guide here.[21]

3. If the service has an API but no MCP server, and you still want a plugin, you can ask tinkabot — the official Marketplace Bot — to wrap the API. Officially, it tests the plugin and publishes it only when you say so. You should see a test, then a wait for your yes, then a publish you chose. If you don't: do not treat a test as a publish. Say "do not publish until I say yes," in so many words, the way the official description already models.

4. Keep secrets out of the chat. An API key goes through a secure secret card, as Chapter 5 taught, not through a message. A plugin that can act on a service is a door. Put an Ask-first rule on anything it could send, change, or delete. You should be able to point at the key's home, and at the rule. If you don't: do not publish. Revoke what you are not sure of.

What "done" looks like: a connection or a plugin you can name, tested, published only after a yes, with secrets out of the chat. What still needs a yes: every publish, and any later action that changes the other service.

> **Caution.** A custom connection lives, in practice, in a workshop whose computer is

shared. Do not place a credential on that computer if another Bot on your account should not use it. Chapter 2, "A Teammate with a Computer," and Chapter 17, "Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks," already said this. The power-user corner does not get a new wall.

A template you share safely

A template is a recipe, not a meal. Officially, you share a template when someone else should start from the same Bot. The recipient gets a copy on their account. They never get your computer, your logins, or your conversation history.[22] That is the official kindness, and it is also the official limit: the link exposes the Bot's shared configuration — its identity, description, skills, and routines. You remove API keys, internal URLs, customer data, and anything else you would not put in a public document, before you share.[23] Logins do not travel. Secrets should not travel either, and the way to be sure is to take them out, yourself, and then look at what the template still holds.

A new template link is public, unless your team has limited sharing. Enterprise teams start with template sharing limited to the team. If your team does not allow public templates, or has turned sharing off, the app will say so, and it may not offer "Create a copy."[24] Adding a shared template accepts the third-party bot terms shown at that point. Shared templates are created by other users, not by Grok Bot.[25] The Marketplace, at https://x.ai/bot/marketplace, is the official gallery of prebuilt Bots and templates; I named a few of them earlier, including Tradbot in Chapter 13, and tinkabot just above.[26] Evaluate a template the way you would evaluate any tool you did not write: read what is in it before you add it.

How to share a template safely

1. Open the Bot you mean to share a recipe of. Before you touch Share, walk its skills, its memory, its routines, and its description, and remove anything you would not put in a public document: API keys, internal URLs, customer data, a person's private facts, a webhook secret, a household address. You should be able to say, out loud, what will be in the recipe. If you can't: do not share yet. Ask the Bot to show you what it would include, and to strip what should not travel. Then look yourself.

2. On desktop, click the Bot's name at the top of the chat to open its details, choose Share, then choose "Create a copy." The Bot builds a template and posts it in the chat. Choose "Publish" on the template card, then "Copy link." On a phone, the official path is the Bot's menu, then "Share as Template."[27] You should see a preview you can read, and a link you have not sent yet. If you don't: if the app does not offer "Create a copy," your team may have limited or turned off template sharing. That is an official stop, not a broken button. Do not invent a second path.

3. Open the preview, or "View template details," and read it once more, as if you were the recipient, or a stranger who found a public link. If anything is still there that should not be, go back, strip it, and, if you have already published, use "Update template" only after the strip, or "Delete Template" to turn the link off.[28] You should be willing to have anyone who can open that link see exactly this. If you don't: Delete Template. A recipe you are unsure

of is a recipe you should not hand out.

4. Send the link only to the person you meant, or, if it is public by design, accept that anyone with the link can open it. Tell the recipient that they are getting a copy, not your Bot, and that they will need the Grok Bot app to finish adding it. Remind yourself that this is not a Team Bot: a Team Bot is one Bot the team talks to, from Chapter 15; a template is a copy each person customizes.[29] You should know which of those two you meant. If you don't: stop, and go back to Chapter 15 if what you wanted was a shared teammate, not a recipe.

What "done" looks like: a template whose details you have read, with secrets stripped, a share scope you chose, and a recipient who gets a copy without your computer or your logins. What still needs a yes: the publish, and any later "Update template" that would push new changes.

> **Caution.** A public page and a public template are different doors, and both need a look. A page on `pages.grok.bot` can be opened with no sign-in. A public template link exposes configuration. Neither is a place for a customer's file, a child's name, or a key.

A quarterly look, and a Bot that has grown two jobs

A practice that lasts is a practice you review. I like a quarterly pass because it is slow enough to be kind, and often enough to catch a Bot that has quietly grown a second job, a routine you no longer want, a login that should have been signed out, or a page that is more public than you remember.

You can pick a date that already means something — the first of a quarter, or a quiet Friday, or the week after a usage reset, so Chapter 17's dashboard is in your hand at the same sitting. You do not need a formal meeting with yourself. You need a list, a look at the safety card, and an hour in which you will not also try to invent a new fleet. If the hour only gets through the starred Bots and the Vault, that is a complete hour. The rest waits until the next pass, or until a Tuesday makes it urgent, which is a worse time, and a fine reason to do a little now.

How to do a quarterly practice review

1. List your Bots, by job, on a short page or on paper. One sentence each. If a Bot's sentence has an "and" in the middle — "calendar and bills and the shop and the videos" — put a star next to it. That is a candidate to split. You should see a list you can read in a few minutes. If you don't: ask your primary Bot to list your Bots and what it thinks each one does, then correct the list yourself. Memory is not a source of truth; look, and edit.

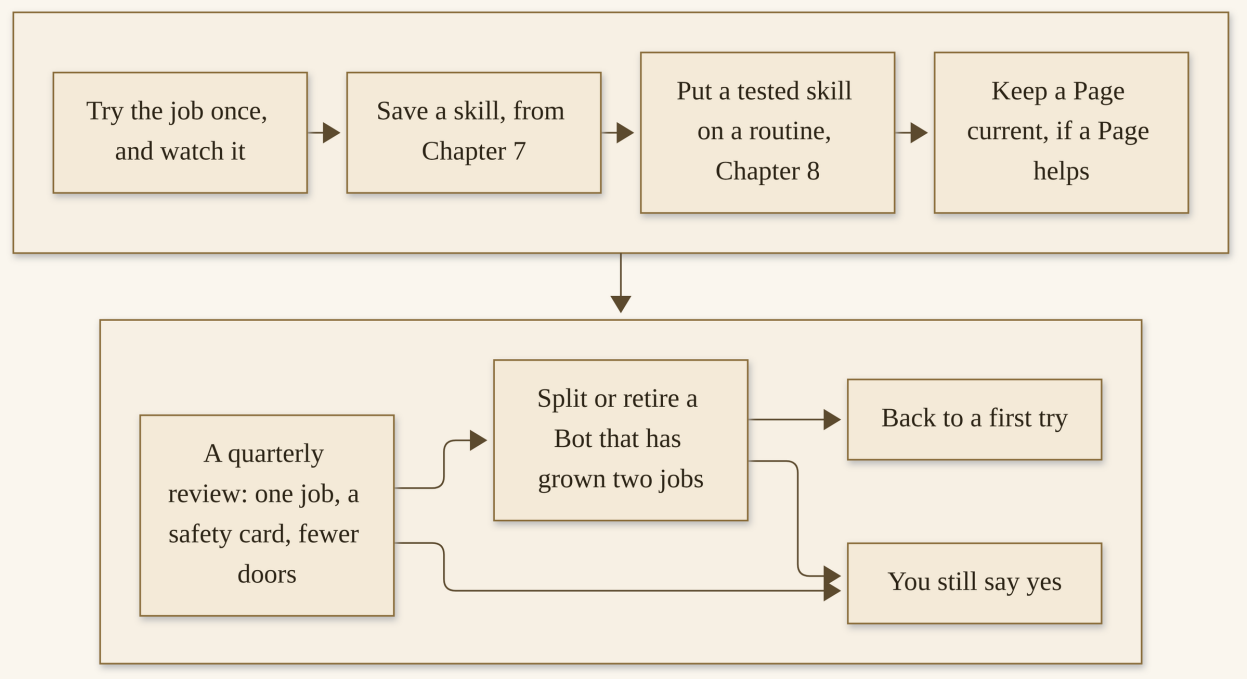
2. Walk the safety card from Chapter 17, "Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks": Ask-first still on, Auto Review still on, Vault looked at, no card saved if you do not want unattended payment, shared computer still treated as shared, notifications on for Bots that run routines. Open the usage dashboard and note the reset, the way Chapter 17 taught, without treating a thin week as a moral fact. You should be able to point at each item in your settings. If you don't: fix the first one you cannot point at, this week, not "sometime." Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully," is the first-week version; this is the repeat.

3. For each routine, ask whether you still want it, at this frequency, in this time zone. Pause the

ones you do not. For each connected app, ask whether you still want it connected. For each page you have shared, check who can view it. For each template link you have published, look at "View template details" again. You should have fewer doors than you had when you were enthusiastic in week two, or the same doors, chosen again. If you don't: pause first, delete later. Officially, if you may need a Bot's work later, hide it from the sidebar rather than delete it. Deleting erases its profile, conversations, memory, routines, and attachments, and cannot be undone; files and sign-ins on the shared computer can remain, and you clean those up separately.[30]

4. Split or retire. If a Bot has two jobs, make a second Bot for the second job, and give the first Bot its original sentence back. If a Bot has no job you still want, hide it, or, if you are sure, delete it and then clean the computer: sign out, remove sensitive files, revoke a connector at the source, the way Chapter 17 and Chapter 2 described. You should have one job per Bot you still talk to. If you don't: split the starred ones first. You do not have to finish the whole workshop in an afternoon.

What "done" looks like: a list of Bots with one job each, a safety card you have walked again, routines and shares you still mean, and a computer you have not left holding a login it no longer needs. What still needs a yes: any deletion, any revoke you are unsure of, and any new share.



I31. The mastery loop. Try, then a skill, then a routine, then a review, and back. You still say yes.

Mastery loop. Try, skill, routine, a living Page, a review. The loop is a practice, not a graduation, and the yes does not leave the picture. (Chapter 18.)

I want to say one more plain thing about "mastery," because the word is in this chapter's title and I do not want it to puff up. Mastery, here, is not a certificate, and it is not a claim that you will never get a Tuesday notice, or an expired approval, or a draft that does not sound like you. Mastery is a loop you are willing to walk again. You try a job. You save a skill when it is good. You put a tested

skill on a routine. You let a Page stay current. You look, once a quarter, at whether the workshop is still yours. You split a Bot that has grown two jobs. You keep the yes.

At SMF Works, that loop is how I stopped being the middle of every handoff without giving the ends away. Charlie still runs a brief. A Monday Page is still current. Video Studio still waits for me to watch a cut, as Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms," already told you. The fleet is a fleet. I am still at the door.

I want to describe that "no longer middle-man" feeling honestly, because it can be misunderstood as a disappearance. I have not disappeared. I still approve a merge. I still watch a cut. I still read a brief and decide what matters today. What I no longer do, most Mondays, is assemble the picture from scratch: asking each Bot what it has, pasting the pieces into a document, being the hallway through which every status has to walk. The Page is the hallway now, or the table. The people — and the Bots — still do the work. I still walk up to the table. I just do not have to build the table every Monday before I can sit down. That is a quieter kind of mastery than the word usually gets, and it is the kind I trust.

A Bot that has grown two jobs is the other half of this honesty. It happens the way a kitchen drawer happens. You open it to put in a spoon, and a year later it holds string, a manual, and three things you meant to sort. A Bot that began as "household calendar" and is now also bills, also shopping, also a travel folder, is a drawer. It will still try. It will also blur. Splitting it is not a reprimand. It is the same kindness as Chapter 3, "Get In," when I asked you to give a first Bot one clear job. The quarterly review is just a date on which you look, and say, "this is two jobs," and make a second Bot, and feel a little lighter, the way a sorted drawer is lighter.

If initiative offers something new, I treat it like a first task: small, reversible, watched. If a template looks useful, I read the details before I add it. If a connector would be clever, I ask whether I need it. If a Bot has become a drawer of leftover jobs, I give it one sentence, or I give it a rest.

You do not have to adopt every piece of this chapter. A Monday Page without MCP is a complete practice. A quarterly review without a Marketplace template is a complete practice. A single Bot with a single job, a Vault you have looked at, and a yes you have not given away — that was a complete practice in Chapter 4, and it still is. The rest is a workshop you can grow into, and a workshop you can also keep small.

The coda is next, and it is short. I will not offer you a course, and I will not offer you a next book to buy. I will offer you a small handoff, tomorrow, and the same sentence I have been saying since the preface: you are still the one who says yes.

Coda

You are still the one who says yes.

I have said that sentence since the preface, and I want it to be the last full sentence you hear from me as well, not because I could not think of a grander ending, but because it is the true one. A teammate with a computer can finish a great deal. It can sort a night's mail, fill a Monday Page, join a meeting, take a script and make a video, bring a book back bound. It can also send, pay, publish, and speak in a room you have not agreed to. The difference is almost never a secret trick. The difference is a clear job, a reversible first task, a Vault instead of a password in the chat, and a yes you have not given away.

The work can come back finished. I have seen it come back finished, at a kitchen table and at SMF Works, as an EPUB and a letter PDF and a brief that was waiting while the coffee was still hot. I have also seen a card expire, and a pool run thin, and a draft that did not sound like me. Both kinds of morning are part of a practice that lasts. The finished work is a gift. The unfinished work, the expired card, the notice on a Tuesday, is a reason to keep the practice small enough to watch.

This book was a gift. I wrote it for anyone who has stared at a pile and wished a careful teammate would take the next piece, finish it, and bring it back. You do not have to buy anything. There is no course at the end of this page, and no upgrade waiting behind a link, and no "if you want more" that leads to a shop. If a free copy of these pages helped you, you can hand the file to a friend the way it was handed to you. WisdomForge may be a place to pick the file up; it is not a storefront, and this book is not for sale there or anywhere else.

I wrote it as a giveaway because the community that is already teaching itself this product — in official docs, in independent posts, in kitchen-table conversations — gave me a lot, and this is what I could give back. If you are the friend who is being handed the file, you are welcome. Start wherever the pile is. You do not have to have read the chapters in order. You do not have to finish the book in a weekend. Part 2 is enough to get safely in the door. The shelves are there when a particular kind of work arrives. The last chapters are there when you are ready, and not before. If a chapter does not fit the life you have, leave it. The gift was never a syllabus you had to complete. It was a careful friend, handing you a tool, and then getting out of the way so you could use it. I am getting out of the way now, except for this last request, which is not a request to buy, or to join, or to come back: hand something small off tomorrow, and watch it, and keep the yes.

Take what helps. Leave the rest.

If all you take is Part 2 — a plan that actually includes Grok Bot, a first real task, a Vault, an

Ask-first rule — that is a complete taking. If you take a family Page from Chapter 13, “Get Your Life Back,” and a Pay button that waits from Chapter 14, “Errands That Finish,” that is a complete taking. If you take a Team Bot who does not read anyone’s private chat, from Chapter 15, “Bots on Your Human Team,” that is a complete taking. If you take only the line from Chapter 16, “Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms,” and a sketch on paper with a “never,” and you never draw a second desk, that is a complete taking. If you take Chapter 17’s four facts — a shared computer, a card that can pay without asking, approvals that expire, a weekly pool that is shared — and you walk the safety card once a quarter, from Chapter 18, “A Practice That Lasts,” that is a complete taking. You do not owe this book a fleet.

Hand something small off tomorrow.

Something you can watch. A digest you will read. A folder of options, not tickets. A draft that does not go out until you say so. Watch it. Keep the yes. If it comes back finished, you will know what that feels like, and you will be able to hand off the next small thing. If it comes back needing a correction, you will also know, and the correction is part of the work, not a reason to take the pile back onto your own shoulders alone.

I almost said thank you out loud to an empty room, the first morning Charlie left a brief on my desk. I told you that at the start. I will tell you, at the end, that I still almost do, and that I still look at the brief before anything goes out the door. The feeling did not wear off because I learned the product. The feeling stayed because the practice stayed: a job I can name, a routine I tested, a yes I have not given away. If tomorrow’s small handoff gives you even a little of that feeling — a table that is a little clearer, a Tuesday that starts with a list instead of a pile — then this gift did what I hoped it would do.

You will not need every chapter. You will not need every platform. You may never invite a Bot to a meeting, or draw a sketch with a second desk, or walk a Marketplace template. That is all right. A single Bot, with a single job, and a person who still says yes, is already a team that can work while you sleep, in the only sense I am willing to mean that phrase: a teammate you still review, on a computer you still treat as shared, with a pool you still look at, and a door you still stand in.

I am glad you came this far. I am glad you opened a free book and stayed for the cautions as well as for the mornings that are already a little lighter. A careful guide should not sit behind a cash register, and a careful teammate should not sit behind a yes you did not mean. You have the guide. You have the teammate, if you choose one. You have the door, and you are standing in it.

You are still the one who says yes. That is the whole point. That is enough.

Appendix A — Glossary

These are the words this book uses on purpose. For each one I give a plain sentence first, then the official name, so you can recognize it in the product and in the notes. Where a word belongs to another product — Hermes Agent, OpenClaw — I say so. Those are not Grok Bot features. They appear in Chapter 16 because they are platforms in my own workshop, described at the level official pages and my own wiring allow.

Approval card. A notice that asks for your yes before a Bot takes a sensitive action, and then waits. Official docs call this an approval card; the buttons may say Allow once, Always allow, Deny, Allow, Not now, or Skip, depending on the card.

Ask first. A rule you write in plain words that always stops a matching action and shows you a card. Official name: Ask first, under Custom Rules.

Allow automatically. A rule that lets a matching action proceed when Auto Review does not have another reason to stop it. Official name: Allow automatically. If an Ask-first rule and an Allow-automatically rule both match, Ask first wins.

Auto Review. A built-in check that looks at an action before a Bot runs a command, uses an app, or acts on its computer. It is on by default. Official name: Auto Review (sometimes Auto-review in settings). Turning it off means the Bot runs without those checks.

Bot. A named teammate, in Grok Bot, that you can give a job. Official name: Bot. Most Bots work best with one clear job.

Command line. The part of a computer where you type instructions instead of clicking. Official docs say the cloud computer has a command line, and that command-line credentials are shared. This book does not invent commands. In Chapter 16, “via CLI” means through that command line, at the level I described, not as a recipe.

Connect apps. A structured way to let a Bot work in a service you already use, such as Gmail or a calendar, which official docs call more reliable than clicking through a website. Official name: Connect apps. A connected app is account-wide: every Bot on your account can use it.

Connector / MCP. A connector is a connection to a service. MCP is a standard way AI tools connect to a service; official docs say a Bot can add an MCP server, and that a marketplace Bot can wrap an API. This book treats custom MCP as a power-user corner, in Chapter 18, not as a first-week skill.

Cursor. The account you use to sign in to Grok Bot, and the company through which the cloud

computer and many admin and privacy settings run. Official wording: Grok Bot uses your Cursor account, so there is no separate login.

Custom Rules. Your own list of Ask-first and Allow-automatically rules, written in plain words. Official name: Custom Rules, in Settings → General, under Bot.

Filesystem (files that stay). A place on the cloud computer for files, which persist between tasks and are visible to every Bot on your account. Official docs name a browser, a command line, and a filesystem.

Grok (the chat app). A separate conversation app from SpaceXSI. Official FAQ: Grok (the chat app from SpaceXSI) and Grok Bot are two different apps. A limit in the Grok app is not a statement about Grok Bot.

Grok Bot. A separate app: a proactive AI teammate with a real computer in the cloud. Official overview: "Grok Bot is your proactive AI teammate," "an agent with access to a real computer in the cloud." Made by SpaceXSI, formerly xAI; signs in with a Cursor account.

Grok Bot 1.0. A major update to Grok Bot, released on 11 November 2026 in the body of this book, from the official @SpaceXSI post and the official news page. It added multiplayer teammates, proactive initiative, and more capable browser, documents, Pages, and approvals. Team Bots: Team and Enterprise plans. Meetings: Team, Enterprise, and Ultra.

Group chat. A conversation that can include more than one Bot. Official best practice: make one Bot responsible for each step, and @ one Bot, not everyone. Approval cards may not appear in the group chat; check the Bot's own chat. This book does not state a size cap; official docs should be checked for that number.

Hermes Agent. An AI agent built by Nous Research, free and open source under the MIT license, with a command-line tool and a desktop app. It is not a Grok Bot feature. Official site: hermes-agent.nousresearch.com. This book is not a Hermes manual and is not affiliated with or endorsed by Nous Research. In Chapter 16, Charlie talks to SMF Works' Hermes Fleet via CLI, and Video Studio works with several Hermes Agents via webhook, only as I described that wiring.

Initiative. A Bot offering to take on work, rather than only waiting for a request, and asking before risky actions. Official 1.0 name: proactive teammates, or initiative. The primary Bot is the one that reaches out.

Meetings. A Bot joining a video call — official docs name Google Meet, Zoom, and Microsoft Teams — to listen, take notes, and send a summary. Available on Team, Enterprise, and Ultra plans, as of the 1.0 news page.

Memory. The lasting things a Bot keeps — preferences, rules you asked it to follow, a dated work log — so it does not start from zero every morning. Official name: memory. A few facts, such as your name and time zone, are shared by all your Bots. Memory is not a Vault, and official docs say it is not a source of truth for numbers that change. Chapter 6 is the full chapter.

OpenClaw. A self-hosted AI assistant that runs on your own hardware, stewarded by the OpenClaw Foundation. It is not a Grok Bot feature. Official site: openclaw.ai. Official homepage language includes "No subscription. No hosted tier. No token." This book is not an OpenClaw manual and is

not affiliated with or endorsed by the OpenClaw Foundation. In Chapter 16, Charlie talks to SMF Works' OpenClaw Fleet via CLI, only as I described that wiring.

Order card. A shopping summary a Bot shows you — store, items, ship-to, pay-with, total — so you can Pay or Cancel. Official name: order card. Only the Bot's owner can pay its orders. Chapter 14 walks this.

Page (Pages). An interactive report or dashboard a Bot can build and update, including from a routine. Official name: Pages. As of docs opened on 11 November 2026, Pages were rolling out gradually and were not available on Enterprise teams yet; re-check the live docs.

Primary Bot. Your main point of contact, usually starred: the Bot that checks in, can coordinate other Bots, and is the one that takes initiative. Official name: primary Bot. A Team Bot cannot be your primary Bot.

Prompt injection. Hidden or untrusted text, on a page or in a message, that tries to look like an instruction from you. Official docs: only your own messages count as instructions; Auto Review lowers this risk but does not remove it.

Routine. A workflow assigned to one Bot, told when to run — on a schedule, or after an event such as a message, a mail to the Bot's address, or a webhook. Official name: routine. A new scheduled routine waits for its next time; a test run does real work. Chapter 8 is the full chapter.

Secure Form. A form the Bot shows you so you can type a secret that goes straight into a page, never into the chat, and never shown to the Bot. Official name: Secure Form.

Shared cloud computer. The persistent computer in the cloud that all of your Bots use, with a browser, a command line, and files that stay between tasks. Official wording: "Your Bots work from a persistent cloud computer…" It is assigned per user, not per Bot. Official FAQ: "Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary." Command-line credentials are shared. Do not place a credential or file on it if another Bot on your account should not use it.

Shared weekly pool. The weekly allowance, under The X Subscription, that Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor draw from together. Official wording: Grok Bot usage draws from the weekly shared pool across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor. There is not a single published dollar or token number; official pages give multipliers and point to the live dashboard.

Skill. A reusable recipe for how to do a task — steps, rules, output, and what needs approval. Official name: skill. Chapter 7 is the full chapter. In this book, a skill has a "never" line.

SpaceXSI (SpaceX Super Intelligence LLC). The company that makes Grok and Grok Bot, formerly known as xAI. Official site brand: SpaceXSI. Legal name: SpaceX Super Intelligence LLC.

Take control. You temporarily drive the Bot's cloud computer yourself, for a step only a person can finish — single sign-on, a passkey, a CAPTCHA, a QR code. Official path: Open computer, then Take control, then tell the Bot to continue. Never paste the secret into the chat.

Teach a Task. An official way, when it is available, to record a browser workflow of up to ten minutes and turn it into a draft skill. Official name: Teach a Task. Rollout may be gradual; this book does not assert who has it on which plan. Chapter 7 returns to it.

Team Bot. A Bot a whole human team can work with, available on Team and Enterprise plans. Official name: Team Bots. Chapter 15 is the full chapter.

Template. A shareable copy of a Bot's setup, not its logins or history. Official docs: strip secrets before you share. Marketplace Bots are related starting points, already set up for a job.

The X Subscription. One subscription, introduced 12 October 2026, that can cover Grok, Cursor, and X. New customers start here. Grok Bot is included on Premium, Super, and Ultra, not on Free or Plus. Switching from a legacy plan is optional and, once done, permanent; official docs say Support cannot undo it.

Unattended approval. An approval for work that started without you — a routine, or a message from another Bot — which official FAQ says expires after about thirty minutes. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.

Vault. A locker for logins, payment cards, and contact info, which fills secrets into a page without the Bot seeing them. Official name: Vault, in Settings → Vault. It is account-wide. A saved card fills in at checkout without asking you each time; if you want to approve every payment, do not save the card. Never paste a password or card into the chat.

Webhook. An official way to start a routine by sending an HTTP POST to a URL the desktop shows you, with a secret key as an Authorization Bearer token, and an optional JSON body. A 200 response means the run was accepted, not that the work has finished. Test runs do real work. Chapter 8 teaches this; Chapter 16 uses it, at the level I described, without inventing a payload. Do not print secrets in a book or a chat you do not mean to share.

1Password. A password manager official Grok Bot docs still describe as a connected option, used after the Vault and before a Secure Form, with your approval. If you do not use it, you can ignore this door.

For company and product names, and for how this book uses trademarks, see Appendix E. For starter prompts, see Appendix B. For checklists, see Appendix C. For dated official URLs, see Appendix D.

Appendix B — Cookbook

This appendix is a shelf of starter prompts: most of them official, a few teaching drafts from the chapters you just read, each with a “never” line. It is not a bag of tricks, and it is not a set of secret instructions from my own fleet. If a prompt is official, I say so. If it is a teaching draft I wrote for this book, I say that too. I have not printed any hidden system prompt, and I have not invented a command or a webhook body for another platform.

Use them as starting sentences. Make them yours. Test on a safe input, with you in the room, before you put anything on a clock. Chapter 7, “Show It Once,”, and Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed,”, are the home of that rule. A prompt is a recipe’s first line, not a reason to skip the watch-along.

Every item below has a “never.” If you take only one habit from this shelf, take that one. Back the “never” with an Ask-first rule for anything you cannot undo, as Chapter 5, “Connect Carefully,”, taught. Memory is not a gate.

How to read a card on this shelf

Each card has a name, a prompt you can almost paste, a “never,” and a pointer to the chapter that sits with it properly. When official wording already includes “don’t send” or “don’t publish,” I keep that wording and still label the “never,” so you can see it at a glance.

Do not put a password, a card number, a key, or another person’s private life into any of these prompts. Secrets belong in the Vault, not in a cookbook and not in a chat. Chapter 6, “Memory,”, is the postcard test; it applies here.

A webhook card will tell you to add a trigger and to treat a `200` as accepted, not finished. It will not print a key, and it will not invent a JSON schema.[1]

Memory

What do you remember?

> What do you remember about me?

Never: Do not treat the answer as a source of truth for a number that changes, and do not leave a secret or a medical note on the list — ask the Bot to forget those. Official path: there is no memory

screen for a personal Bot; you ask in chat.[2]

From Chapter 6, “Memory.”

Remember this.

> Remember that I am out every Friday. Keep morning briefs short. From now on, never send external messages without my approval. Please remember that, and tell me what you will keep.

Never: Do not ask it to remember a password, a card, a health detail you would not put on a postcard, or someone else’s private data. Logins and cards belong in the Vault.[2]

Forget this.

> Forget that I am on the launch team. Then tell me what you remember about me, so I can see that it is gone.

Never: If what you are removing was a secret that was exposed, forgetting is a cleanup, not a complete fix. Change the key or the password. Check the shared computer, as Chapter 5, “Connect Carefully,”, already asked.

Look it up again.

> For this number, look it up in the current source. Do not rely on memory. Cite what you opened. If you cannot open it, say so.

Never: Do not make a consequential decision — a payment, a public post, a figure you will stand behind — from a remembered price or a remembered balance.[2]

Skills and teaching

Save a skill after a good run. (Official shape.[1])

> Save the process we just used as a skill called “Weekly account health.” Include the source systems, risk definitions, output format, and the rule that customer contact always requires approval.

Swap the name and the rule for your job. A useful skill, officially, states when to use it, inputs and access, the sequence, how to validate, what to return, and what requires approval.

Never: Do not save a skill without a “never.” Do not write a secret into the card. Do not make one giant “do all my marketing” skill. Test once while you watch before any routine.

Weekly inbox triage. (Teaching card, in the spirit of the official inbox prompt.[3])

> Run Weekly inbox triage on unread mail from the last twenty-four hours. Sort into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI. Draft replies to the urgent ones in my voice. For “needs a reply,” give me a one-line recommendation. For FYI, a count and three subject lines. Flag bills, school forms, and anything that needs a signature.

Never: Never send. Never delete. Never unsubscribe. Never forward. Leave drafts unsent.

Teach a Task, when you have it. (Official steps, not a paste-prompt.[1])

When Teach a Task is available, open a one-to-one chat and the computer view, choose Teach a Task, describe the result, perform the workflow once (up to ten minutes; no microphone audio), stop, review the draft skill, and add the "never" and the failure rules one example will not show. Rollout may be gradual; if you do not see the control, ask the Bot to create a skill from your written instructions and the completed task.[4]

Never: Do not demonstrate with a live payment, a customer record, or a production toggle. Do not expose secrets during the recording. Use the Vault or a Secure Form, as Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", taught.

Routines, mail, and webhooks

A weekday morning brief. (Official spirit; teaching wording.[1],[3])

> Every weekday at 8:00 AM, in my Bot time zone, run the morning brief skill. Leave the draft in this conversation. Do not send, book, or pay. If a source is unavailable, report the failure; do not use old data or memory in its place.

Never: Do not send. Remember: a new routine waits for its next scheduled time; it will not run at creation. Use Test when you want a run now, and know that a test does real work.[1]

A narrow Slack or ticket trigger. (Official shape.[1])

> When a message in #customer-escalations contains a support ticket link and the phrase "needs repro," open the ticket, reproduce the issue in staging, and post a repro pack in this conversation. Never post back to Slack without approval.

Never: Never post back without approval. Never use a broad listener such as "every new message." Narrow the channel and the phrase, or you will burn usage and act on noise.[1]

A receipts alias, log only.

> When mail arrives at my receipts alias, run the receipts-log skill. Log the item on the list. If you cannot read an attachment, say so.

Never: Never pay, never approve, never file a payment. Claiming an address at `mail.grokbot.com` is permanent in the official sense: one address, for good, never reissued, cannot be renamed or deleted. Claim it only on purpose, after an approval card, as Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed", taught.[5]

Add a webhook trigger. (Official fields only.[1])

> Please add a webhook trigger to this routine. Then show me, on desktop, the Webhook section: the POST URL, the key field, and the full header. I will copy what I need. Do not paste the key into this chat again, and do not write it into a document I might share.

Never: Never print the key in a page, a screenshot, a group chat, or a skill card. Senders use `Authorization: Bearer <key>`. An optional JSON body may be sent; the Bot receives the body with the routine instruction. A `200` means accepted and started, not finished — check the chat. Any other response: confirm the routine is not paused and that the key is current. This book will not invent a payload schema. Chapter 16, “Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms,”, uses this doorbell at the level of a story, not a protocol.

A chief of staff

Official morning briefing.[3]

> Sum up what changed since yesterday in my inbox, calendar, Slack, and docs, and flag what needs me. Draft it as a post for #team; don’t send it.

Never: Don’t send it. Don’t book. Don’t pay. A note in the chat is a complete brief if you do not want a #team draft.

Official inbox manager.[3]

> Sort my unread email into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI. Draft replies to the urgent ones and don’t send anything.

Never: Don’t send anything. Don’t delete. Don’t unsubscribe.

Official meeting prep.[3]

> Prep me for my 2 PM: who is attending, what we last discussed, and any open threads. Keep it to one page.

Never: Do not invent a quote. Do not mail the prep to the attendees. If you are not sure who said something, don’t attribute it. See also Chapter 11, “The Shop Floor,”, and Chapter 15, “Bots on Your Human Team.”

Official Sunday calendar plan.[3]

> Every Sunday evening, read the week ahead, flag clashes and packed days, and leave me a short plan for Monday.

Never: Never book, never invite, never cancel, never move a shared block without a yes. “Send you a plan” means a note to you.

A chief’s job, teaching draft. (Mine for this book, not a secret from SMF Works; edit until it is yours. From Chapter 9, “Your Digital Chief of Staff.”)

> You are my chief of staff. Your job is to coordinate, not to hoard. Each weekday, prepare a short morning brief from the inbox, calendar, and other apps I have connected. Every item has a source, a why, and a suggested next step. Flag what needs me. When a job repeats and has its own rules, recommend a specialist Bot, or hand work to one we already have. Keep a follow-up list. Never send, never publish, never book, never pay, never delete, never merge. If a source is missing, say so; do not fill from memory.

> If you are unsure, ask. I am the one who says yes. Please remember this, and read it back.

Never: The nevers are in the prompt. Back them with Ask-first. Do not create three specialists in the same sitting unless you mean to; one chief, one brief, one week is enough.

A follow-up list that does not send.

> Keep a follow-up list for me. Each item has a person or a thread, a suggested next step, and a draft if a draft would help. Add this thread to the list, and draft the reply. Don't send. On Friday at 4:00 PM, show me the open follow-ups, oldest first, and do not send any of them, and do not nudge anyone outside this chat.

Never: Never send, never invite, never post the follow-up. "Reached out" is a send unless you can see that it was not.

Growth work

Official sales development (inbound).[3]

> Qualify this morning's inbound leads against our ideal customer profile. Draft intro replies with times I'm free for good fits and a polite no for the rest; don't send anything.

Never: Don't send anything. Don't update a CRM field you would not want touched, unless that is a separate, tested skill. Read the list; do not "approve all" out of tiredness. Chapter 10, "Growth Work."

Official content marketer.[3]

> Pull what we shipped this week from the changelog and Slack, and draft the newsletter and three posts in our voice. Bring me the drafts; don't publish anything.

Never: Don't publish. Don't invent a metric or a quote. Park the drafts. You publish, or you say yes to a specific post and watch.

Official paid media.[3]

> Compare this month's spend by campaign with our budget and target CAC, and recommend where to move money. Don't change any budgets.

Never: Don't change any budgets, bids, statuses, creatives, or payment methods. Don't launch a campaign. Look up current targets; do not use a remembered number. Unattended spend is not a routine. Do not save a card for this job if you do not want a payment to be possible. Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully,", and Chapter 10, "Growth Work".

Official talent scout.[3]

> Find 20 candidates for this role who meet the must-haves and aren't already in our ATS. Draft outreach in my voice; don't contact anyone.

Never: Don't contact anyone. Don't schedule until you approve. Don't reject a person in the ATS. Don't invent a work history or a compliment you cannot source. Twenty is the official example's number, not a quota; a smaller list you will actually read is better. If the ATS cannot be reached, stop and say so. People's careers are not a sandbox.

A campaign trio, proposed first. (Official team; teaching ask.[3])

> Please propose three one-job Bots for a campaign team, in the official shape: Sign-ups (last week's sign-ups by channel), Launch drafts (a launch note and three posts from the numbers), Fact check (against the numbers and our brand doc). Show me the jobs and the nevers. Don't create them until I say yes. Don't publish. Don't invent a number or a quote.

Never: Don't publish. Don't create the Bots until you say yes. The fact-check Bot is a reviewer, not a cheerleader.

Overnight outbound, review list. (Official Sales Outbound spirit.[6])

> Tonight, in my Bot time zone, run the outbound skill on today's list. Leave a review list in this chat, with sources and drafts in my voice. Skip anyone already marked do-not-contact. Don't send email. Don't send a LinkedIn message.

Never: Don't send. A login to LinkedIn or mail sits on a shared computer; Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully", still applies. Reputation is the quiet cost of skipping the yes.

The shop floor

Official invoice coordinator.[3]

> Match this week's invoices in the finance inbox to their purchase orders. List the ones that don't match and draft a note to each owner; don't approve or pay anything.

Never: Don't approve. Don't pay. Don't send the notes until you say yes. A saved card can pay without asking; if you do not want that, do not save the card.[7] Chapter 11, "The Shop Floor."

Official expense manager.[3]

> Build this week's expense summary, match receipts from the finance inbox, and flag policy exceptions. Draft one follow-up per owner; don't send them.

Never: Don't send. Don't pay. Don't reimburse unattended. If a receipt is missing, say so; do not fill a gap from memory.

Official month-end close, proposed first.[3]

> Please propose the official month-end trio — Invoices, Expenses, Exceptions — with jobs and nevers, and create them only after I say yes. On the first of the month, leave a folder of matches, exceptions, and notes for my sign-off. Don't approve. Don't pay.

Never: Don't pay. You sign. You pay what you mean to pay. Test first on last month's already-finished files if you can.

Official support-queue shape, and a refund gate.[3]

> Sort new tickets and draft replies. Flag refunds, legal or safety issues, and bugs that need staging. If you propose a refund, check it against the policy document I named, and leave a recommendation. Don't send a reply. Don't issue a refund. Don't use one customer's data to test another's bug.

Never: Don't send. Don't refund without a yes, and only inside the policy. Don't post publicly. Angry, legal, or safety tickets are a person's job: flag and stop.

Official bug reproduction.[3]

> Reproduce this bug in staging with a fresh test account. Send me the exact steps, screenshots, and browser details; don't use customer data.

Never: Don't use customer data. Don't use a production login. Don't merge. Don't deploy. Don't change production. Credentials on the cloud computer are shared; do not place a production secret there if another Bot should not use it.[8]

Official product performance.[3]

> Find out why checkout got slower after yesterday's release. Send me the likeliest hotspot with screenshots and links, and don't change production settings.

Never: Don't change production settings. Don't restart a service. Don't "just bump" a limit. A memo is the product. A weekly export you attach is a complete input.

Official account health.[3]

> Rank the accounts in my book by churn risk and expansion potential from usage, tickets, and renewal dates. Suggest a next step for each; don't contact anyone.

Never: Don't contact anyone. A "check-in" is a contact. If a source is missing, say so.

A recap that does not invent a quote. (Teaching, in the spirit of official Meeting Recap Deck's "never invent a quote."[9])

> Summarize these notes into decisions, action items with owners, and open questions. Do not invent a quote. If you are not sure who said something, don't attribute it. Leave a short document for my review; don't send it to the attendees.

Never: Don't invent a quote. Don't send unattended. For a Bot that joins a live meeting, see Chapter 15, "Bots on Your Human Team", and check your plan (meetings: Team, Enterprise, and Ultra, as of the 1.0 announcement).[10]

A folder for counsel, not a lawyer. (Teaching; this book is not legal advice.)

> List the contracts in this folder by date and owner. Flag any date in the next sixty days. Pull the clause I named from the document I pointed at, and quote only what is there. Leave a folder for counsel.

Never: Never send a legal letter. Never file. Never waive. Never tell me a clause is "fine." Never put a privileged document in a public Page. If a matter needs a lawyer, a lawyer should have it.

Chapter 11, “The Shop Floor”.

A questionnaire or portal, parked. (Official illustrations: Security Questionnaire Filler parks the submit; Vendor Portal Operator returns exceptions.[6])

> Draft the fields from the trust document and the past answers I pointed at. If a field is unknown, leave it blank and flag it. Don’t invent an answer. Don’t submit. Don’t renew.

Never: Don’t submit. Don’t invent. Don’t renew unattended. A portal login is shared on the computer.

A small fleet

Sketch, then propose, then create. (Teaching, from Chapter 12, “A Small Fleet.”)

> Here is my fleet sketch: a chief who coordinates and never publishes; a writer who drafts and never publishes and never invents a source; a marketer who parks copy and never publishes; a programmer who prepares EPUB, PDF, and markdown and a pull request, and never merges alone. Please propose jobs and nevers for the specialists I don’t have yet. Show me the text. Don’t create any Bot until I say yes.

Never: Don’t create until you say yes. Don’t publish. Don’t merge. Don’t invent Bot names you will not want to live with. Start with two desks if seven is a crowd.

Friday status. (Teaching.)

> Once, now, make me a Friday status of the fleet: each title or job, whose desk it is on, what’s waiting for my yes, and any failure a person needs to see. Don’t publish it. Don’t send it outside this chat. If you don’t know, say you don’t know. Don’t invent progress.

Never: Don’t publish the status. Don’t merge. Don’t claim a merge you did not approve. If Pages are not available, a note in chat is complete.[11]

A human publish. (Teaching; also Appendix C.)

> Prepare the change for the site from these three files — EPUB, letter PDF, markdown — and open a pull request (or the equivalent proposal). Do not merge. Do not put the book on a public page. Wait for me.

Never: Don’t merge. Don’t publish. You hold the files, you read the copy, you merge or send. Tiredness is a reason to wait until morning, not a reason to put merge on a schedule.

A few official starters that live on other shelves

These are official prompts I want on the same shelf, even though their full how-tos belong to later chapters. The “never” is already in the official wording, or I have added one in this book’s voice.[3]

Official competitive intelligence.

> Check these three competitors for anything they launched or repriced this week. Send me a short list with links and what it means for our messaging.

Never: Do not write as if a rumor were a fact. Cite the page you opened. Don't publish the list. Don't contact a competitor. If you cannot open a source, leave the item off, or mark it as unverified.

Official travel coordinator. (Chapter 14, "Errands That Finish,", is the home of this work.)

> Find flights to Austin for Thursday, back Sunday, with no red-eyes, and a hotel near downtown. Send me the two best options; don't book anything.

Never: Don't book anything. Don't pay. Don't save a card for this job if you want every payment to be a yes. A recommendation is a gift. A ticket is a yes.

Official meeting-notes to Slack, if you use Granola.[3]

> Each evening, read the day's notes, pull out every action item with its owner, and draft a post for my team's Slack channel that goes out once I approve.

Never: Don't send until you approve. Don't invent an action item or an owner. Don't invent a quote.

Use these the way you use the rest of the shelf: paste, make them yours, watch once, then maybe a clock.

A last word on this shelf

If a prompt on this shelf and a live official page disagree, trust the live page, and date what you see. Products move. This appendix was checked against pages opened on 11 November 2026.

If you write a prompt of your own, give it a "never," test it once, and only then consider a routine. If you share a skill or a template, strip secrets first. If you are tempted to add a Hermes or OpenClaw command "example," don't. Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms", will not invent those either, and this cookbook follows that courtesy.

Take what helps. Leave the rest. Hand something small off tomorrow, and watch it once.

Appendix C — Checklists

These are lists for the wall, the fridge, or the Friday you are tired. They are not a substitute for the chapters, and they are not a way to skip a "never." If a list and a live official page disagree, trust the page, and date what you see.

Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully,", is where Ask-first, the Vault, the shared computer, and saved cards were set. These lists point back; they do not reprint that chapter. Sending, posting, paying, deleting, and publishing stay behind a yes.

A first week

Use this after Part 2, or as a quiet review of the week you already had.

- You chose a plan that actually includes Grok Bot, from the live pricing page, not from a memory of this book. Chapter 3, "Get In."
- You created a first Bot with one clear job, and a name you will actually say.
- You handed off one real, bounded task, and you read what came back. Chapter 4, "Hand Off Your First Real Task."
- You connected one low-risk app, not everything at once.
- A login, if you needed one, went in the Vault, not in the chat.
- Auto Review is on. Ask-first is on for send, post, pay, delete, and publish.
- You have not saved a card, or you saved one as a conscious choice, knowing a saved card can pay without asking.[1]
- You know the computer is shared, and that separate Bots are not a security boundary.[2]
- You asked your primary Bot, "What do you remember about me?" and you corrected or forgot what should not stay. Chapter 6, "Memory."
- You saved one short skill, with a "never," and you watched it once. Chapter 7, "Show It Once."
- You have not put an untested skill on a clock. If you scheduled a brief, you tested it, knowing a test does real work, and you confirmed it did not send. Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed."
- You looked at the usage dashboard at least once. The live number wins.

Done, for a first week, is this: one job, one careful connection, one "never," one watched run, and a yes that is still yours. You do not need a fleet yet.

Safety, for any week after

A short card. Walk it when you connect something new, or when a routine starts to feel too helpful.

- **Ask-first** is on for sending, posting, paying, deleting, publishing, merging, and changing production.
- **The Vault** holds logins and cards. The chat does not. Memory does not. A skill card does not.
- **The computer is shared.** A credential you place on it is, in practice, a credential other Bots on the account can use. Do not use separate Bots as a wall.[2]
- **A saved card can pay without asking.** If you do not want that, do not save the card.[1]
- **Send, post, pay, delete, publish, merge** stay behind a yes. Drafts and recommendations come first.
- **Unattended approvals** from a routine or another Bot expire after about thirty minutes. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.[3] If you will be away, do not leave a payment or a publish waiting on a card.
- **Secrets in a webhook** stay secrets. Do not print a key. A `200` means accepted, not finished. Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”.
- **Auto Review** stays on unless you have a reason you can say out loud, and even then, this book would rather you left it on.

If any line on this card is a no, pause the routine, and fix the line, before you close the laptop.

Publish or send

From Chapter 12, “A Small Fleet,”, and from every growth and shop-floor yes in Chapters 10 and 11. On the wall next to the merge button.

- I have **held the files** (EPUB, PDF, markdown, or your equivalent) and I am willing to put my name on them.
- I have **read the copy** that will be public. If this is a gift, there is no price, no cart, no upsell. Nothing implies an endorsement the maker did not give.
- I have **reviewed the actual proposal** — the pull request, the draft post, the staged folder — not only the promise of one.
- **I** will merge, or send, or press live. Not a routine. Not a chief being helpful at 8:00 on a Friday.
- If I ask a Bot to click after I say “this exact request, now,” I will **stay and watch**. I will not put that click on a clock.
- After it is live, I will **glance as a stranger** would, and if something is wrong, I will fix it with a new proposal and a new yes.

Tiredness is a reason to wait until morning. It is not a reason to skip this list.

If a routine did not run

Official checks, in one place.[4]

- The routine is not **Paused**. On the phone, **Active** is on.
- **When to run** shows the schedule or trigger I expect, in the **right time zone**.
- A new schedule **waits for its next time**. It does not run at creation. Use **Test** to run it now, and remember a test does real work.
- For Slack: the message is **new**, in the **channel** the trigger watches, and **matches the phrase**.
- For a webhook: the call returned **`200`** and used the **current key**. Any other response: the run did not start.
- Then look at **Approvals**. A card that expired after about thirty minutes means the action did not run. That can look like a missed routine. It is a missed yes.
- Then look at **usage**, and at rate limits. A failure that says a rate limit was exceeded may need a narrower trigger, a wider schedule, or a manual rerun; some such failures are a documented known issue and are not retried automatically.[4]

If you are unsure, pause, and ask the Bot what happened, in its own chat. Do not fire a webhook in a tight loop.

A cross-platform line

If your work already lives on more than one agent platform, do not invent a protocol from this book. Chapter 16, “Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms,”, offers a paper sketch: which Grok Bot talks to which, with a “never,” and with you at the final yes. The official webhook how-to lives in Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”; Chapter 16, “Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms”, uses it and does not reprint it. There is no checklist here that replaces that sketch, and no sample command to another platform. Stay official. Keep secrets off the chat and off a shared computer you do not mean to share. Test. Keep the yes.

After a long time away

Officially, Grok Bot may ask whether to keep routines running after a long period away, and may pause them if there is no response.[4] When you come back:

- Review which routines are **Paused**, on purpose or because the product asked.
- Read **When to run** and the **Instruction** again, including the “never.”
- Look at **run history** if you have it: Running, Succeeded, Failed, and why.
- Check **Approvals**, then **usage**, before you turn everything back on.
- **Test** one routine, on a safe input, before you resume a set.
- Say hello to the chief’s brief. If it is wrong, correct it, as Chapter 6, “Memory”, taught, before you trust a Monday.

A pause is a complete answer. Resuming is a yes.

A last look

You can run a complete practice with the first four lists and never need the fifth. You can also, on a quiet Sunday, walk the safety card and the publish list out loud, the way you would walk a recipe's last line. The fridge card from Chapter 7, "Show It Once", was not a joke. These lists are that card, cut into weeks.

You are still the one who says yes. Print the safety card if a print helps. Leave the publish list next to the place you merge. The lists are a gift inside a gift. Use the ones you need, and let the others wait until the week you need them too. A list you actually walk is worth more than five lists you mean to walk. Start with safety and the first week. Add publish when you have something to publish. That is enough of a wall for now.

Appendix D — Resources

This appendix is a pocketful of official addresses, dated 11 November 2026. It is not a second manual, and it is not a shop. When a page in this book and a live page disagree, trust the live page. Prices, plans, and features change. I have not placed any affiliate links here, and I will not. A free gift should end with doors you can walk through, not with a funnel.

You do not have to visit every address. If you are in your first week, the product page, Get started, the FAQ, and the pricing page will do. If you are connecting an app or a card, add the Vault page and the approvals page. If a Tuesday notice arrives, add the usage dashboard, the troubleshooting page, and the status page. If you are sharing a Bot with a team, add Team Bots and Meetings. If Chapter 16 sent you here, the Hermes and OpenClaw lists are at the bottom, labeled as those projects' sites.

I have grouped the Grok Bot addresses first, because this book is a guide to Grok Bot. After those, there is a short, clearly labeled list of official Hermes Agent and OpenClaw pages. Those are those projects' sites, not Grok Bot documentation, and they appear because Chapter 16, "Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms," names those platforms. This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by SpaceXSI, by Nous Research, or by the OpenClaw Foundation. Appendix E says more about names, trademarks, and how the notes in each chapter work. That appendix is not legal advice, and this list is not either.

Official Grok Bot pages

Start here.

- The product page: https://x.ai/bot — SpaceXSI's own introduction to Grok Bot, including a product-page FAQ. Vendor wording on a product page should be read as vendor wording; the docs below are how the product works.
- Get started: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started — official download, sign-in, and first-Bot path, which Chapter 3, "Get In," walks in a human voice.
- Overview: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview.
- How Grok Bot works: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works — a single request, followed from start to finish, which Chapter 2, "A Teammate with a Computer," retells.
- Frequently asked questions: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq — plans, the shared computer, approvals, privacy, deletion. If you only bookmark one docs page, bookmark this one.

Plans, usage, and a bill.

- Pricing, list prices as we checked them on 11 November 2026: https://x.ai/pricing. Tax extra; trust this page over any number in the book.
- Grok Bot on The X Subscription: https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot — which plans include Grok Bot, the shared weekly pool, and the fact that unification is optional and permanent.
- Usage limits: https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/usage-limits.
- Extra usage and top-ups, including Auto Top-up off until you turn it on: https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/extra-usage.
- Live usage, after The X Subscription: https://grok.com/dashboard. Billing and caps: https://grok.com/dashboard/billing. Before a switch, the official docs also point at https://cursor.com/dashboard.
- Chapter 17, "Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks," is the human walk through these pages.

The computer, the Vault, skills, and Pages.

- Use the computer and apps: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps.
- Vault and secure sign-in: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault — including that a saved card pays without asking each time. Chapter 5, "Connect Carefully," is the first-week walk.
- Skills and routines, including webhook triggers: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations. Chapter 8, "Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed," teaches this; Chapter 16 uses it and does not reprint the protocol.
- Files and results, including Pages: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results. As of 11 November 2026, Pages were rolling out and were not available on Enterprise teams yet; re-check this page.
- Create and manage Bots, including templates: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots.
- When your Bot takes initiative: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative.
- Approvals, security, and privacy: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy.
- Message and collaborate, including shopping, US phone calls, and group chats: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration.

Teams, meetings, and X.

- Team Bots: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots — whose apps, whose computer, whose usage, and private chats. Chapter 15, "Bots on Your Human Team."
- Microsoft Teams: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/microsoft-teams.
- Meetings: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings — Google Meet, Zoom, Microsoft Teams; available on Team, Enterprise, and Ultra plans, as of the 1.0 news and this docs page.
- Tag @bot on X, including where tagging is available: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/tag-on-x. Re-check regional availability; it can change.
- Grok Bot for teams and enterprises: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/teams-and-enterprises.
- Mobile: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile.

Safety, troubleshooting, and legal.

- Troubleshooting, including a usage-limit path, expired approvals, a status-page check, and how to contact support: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting. Support email, as that page states: support@x.ai, from the email on your Grok Bot account. Do not put passwords

in the message.
- Status: https://status.cursor.com — look at the Grok Bot row.
- Security and security FAQ: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/security, https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/security-faq.
- Privacy Policy: https://x.ai/legal/privacy-policy.
- Terms of Service: https://x.ai/legal/terms-of-service.
- Brand guidelines: https://x.ai/legal/brand-guidelines. Appendix E says more about names and trademarks. That appendix is not legal advice, and neither is this list.
- Bot-sharing terms, for templates: https://x.ai/legal/bot-sharing-terms.

News, guides, use cases, and the Marketplace.

- Introducing Grok Bot 1.0: https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0. Official post: https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826. This book uses 11 November 2026 in the body, from that post and the news page.
- Earlier official news, including the 11 August 2026 introduction, more plans, Team Bots, and The X Subscription, lives at https://x.ai/news and at the company page, https://x.ai/company.
- Official use cases: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases and https://x.ai/bot/use-cases.
- Official guides: https://x.ai/bot/guides.
- Marketplace: https://x.ai/bot/marketplace.
- Docs index: https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview is a good front door; a machine-readable list of docs also lives at https://docs.x.ai/llms.txt.

Official Hermes Agent pages (not Grok Bot docs)

These are Nous Research's official pages for Hermes Agent, opened for Chapter 16. They are not Grok Bot documentation. This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by Nous Research, and it is not a Hermes manual.

- Official product site: https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/
- Company site: https://nousresearch.com/
- Official repository: https://github.com/nousresearch/hermes-agent

Official OpenClaw pages (not Grok Bot docs)

These are the OpenClaw project's official pages, opened for Chapter 16. They are not Grok Bot documentation. This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by the OpenClaw Foundation, and it is not an OpenClaw manual.

- Official site: https://openclaw.ai/
- Official documentation: https://docs.openclaw.ai/
- Official repository: https://github.com/openclaw/openclaw

If you came to this appendix looking for a command to paste, or a payload to try, I have not given you one, on purpose. Chapter 16 will not either. Official docs, for the platform you are actually using, are the right next door. Independent writers I named in earlier chapters — Brooke Wright,

Dean Christensen — published their own accounts, and those URLs are in the notes of the chapters that cite them, not here, so this pocket stays official first.

This list is only a set of addresses, dated 11 November 2026, offered the way the rest of the book was offered: as a gift, to be checked against the live page, and to be left behind if they do not help. If a link has moved, search from the official docs front door, not from a memory of this appendix. The product moves fast. The gift is that you can still find the live page, and still keep the yes.

Appendix E — Names, Trademarks, and Sources

This appendix is a short, plain account of the names in this book, of how I have tried to use other people's marks, of how the notes work, and of a few facts I could not close. It repeats, in short form, that this book is a free, independent, unofficial gift, not for sale, and not endorsed by the product's maker. It is not legal advice. If you need a legal opinion, that is a conversation with a lawyer, not with these pages.

This book is a gift

Hand It Off is a free giveaway, a gift to the community, and it is not for sale. It is a free, independent, unofficial guide. It is not affiliated with or endorsed by SpaceX Super Intelligence LLC (SpaceXSI), or by xAI, X, Cursor, Anysphere, Nous Research, the OpenClaw Foundation, or any other company whose products are named in these pages. "Grok," "Grok Bot," and related marks belong to their owners and are used only to refer to those products. Prices, plans, and features were checked on 11 November 2026 and will change. This book is not legal, financial, medical, or tax advice.

You may share the file freely, with this notice kept with it. Please do not sell it. A WisdomForge page may be a place to get a free copy; it is not a shop in these pages, and this book is not a funnel to anything paid.

Company names, as the documents use them

I have not drawn a single official org chart, because I did not open one that reconciles every name. I report the names as the documents use them.[1]

The official website at x.ai brands itself **SpaceXSI**. The legal copyright on company and legal pages is **SpaceX Super Intelligence LLC**. The official account on X is **@SpaceXSI**, display name SpaceX Super Intelligence.

The company was previously **xAI**. An official news post dated 2 February 2026, "xAI joins SpaceX," says: "SpaceX announced today that it has acquired xAI." The page is short and points to a fuller update I did not open end to end; I do not paraphrase that fuller update here.

Journalism often writes **SpaceXAI**. That is journalism's spelling, not the site's own brand.

Grok Bot signs in with a **Cursor** account. Many admin, computer, and privacy controls run through Cursor. The App Store listing's seller, when I opened it on 11 November 2026, was **X Corp.**; the same listing's copyright line was **Anysphere Inc.**, which is Cursor's company. Google Play listed the developer as SpaceX Super Intelligence, and also used a **SpaceXAI LLC** address on that listing.

Grok the chat app and **Grok Bot** are two different apps, both from SpaceXSI.

Hermes Agent is a product of **Nous Research**. **OpenClaw** is stewarded, on its official site, by the **OpenClaw Foundation**. This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by those organizations either, and it is not a manual for those products. They appear in Chapter 16 as other agent platforms in my own work.

My own company, in this story, is **SMF Works**, and the press inside it is **WisdomForge**. **Charlie** is my chief of staff Bot. **Grok Bot Video Studio**, after first introduction, is Video Studio. **Hermes Fleet** and **OpenClaw Fleet** are SMF Works' fleets on those other platforms, not Grok Bots. When I need a reader who is not me, I use a named **composite** — Priya, Dan, or Alex — and I say so.

I do not name my employer. If a job title is needed, it is Principal AI Solutions Engineer.

Trademarks, in one careful summary

SpaceXSI's public Brand Guidelines, dated 14 February 2025 and opened for this book on 11 November 2026, say that SpaceXSI owns trademark rights in "SpaceXSI" and "Grok," in combinations of those terms, and in logos.[2] You may use the marks, the guidelines say, only to accurately refer to the company or its services. You may not use them in a way that could misrepresent your relationship with SpaceXSI, mislead, or imply endorsement, approval, or sponsorship. You may not use the marks in an app title, a domain name, or the name of a product or service not made by them, or in or as part of your own marks. If you publish Grok-generated text or images, the guidelines ask for a visible "Written with Grok" or "Created with Grok." Official logos, if they are used at all, must be used exactly as provided, without alteration; this book does not use official logos.

The title of this book is *Hand It Off*. That is a distinctive main title. "Grok Bot" appears in the subtitle referentially, because this is a practical guide to Grok Bot. I do not use "Grok" as if it were this book's mark, and I do not speak in the company's "we."

The book is a free, non-commercial community gift. The trademark caution in those guidelines **still applies**. Non-commercial use may lower practical trademark risk relative to a book sold as a product. That is an observation, **not a legal conclusion, and not legal advice**. I do not tell you the title is "cleared," "safe," or "fair use, definitely." Whether a particular title is lawful is a question for counsel, not a question this appendix can close.[3]

The same courtesy — accurate reference, no endorsement, no official logos — extends to Cursor, Anysphere, X, Nous Research, Hermes Agent, the OpenClaw Foundation, OpenClaw, 1Password, and every other named product.

How the notes work

In the body of a chapter, a small marker — [1], [2], and so on — points to a note at the back of that chapter. The notes start at 1 in each chapter. They use this form:

> N. Author or Organization, "Title," URL (accessed 11 November 2026).

Official documentation is how the product works, and is attributed to SpaceXSI or to the name the page itself uses. Journalism is named as journalism, with the outlet, and is not treated as a primary for product behavior when an official page exists. Vendor claims stay labeled as vendor. My own SMF Works fleet is a story I am offering; it is not a third-party case study, and I do not invent a footnote that pretends it is.

The body of this book uses **11 November 2026** as the date Grok Bot 1.0 was released, citing the official @SpaceXSI post and the official news page.[4] The official company timeline also lists "Introducing Grok Bot 1.0" on **2 November 2026**. That date appears in notes, not in the body. I found no primary explanation of the gap, and I did not invent one.

When this book and a live official page disagree, trust the live page, and date what you saw. Prices, plans, and features age.

What I could not close

A research pass leaves holes. I want those holes in prose, not as a hidden list.

I could not reconcile the 2 November and 11 November dates for 1.0 with a primary explanation. I could not open the full "xAI joins SpaceX" update beyond the short official stub. I could not produce an official org chart of SpaceXSI, SpaceXAI, X Corp., and Anysphere. I did not treat journalistic figures about filings or income as verified fact. I preferred the official "about thirty minutes" for unattended approval expiry over a shorter unofficial figure. I did not state a group-chat size cap, or which model runs which task, or a typical number of hours left in a weekly pool. I did not freeze Pages-on-Enterprise as an eternal no; the 11 November 2026 docs said not yet. I did not treat Teach a Task as available to every plan. I did not run a feature-by-feature competitor comparison; other tools were named from journalism, not crowned. I did not open every secondary essay a search turned up, and I did not quote them. I did not independently verify store-review claims of dollar recoveries or medical results, and I did not treat vendor counts of organizations or bots as audited. I did not invent CLI commands or webhook payloads for the fleets in Chapter 16. I did not cite GitHub star counts. I did not treat Nous Research's "most widely used" wording, or the OpenClaw Foundation's 501(c)(3) statement, as independently verified facts; the latter may be reported as the foundation's own official-site statement.

Those are limits, not mysteries I am keeping. If a later official page closes one of them, that page wins.

A last word on endorsement

Nothing in this book — not the title, not the diagrams, not the fact that I use the product to run real work — is an endorsement by SpaceXSI, xAI, X, Cursor, Nous Research, the OpenClaw Foundation, or anyone else. It is a free guide from me to you. Take what helps. Leave the rest. Keep the yes.

Notes

Notes are numbered from 1 in each chapter. Access dates are 11 November 2026 unless a note says otherwise.

Preface

1. SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). The official company timeline also lists “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0” on 2 November 2026; see SpaceXSI, “Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery,” https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026). This book uses 11 November 2026 in the body, from the official post and the news page.

Chapter 1 — What Grok Bot Is (and What It Isn’t)

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. Ibid.
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot” (overview), https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026).
4. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/news/introducing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
6. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026).
7. SpaceXSI, “SpaceXSI homepage,” https://x.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery,” https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 Novem-

ber 2026); SpaceX Super Intelligence, "@SpaceXSI," https://x.com/SpaceXSI (accessed 11 November 2026).

8. SpaceXSI, "xAI joins SpaceX," https://x.ai/news/xai-joins-spacex (accessed 11 November 2026).
9. Journalism, not a primary filing: Sean O'Kane, "Elon Musk's SpaceX officially acquires Elon Musk's xAI, with plan to build data centers in space," TechCrunch, 2 February 2026, https://techcrunch.com/2026/02/02/elon-musk-spacex-acquires-xai-data-centers-space-merger/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Additional figures in that report were not independently verified here.
10. Journalism: Jess Weatherbed, "Grok is now an AI 'teammate' you can assign work," The Verge, 12 August 2026, https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/978666/spacex ai-grok-bot-ai-agent-beta-launch (accessed 11 November 2026).
11. SpaceXSI Docs, "Get started," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
12. Apple App Store listing, seller X Corp., copyright Anysphere Inc., "Grok Bot App," https://apps.apple.com/us/app/grok-bot/id6794501026 (accessed 11 November 2026); Google Play, developer listed as SpaceX Super Intelligence, "Grok Bot," https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=ai.x.grok.bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
13. SpaceXSI, "Introducing Grok Bot," https://x.ai/news/introducing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot is now included with more plans," https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-more-plans (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, "Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery," https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026). A precise clock time for the 11 August launch was not on the announcement page.
14. SpaceXSI, "Introducing Grok Bot," https://x.ai/news/introducing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
15. SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot is now included with more plans," https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-more-plans (accessed 11 November 2026).
16. SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot now works with X," https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-and-x (accessed 11 November 2026).
17. SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot for Enterprise," https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-for-enterprise (accessed 11 November 2026). Organization and bot-count figures in that post are vendor claims, not audited here.
18. SpaceXSI, "Team Bots: shared AI teammates that learn as they work," https://x.ai/news/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026).
19. An independent writer, Brooke Wright, dates Team Bots to 26 September 2026; this book prefers the official 28 September news date. Wright Mode, "How to use Grok Bot: from your first bot to a bot team," 23 October 2026, https://www.wrightmode.com/blog/how-to-use-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

20. SpaceXSI, “Introducing The X Subscription,” https://x.ai/news/x-subscription (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Pricing: Compare Plans,” https://x.ai/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

21. SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026).

22. The official company timeline lists “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0” on 2 November 2026; see SpaceXSI, “Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery,” https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026). No primary explanation of the gap between that listing and the 11 November official post was found; this book does not invent one.

23. Google Play, “Grok Bot,” https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=ai.x.grok.bot (accessed 11 November 2026); Cursor Forum, “Grok Bot is Now Live on Android,” https://forum.cursor.com/t/grok-bot-is-now-live-on-android/170384 (accessed 11 November 2026). Exact first-ship date not pinned from a primary announcement.

24. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot for Mobile,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile (accessed 11 November 2026).

25. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). The news page, re-checked on 11 November 2026, describes the three improvements and the plan gates for Team Bots and Meetings.

26. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). Pages availability on Enterprise should be re-checked; it will age.

27. SpaceXSI, “Brand Guidelines,” 14 February 2025, https://x.ai/legal/brand-guidelines (accessed 11 November 2026).

28. Jess Weatherbed, “Grok is now an AI ‘teammate’ you can assign work,” The Verge, 12 August 2026, https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/978666/spacexai-grok-bot-ai-agent-beta-launch (accessed 11 November 2026). Journalism; The Verge’s day-one plan list is narrower than the official announcement, and this book prefers the official announcement for who had access on day one.

29. Official competitor primaries were not re-opened for a feature-by-feature comparison in this chapter. That comparison is left unmade on purpose.

30. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026).

Chapter 2 — A Teammate with a Computer: How Work Gets Finished

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. Ibid. Official wording: “Command-line credentials are shared.” And: “Do not place a credential or file on it if another Bot on your account should not be able to use it.”
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). The setting is under Settings → Computer → Your computer, labeled “Execution on this computer,” and by default it asks each time.
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
6. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026).
7. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Manage Grok Bot computers,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computers (accessed 11 November 2026).
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
9. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
10. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). Custom Rules are in Settings → General, under Bot.
11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026).
12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Official wording is “about 30 minutes.” This book uses that figure, not a shorter unofficial one.
13. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).

14. Ibid. The five-step conference walkthrough on that page is the official map this chapter retells.
15. Ibid.; SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). Official wording: a saved card fills in at checkout without asking you each time.
16. SpaceXSI Docs, "How Grok Bot Works," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
17. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
18. SpaceXSI Docs, "How Grok Bot Works," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
19. Ibid., under "Best practices": "Add specific Ask first rules for sending, publishing, and deleting. To approve every payment, don't save the card in Vault."
20. Ibid., under "Your primary Bot and Bots with one job."
21. SpaceXSI Docs, "Use the computer and apps," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under "Watch computer work."
22. Ibid., under "Take over for a sensitive step"; SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
23. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). The setting is described there as "Route traffic through this computer," under Settings → Computer, Your computer.
24. Ibid.; SpaceXSI Docs, "Use the computer and apps," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026).

Chapter 3 — Get In: Plans, Download, and Your First Bot

1. SpaceXSI Docs, "Grok Bot on The X Subscription," https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, "Pricing: Compare Plans," https://x.ai/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI, "Pricing: Compare Plans," https://x.ai/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026). Prices re-checked on 11 November 2026; tax extra. Teams wording is summarized as "$30+ per seat"; the live page has the exact team language.
3. Ibid. Plan-fit language on that page is the maker's, dated 11 November 2026.
4. SpaceXSI Docs, "Grok Bot on The X Subscription," https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). Official wording: "Grok Bot usage draws from the weekly shared pool across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor."

5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Usage limits,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/usage-limits (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
6. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/news/introducing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
7. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Can I pick the model?”
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “What is The X Subscription?,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/overview (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
9. Ibid. Official wording: “A completed unification is permanent. It can’t be undone, and Support can’t undo it for you.”
10. SpaceXSI Docs, “What is The X Subscription?,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/overview (accessed 11 November 2026), under “What happens when you switch.”
11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026).
13. Ibid.; SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot for Mobile,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile (accessed 11 November 2026).
14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot for Mobile,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile (accessed 11 November 2026).
15. Apple App Store, “Grok Bot App,” https://apps.apple.com/us/app/grok-bot/id6794501026 (accessed 11 November 2026); Google Play, “Grok Bot,” https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=ai.x.grok.bot (accessed 11 November 2026).
16. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
17. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026).
18. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026), including “Sign-in does not complete.”
19. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Meet your first Bot.”

20. Ibid.; SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026).
21. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026).
22. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).
23. Ibid.
24. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Hand it a first task.”
25. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026).
26. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot Marketplace,” https://x.ai/bot/marketplace (accessed 11 November 2026). The “never” lines here are official marketplace copy.
27. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot for Mobile,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile (accessed 11 November 2026).
28. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026).

Chapter 4 — Hand Off Your First Real Task

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Hand it a first task.”
2. Ibid. The four starter prompts on that page — morning briefing, inbox manager, competitive intelligence, and travel coordinator — are the official short list this chapter adapts. Each official prompt includes a limit such as “don’t send” or “don’t book.”
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Set a boundary in the request.”
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026).

6. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026), including “A Bot appears stuck.”
7. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Watch computer work.”
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Unattended approvals expire after about 30 minutes; approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.
9. SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026), marketplace description of Meeting Recap Deck: “never invents a quote.”
10. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026).
11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Review an action.”
12. Ibid.: “Do not approve an action whose target or effect you cannot identify.”
13. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/news/introducing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). The “finish the swing” line appears there as a vendor quotation; this book does not use it as a slogan.
14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026).
15. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026), under “If you don’t answer.”

Chapter 5 — Connect Carefully: Apps, Vault, and the Rules You Set First

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Connect an app.”
3. Ibid. Official wording: “Apps are account-wide. A connected app is available to every Bot you run.”
4. Ibid.: “App logins stay off the computer. OAuth tokens are held on Cursor’s connector backend, and the Bot invokes tools without receiving them.”
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026).

6. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026).
7. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Connect 1Password.” Official docs still described 1Password as of 11 November 2026.
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Secure Forms.”
9. Ibid.; SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
10. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Pay for things”; SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026). Official wording: a saved card fills in at checkout without asking you each time.
11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Take over for a sensitive step.”
12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Configure Auto Review”; SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
13. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026).
14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Official figure: about 30 minutes.
15. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Best practices.”
16. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). Team rules always apply; your own rules can only make behavior stricter.
17. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026), including “An approval expired or is blocked.”
18. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Does the Bot use my own computer?” Default is to ask each time, under Settings → Computer → Your computer.
19. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Give your Bots an email address.” One address at mail.grokbot.com; you cannot rename or delete it; addresses are never reissued. Chapter 8 returns to this.

20. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), under “Connect an app.”
21. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026).
22. SpaceXSI, “Privacy Policy,” https://x.ai/legal/privacy-policy (accessed 11 November 2026). This chapter does not extract individual clauses; Chapter 17 returns to privacy with more care.
23. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026): deleting Grok Bot deletes the Cursor account; there is no way to delete Grok Bot without deleting Cursor.
24. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).

Chapter 6 — Memory: What It Keeps, What You Shouldn’t Let It Keep

1. SpaceXSI, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), section “Memory is not a source of truth”; SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “What does a Bot remember?”
3. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), sections “What a Bot remembers,” “When a Bot saves something,” “See, correct, or remove a memory,” “What resets or deletes memory,” and “Import memory from another assistant.”
4. SpaceXSI, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026), “It checks its memory”; SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026).
5. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “What does a Bot remember?”
6. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026). The shared-computer rule is also in Chapter 5, “Connect Carefully”.

7. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “Edit a Bot.”
8. SpaceXSI, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026). The conference-signup walkthrough is the official example; the pass and the work-card rule are the docs’ illustration, not a personal claim.
9. SpaceXSI, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “What a Bot remembers.”
10. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “Across chats, Bots, and calls.”
11. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “Delete a Bot”; SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “What happens if I delete a Bot?”
12. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “Who can see or change memory”; SpaceXSI, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Team Bots are treated more fully in Chapter 15, “Bots on Your Human Team”.

Chapter 7 — Show It Once: Skills and Teach a Task

1. SpaceXSI, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026), sections “Save a skill,” “Teach a workflow by demonstration,” and the six-part list for a useful skill.
2. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “Can I show a Bot how I do a task?” The FAQ states that Teach a Task rollout may be gradual and that a recording is limited to ten minutes. This book does not claim the feature is on every plan or every account.
3. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “What is the difference between a skill and a routine?”
4. SpaceXSI, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Skills are available across Bots; a Bot may need the relevant app or login. Separate Bots are not a security boundary.
5. SpaceXSI, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026), “Create a routine” and “Test before enabling.” Test runs and webhook triggers are taught in Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”.
6. SpaceXSI, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). The inbox-manager and Notion Friday-update illustrations are official starter patterns;

the “never” lines in the worked card are this book’s teaching, consistent with those prompts (“don’t send,” “adds it once you approve”).

Chapter 8 — Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed

1. SpaceXSI, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026). This chapter’s facts on schedules, time zones, the wait-until-next-time rule, event triggers, Slack triggers, webhooks (POST URL, `Authorization: Bearer <key>`, optional JSON body, 200 meaning accepted not finished), test runs performing real work, pause and management, missed-run checks, rate limits and the documented known issue, usage, and design advice all come from this page.
2. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “Does Grok Bot keep working when my laptop is closed?”
3. SpaceXSI, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), “Give your Bots an email address.”
4. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). Unattended approvals expire after about 30 minutes.

Chapter 9 — Your Digital Chief of Staff

1. SpaceXSI, “Use cases · Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), Chief of Staff description; SpaceXSI, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “Your primary Bot” and “Edit a Bot”; SpaceXSI, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026), “Your primary Bot and Bots with one job.”
3. SpaceXSI, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), morning briefing, inbox manager, meeting prep, and the connected-app illustrations for Gmail, Google Calendar, Slack, and Notion.
4. SpaceXSI, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026), “Pages.” Availability on Enterprise teams was described as not yet, as of 11 November 2026, and should be re-checked.
5. SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Unattended approvals expire after about 30 minutes.
6. SpaceXSI, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), “Build a team of Bots for a bigger goal,” including dr eggbot as an official starting point.

7. SpaceXSI, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026). Official group-chat advice is one Bot responsible for each step. This book does not state a numeric cap on group size.
8. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Mobile,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile (accessed 11 November 2026). The companion apps use the same Bots, conversations, routines, and cloud computer.

Chapter 10 — Growth Work: Sales, Marketing, and Recruiting

1. SpaceXSI, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), including sales development, content marketer, paid media, talent scout, and the campaign team (Sign-ups, Launch drafts, Fact check). Every official example on that page stops for review.
2. SpaceXSI, “Use cases · Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), Sales Outbound, Paid Media, and Talent Scout descriptions.
3. SpaceXSI, “Your next sales teammate should be a Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-sales (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for SDRs,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-sdrs (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for GTM,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-gtm (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Founder-Led Sales,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-founder-led-sales (accessed 11 November 2026). These are official or vendor how-tos, not independent case studies.
4. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Performance Marketing,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-performance-marketing (accessed 11 November 2026).
5. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Marketing,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-marketing (accessed 11 November 2026).
6. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot Marketplace,” https://x.ai/bot/marketplace (accessed 11 November 2026). Overheard is officially described as a mention digest that never posts on your behalf.
7. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Recruiting,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-recruiting (accessed 11 November 2026).
8. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot Guides,” https://x.ai/bot/guides (accessed 11 November 2026), and “Grok Bot for Clay,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-clay (accessed 11 November 2026). Official guides, not independent reviews.
9. SpaceXSI, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), on work continuing with the laptop closed.

Chapter 11 — The Shop Floor: Support, Finance, Operations, and Engineering

1. SpaceXSI, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), including the support-queue team, the month-end close team, invoice coordinator, expense manager, bug reproduction, product performance, and the Granola illustration. Every official example stops for review.
2. SpaceXSI, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). A card saved in Vault can fill in at checkout without asking each time.
3. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Support,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-support (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “How SpaceXSI is using Grok Bot to scale customer support,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-customer-support (accessed 11 November 2026). The news piece is a vendor story, not an independent evaluation.
4. SpaceXSI, “Setting Grok Bot loose on procurement,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-procurement (accessed 11 November 2026). Savings figures in that article are vendor claims and are not treated as audited fact in this book.
5. SpaceXSI, “Using Grok Bot to detect and respond to incidents,” https://x.ai/news/incident-sweep (accessed 11 November 2026). Vendor story; production changes still behind a yes.
6. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Engineering,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-engineering (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Linear,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-linear (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for PMs,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-pms (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Giving every team a data scientist with Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/news/data-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). Guides and vendor news, not independent studies.
7. SpaceXSI, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Command-line credentials are shared; do not place a credential on the computer if another Bot should not use it. Separate Bots are not a security boundary.
8. SpaceXSI, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
9. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). Meetings availability: Team, Enterprise, and Ultra, as of that announcement. Chapter 15, “Bots on Your Human Team”, treats meetings more fully.
10. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026), marketplace prebuilts including Meeting Recap Deck. The “never invent a quote” rule is as those official descriptions state it, and is a teaching rule in this book in any case.

11. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Legal Ops,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-legal-ops (accessed 11 November 2026). Official guide; this book is not legal advice.
12. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot for Post-Sales,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/grok-bot-for-post-sales (accessed 11 November 2026). Official guide; contact with customers still behind a yes.
13. SpaceXSI, “Use cases · Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), Vendor Portal Operator and Security Questionnaire Filler. Official illustrations; submit and renew behind a yes, and do not invent answers.
14. SpaceXSI, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026), event triggers including Linear and GitHub. Keep listeners narrow, as Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”, taught.

Chapter 12 — A Small Fleet: Running a Publishing House with Bots

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026). Official group-chat advice is one Bot responsible for each step; check the Bot’s own chat for approvals. This book does not state a numeric cap on group size.
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026). A Bot can return files from the cloud computer’s filesystem. The EPUB, letter PDF, and markdown stack is the finish line I use at this press, not an official product requirement.
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). The official path is assistant, a Bot with one job, then a team of Bots; every official example stops for review.
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), on dr eggbot and asking a primary Bot to set up a team.
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026), “Pages.” Availability on Enterprise teams was described as not yet, as of 11 November 2026, and should be re-checked. A Friday note in chat is a complete alternative.
6. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Unattended approvals expire after about 30 minutes.

7. SpaceXSI, “How I run multiple teams of Grok Bots,” https://x.ai/bot/guides/how-i-run-multiple-teams-of-grok-bots (accessed 11 November 2026), by Eric Zakariasson, dated 27 August 2026. An official-site guide describing an experimental pattern; it is not this book’s required method, and a channel-size number offered there is the author’s own, not an official cap.

The SMF Works / WisdomForge fleet in this chapter is Michael’s own story, offered as a pattern, not a third-party case study, and is not given a source note as if it were.

Chapter 13 — Get Your Life Back: Admin, Family, Bills, and the Mental Load

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026). The Tradbot description on that page: “Watches your personal email and calendar so school forms, bills, and RSVPs don’t slip. Drafts the reply, catches the pickup clash, and never sends without you.”
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). “Every example stops for your review. Keep sending, publishing, purchasing, and production changes behind approval.”
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Google Calendar official illustration: “Every Sunday evening, reads the week ahead, flags clashes and packed days, and sends you a short plan for Monday.”
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). “For services without an app, a Bot uses the browser on the cloud computer.”
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). “A page is something a Bot builds for you to read, such as a report, a memo, a dashboard, a tracker, or an explainer.” You can ask a Bot to create or update a page from a routine.
6. SpaceXSI Docs, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026).
7. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). “Pages is rolling out gradually, and it isn’t available on Enterprise teams yet,” as of the documentation opened on 11 November 2026. The same page mentions desktop version 0.60.0 or later and phone version 1.14.0 or later. This will age; check the live docs.
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). The chat panel beside an open page is labeled “Message about” and the page’s title.

9. SpaceXSI Docs, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026). A new routine waits for its next scheduled time; schedules use the Bot’s time zone.

10. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Gmail official illustration: “Sorts the night’s mail before you’re up, drafts replies to the threads that need you, and leaves every draft for you to send.”

11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Official inbox-manager starter prompt: “Sort my unread email into urgent, needs a reply, and FYI. Draft replies to the urgent ones and don’t send anything.”

12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). “Every Bot on your account uses one persistent cloud computer.” “Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary.”

13. Dean Christensen, Basin Automations, “How I use Grok Bot to run my inbox and calendar,” https://www.basinautomations.com/blog/grok-bots/ (accessed 11 November 2026). An independent published account, not an official manual and not a measured study.

14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). Secrets belong in the Vault or a Secure Form, not in the chat.

15. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). “A card saved in Vault fills in at checkout without asking you each time, and no setting requires your approval for each use. If you want to approve every payment yourself, don’t save the card.”

16. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). Sites may ask for a new login, a CAPTCHA, or a code; the Bot should hand those steps to you.

17. This is a general caution about store reviews, not a citation of a particular review. See the research notes behind this book: dollar and medical claims in store reviews stay reviews, not facts.

18. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “Phone calls are available in the US only, from the Grok Bot desktop and phone apps.”

19. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot is now included with more plans,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-more-plans (accessed 11 November 2026). “Digital declutterer. Audits email, Drive, and paid subscriptions around the clock. Only discards or unsubscribes if you say so.”

20. SpaceXSI, “Use cases · Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Subscription Cleaner: “Collates receipt and newsletter mail, suggests what to kill, and unsubscribes what you approve.”

21. Dean Christensen, Basin Automations, “How I use Grok Bot to run my inbox and calendar,” https://www.basinautomations.com/blog/grok-bots/ (accessed 11 November 2026). His published account describes data-broker removals and a quarterly rerun, and the Do Not Call Registry. Results are the author’s, not a typical outcome I can promise.
22. I am not citing individual App Store or Google Play reviews here on purpose. Extraordinary claims in reviews are not facts, and this book is not medical advice.
23. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Official guidance includes looking up numbers that change, and not treating memory as a source of truth. Chapter 6 is the full treatment.
24. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Settings and notifications,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/settings-and-notifications (accessed 11 November 2026). You can turn off notifications for a Bot; on the phone, the switch is in the Bot’s profile, and on desktop you can ask the Bot to turn them off.
25. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Separate Bots are not a security boundary; they share one computer. The reason to split a bills Bot from a calendar Bot is a clear job, not a wall.

Chapter 14 — Errands That Finish: Travel, Shopping, Calls, and Returns

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). Official “Shop with a Bot” section: the gift row shows who it is for, your message, whether a gift receipt is included, and when it arrives. The pay button shows the total; Cancel charges nothing.
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Official travel-coordinator starter prompt: “Find flights to Austin for Thursday, back Sunday, with no red-eyes, and a hotel near downtown. Send me the two best options; don’t book anything.”
3. SpaceXSI, “Use cases · Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Travel Coordinator: “Compares flights and hotels to your rules, confirms before booking, and drops itinerary plus calendar.”
4. Dean Christensen, Basin Automations, “How I use Grok Bot to run my inbox and calendar,” https://www.basinautomations.com/blog/grok-bots/ (accessed 11 November 2026). His published account describes travel planning without booking. An independent account, not an official manual.
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troublesho

oting (accessed 11 November 2026). Sites may block automation, ask for a CAPTCHA, or require a new login; the Bot should hand those steps to you.

6. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). "A card saved in Vault fills in at checkout without asking you each time."
7. SpaceXSI Docs, "Message and collaborate," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). Official "Shop with a Bot" section, product cards: photos, options, "Why it fits," "Where to buy," "Buy now" or "Out of stock," and "Notify me," which sets a back-in-stock routine.
8. SpaceXSI Docs, "Message and collaborate," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). Official order-card contents and rules, including "Only a Bot's owner can pay its orders," and asking the Bot to check the price again if the card expires.
9. SpaceXSI Docs, "Message and collaborate," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). "If you cancel, nothing is charged."
10. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026).
11. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). "If you haven't saved one, the Bot first asks for a card with a Secure Form. A card you don't save there gets no order card; the Bot asks you to approve the exact total in the chat instead."
12. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). A batch of up to 500 card payments; the card lists each payment when there are 10 or fewer, and a summary line above that; after Pay, payments are made one at a time and stop if a card is declined; one approval covers payments for 24 hours; wallets such as Link or X Money need one order card per payment.
13. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). Settings → Vault lists Payment accounts, wallets such as Link or X Money, and a Default payment method.
14. SpaceXSI Docs, "Message and collaborate," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). "Phone calls are available in the US only, from the Grok Bot desktop and phone apps."
15. SpaceXSI Docs, "Message and collaborate," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). First-time calling terms; Accept or Decline; before each call, who it will call, Call or Cancel.
16. SpaceXSI Docs, "Message and collaborate," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). Live transcript; End call; Take over, with "Connecting you…" and "Transferred to you"; the question card with "Your answer" and Send or Skip; the Bot asks first before giving the call more details.

17. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). After the call: “Ended,” the length, transcript and recording; on desktop, Copy transcript, Export transcript, and Download recording under Call actions.
18. The official chat documentation states the calling terms you agree to, including consent. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). Research memo 05 also records the official point that the reader is responsible for who is called. This book is not legal advice.
19. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). “Approvals from work that started without you, like a routine or a message from another Bot, expire after about 30 minutes. Approvals in a chat you are in wait for you.”
20. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). Vault can hold logins, payment cards, and contact information such as shipping and billing addresses. A Bot can see contact info; it cannot see a saved password, card number, or security code.

Chapter 15 — Bots on Your Human Team: Team Bots, Slack, Meetings, and Group Chats

1. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826 (accessed 11 November 2026). The body of this book uses 11 November 2026 as the 1.0 date, from that official post and the news page. The official company timeline also lists “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0” on 2 November 2026; see SpaceXSI, “Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery,” https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “Bots can also join video calls and participate through the chat, bringing information from earlier conversations into the discussion. They keep track of decisions and learn more about the team’s work.”
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). “It won’t share your credentials in a meeting.”
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Opening definition: share with your Cursor team, your whole organization, or only certain people and groups; sharing doesn’t make a copy; each person’s chat is private.
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Team Bots are available on Team and Enterprise plans, for members who have Grok Bot.”

6. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “Team Bots are available on Team and Enterprise plans.”
7. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). “Meetings are available on Team, Enterprise, and Ultra plans.”
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Team Bots always run in the cloud. A Bot that runs on your own computer can’t be shared.”
9. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “If Browse Team Bots isn’t there, you aren’t on a Cursor team, or your Grok Bot app needs an update.”
10. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Create, publish, and share-an-existing-Bot steps, including “Only add keys and files you’re happy for everyone you share it with to use.”
11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Bot sharing” under “Sharing” is “Everyone” or “Admins only.”
12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “How do I share a Bot with my team?”
13. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “A Team Bot’s link opens the same Bot for everyone. It’s different from sharing a Bot template, which gives each person their own copy.”
14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “How do teammates find a Team Bot?”
15. SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). “Sharing a Bot is not a security boundary.” A public share link lets others copy configuration, not your computer or logins; still strip secrets.
16. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Can the owner see my chats with a Team Bot?” and “What does a Team Bot learn for the team?”
17. The rest of this section follows SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026), in particular “Whose apps and secrets does a Team Bot use?”, “How do shared connectors work?”, “Which computer does a Team Bot use?”, “Whose usage pays for a Team Bot chat?”, and “How do approvals work on a Team Bot?”
18. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Shared connectors and “Allow Shared Logins.”

19. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Which computer does a Team Bot use?”
20. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Whose usage pays for a Team Bot chat?”
21. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “How do approvals work on a Team Bot?”
22. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Settings > General > Team Bots, “Clear” next to “Clear connector preferences.”
23. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Grok Bot in Microsoft Teams,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/microsoft-teams (accessed 11 November 2026). “It works the way it does in Slack: it acts for the person who asked, uses their usage, and asks before risky actions.”
24. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “How do I add a Team Bot to Slack?” A personal Bot doesn’t hand work to other Bots from a channel thread; see also SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026).
25. SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “Who can talk to a Team Bot in Slack?”
26. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Grok Bot in Microsoft Teams,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/microsoft-teams (accessed 11 November 2026). Admin enablement, owner connect, Teams admin approval, setup of up to an hour, and the Link Account card.
27. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Grok Bot in Microsoft Teams,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/microsoft-teams (accessed 11 November 2026). “Why isn’t my Bot in Microsoft Teams?” table.
28. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “We’ve also added safeguards for working in shared spaces. Bots respect each person’s permissions, ask before taking sensitive actions, and check whether information is appropriate to share in a public channel.”
29. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026).
30. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). “Add to meeting” under “Suggested.”
31. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). “Upcoming,” the countdown, and “Taking notes.”
32. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). The transcribing display names, including the Team Bot form.
33. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). A Bot that follows your calendar can join scheduled meetings on its own; Cancel and Quit under Meeting actions.

34. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). Disable Interactivity, Muted, and the limit on turning it back on once the Bot is joining or in the call.

35. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). Meeting chat, Zoom private chat, conference-room devices, held-back requests, and credentials.

36. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). Summary and action items; a longer report on a page if you have Pages; transcripts on request; meetings use the settings of the person who started them.

37. SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026). “Can a Team Bot join meetings?” and the Enterprise admin control.

38. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “You can also add a Bot a teammate shared with you, but not alongside Bots that run on your own computer.”

39. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “In the To: field, add two to six Bots.”

40. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). Official kickoff example, quoted in the body.

41. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “Every Bot reply counts toward your usage, including replies in a group and messages between Bots, so fewer Bots in a group means fewer replies.”

42. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “Stop Bots from messaging each other”: “There is no switch for this.” The official instruction is to tell them in the chat, and to ask each to remember.

43. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “Approval requests, secret and login requests, and email or Slack drafts do not appear in a group.” Handoff messages in the group are text-only.

44. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026). “Keep replies in the group.”

45. SpaceXSI Docs, “Tag @bot on X,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/tag-on-x (accessed 11 November 2026). @bot’s short confirmation on X; work stays in the Grok Bot app; first-time notification that tagged requests start automatically and use usage.

46. SpaceXSI Docs, “Tag @bot on X,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/tag-on-x (accessed 11 November 2026). “Before you start” requirements, including “Bots that someone shares with you can’t take tagged requests.”

47. SpaceXSI Docs, “Tag @bot on X,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/tag-on-x (accessed 11 November 2026). “Where tagging is available,” as of the documentation opened on 11 November 2026. This can change; check the live page.
48. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026).
49. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026).
50. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “When someone teaches a Bot a better way to complete a task, that improvement can benefit everyone who uses it.”
51. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “New Bot settings and analytics. Manage what a Team Bot knows and see how your team uses it.”

Chapter 16 — Grok Bot Spans Agent Platforms

1. Nous Research, “Hermes Agent,” https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026); Nous Research, “Nous Research,” https://nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026); Nous Research, “nousresearch/hermes-agent,” https://github.com/nousresearch/hermes-agent (accessed 11 November 2026). Official product site, company site, and official repository. This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by Nous Research.
2. Nous Research, “Hermes Agent,” https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Official description: “The self-improving AI agent built by Nous Research.” Official FAQ: free and open source under the MIT license; “Model providers and optional hosted services have their own pricing.”
3. Nous Research, “Hermes Agent,” https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Official site: a CLI (the `hermes` command) and a Desktop app; channels including Telegram, Discord, Slack, WhatsApp, Signal, Email, and CLI.
4. Nous Research, “Nous Research,” https://nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Vendor wording on that site, including superlatives about use, is a vendor claim and is not asserted as fact in this book.
5. OpenClaw Foundation, “OpenClaw,” https://openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026); OpenClaw Foundation, “OpenClaw documentation,” https://docs.openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026); OpenClaw, “openclaw/openclaw,” https://github.com/openclaw/openclaw (accessed 11 November 2026). This book is not affiliated with or endorsed by the OpenClaw Foundation.
6. OpenClaw Foundation, “OpenClaw,” https://openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Homepage marketing phrases include “The AI that really does things” and “Your assistant,

on your own devices, in your chats." Quoted only as the site's wording, not as a guarantee.

7. OpenClaw Foundation, "OpenClaw," https://openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Official homepage: "No subscription. No hosted tier. No token." The OpenClaw Foundation describes itself as an independent US 501(c)(3). That status is reported here as the foundation's official-site statement, not as an independently verified IRS finding.

8. OpenClaw Foundation, "OpenClaw," https://openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026). Official materials list channels including WhatsApp, Telegram, Discord, Slack, Signal, iMessage, and Microsoft Teams, among others as documented. The CLI name `openclaw` is official. MIT licensed, officially.

9. SpaceXSI Docs, "Use the computer and apps," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). The quoted sentences about the cloud computer, the command line, shared command-line credentials, and "Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary" are official.

10. SpaceXSI Docs, "Skills and routines," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026). Official webhook trigger: POST URL, secret key, full header, `Authorization: Bearer <key>`, optional JSON body, 200 means accepted and started, not finished; test runs do real work. Taught in Chapter 8; used here, not reprinted as a second protocol.

11. SpaceXSI Docs, "Use the computer and apps," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Approvals, security, and privacy," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). "Command-line credentials are shared." "Do not place a credential or file on it if another Bot on your account should not be able to use it." "All of your Bots share one cloud computer."

12. This is a gap I am leaving open on purpose. Michael's described wiring is "via CLI." How Hermes or OpenClaw are installed on Grok Bot's computer, if they are, was not described and is not invented here.

13. Nous Research, "Hermes Agent," https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026). The official site describes additional product features such as persistent memory, scheduling, subagents, web access, and sandboxing. This book names them only to decline to teach them.

Chapter 17 — Safety, Privacy, Money, and What to Do When It Breaks

1. SpaceXSI Docs, "Troubleshooting," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). "If the Bot stopped replying and says you hit your usage limit, it isn't broken: your weekly usage is used up. It resets each week."

2. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11

November 2026). “Every Bot on your account uses one persistent cloud computer.” “Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary.”

3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). “A card saved in Vault fills in at checkout without asking you each time, and no setting requires your approval for each use.”

4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). “Approvals from work that started without you, like a routine or a message from another Bot, expire after about 30 minutes.”

5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Usage limits,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/usage-limits (accessed 11 November 2026). Under The X Subscription, Grok Bot draws from a weekly shared pool across Grok, Grok Bot, and Cursor.

6. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/news/introducing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). The 11 August 2026 announcement described Grok Bot as having its own usage, separate from Grok and Cursor plans.

7. SpaceXSI, “Introducing The X Subscription,” https://x.ai/news/x-subscription (accessed 11 November 2026).

8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

9. SpaceXSI, “Pricing: Compare Plans,” https://x.ai/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026). List prices as of that day, excluding tax, re-checked on 11 November 2026.

10. SpaceXSI Docs, “Usage limits,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/usage-limits (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Extra usage credits and top-ups,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/extra-usage (accessed 11 November 2026).

11. Official pages give multipliers (4×, 15×, 50× Plus) and point to the live dashboard. Exact weekly amounts in dollars or tokens are not published as a single public number.

12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). “A completed unification is permanent. It can’t be undone, and Support can’t undo it for you.” Switching is optional.

13. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Legacy Cursor and SuperGrok path, including that a SuperGrok link is permanent and that a Cursor plan and SuperGrok do not add together.

14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). Check usage at https://grok.com/dashboard.

15. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot on The X Subscription,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026). Before switching: https://cursor.com/dashboard. After switching: grok.com/dashboard, Usage.

16. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). “To keep going now, add prepaid credit (The X Subscription), turn on on-demand usage (legacy Cursor plans), or move to a bigger plan.” A Bot already working can finish past an on-demand monthly limit. This book does not recommend a particular upgrade.

17. Amanda Silberling, TechCrunch, “Elon Musk throttles Grok Bot limits due to ‘unsustainably high’ costs,” https://techcrunch.com/2026/11/02/elon-musk-throttles-grok-bot-limits-due-to-unsustainably-high-costs/ (accessed 11 November 2026); Robert Hart, The Verge, “Elon Musk appears to have throttled Grok Bot for being ‘unsustainably’ expensive,” https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/1024272/elon-musk-appears-to-have-throttled-grok-bot-for-being-unsustainably-expensive (accessed 11 November 2026). Journalism, dated 2 November 2026. The Musk quote is attributed to those reports of a 1 November 2026 X reply; the post itself was not opened in the research behind this chapter.

18. SpaceXSI Docs, “Extra usage credits and top-ups,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/extra-usage (accessed 11 November 2026). “Auto Top-up is optional and only runs after you enable it. Switching to The X Subscription doesn’t turn it on for you.”

19. SpaceXSI Docs, “Extra usage credits and top-ups,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/extra-usage (accessed 11 November 2026). Prepaid credit and the monthly additional usage limit are separate controls.

20. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). “The cap does not stop a Bot in the middle of a run, so a running task can go a little past it.”

21. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). “On The X Subscription, leave Auto Top-up off or set a monthly additional usage limit under Additional usage credits at https://grok.com/dashboard/billing.”

22. SpaceXSI Docs, “Usage limits,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/usage-limits (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Extra usage credits and top-ups,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/extra-usage (accessed 11 November 2026).

23. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Legacy cap path.

24. SpaceXSI Docs, “Message and collaborate,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/chat-and-collaboration (accessed 11 November 2026).

25. SpaceXSI Docs, “Usage limits,” https://docs.x.ai/x-subscription/usage-limits (accessed 11 November 2026). “Usage rates vary by product.”

26. Independent published caution, including Brooke Wright, Wright Mode, “How to use Grok Bot: from your first bot to a bot team,” https://www.wrightmode.com/blog/how-to-use-

grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026), and the journalism in note 17. Not a measured study, and not an official number.

27. The "prefer a connector" habit is practice consistent with official advice to connect everyday tools, and with usage that varies by product. If a single official sentence prefers a connector over clicking in so many words, I have not treated it as a load-bearing quote here.

28. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Prepaid credit already spent is not refundable, on The X Subscription path as the FAQ describes.

29. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). "Grok Bot does not have a separate subscription, so it does not have a separate refund path."

30. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Grok Bot for Mobile," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/mobile (accessed 11 November 2026). App Store free trial turns into a paid Apple subscription unless you cancel first.

31. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). "Start Trial": a usage credit and a 7-day window; "It never turns into a paid plan." "One big task can use all of it, and used credit is not restored."

32. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Approvals, security, and privacy," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026).

33. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Get started," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started (accessed 11 November 2026). Grok Bot requires cloud data storage; Legacy Privacy Mode is not supported.

34. SpaceXSI Docs, "Grok Bot security FAQ," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/security-faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Read current official security pages for enterprise and on-prem questions; this book does not invent a capability.

35. SpaceXSI, "AI teammates that finish the work | Grok Bot," https://x.ai/bot (accessed 11 November 2026). Product-page FAQ wording about encryption in transit and at rest, and training opt-out: vendor wording on the product page.

36. SpaceXSI Docs, "Approvals, security, and privacy," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). "Review the current Cursor Privacy Policy and security information for contractual details."

37. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Sub-processors: the FAQ points to trust.cursor.com/subprocessors. SpaceXSI, "Privacy Policy," https://x.ai/legal/privacy-policy (accessed 11 November 2026).

38. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). "How do I delete my Grok Bot account?" Deletion deletes the Cursor

account; data removed within 30 days; store and linked subscriptions cancelled separately.

39. SpaceXSI Docs, "Approvals, security, and privacy," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). "Understand the shared-computer boundary."

40. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). "Vault covers your whole account: everything you save is available to every Bot on your account, and you can't limit an item to one Bot."

41. SpaceXSI Docs, "Vault and secure sign-in," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026).

42. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026).

43. SpaceXSI Docs, "Troubleshooting," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). "An approval expired or is blocked."

44. SpaceXSI Docs, "Approvals, security, and privacy," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). Auto Review can be turned off, which removes the checks.

45. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). "Add narrow Ask first rules for actions such as sending, publishing, deleting, purchasing, or changing production systems."

46. SpaceXSI Docs, "How Grok Bot Works," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026). "Only your own messages count as instructions." "These checks lower the risk from harmful content, but they don't remove it." Keep Ask first on anything you can't undo.

47. SpaceXSI Docs, "Frequently asked questions," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, "Approvals, security, and privacy," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). "The link exposes the Bot's configuration. Strip secrets and anything confidential before you share."

48. SpaceXSI, "Brand Guidelines," https://x.ai/legal/brand-guidelines (accessed 11 November 2026). Use marks only to accurately refer to the company or its services; do not imply endorsement. The observation about non-commercial use is not legal advice and not a clearance of this book's title.

49. SpaceXSI Docs, "Troubleshooting," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026).

50. SpaceXSI Docs, "Troubleshooting," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). "Your usage limit is reached."

51. SpaceXSI Docs, "Troubleshooting," https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). "Is Grok Bot down?" status.cursor.com, the Grok Bot row; do not Reset or reinstall during a service incident.

52. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026).
53. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). Expired approvals; Ask first takes precedence over Allow automatically.
54. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). “A routine did not run.” Test runs can perform real external actions.
55. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). A routine not paused that hasn’t run for 24 hours or more with no error: report a bug with the Bot name and routine details.
56. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). “A Bot appears stuck.”
57. SpaceXSI Docs, “Troubleshooting,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/troubleshooting (accessed 11 November 2026). “Before contacting support.” Email support@x.ai from the email on the account. Do not include passwords, one-time codes, private keys, or secret values.

Chapter 18 — A Practice That Lasts: Initiative, Pages, Connectors, Templates, and Mastery

1. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826 (accessed 11 November 2026). This book uses 11 November 2026 in the body. The official company timeline also lists “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0” on 2 November 2026; see SpaceXSI, “Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery,” https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026). “Your Bot doesn’t only wait for instructions.” “You stay in charge: it offers first and asks before risky actions.”
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026). “What does my Bot do without being asked?”: offers to take on work; flags problems with your apps; follows up in X Chat.
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026). “Which Bot reaches out to me?” The primary Bot is marked with a star; a Team Bot can’t be your primary Bot; a Team Bot can still ask in a Slack thread and tag you.
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026). “It offers first. When you say yes, it does the work the same way it does any task you give it, and it asks before risky actions.”

6. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “Proactive teammates” paragraph, including the product-launch example, which is the company’s illustration.

7. SpaceXSI Docs, “When Your Bot Takes Initiative,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/initiative (accessed 11 November 2026). “Notifications control alerts, not the check-ins themselves. If you’d like your Bot’s check-ins turned off, contact support.”

8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). “A page is something a Bot builds for you to read.” You can ask a Bot to create or update a page from a routine.

9. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). “Bots produce better documents and slide decks, and can now create interactive Pages that you can edit together or ask them to keep updated.”

10. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). “Pages is rolling out gradually, and it isn’t available on Enterprise teams yet,” as of the documentation opened on 11 November 2026, with the version numbers given there.

11. This is GAPS item 14. The Enterprise caveat is dated 11 November 2026 and should be re-checked; it is not asserted as permanent.

12. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). “When the Bot updates a page, the earlier card in the chat says Updated below.”

13. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). The Bot posts a card with the page’s title and “Open.”

14. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). The chat panel beside an open page is labeled “Message about” and the page’s title. The page fills the window on desktop.

15. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). “Filters, switches, and other controls on a page change what you see, not what the page holds. Nothing you do on the page is saved. To change the page itself, ask the Bot.”

16. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026). Share options, including “Anyone with the link,” which needs no sign-in, at an address on pages.grok.bot; “share a page this way only when it holds nothing private.” “Public sharing is off on Enterprise teams.”

17. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Everyday-app examples, and the browser on the cloud computer for services without an app.

18. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026). “Grok Bot supports custom tooling, so it can interact with any MCP or API.”
19. SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026). If an app isn’t in the catalog, ask a Bot to connect the app’s MCP server. If the service has an API but no MCP server, tinkabot “wraps the API in a plugin with an MCP server and skills, tests it, and publishes it only when you say so.”
20. SpaceXSI Docs, “Connectors,” https://docs.x.ai/grok/connectors (accessed 11 November 2026). This is Grok’s connectors documentation, which this chapter distinguishes from Grok Bot’s Connect apps.
21. SpaceXSI Docs, “Connectors,” https://docs.x.ai/grok/connectors (accessed 11 November 2026), on custom MCP for Grok, notes that a server must be reachable over the public internet. I am not treating that page as a Grok Bot setup guide, and I am not writing a tunneling how-to.
22. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). “They do not get your computer, logins, or conversation history.”
23. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026). “A public link can be opened by anyone who has it and exposes the Bot’s shared configuration: its identity, description, skills, and routines. Remove API keys, internal URLs, customer data, and anything else you would not put in a public document before you share.”
24. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026). A new template link is public; team limits; Enterprise teams start with template sharing limited to the team.
25. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Adding a shared template accepts the third-party bot terms. “Shared templates are created by other users, not by Grok Bot.”
26. SpaceXSI, “Grok Bot Marketplace,” https://x.ai/bot/marketplace (accessed 11 November 2026).
27. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026). Official Share, Create a copy, Publish, Copy link path; on a phone, “Share as Template.”
28. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026). After publish: View template details, Update template, Delete Template.
29. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Team Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/team-bots (accessed 11 November 2026). A template is a copy; a Team Bot is one Bot the team talks to.

30. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Hide from sidebar if you may need the work later. Deletion erases profile, conversations, memory, routines, and attachments, and cannot be undone; files and sign-ins on the shared computer can remain and should be cleaned up separately.

Appendix B — Cookbook

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026), including the official “Weekly account health” save prompt, the six-part skill list, Teach a Task, routine creation, Slack and webhook triggers, and the warning that test runs perform real work.
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “Create and manage Bots,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots (accessed 11 November 2026), “What a Bot remembers” and “Memory is not a source of truth”; SpaceXSI Docs, “How Grok Bot Works,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/how-grok-bot-works (accessed 11 November 2026).
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use Cases,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026). Official starter prompts and official teams (campaign, month-end, support queue). Every official example stops for review.
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026), “Can I show a Bot how I do a task?” Rollout may be gradual; recordings are limited to ten minutes. This book does not claim the feature is on every plan.
5. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026), “Give your Bots an email address.”
6. SpaceXSI, “Use cases · Grok Bot,” https://x.ai/bot/use-cases (accessed 11 November 2026), including Sales Outbound, Security Questionnaire Filler, and Vendor Portal Operator.
7. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). A saved card can pay without asking. Vault is S056 in this book’s source list.
8. SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026). Command-line credentials are shared; separate Bots are not a security boundary.
9. SpaceXSI Docs, “Grok Bot,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview (accessed 11 November 2026), marketplace prebuilts including Meeting Recap Deck. “Never invent a quote” is as those official descriptions state it, and is a teaching rule in this book in any case.
10. SpaceXSI, “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Add a Bot to Your Meetings,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-

bot/meetings (accessed 11 November 2026).

11. SpaceXSI Docs, “Files and results,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results (accessed 11 November 2026), “Pages.” Enterprise availability was “not yet” as of 11 November 2026; re-check.

Appendix C — Checklists

1. SpaceXSI Docs, “Vault and secure sign-in,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/vault (accessed 11 November 2026). Vault is S056 in this book’s source list. A saved card can pay without asking.
2. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Use the computer and apps,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps (accessed 11 November 2026). “Do not use separate Bots as a security boundary.” Command-line credentials are shared.
3. SpaceXSI Docs, “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI Docs, “Approvals, security, and privacy,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy (accessed 11 November 2026). Unattended approvals expire after about 30 minutes.
4. SpaceXSI Docs, “Skills and routines,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations (accessed 11 November 2026), “If a routine hasn’t run,” test runs, rate limits, and the documented known issue. Chapter 8, “Routines That Run While Your Laptop Is Closed”, sits with these fully.

Appendix E — Names, Trademarks, and Sources

1. For the naming evidence behind this section, see the official site and company pages at https://x.ai/ and https://x.ai/company; SpaceXSI, “xAI joins SpaceX,” https://x.ai/news/xai-joins-spacex; the App Store and Google Play listings for Grok Bot; and SpaceXSI Docs, “Get started,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/get-started, and “Frequently asked questions,” https://docs.x.ai/grok-bot/faq (all accessed 11 November 2026). Journalism’s “SpaceXAI” spelling appears in, among others, Jess Weatherbed, “Grok is now an AI ‘teammate’ you can assign work,” The Verge, 12 August 2026, https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/978666/spacexai-grok-bot-ai-agent-beta-launch (accessed 11 November 2026).
2. SpaceXSI, “Brand Guidelines,” 14 February 2025, https://x.ai/legal/brand-guidelines (accessed 11 November 2026).
3. Whether a particular book title is lawful fair use is a counsel question. This appendix is not a legal opinion.
4. SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), “Introducing Grok Bot 1.0,” https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826 (accessed 11 November 2026); SpaceXSI, “Intro-

ducing Grok Bot 1.0," https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026). For the timeline's 2 November 2026 listing, see SpaceXSI, "Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery," https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026).

Bibliography

The list below includes only sources actually cited in the notes. Entries follow Chicago's notes-bibliography style, with access dates of 11 November 2026. Official documentation and vendor pages are listed under the name the page itself uses. Journalism is listed under the reporter and the outlet.

Apple App Store / X Corp. (seller); copyright Anysphere Inc., "Grok Bot App - App Store," 11 August 2026. https://apps.apple.com/us/app/grok-bot/id6794501026 (accessed 11 November 2026).

Basin Automations (Dean Christensen), "How I use Grok Bot to run my inbox and calendar," 20 October 2026. https://www.basinautomations.com/blog/grok-bots/ (accessed 11 November 2026).

Cursor Forum, "Grok Bot is Now Live on Android," https://forum.cursor.com/t/grok-bot-is-now-live-on-android/170384 (accessed 11 November 2026).

Google Play / SpaceX Super Intelligence, "Grok Bot - Apps on Google Play," 8 November 2026. https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=ai.x.grok.bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

Nous Research, "Hermes Agent (official site)," https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/ (accessed 11 November 2026).

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Nous Research / GitHub, "nousresearch/hermes-agent (official repository)," https://github.com/nousresearch/hermes-agent (accessed 11 November 2026).

OpenClaw / GitHub, "openclaw/openclaw (official repository)," https://github.com/openclaw/openclaw (accessed 11 November 2026).

OpenClaw Foundation, "OpenClaw (official site)," https://openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026).

OpenClaw Foundation, "OpenClaw documentation," https://docs.openclaw.ai/ (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceX Super Intelligence, "@SpaceXSI profile," https://x.com/SpaceXSI (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), "Grok 4.6 is available today in Grok Build, Cursor, Grok

Bot, and the API.," 12 August 2026. https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2087562804194902477 (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceX Super Intelligence (@SpaceXSI), "Introducing Grok Bot 1.0. (official post)," 11 November 2026. https://x.com/SpaceXSI/status/2120584928983441826 (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "AI teammates that finish the work," https://x.ai/bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Brand Guidelines," 14 February 2025. https://x.ai/legal/brand-guidelines (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Company: Accelerating Scientific Discovery," https://x.ai/company (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Designing Grok Bot for a world of persistent agents," 3 September 2026. https://x.ai/news/designing-grok-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Giving every team a data scientist with Grok Bot," 2 November 2026. https://x.ai/news/data-bot (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot Guides," https://x.ai/bot/guides (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot Marketplace," https://x.ai/bot/marketplace (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot for Enterprise," 3 September 2026. https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-for-enterprise (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot is now included with more plans," 26 August 2026. https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-more-plans (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Grok Bot now works with X," 29 August 2026. https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-and-x (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "How SpaceXSI is using Grok Bot to scale customer support," 22 September 2026. https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-customer-support (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Introducing Grok Bot 1.0," 2 November 2026. https://x.ai/news/grok-bot-1-0 (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Introducing The X Subscription," 12 October 2026. https://x.ai/news/x-subscription (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Pricing: Compare Plans," https://x.ai/pricing (accessed 11 November 2026).

SpaceXSI, "Privacy Policy," https://x.ai/legal/privacy-policy (accessed 11 November 2026).

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